# The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Meeting of the Father and the Son

Āryapitāputrasamāgamananāmamahāyānasūtra · Toh 60 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ཡབ་དང་སྲས་མཇལ་བ་ཞེས་བ་ཐུ་ཐེག་པ་ཆེན་པོའི་མདོ།

The Meeting of the Father and the Son, known in Sanskrit as the Pitāputrasamāgamana Sūtra and in Tibetan as Yab dang sras mjal ba, is a Great Vehicle sūtra that also bears the subtitle "the Definitive Teaching on Reality." It recounts the Buddha's meeting with his father, King Śuddhodana, along with members of the Śākya clan, an occasion on which the Buddha teaches the ultimate nature of things, emptiness and the true character of reality, to those assembled. The work opens in the classic sūtra manner, with homage to the buddhas, bodhisattvas, śrāvakas, and pratyekabuddhas, and a description of the Blessed One surrounded by a retinue of liberated, tamed, and peaceful disciples. It is Toh 60 in the Kangyur, where it forms the sixteenth chapter of the Heap of Jewels, or Ratnakūṭa, collection of sūtras, and it became an influential scriptural source for later Indian and Tibetan discussions of emptiness.

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From the Noble Great Heap of Jewels, the Dharma discourse in one hundred thousand chapters, the sixteenth chapter: The Noble Meeting of the Father and the Son, the Definitive Teaching on Reality. The first fascicle.

In the language of India: ārya pitāputra samāgaman nāma mahāyānasūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Meeting of the Father and the Son.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas, and to the noble śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, the Buddha, was liberated, with a retinue of the liberated; tamed, with a retinue of the tamed; at peace, with a retinue of those at peace; crossed over, with a retinue of those who had crossed over; gone beyond, with a retinue of those gone beyond; arrived on firm ground, with a retinue of those who had arrived on firm ground; come to relief, with a retinue of those who had come to relief. He was a monk, with a retinue of monks; a destroyer of afflictions, with a retinue of destroyers of afflictions; a renunciant (śramaṇa), with a retinue of renunciants; one who had removed evil, with a retinue of those who had removed evil; a true brahmin, with a retinue of true brahmins; one whose nature was to have removed evil,

with a retinue of those whose nature was to have removed evil; possessed of knowledge, with a retinue of those possessed of knowledge; one who had bathed, with a retinue of those who had bathed; a proclaimer, with a retinue of proclaimers; purified of afflictions, with a retinue of those purified of afflictions.

He had eliminated the five factors, with a retinue of those who had eliminated the five factors; he was free of obscurations, with a retinue of those free of obscurations; his mind was clear, with a retinue of those whose minds were clear; he was endowed with the six factors, with a retinue of those endowed with the six factors; he was free of attachment and aversion, with a retinue of those free of attachment and aversion; he had the single guard, with a retinue of those with the single guard; he was perfect in guarding the door of mindfulness, with a retinue of those perfect in guarding the door of mindfulness; he was endowed with the four reliances, with a retinue of those endowed with the four reliances; he had eliminated partial truths, with a retinue of those who had eliminated partial truths; he had abandoned seeking, with a retinue of those who had abandoned seeking.

He had reached the end, with a retinue of those who had reached the end; he had arrived at the ultimate goal, with a retinue of those who had arrived at the ultimate goal; he had cultivated himself, with a retinue of those who had cultivated themselves; he was free of the turbidity of conceptualizing, with a retinue of those free of the turbidity of conceptualizing; his conceptual thought was completely cut off, with a retinue of those whose conceptual thought was completely cut off; his bodily formations were fully stilled, with a retinue of those whose bodily formations were fully stilled; he was intent upon the unshakable, with a retinue of those intent upon the unshakable; his mind was fully liberated, with a retinue of those whose minds were fully liberated; his wisdom was fully liberated, with a retinue of those whose wisdom was fully liberated. He was a noble one, with a retinue of noble ones, free of the faults of branches, leaves, petals, shoots, and bark, pure, established in the heartwood.

He was dwelling in the land of the Śākyas, at Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park, together with a great Saṅgha of twelve hundred and fifty monks, among them the group of five, Yaśas, Udāyin, Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, Gayā Kāśyapa, Nadī Kāśyapa, Mahākāśyapa, Śāriputra, and Maudgalyāyana. All of them were arhats. Their defilements were exhausted, they were without afflictions, and they had gained mastery. Their minds were fully liberated and their wisdom was fully liberated. They were thoroughbreds, great elephants; they had done what was to be done, accomplished their task, and laid down the burden. They

had attained their own goal, and their fetters to existence were utterly exhausted. Their minds were fully liberated through perfect knowledge, and they had reached the supreme perfection of mastery over all minds. He was with these, every one of this kind.

At that time, at the break of dawn, the Blessed One was seated in the open air, surrounded by the Saṅgha of monks, and with the Saṅgha of monks gazing at him from in front. Then the Blessed One, remaining silent, looked upon the entire Saṅgha of monks, who were silent. Having looked upon the entire Saṅgha of monks, he said to the monks, "Monks, find some monk of such a kind that he can bring King Śuddhodana to faith."

Then the venerable Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and placed his right knee on the ground. Bowing with palms joined toward the Blessed One, he said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, I shall bring King Śuddhodana to faith."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said to the venerable Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya, "Kauṇḍinya, you are one who should be endowed with the qualities of one held in the very highest esteem, so remain seated."

Likewise the venerable Vāṣpa, Mahānāman, Yaśas, Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, Nadī Kāśyapa, Gayā Kāśyapa, Mahākāśyapa, the venerable Śāriputra, and Mahāmaudgalyāyana also said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, I shall bring King Śuddhodana to faith."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Maudgalyāyana, you too are one who should be endowed with the qualities of one held in the very highest esteem, so remain seated."

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana thought, "Which monk does the Blessed One wish to bring King Śuddhodana to faith?" Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana entered into meditative equipoise in a samādhi of that kind. With his mind in equipoise in this way, he saw that the Blessed One's intention rested on the venerable Udāyin, and that his intention was, "This monk Udāyin will bring King Śuddhodana to faith." It was like this. Suppose that in a multistoried house, or in the courtyard of a multistoried house whose door faces north, the rays of the sun came through an eastern window and shone upon the western wall. In just the same way, at that time the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana saw the Blessed One's intention shining upon the venerable Udāyin, and saw that his intention was, "This monk Udāyin will bring

King Śuddhodana to faith."

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana rose from that samādhi, went to where the venerable Udāyin was, and said to the venerable Udāyin, "Venerable Udāyin, the Blessed One intends and wishes this concerning you: 'The monk Udāyin is able to bring King Śuddhodana to faith.' Venerable Udāyin, since that is so, arouse your confidence to bring King Śuddhodana to faith."

When he had said this, the venerable Udāyin said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, families are extremely hard to bring to faith, and royal families are harder still. Why is that? Because kings, kṣatriyas anointed on the crown of the head, are hard to please. Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, it is like this. Suppose there were ten loads of firewood, or twenty, or thirty, or forty, or fifty, or even a hundred loads of firewood, without any moisture, dry, and many years old, and someone set fire to it. A great mass of fire would blaze up. If someone then poured butter or sesame oil on it, that mass of fire would blaze far greater than before, and to go on top of it or into its immediate surroundings would be extremely hard. Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, in just the same way, kings, kṣatriyas anointed on the crown of the head, are hard to please. Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, it is like this. Just as it is extremely hard to go between the teeth of a tusked elephant whose mouth is gaping open, venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, in just the same way, kings, kṣatriyas anointed on the crown of the head, are hard to please."

When he had said this, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana said to the venerable Udāyin, "Venerable Udāyin, that is indeed so. Nevertheless, the Blessed One intends and wishes this concerning you: 'This monk Udāyin is able to bring King Śuddhodana to faith.'"

He said, "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, does the Blessed One intend me to bring King Śuddhodana to faith?"

He said, "Venerable Udāyin, it is so. The Blessed One intends, 'The monk Udāyin will bring King Śuddhodana to faith.'"

Then the Blessed One himself said to the venerable Udāyin, "Udāyin, bring King Śuddhodana to faith. Why is that? Udāyin, King Śuddhodana is to be brought to faith either by me or else by you. Udāyin, among all my śrāvakas, however many there are, you are in this way the foremost of those who bring families to faith."

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Udāyin in verse:

"Good Udāyin, listen to me.
Since you are the very foremost at bringing families to faith,
Swiftly bring to faith the noblest of kings,
Who gives joy to the Śākya clans.
If that supreme king is brought to faith,
Son of good family, for gods and for humans
Good will come that has no end and no middle;
So swiftly bring the noblest of men to faith.
At present that lord of the Śākyas
Is stirred up and undone by thoughts of overweening pride;
Like a boulder rolling from a mountainside,
He remains, having cast off all diligence and striving.
Because he keeps recalling his lost sovereignty,
His mind is wounded, and he loses heart and mind.
Just as merchants parted from their wealth
Keep recalling it and dwell in torment,
And as gods, dying and passing from the abodes of the gods,
Keep recalling the divine riches they desire,
So, not truly knowing the teaching of the Victor,
The king, his happiness lost, utters pitiful laments.
Recalling his seven kinds of precious things,
The four human excellences,
And his enjoyments,
That lord of the earth utters pitiful laments.
Just as when a man is overpowered
By a mighty rākṣasa who steals the vital luster,
He knows neither himself nor others,
So too is that lord of the earth.
Just as people hidden behind Kailāsa, the mountain of snow,
Do not see what is to be seen,
So, being hidden by great pride,
The king does not see what should be seen.
A man fallen asleep or crazed by a death
Does not know even his own mind;
So, being intoxicated by great pride,
That king too does not know what is virtuous."

Just as a woman, maddened by her husband's death,
Cries out in pitiful laments,
So too, intoxicated by his great pride,
That king also cries out in pitiful laments.
Therefore, Udāyin, you who are skilled in means,
You must bring the king to faith here.
Bring down the banner of pride
And raise the sublime banner of the Dharma.
Udāyin, apart from you, among the beings in existence
There is no one who shares your fortune and your conduct,
So there is no monk at all
Who could bring the king's mind to faith.

Udāyin, long ago, in times past,
There lived a lord of the earth
Whose name was Truth Increaser,
A renowned protector of the land.
He was a Dharma king, endowed with Dharma,
Honored by koṭis upon koṭis of living beings.
This earth, reaching to the ocean's shores,
Was ruled by that righteous king.
Its villages and towns stood close together,
Filled with fruit trees rich in fruit and flowers.
It was filled with noble people
And with humans free of wrongdoing.
It was full of many hundreds of gandharvas;
No thorny stalks, no noxious grass or trees were found.
It was soft, adorned with clusters of ascetics' dwellings,
And beautified by rivers with easy fords.
Hundreds of bands of sages roamed there,
And everywhere the people practiced bright deeds.
The evil paths to the lower realms were cut off,
And so all beings longed for the abodes of the gods.

That king had a son
Who had seen the buddhas who appeared in the past;
He had developed roots of virtue
And possessed an intelligence imbued with many qualities.
His name was Matigarbha,

Honored by koṭis upon koṭis of living beings.
He saw the faults in sense pleasures,
And though he lived in the house of the lord of men, he delighted in solitude.

The king called Truth Increaser
Set bands of young women all around him,
And said, "In this splendid house, like a palace of the gods,
Enjoy the fine pleasures of the senses.
Excellent son, whatever you wished,
What have I not done for you?
Why is your mind not drawn to pleasures?
Tell me quickly, my son.
Become skilled in the delights of worldly existence;
Son, take joy in this precious house.
Keep company with a retinue of precious women;
Delight in the objects of the senses and grow fond of them.
Even sages who dwell in forests of austerity
Leave them and come back again to these things;
They give up their austerities and enjoy the delights of pleasure.
These pleasures are laid out for you, my only son;
Therefore enjoy the delights of pleasure.
I and the whole kingdom are at one with you.
In this house adorned with celestial mansions,
Like the abode of Vaiśravaṇa, take your pleasure.
These women too are of supreme beauty,
Like goddesses, perfected in the arts,
Skilled in the ways of music and in song,
Accomplished in attendance, their charms captivating the mind.
Their eyes are like lotus petals,
Their lips lovely and charming, the color of the bimba fruit.
Their teeth and complexions are flawless and fine,
Their foreheads and brows are lovely and their necks graceful.
Their thighs are like an elephant's trunk,
Their shoulders full, their upper arms shapely.
The palms of their hands and the soles of their feet are copper-colored,
Their fingers and calves slender and fine.
Their tongues, copper-hued, are thin and clean,

And their way of speaking is measured and gentle.
Their teeth are well set, without any gaps,
Their eyeteeth brilliant white, the finest adornment.
Their bellies are smooth, their navels lovely,
Their hips broad and their waists like a vajra.
Their calves are like elephant tusks,
Like the well-grown pith of a reed.
Their gait is like that of a proud elephant.
Thinking of no one else, they gaze at you with all their hearts.
They long to play and are in the bloom of youth.
Young prince, look on them with compassion and show them love.
Dear son, the fine complexions and the youthful bloom
Of you and of these women
Will fall like flowers from the treetop.
So give up your pride and indulge in pleasure."

Then Matigarbha spoke thus
To his lamenting father and to all the retinue:
"Father, what you say is sincere;
Truly, your words bring no reproach upon your good name.
Yet hear my words, O king, inclined toward true qualities,
Pondered and well settled.
Hear how, even in my dreams,
My mind takes no delight in pleasures and is not drawn to them.
These things the lord of the earth has said
Do not appeal to the wise.
Foolish people think them right,
But the wise always disparage them.
For what reason would one who is not blind
Take a wrong road at the word of the blind?
Who, standing on dry land, would ever
Long to be helplessly swept away by water?
How would one who is free
Enter that prison at the word of one in chains?
How would one standing on level ground, unconfused,
Long for a perilous place?
Lord of the earth, one attached to pleasures,

Swept away by the waters of sensual enjoyment,
I regard as like the blind, like one swept away by water,
Like one in prison, like one in a perilous place.
Lord of men, you are like the blind;
I have eyes and see the difference.
You are swept away by the river of desire;
I utterly reject all pleasures.
Pleasures are like poisonous leaves;
Like the head of a snake, they bring suffering;
They are like a trident, a sword, a short spear,
Like a mass of fire blazing fiercely."

Thus Matigarbha spoke
To his lamenting father and the retinue,
And paying no heed to the seven precious things,
He renounced the kingdom and went forth.
As a snake casts off its old skin,
He cast it away like discarded mucus and ashes;
Matigarbha, without attachment,
Free of all wrongdoing, went forth.
When the prince had thus gone forth,
A minister's son followed him into homelessness;
His name was Candradatta,
And he went forth after Matigarbha.
When the prince had thus gone forth,
He developed the four abodes of Brahmā (brahmavihāras),
And together with his companion
He brought forth the five higher knowledges, complete and entire.
Because he saw the faults in pleasures,
That lion among men passed beyond the desire realm.
In order to attain the true state of Brahmā,
He turned the wheel of Brahmā.
When the prince had gone forth in this way,
The father lost faith in his son,
And Candradatta went to him and

and delighted him with well-spoken words.
Udāyin, what do you think of that?

Do you think that Essence of Intellect at that time was someone else?
At that time I myself was he,
who did not pursue the enjoyments of sensual pleasure.
Udāyin, what do you think of that?
Do you think that Increase of Truth was someone else?
This very lord of men, Śuddhodana, at that time
was the king called Increase of Truth.
Udāyin, what do you think of that?
Do you think that Candradatta, who went forth after him, was someone else?
You yourself, at that time, on that occasion,
were the one who brought Increase of Truth to faith.
Therefore, Udāyin, you must here
awaken faith in King Śuddhodana.
If this protector of the earth comes to faith,
great happiness and prosperity will come about.

Then the venerable Udāyin assented to the Blessed One by remaining silent. When that night had passed, in the morning, the venerable Udāyin put on his robe and lower garment, took up his alms bowl, and went to the great city of Kapilavastu.

At that time King Śuddhodana was seated before the assembly of his queens, gathered together with about a thousand Śākyas on a certain matter of business. King Śuddhodana had heard that the Blessed One had come to Kapilavastu and was staying in Kapilavastu itself, in the Nyagrodha Park, and he thought: "Because that prince went forth, I have been deprived of great sovereign wealth. Had that prince remained in the household, he would have become a wheel-turning king, victorious over the four quarters, righteous, a Dharma king possessing the seven precious things. These are his seven precious things: the precious wheel, the precious elephant, the precious horse, the precious jewel, the precious woman, the precious householder, and the precious minister; these are the seven. He would have had a full thousand sons, heroic, valiant, endowed with the finest bodily form, crushers of opposing armies. He would have subdued this world system of four great continents without punishment and without driving it by weapons, evenly and without unevenness, in harmony with the Dharma, and would have protected it well for a full eon. Had that come to pass, we too would have held sovereign power in the realm of a wheel-turning king; we would have been served,

honored, respected and worshiped, and we would have gained great sovereign power as well. But now, because that prince went forth, we have been parted from such great power and wealth."

Having thought this, he commanded the Śākyas: "No one is to go to see my son or to wait upon him. If anyone goes to see my son or to wait upon him, he will be punished with bodily harm."

At that time a Śākya youth called Joyful Face rose from that assembly and went out. When the Śākya youth Joyful Face saw the venerable Udāyin coming from far off, he went to where the venerable Udāyin was, greeted the venerable Udāyin warmly, and said: "Come here, venerable Udāyin! Welcome, venerable Udāyin! It is a long time since you came, venerable Udāyin. Venerable Udāyin, is the Blessed One free from illness? Is he strong? Does he dwell at ease? Is he free from discomfort? Is nothing troubling him? Did the Blessed One travel in comfort? Is he not too weary? Is he not worn out by the alms round?"

When he had said this, the venerable Udāyin said to the Śākya youth Joyful Face: "Joyful Face, it is so. The Blessed One is free from illness. He is strong. He dwells at ease. He is free from discomfort. Nothing troubles him. He traveled in comfort. He is not weary. He is not worn out by the alms round."

The Śākya youth Well Awakened, too, seeing the Śākya youth Joyful Face seated in a secluded place with the venerable Udāyin, rose from that assembly, went to where the venerable Udāyin was, greeted the venerable Udāyin warmly, and said: "Come here, venerable Udāyin! Welcome, venerable Udāyin! It is a long time since you came, venerable Udāyin. Venerable Udāyin, is the Blessed One free from illness? Is he strong? Does he dwell at ease? Is he free from discomfort? Is nothing troubling him? Did the Blessed One travel in comfort? Is he not too weary? Is he not worn out by the alms round?"

When he had said this, the venerable Udāyin said to the Śākya youth Well Awakened: "Well Awakened, it is so. The Blessed One is free from illness. He is strong. He dwells at ease. He is free from discomfort. Nothing troubles him. He traveled in comfort. He is not weary. He is not worn out by the alms round."

The Śākya youths Aśoka and Vigataśoka, too, seeing the venerable Udāyin, the Śākya youth Joyful Face and the Śākya youth Well Awakened seated in a secluded place, went to where the venerable Udāyin was, greeted the venerable Udāyin warmly, and said: "Come here, venerable Udāyin! Welcome, venerable Udāyin! It is a long time since you came, venerable Udāyin.

Venerable Udāyin, is the Blessed One free from illness? Is he strong? Does he dwell at ease? Is he free from discomfort? Is nothing troubling him? Did the Blessed One travel in comfort? Is he not too weary? Is he not worn out by the alms round?"

When they had said this, the venerable Udāyin said to the Śākya youths Aśoka and Vigataśoka: "Aśoka and Vigataśoka, the Blessed One is free from illness. He is strong. He dwells at ease. He is free from discomfort. Nothing troubles him. He traveled in comfort. He is not weary. He is not worn out by the alms round. And why is that? Because the Four Great Kings, Śakra (Indra) the lord of the gods, and Brahmā the lord of the Sahā world strive to make offerings to the Blessed One."

When he had said this, those Śākya youths said to the venerable Udāyin, "Reverend Udāyin, although we wish to see the Blessed One (the Buddha) and attend upon him, we are not able to do so. Why is that? Because King Śuddhodana has decreed, 'Let no one go to see my son or to attend upon him. If anyone goes to see him or attend upon him, he will be punished with bodily harm.' Therefore, noble Udāyin, out of fear of the king we cannot go to see the Blessed One or to attend upon him."

Then the venerable Udāyin thought, "Alas, this King Śuddhodana is utterly overcome by pride. How shall I go into his presence?" Then he thought this: "What if, by miraculous power, I were to rise into the sky to the height of seven palm trees, sit cross-legged in the air above, and go to King Śuddhodana in that way?" Then the venerable Udāyin entered into a meditative absorption of that kind, and with his mind so composed he rose into the sky to the height of seven palm trees, sat cross-legged in the air, and went to where King Śuddhodana was.

King Śuddhodana, seeing from far off the venerable Udāyin coming through the sky by miraculous power, risen to the height of seven palm trees and seated cross-legged in the air, joined his palms toward him and spoke these verses:

"You who wear the dyed robe, from where have you come?
Tell me quickly what it is you need.
Whatever you need, that too I shall quickly give.
One perfected in ascetic discipline is very hard to see."

When he had said this, the venerable Udāyin replied to King Śuddhodana in verse:

"O king, I am a son of your son.
It is the Dharma I need, O king, wherever it abides.
I am one who carries the Tathāgata's food;
I bear the food of the Sugata, the Protector.

Lord of the realm, possessed of great splendor,
You have a son, supreme among men, who has won renown.
With his majesty he blazes in every direction,
Like the noonday light of the autumn sun.

Just as the sun in a cloudless sky
Blazes forth, shedding light in every direction,
So, O elephant among kings, your son,
Possessed of wisdom, shines in every direction.

Just as, when the autumn sun has risen,
It outshines the fireflies and shines forth,
So, O elephant among kings, your son
Has vanquished all the other non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and dwells resplendent.

Just as the stars, outshone by the sun,
In daytime, empty of light, cannot glitter,
So, O elephant among kings, outshone
By your son, the other tīrthikas do not appear.

Just as the moon, outshone by the sun,
Empty of light, does not appear in the expanse of the sky,
So the tīrthikas, outshone by your son,
Have no brilliance, like the moon outshone by the sun.

When small creatures hear the lion's roar,
They are stupefied by its force and, each as best it can,
Scatter into the ravines of the mountains and cower there;
The tiger's roar is hard for others to bear.

Just so, O king, the speech of the great sage:
When the other tīrthikas hear the roar of selflessness,
Though, of meager wisdom, they have reached the Peak of Existence,
On hearing his speech they all become afraid.

To the blind world together with its gods
He who has eyes has granted sight.
He makes light and clears away the dust;

The maṇḍala of wisdom's light has dawned.

He has fully shown the two paths, of happiness and of unhappiness;
The Victor has shown the path and the path that strays.
He brings those who have lost the way onto the path,
And draws those sunk in the mire out onto the plain.

Just as, on parched ground, a cloud
Satisfies with rain both the heights and the hollows,
So, O elephant among kings, your son
Satisfies beings, gods included, with the Dharma.

Just as ravines and forests satisfied by rain,
With grasses and shrubs, groves and trees,
Vines and trunks and all kinds of healing herbs,
And many kinds of flowers, adorn the earth,

So the king's son, who possesses the ten powers and the fearlessnesses,
On the trunk of the eighteen unshared qualities,
Adorned with the flowers and fruits
Of omniscient wisdom, is beautiful."

Just as Mount Meru in the midst of the ocean,
Abode of the gods, unmoving, shines in splendor,
So too, O elephant among kings, your son
Shines in splendor in the ocean of ascetics.

Just as Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, husband of Śacī,
Looks splendid when seated upon his divine throne,
So too, O elephant among kings, your son
Shines in splendor amid the assembly of ascetics.

Mighty with loving-kindness, sounding deep thunder,
Wreathed in garlands of lightning, his great compassion,
Massing dense clouds, the streaming rain of the applications of mindfulness,
That Victor, supreme nāga, lets fall the rain of Dharma.

His perfectly pure disk, its rays the excellent moral discipline,
His absorption utterly crushing the asuras of affliction,
His rays of wisdom drying up the craving for existence,
The great sun of the Victor shines in splendor upon beings.

Absorption and moral discipline are its rafts and great ships,
The applications of mindfulness its hoard of precious jewels,
The factors of awakening its mine of gems, meditative concentration its waves:
Those who want liberation should resort to the ocean of the Buddha.

Its roots, pure moral discipline, firmly planted,
Absorption its leaves, mindfulness its branches and foliage,
The factors of awakening its flowers, emptiness its trunk:
Rely on the Victor's tree, which gives the shade of selflessness.

Great in strength, dwelling at the forest's edge of moral discipline,
Abiding in the mountain cave of peaceful absorption,
His domain emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness,
Your son, the Victor, is a mighty lion.

The Sage teaches the abiding that is non-abiding.
As the Victor, a lordly bull, walks with majestic gait,
Childish ordinary beings and the other tīrthikas are struck with fear,
And your son lets out the bellow of the bull.

Adorned with the treasure of moral discipline and the riches of good qualities,
Protected by the calm abiding of serene meditative concentration,
Guarded by wisdom, his domain liberation,
The Victor, the chief caravan leader, bestows wealth.

Having destroyed evil by embracing virtue,
Pacifying afflictions, and commanding the practice of virtue,
In the world with its gods and asuras,
O king, your supreme son shines in splendor.

Supreme clouds of moral discipline flashing the lightning of intelligence,
Soaking the earth with the moisture of the great rain of the eightfold path,
The Sage bestows the fruit of a precious harvest:
Your son, a great nāga, sounds the thunder.

The king said:
Has that supreme person come in comfort?
Is the Guide not wearied by wandering for alms?
Is his body not exhausted with fatigue?
Has he not withered like an utpala lotus lying on open ground?

Udāyin said:
Possessing the power of miracles, his domain meditative concentration,
His limbs full and flourishing with delight and ease,
Since the Sage abides in the attainment of peace,
The Victor, like a golden lotus, does not wither.

The king said:
In the past he was roused by the sound of clay drums and kettledrums,
Roused by the sweet melody of flutes,
Awakened again and again by the singing of women.
Now, when he wakes, does he not suffer?

Udāyin said:
Contemplating in meditative concentration, his domain the peace of absorption,
Skilled in the ways of accomplishing absorption,
Whether he sleeps or rises, walks or sits,
The Victor has no suffering; he is ever joyful.

The king said:
He used to lie upon a supreme bed, laid out as befits greatness,
Surrounded on every side by rows of lamps,
Encircled by a throng of women as he lay.
Now, lying in darkness, how can he not be bewildered?

Udāyin said:
When the noble Great Sage lies upon his bed,
He spreads the seat of loving-kindness and rises at ease through compassion;
Abiding in joy, he is filled with delight;
For one beyond existence, possessed of equanimity, there is no bewilderment.

The king said:
The heroes of the Śākyas always attended upon him,
And he played and took delight with those learned in the treatises,
Taking his pleasure in a house like a celestial palace.
How can my son be happy at the forest's edge?

Udāyin said:
Those born of the Dharma, endowed with peaceful minds,
Always attend upon him whose mind is at peace.
Since he cultivates peace in the peaceful wilderness,
The fearless Teacher delights there.

The king said:
In the past, when the prince lived at home,
His limbs anointed with sweet-scented oil,
He was bathed as befits a king.
At the forest's edge, who bathes the Sage?

Udāyin said:
Pure discipline is the bathing steps, the Dharma the water of the pool;
Bathed in it, the Sage bathes others too.
His body unwet, he comes forth together with his heirs;
Having crossed over himself, he ferries a multitude of people across.

The king said:
Adorned with golden threads and garlands of jewels,
He wore excellent, fine garments befitting a king,
And leaf patterns were beautifully painted on him with fragrant sandalwood.
Amid that great forest, who adorns the Sage?

Udāyin said:
Anointed with the perfume of moral discipline, adorned with the garland of good qualities,
Conscience his clothing, absorption and meditative concentration his ornaments,
His body adorned with the superknowledges, the knowledges, and the deliverances,
Radiant with liberation, the Sage shines in the forest.

The king said:
Heroes come from battle, bearing two-pointed weapons and swords,
Guarded his person,
And he was always sheltered by canopies and parasols.
Now that he stays alone in the forest, who guards him?

Udāyin said:
The Sage is wholly protected by the power of loving-kindness;
Wisdom is his army, the śrāvakas his attendants and servants.
Certain in his mass of good qualities, he has no fear;
He possesses the joy of the ten powers and has attained the fearlessnesses.

The king said:
You have spoken of my son's good qualities,

And I have heard you tell how he practices the Dharma well and is unwearied.
You too, take this food, honoring it as alms,
And I too shall go, as befits a lord of men.

When he had said this, the venerable Udāyin spoke thus to King Śuddhodana: "Great king, that Blessed One is the master of the assembly, the foremost of the assembly, the one who gathers the community of ascetics, a great sage. When he sits amid the community of ascetics, that king of ascetics is radiant, brilliant, and resplendent. Great king, it is like this: for example, when on the fifteenth day of the waxing fortnight the moon is full and complete, surrounded on every side by the host of stars, it is radiant, brilliant, and resplendent. Likewise that Blessed One too, when he sits amid the community of ascetics, is radiant, brilliant, and resplendent. Great king, it is like this: for example, the sun in the autumn season is exceedingly radiant, brilliant, and resplendent. Likewise that Blessed One too, when he sits amid the community of ascetics, is exceedingly radiant, brilliant, and resplendent. It is like this: for example, Mount Meru, king of mountains, standing in the midst of the ocean, is radiant, brilliant, and resplendent.

In the same way, that Blessed One (the Buddha), seated in the midst of the assembly of renunciants, is radiant, resplendent, and glorious. It is like this: just as Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, is radiant, resplendent, and glorious when he dwells in Sudharmā, the assembly hall of the gods, so too that Blessed One, seated in the midst of the assembly of renunciants, is radiant, resplendent, and glorious. It is like this: just as the god Suyāma, the god Santuṣita, the god Sunirmita, and the god Vaśavartin are each radiant, resplendent, and glorious when they dwell in the midst of their assemblies of gods, so too the Blessed One, seated in the midst of the assembly of renunciants, is radiant, resplendent, and glorious. It is like this: just as Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, is radiant, resplendent, and glorious when he is surrounded by a thousand koṭis of Brahmās, so too that Blessed One, seated in the midst of the assembly of renunciants, is radiant, resplendent, and glorious.

Then, when King Śuddhodana had heard this account of the Blessed One's qualities, he thought: "If this one, who is merely a śrāvaka of that Blessed One, is renowned for such great miraculous power, such great might, and such great mastery, then what need is there to speak of the Blessed One himself? At the very moment of his birth this great earth shook in six ways. It shook, shook strongly, and shook strongly all over. It moved, moved strongly, and

moved strongly all over. It rocked, rocked strongly, and rocked strongly all over. It quaked, quaked strongly, and quaked strongly all over. It roared, roared strongly, and roared strongly all over. It surged, surged strongly, and surged strongly all over, and an immeasurable light appeared. What need is there to speak of that? As soon as he was born, unsupported by anyone, he took seven steps upon the ground; from the sky above came two streams of water, one cold and one warm, and with these two he was bathed; a fine divine throne with a center made of gold appeared for him; and from the sky above appeared a divine parasol together with yak-tail whisks. What need is there to speak of that? As soon as he was born all the gods bowed to him, and from the time he was born until the time he went forth he was never mistaken, always steadfast in his commitments, acting just as he had spoken, always and without interruption firm in diligence, speaking truly, free from deceit. What need is there to speak of that? And when he awakened fully to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, he declared, 'Having crossed over, I shall bring others across.' What need is there to speak of that?"

Thinking thus, and recalling the pledge the Blessed One had made when he was a bodhisattva, the king spoke these verses:

He who, possessed of supreme intelligence, as soon as he was born
Uttered speech that was free from error,
He who possesses words of truth:
What wise person would not trust him?

He who, at the very moment he was born,
Declared, "I shall become the chief of the world,"
The Protector who spoke words beyond compare:
What wise person would not trust him?

He who, even at the time when dreams are dreamt,
Never once spoke a false word,
Who did just as he had said:
What wise person would not trust him?

He whom heaps of gold as large as snow mountains
Could not cause to become attached,
He who has passed wholly beyond attachment:
What wise person would not trust him?

He whom harsh words like sharpened weapons
Could not cause to become angry,

He who has gone far beyond the very stuff of aversion:
What wise person would not trust him?

He whom what breeds attachment, aversion, and delusion
Was never able to overcome,
He who is endowed with the king of wisdom:
What wise person would not trust him?

He whom the many joys and pleasures of desire
And all the ways of fancying enjoyments
Were never able to bind:
What wise person would not trust him?

He whom the eight kinds of marvels
Could never make cling to amazement,
Endowed with dense splendor and never dejected:
What wise person would not trust him?

He whom the sweet words spoken by the learned,
With many and various kinds of phrases,
Were never able to bind:
What wise person would not trust him?

He whom those striving in the ways of meaning,
And words that fix on faith in the Dharma and on longing,
Were never able to bind:
Who would not trust his words?

He who, stainless and possessed of infinite strength,
When he went forth from the supreme city,
Could not be stopped by armies:
Who would not trust his words?

He who, longing for supreme awakening,
Abandoned the pleasures of desire
And, for the sake of the deathless, lived the life of a wild deer:
Who would not trust his words?

The being free of clinging who, longing for supreme awakening,
Practiced fierce austerities for six years:
Who would not trust his words?

He who, for the benefit and happiness of the world,
In his quest for supreme awakening,
Took broth at the end of six full years:
Who would not trust his words?

He whom Māra, for six years,
Constantly followed, seeking an opening,
Yet in whom he found no opening at all:
Who would not trust his words?

He who is free of attachment and aversion,
Who asks nothing at all of anyone,
And who has worked for the benefit of the world:
Who would not trust his words?

He who, without hearing it from another,
Awakened fully to unsurpassed awakening,
Hard to realize and utterly peaceful:
Who would not trust his words?

When, at the entreaty of Brahmā himself,
The Blessed One heeded his words
And himself expounded the Dharma:
Who would not trust his words?

When he, out of loving concern for me,
Has come home to the city of the Śākyas
And brings liberation to the assembly of Śākyas:
Who would not trust his words?

When the Blessed One, who has crossed over,
Recalls the pledge he made long ago
And delivers us from the stream of existence:
Who would not trust his words?

At this time the moment has come; knowing the time in this way,
The Blessed One knew that it was the time,
The Guide who shows compassion at the proper time.

who would not believe his words?
"To behold the supreme body
Of the Leader of humankind, I must go."
So the king reflected

Within his own mind.

Then King Śuddhodana, having reflected in this way for a long while, said to the venerable Udāyin, "Monk, what do you need?" When he had said this, the venerable Udāyin answered King Śuddhodana in verse:

"Thinking of your welfare, O King,
I have come here to inspire faith in you.
If they give rise to faith in the one with the ten powers,
Men and women alike will go to the higher realms.

He has the ten powers and boundless qualities,
The great sage who brings joy to the Śākyas.
He has come here. King, give rise to faith,
And your fame will spread without measure in the world.

Your son is the supreme lord of men,
With the ten powers, compassion and great love.
Like a lotus in the water, free of attachment,
The Ten-Powered One acts with a mind unattached.

He has crossed the four rivers of existence
And ferries many beings across the great flood.
Since the chief of two-footed beings bestows fearlessness,
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

He has drawn out all four thorns of existence;
As chief of physicians he pulls out the thorns of beings.
He is the most excellent of skilled healers.
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

He defeated the measureless great hosts of Māra
And utterly crushed the dark side with all its armies.
Since he has attained the supremely peaceful awakening,
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

'Free beings, teach the Dharma,
And explain to humans the deathless peace':
Since the lord of gods made this entreaty to the lord of men,
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

He overpowered the hosts of opponents;
The Teacher set turning the measureless wheel.

Since he tames countless millions of beings,
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

He whose eyes are pure, for beings
Whose eyes are veiled by darkness and thick cataracts,
Cleanses the eye, removes the cataract and brings clarity.
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

To those tormented by the fear of aging and death
He teaches the supreme state free of aging and death,
And he leads beings to the deathless abode.
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

On this world scorched by the three great fires,
Like a great cloud's rain on fire-burnt ground,
He pours the rain of the excellent cloud of the four and the two.
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

He has cast off the three stains and cleared away all faults;
He frees people from the three stains,
And the Ten-Powered One brings forth illumination.
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

Loving all beings as a father does,
The compassionate Ten-Powered One regards them with loving-kindness.
Since with compassion and love he sets beings free,
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

The Blessed One tames beings who are untamed;
The compassionate one brings peace to those without peace,
And calms the afflictions even of the agitated.
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

He dries up the ocean of existence for beings;
Just as a son of the gods rescues from the ocean,
The Ten-Powered One with great compassion ferries them across.
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

Adorned with hosts of boundless qualities,
With great compassion he acts from a mind of clear faith.
Since he brings faith to people long troubled,
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

Like a precious jewel that clears the water,
The Victor acts to make people clear,
And he fully clears the strife and turbidity of humans.
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

A precious jewel, by nature wholly pure,
Gives rise to full delight in the wise.
Just so the Victor, his mind pure with every fault removed,
Gives rise to full delight in the wise.

When they gain faith in the Lord of the World,
Gods and humans cast off even the burden of suffering;
Abandoning the stream of existence, they long for supreme peace.
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans.

When I speak of but a portion of his qualities,
It is like a garuḍa tracing a path in the expanse of the sky;
I have not reached the end of the Victor's qualities.
Give rise to faith in the Leader, supreme among humans."

Then King Śuddhodana heard this fine discourse from the venerable Udāyin, and he himself had directly seen such qualities as the Blessed One had displayed while a bodhisattva. He also recalled the promise that had been made: "Having first crossed over myself, I shall ferry you across as well, O bull among men." At that moment he gained faith in the Blessed One. With a mind that had gained faith in this way, he spoke these words to the venerable Udāyin: "Monk, since you are a son born of my son's Dharma, eat your meal, then take the Blessed One's food and go. I too shall come afterward to see the Blessed One."

Then the venerable Udāyin, having thus brought King Śuddhodana to clear faith, ate his meal, took the Blessed One's food, and departed. At that time the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, King Śuddhodana has been brought to faith by the monk Udāyin. Today this will be for the benefit of a great many people."

Then the venerable Udāyin, carrying the Blessed One's food, went to where the Blessed One was and reported to the Blessed One all that he had done. The Blessed One then gave his approval to the venerable Udāyin, saying, "Excellent, Udāyin, excellent! Today, by bringing King Śuddhodana to faith, you have generated a great deal of merit."

At that time the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, as for the heap of merit that the monk Udāyin has generated today by bringing King Śuddhodana to clear faith, if it had any form, it would not fit even into world systems as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges in the world systems of the ten directions. So immeasurable is that heap of merit."

The second fascicle.

Then the Blessed One, having eaten his meal, withdrew his hand, washed his alms bowl, and displayed a sign of the following kind.

When the Blessed One (the Buddha) had made such a sign, the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, surrounded and preceded by a hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of yakṣas, vanished from his own abode. In the time it takes a strong man to stretch out his bent arm or to bend his outstretched arm, he appeared before the Blessed One. He bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and took up his place on the northern side. There, in the sky above, surrounded by his host of yakṣas, he remained with palms joined, making offerings to the Blessed One and to the Saṅgha of monks.

The Great King Dhṛtarāṣṭra, too, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of gandharvas, appeared before the Blessed One just as before. He bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and took up his place on the eastern side. There, in the sky above, surrounded by his host of gandharvas, he remained with palms joined, making offerings to the Blessed One and to the Saṅgha of monks.

The Great King Virūḍhaka, too, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of kumbhāṇḍas, appeared before the Blessed One just as before. He bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and took up his place on the southern side. There, in the sky above, surrounded by his host of kumbhāṇḍas, he remained with palms joined, making offerings to the Blessed One and to the Saṅgha of monks.

The Great King Virūpākṣa, too, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of nāgas, appeared before the Blessed One just as before. He bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and took up his place on the western side. There, in the sky above, surrounded by his host of nāgas, he remained with palms joined, making offerings to the Blessed One and to the Saṅgha of monks.

Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, too, surrounded and preceded by many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, remained just as before in the sky above with palms joined, making offerings to the Blessed One and to the Saṅgha of monks.

In the same way, Suyāma, king of the gods, Santuṣita, Sunirmita, Vaśavartin, king of the gods, Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, the gods of Ābhāsvara, Śubhakṛtsna and Bṛhatphala, the king of the gods, and the gods of the Pure Abodes all vanished from their divine realms. They appeared before the Blessed One and bowed their heads at his feet. Then, in the sky above, each of them together with many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of attendant gods remained making offerings to the Blessed One and to the Saṅgha of monks.

Vemacitrin, lord of the asuras, together with sixty niyutas of asuras, also vanished from the abode of the asuras, in the time it takes a strong man to stretch out his bent arm or to bend his outstretched arm. He appeared before the Blessed One, bowed his head at his feet, and remained making offerings to the Blessed One and to the Saṅgha of monks.

Eighty-six thousand garuḍa kings, too, vanished from their own abodes. They appeared before the Blessed One, bowed their heads at his feet, and remained making offerings to the Blessed One and to the Saṅgha of monks.

Eighty koṭis of other non-Buddhist wandering ascetics (parivrājakas), who had come from various kingdoms, also gathered there.

On this it is said:

In the center of the expanse of the utterly pure sky,
the full moon, complete without remainder,
outshines the hosts of stars
and shines in beauty in the sky as the moon.

He whose face is like the stainless disk of the moon
dispels darkness and dimness of sight and destroys the three stains;
outshining the hosts of logicians,
he is beautiful like the lord of stars in the sky.

The sun, bearing a body of a hundred rays,
dispels the darkness in autumn and shines in beauty;
outshining the hosts of asuras,
that sun also opens the mouths of the lotuses.

He whose body is like the sun's hundred rays
outshines the three thousand worlds;
the sun among humans shines in beauty
and opens the supreme lotus grove of the śrāvakas.

Śakra (Indra), king of the gods, their lord,
in his assembly hall encircled by hosts of gods,
outshining the divine retinue,
the Bountiful One, with Śacī and his other consorts, shines in beauty.

The lord of bipeds, dense with glory, with the ten powers,
honored at the head of the hosts of renunciants in the three thousand worlds,
outshining the hosts of logicians,
shines in beauty amid the hosts of renunciants.

The lord of gods who rules the Yāma gods,
Suyāma, worshiped and revered by the gods,
Suyāma, having entered among the hosts of gods,
dwells in beauty among the Yāmas.

He of boundless splendor, who has the ten powers,
outshining those who go by evil paths to evil destinies,
fully teaches the eightfold path
and shines in beauty with the qualities of the ten powers.

Santuṣita, king of the gods,
encircled by hosts of gods in the abode of Tuṣita,
outshining many hosts of gods,
is beautiful through his former roots of virtue.

Likewise the teacher of gods and asuras,
whom the hosts of gods and asuras have made their teacher,
outshining the eight assemblies,
the sublime lion among men graces the world.

Sunirmita, lord and sovereign of the gods,
outshining many hosts of gods,
dwells in the divine abode by the power of his own merit,
and dwelling there he is utterly beautiful.

Likewise the one fully liberated from the afflictions,
possessed of the ten powers, free of the afflictions,
the king of discipline who tames the untamed,

outshines all beings and shines in beauty.

Just as the king of the gods who wields control,
dwelling in the divine abode and outshining the hosts of gods,
through the splendor of his former roots of virtue
has come to shine in beauty,

so the Victor, having long ago practiced
the conduct of the ten powers, outshines gods and humans;
through the splendor of his former roots of virtue
that king is utterly beautiful.

In the Brahmā world, Brahmā too
outshines the retinue of Brahmā by himself;
he speaks words most melodious, endowed with eight qualities,
and is manifestly beautiful.

Just so the Victor, who has become like Brahmā,
king of renunciants, honored at the head by the hosts of renunciants,
speaks words of truth
and is manifestly beautiful in the three worlds.

Knowing that gods and humans eager to listen
and the great mahoragas have gathered,
the bull among men, with speech endowed with eight qualities,
teaches them thoroughly.

It may be possible to measure the sky, the path of birds;
it may be possible to measure the ocean with a vase;
it may be possible to weigh Mount Meru by hundreds of weights;
but the qualities of the Buddha cannot be fathomed to their end.

This is the first chapter, on the king being inspired to faith.

Then, not long after the venerable Udāyin had gone, King Śuddhodana addressed the Śākyas: "Friends, it is like this. The harbinger of the sun's rising is the red glow of dawn. When the red glow has appeared, one knows that the sun will rise. Friends, in the same way, the monk Udāyin is the harbinger of the Blessed One, the Omniscient One. Whatever qualities the monk Udāyin has described are certainly the qualities of an omniscient one. Therefore, friends, make ready a thousand of the finest vehicles. And why? Because this very day we shall go to see the Blessed One, who is supremely beautiful to behold."

Saying, "Excellent, Your Majesty," the Śākyas obeyed King Śuddhodana and quickly harnessed the finest conveyances. At that time King Śuddhodana had the whole way between Kapilavastu and the Nyagrodha Park, the route of the king's procession, made level and strewn with clean sand. It was made delightful, filled with scattered flowers, and adorned with silk pennants and many garlands, and at intervals there were stationed dancers, singers, wrestlers, players of pot drums, cymbals, musical instruments, and accompaniments for song, and people carrying every kind of provision.

Then King Śuddhodana, together with those who had set out with the finest vehicles, himself mounted the finest vehicle, came forth from the great city of Kapilavastu, and went to where the Nyagrodha Park was. At that time the finest vehicles of some of the Śākyas were of this kind. The chariots were all blue and drawn by blue horses. Their ornaments too were blue, adorned with nets of bells and little bells, and encircled with blue rim ornaments. They were furnished with parasols, swords, helmets, jeweled yak-tail whisks, and blue foot ornaments. Attendants in blue cloth with uncut fringes and wearing blue ornaments waited upon them, carrying whips with blue ornaments, and there were many guides. Every one of them raised blue banners, and each chariot was surrounded by a hundred men wearing blue ornaments. The vehicles of other Śākyas were of this kind: the chariots were entirely yellow, and likewise entirely red, entirely white, and entirely multicolored, all as before, up to "each chariot was surrounded by a hundred men wearing multicolored ornaments."

Behind each of those chariots were arrayed eighty thousand elephants, every one adorned with golden ornaments, bearing golden banners and covered with golden nets. On those eighty thousand elephants were placed eighty thousand multistoried houses of the seven precious substances, bright and beautiful to behold, and so they proceeded. Behind those eighty thousand elephants were arrayed eighty thousand horses adorned with golden ornaments, hung with strings of golden bells and little bells, and decked with ornaments of the seven precious substances, and so they proceeded.

Then the Blessed One (the Buddha) saw King Śuddhodana and the Śākyas coming from far away, and he said to the monks, "Monks, those of you who have never seen the gods of the Thirty-Three going to their pleasure grove should look at these Śākyas coming from Kapilavastu. Why is that? Monks, these Śākyas who have come out of Kapilavastu are like the gods of the Thirty-Three going to their pleasure grove."

On this it is said:

From the excellent city known as Kapila,
King Śuddhodana, that bull among men,
Has come together with his retinue.
I shall tell how it was; listen to it!

With a hundred thousand excellent chariots,
Well adorned and beautifully decorated,
From the excellent city of Kapilavastu
The excellent lord of men came forth.

The chariots were blue, their ornaments blue,
The horses blue, with a retinue in blue,
The five royal insignia were also blue,
And likewise the fine garments were blue.
The whips were blue, the reins were blue as well,
Together with their nets of bells and little bells;
The people too were clad in blue garments,
Made beautiful by the blue banners they raised.

The chariots were yellow, their ornaments yellow,
The horses yellow, with a retinue in yellow,
The five royal insignia were also yellow,
And likewise the fine garments were yellow.
The whips were yellow, the reins were yellow as well,
Together with their nets of bells and little bells;
The people too were clad in yellow garments,
Made beautiful by the yellow banners they raised.

The chariots were red, their ornaments red,
The horses red, with a retinue in red,
The five royal insignia were also red,
And likewise the fine garments were red.
The whips were red, the reins were red as well,
Together with their nets of bells and little bells;
The people too were clad in red garments,
Made beautiful by the red banners they raised.

The chariots were white, their ornaments white,
The horses white, with a retinue in white,
The five royal insignia were also white,

And likewise the fine garments were white.
The whips were white, the reins were white as well,
Together with their nets of bells and little bells;
The people too were clad in white garments,
Made beautiful by the white banners they raised.

The chariots were multicolored, their ornaments multicolored,
The horses multicolored, with a retinue in many colors,
The five royal insignia were also multicolored,
And likewise the fine garments were multicolored.
The whips were multicolored, the reins multicolored as well,
Together with their nets of bells and little bells;
The people too were clad in multicolored garments,
Made beautiful by the multicolored banners they raised.

Behind all of those chariots
A full eighty thousand elephants were arrayed,
Handsomely adorned with golden banners;
The great elephants were adorned with plates of gold.
On top of them were placed
Multistoried houses of the seven precious substances,
And, adorned with ornaments of every kind,
They were arrayed to follow behind the chariots.

Likewise eighty thousand excellent horses
Were delightfully adorned with ornaments of the seven precious substances;
With royal trappings and a royal gait,
They followed behind those elephants.

Loose flowers of five colors, most fragrant,
Were strewn along the royal road.
Silken pendants were hung all about,
And it was handsomely adorned with vessels of incense.
Singers and dancers, and wrestlers,
And those bearing pot-drums made it beautiful.
And those who played music of every kind,
Overjoyed, followed behind the king.

This was the second chapter, on the king's departure.

Then King Śuddhodana and the Śākyas rode in their vehicles as far as the place where horses are dismounted. Having arrived there, they got down from their vehicles and, surrounded by a retinue on foot that was arrayed before them, went on to the Nyagrodha Park.

At that time the Blessed One, knowing that King Śuddhodana was very proud, rose into the sky, a little more than a man's height above the ground, and walked and remained there in order to inspire faith in King Śuddhodana. As the Blessed One walked thus, on his right Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, walked in attendance, and on his left Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, walked in attendance. Attending the Blessed One as he walked, the god kings Suyāma, Santuṣita, Sunirmita, and Vaśavartin held parasols and waved fans in order to honor the Blessed One. The Great Kings Vaiśravaṇa and Dhṛtarāṣṭra, at the near end of the eastern side of the Blessed One's walkway, draped their upper robes over one shoulder, set their right knees on the ground, bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, paid homage to the Blessed One, and remained there. The Great Kings Virūḍhaka and Virūpākṣa, at the near end of the western side of the Blessed One's walkway, draped their upper robes over one shoulder, set their right knees on the ground, bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, paid homage to the Blessed One, and remained there.

At that time the young gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings, and the young gods of the Thirty-Three, of Yāma, of Tuṣita, of Nirmāṇarati, and of Paranirmitavaśavartin, in order to honor the Blessed One, stood in the sky above and scattered divine flowers: blue lotuses, red lotuses, white water lilies, and white lotuses, divine mandārava flowers and great mandārava flowers, and divine powdered incense.

To make offerings to the Blessed One (the Buddha), divine music, cymbals and songs resounded from the sky above. Melodies of song beyond the human also came forth from the sky above. From the clouds fell a gentle, drizzling rain of perfume. A rain of divine utpala flowers and of divine sandalwood powder fell as well.

Then the Blessed One displayed a miracle of such a kind that gods and humans could see one another.

Then King Śuddhodana saw those gods making offerings to the Blessed One, and he saw the sky filled with tiered mansions made of the seven divine precious substances. He thought: "How wonderful it is, how well the Blessed One spoke! Long ago, when the Blessed One was a youth, he said, 'For me to

hold sovereignty over the four great continents would be no great wonder. In the great trichiliocosm, among gods and humans, I shall hold sovereignty as lord of the Dharma.' This, it seems, is the Blessed One's sovereignty as lord of the Dharma. My retinue is only of humans, while the Blessed One has a retinue of gods and humans."

Then King Śuddhodana arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and spoke these words: "As soon as the Blessed One was born, he walked seven steps upon the great earth unsupported by anyone. Looking to the four directions, he declared, 'I am supreme in the world. I am chief in the world. I am foremost in the world. I shall put an end to birth, aging, sickness and death.' At that time too I touched my head to the Blessed One's feet and paid homage. When the Blessed One went to the farmers' village and sat in the cool shade of the jambu tree, even when the sun had moved on, the jambu tree's shade did not leave the Blessed One's body, and six young sons of the gods remained there, palms joined, paying homage. At that time too I paid homage to the Blessed One. And now, with this, I bow to the Blessed One for the third time."

Having said this, he then also spoke these verses:

"When you, chief of two-footed beings, were born,
You walked seven steps upon this great earth
And declared, 'I am supreme in the world.'
Then, wise one, I bowed to you.
When, great sage, you went to the farmers' village,
The jambu's shade did not leave you as you sat,
And six young sons of the gods bowed down.
Then, worthy of offerings, I bowed to you.
And now, with this, for the third time,
I bow, O sage, at your feet.
Greatly compassionate one, chief honored by gods and humans,
There is none like you in the world, let alone one greater.
That your name was Siddhārtha, as was said before,
Your father and mother gave you after reflection.
Since your aims are fulfilled and you have found the deathless nectar,
Only now do I understand that you are Siddhārtha."

Then the gods of the desire realm arranged a lion throne for the Blessed One, spread with divine wish-fulfilling fine cloths variously interwoven. The entire Nyagrodha Park, too, they carpeted with divine wish-fulfilling fine cloths, and above it they stretched a canopy of divine wish-fulfilling fine cloth.

Then the Blessed One descended from where he stood in the sky and sat upon the throne that had been arranged. King Śuddhodana and his retinue bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat to one side. The gods of the desire realm and the gods of the form realm also bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and remained in the sky.

In this regard, this is the nature of things, and of it this is said:

In the excellent city called Kapilavastu,
in the delightful Nyagrodha Grove,
at the time when King Śuddhodana
met the Protector of the World,
a great multitude of beings gathered there.
Asuras and the lords of the garuḍas,
hosts of nāgas and likewise kumbhāṇḍas,
and the kings of the gandharvas also gathered.
Likewise the lords of the secret ones, the yakṣas, gathered,
with hosts of kinnaras and with human beings,
and likewise the gods who dwell in the realms of desire,
filled with great joy, gathered as well.
Likewise, of those belonging to the form realm,
the Brahmās and the gods of Brahmā's retinue,
the Ābhāsvara gods and the Śubhakṛtsna gods,
those of Bṛhatphala and of the Pure Abodes gathered.
Śramaṇas and likewise brahmins,
carakas and wandering ascetics,
naked ascetics and many other non-Buddhists (tīrthikas),
followers of wrong paths, also gathered.
Through the sublime splendor of the Buddha himself,
for the sake of bringing to full maturity
the mind of the great King Śuddhodana,
at that time a great assembly came about.

Before this, the Blessed One with his well-spoken words
had brought the assemblies to complete satisfaction.

Now the Victor wished to fully display
the might of a Victor to King Śuddhodana.
For King Śuddhodana had once entreated the Blessed One:
"Young prince, since the wise have prophesied
that you will become a king, a great lord of the earth,
do not go forth from your home!
You will be a wheel-turning monarch ruling the four continents,
honored by countless myriads of living beings.
You will possess the seven precious things,
and you will also possess the four kinds of prosperity.
Abiding in the Dharma and protecting the earth,
a great kṣatriya king ruling the four continents,
you will be a lord of men, honored by men,
and greatly honored by the mahoragas." So he had pleaded.

Then at that time the bodhisattva said:
"For immeasurable, countless myriads of eons
I have always spoken words of truth.
O king, listen to my words.
Since in this way you wish to beguile me
with the kingship of the four continents,
great king, in a course such as that
place not the slightest hope in me.
Great king, long ago it happened
that a wave of the ocean flung up a turtle.
When the ocean wave drew back again,
that turtle fell down into a well.
Then the turtle living in the well
said, 'Turtle of the ocean, from where have you come here?
To cut through the doubt that has arisen in me,
tell me quickly!' This is what it said.
To that very turtle in the well
the great-minded turtle of the ocean replied:
'I was carried along and along by the ocean's waves,
and today I have been dropped into this well.
That great ocean wave has drawn back and gone,
and I am not able to go back again.

Since I have been parted from the waves,
turtle, I shall stay here in your well.'
Then the turtle in the well
said, 'Is that ocean only the size of this well,
or is it something larger than this well?
Answer my question quickly!'
The ocean turtle of vast mind
spoke these words to the turtle of the well:
'Turtle of the well, you are childish,
narrow of mind and very feeble in understanding.
I was born in those salty waters,
and though I have been born there again and again for ages,
if I have not been able to know the ocean's shore,
how could I possibly know what its middle is like?'
In the same way, you too, lord of men,
have not understood my might,
and with the honors of the four continents
you wish to beguile me.
I shall become a righteous king, a king of Dharma.
Without punishing by penalties, without driving by weapons,
I shall protect this trichiliocosm world system,
and I shall obtain honor beyond the world."

The Blessed One, whose very nature is the cultivated power of miracles,
wishing to make good his former words,
therefore turned his mind
toward those great assemblies and toward beings.
In order to delight the mind of King Śuddhodana,
he urged them on with his mind,
and the three worlds, entirely and without remainder,
at that time gathered there.

This is the third chapter, on inspiring the king's aspiration.

Then at that time the Blessed One produced such a sign that the thought of making offerings to the Blessed One first arose in Vemacitrin, lord of the asuras. Then Vemacitrin, lord of the asuras, together with six trillion asuras and six trillion asura maidens, was the first to make offerings to the Blessed One. Then all the jewels in the great ocean, as many as there were, both those

that had a price and those beyond price, they presented in order to make offerings to the Blessed One. They also magically emanated other jewels not found in that great ocean, and presented them as offerings. They also emanated six trillion chariots made of the seven precious substances. For each of those chariots they also emanated six trillion thoroughbred horses. Those horses all bore nets of bells and small bells of the seven precious substances, had leg ornaments made of gold, were adorned with the seven precious substances, had plumes made of the seven precious substances, and were decked with golden ornaments. To serve as adornment for those thoroughbreds, they also emanated canopies of the seven precious substances. Those chariots too all had golden banners and were decked with golden ornaments. Those canopies of wish-fulfilling jewels, moreover, followed behind the chariots in the sky above: when the chariots moved on, they moved after them, and when the chariots stopped, they all stopped. To beautify those canopies of wish-fulfilling jewels as well, they arranged hanging fringes of garlands of the seven precious substances. Those canopies of wish-fulfilling jewels were also emanated with nets of bells and small bells of the seven precious substances.

When the wind stirred those chariot ornaments, those horse ornaments, and the ornaments of the canopies of wish-fulfilling jewels, nothing but sweet, delightful sounds arose, pleasant to hear. Just as music of instruments and cymbals with eight parts, played by a skilled musician, gives forth sweet and delightful sounds that are pleasant to hear, so too, when the wind stirred those chariot ornaments, those horse ornaments, and the ornaments of the canopies of wish-fulfilling jewels, nothing but sweet, delightful sounds arose, pleasant to hear.

The height of those chariots covered sixty yojanas of the sky above. Behind those chariots followed all kinds of music and cymbals. In every one of those chariots sat asura maidens adorned with every kind of ornament. To make offerings to the Blessed One, some played music, some struck cymbals, some sang songs, and some danced. Some scattered powdered sandalwood and utpala, some scattered powdered aloeswood and tamāla leaves, some scattered the powder of the divine substances of the asuras, and some scattered gold and silver powder. Some emanated mandārava flowers, great mandārava flowers, mañjūṣaka flowers, great mañjūṣaka flowers, paruṣaka flowers, great paruṣaka flowers, white-hued flowers, great white-hued flowers, pale-hued flowers, great pale-hued flowers, variegated pale-hued flowers, and

greatly variegated pale-hued flowers, and scattered them over the Blessed One. Some scattered flowers of gold, flowers of silver, flowers of crystal, flowers of beryl, flowers of agate, flowers of red pearl, and flowers of emerald. Some filled their hands with the seven precious substances and with treasures and scattered them over the Blessed One. Some offered garments and ornaments. Some scattered girdles, anklets, bracelets, finger rings, wristlets, paired wristlets, three-pointed head ornaments, armlets, diadems, golden threads, pearl necklaces, jewel necklaces, long necklaces, and many-stranded necklaces, and all kinds of neck ornaments.

Some held strings of tinkling ornaments, some head ornaments, some earrings and rings, some golden garlands studded with jewels, some jeweled garlands studded with gold, some golden nets, and some garlands of gold, garlands of jewels, and garlands of pearls. Some held parasols of gold, parasols of silver, parasols of beryl, parasols of crystal, parasols of agate, parasols of emerald, parasols of red pearl, and parasols of the seven precious substances, all manner of different jeweled victory banners, and many flags of every jewel in various hues and of many colors. Some remained there sending down a rain of scented water. Some praised the Blessed One with these verses:

Homage to you, supreme among humans!
Homage to you, most excellent of humans!
Homage to the lord of two-legged beings!
You have no equal whatsoever.
Homage to the light of the world!
Homage to the ocean of wisdom!
Homage to the glorious one!
Homage to the light of the Victors!
Homage to the one perfect in qualities!
Homage to the dispeller of afflictions!
Homage to you whose conduct is pure!
Homage to you whose mind is pure!
You have no stagnation and no discouragement,
You have no laziness and no agitation.
Having taken up diligence, steadfast,
Homage to the one of certain realization!

They also emanated sixty niyutas of jewel palace compounds, lovely to behold and beautiful, made of the seven precious substances. In each of those jewel palace compounds they also emanated sixty niyutas of residences. In each of

those residences they emanated six thousand bright turrets, lovely to behold, made of the seven precious substances. On each of those turrets they also emanated sixty niyutas of bright multi-storied mansions, lovely to behold, made of the seven precious substances. In each of those multi-storied mansions they also emanated sixty niyutas of bright courtyards, lovely to behold, made of the seven precious substances.

Of the golden courtyards, the beams and rafters were of silver, the lattices and door panels of beryl, the thresholds and lintels of crystal, the pillars of agate, the capitals of red pearl, and the floors entirely of emerald. Of the silver courtyards, the beams and rafters were of gold, the lattices and door panels of beryl, the thresholds and lintels of crystal, the pillars of agate, the capitals of red pearl, and the floors entirely of emerald. Of the beryl courtyards, the beams and rafters were of crystal, the lattices and door panels of gold, the thresholds and lintels of silver, the pillars of agate, the capitals of red pearl, and the floors entirely of emerald. Of the crystal courtyards, the beams and rafters were of beryl, the lattices and door panels of agate, the thresholds and lintels of emerald, the pillars of gold, the capitals of silver, and the floors entirely of red pearl. Of the agate courtyards, the beams and rafters were of emerald, the lattices and door panels of red pearl, the thresholds and lintels of gold, the pillars of silver, the capitals of crystal, and the floors entirely of beryl. Of the red pearl courtyards, the beams and rafters were of agate, the lattices and door panels of emerald, the thresholds and lintels of silver, the pillars of gold, the capitals of beryl, and the floors entirely of chrysoberyl. Of the emerald courtyards, the beams and rafters were of red pearl, the lattices and door panels of gold, the thresholds and lintels of silver, the pillars of beryl, the capitals of chrysoberyl, and the floors entirely of crystal.

In those courtyards, too, they emanated sixty niyutas of lion thrones made of the seven precious substances, spread with the various divine fabrics of the asuras, covered with kācalindika cloth, with fine cushions arranged at both ends.

On the footstools of those lion thrones, made of the seven precious substances, were spread sixty koṭis each of many kinds of cloth: very fine cloth made of cotton, very fine cloth made of silk, very fine cloth made of flax, very fine cloth made of bark fiber, and very fine cloth from Kāśi. On both sides of each of those lion thrones there also appeared two asura maidens adorned with every ornament, holding fans made of the seven precious substances, and they fanned the young asura maidens seated on the lion thrones.

In each of those courtyards there also appeared sixty hundred billion parasols made of the seven precious substances. In each of those courtyards there also appeared sixty hundred billion victory banners of the seven precious substances. In the golden courtyards were raised blue banners on yellow poles adorned with crystal. In the silver courtyards were raised yellow banners on red poles adorned with gold. In the beryl courtyards were raised red banners on yellow poles adorned with crystal. In the crystal courtyards were raised white banners on beryl poles adorned with gold. In the courtyards of various jewels were raised multicolored banners on golden poles adorned with beryl. The blue banners had yellow finials, the yellow banners had blue finials, the red banners had white finials, the white banners had red finials, and the banners of various jewels all had finials of the seven precious substances.

Those jeweled palace grounds floated in the sky and circled the Blessed One three times. It was just as Airāvaṇa, the elephant of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, travels through the sky and carries the gods of the Thirty-Three to the pleasure grove of the Pārijāta tree. In the same way, those palace grounds floated in the sky and circled the Blessed One three times.

From those jeweled palace grounds, those halls, those dwellings, those multistoried mansions, those courtyards, those lion thrones, those parasols, those victory banners, and those pennants, there fell a rain of the powder of divine sandalwood, utpala, and aloeswood. There also fell a rain of flowers: mandārava and great mandārava, mañjūṣaka and great mañjūṣaka, paruṣaka and great paruṣaka, white-hued flowers and great white-hued flowers, pale flowers and great pale flowers, variegated pale flowers and greatly variegated pale flowers. There also fell a rain of gold, silver, beryl, crystal, conch, emerald, red pearl, flowers of every kind of jewel, wealth, gold, and wish-fulfilling cloth. By the power of those canopies of wish-fulfilling jewels, whatever jewels those asura youths wished to rain down fell from them.

At that time, around the great city of Kapilavastu, for sixty thousand leagues in circumference and sixty thousand leagues in height, everything was completely filled with such offerings of the asuras. Those jeweled palace grounds circled the Blessed One three times and came to rest before the Blessed One. The great city of Kapilavastu was filled with mandārava flowers to the depth of about seven times a man's height, and it became a mire of scented water. Through the power of the Buddha, the great trichiliocosm, the world system of a billion worlds, was pervaded by the fragrance of that mire of

scented water. All the sentient beings in this great trichiliocosm who smelled the fragrance of that mire of scented water became irreversible from unexcelled, perfect, complete awakening, to say nothing of those who had first generated the mind set on awakening.

Then Vemacitrin, the lord of the asuras, mounted a chariot of the seven precious substances, circled three times, scattered sandalwood powder over the Blessed One, and praised him in these verses:

"For the sake of seeking supreme awakening,
I go for refuge to you, supreme refuge,
Utterly unshakable, bestower of fearlessness
On the world together with its gods.

Whoever goes to him for refuge with a joyful mind
Does not fall into the lower realms;
I go to him for refuge
For the sake of seeking incomparable awakening.

You who have shattered the sufferings of saṃsāra,
Who have crossed into nirvāṇa, purified of the afflictions,
A guide who relies on no other,
To you I go for refuge.

Blessed One, guide of gods and humans
Who are tormented by aging and death,
Whoever takes refuge in you is not born again;
To you I go for refuge."

Then, as Vemacitrin, the lord of the asuras, circled the Blessed One three times, those ornaments of the horses, those ornaments of the chariots, those ornaments of the asuras, those ornaments of parasols, victory banners, and pennants, and those ornaments of canopies, bells, and little bells, stirred by the wind, gave forth sounds sweet, delightful, and joyful to hear, just like an eightfold ensemble of music played by a skilled musician. Thus, as Vemacitrin, the lord of the asuras, circled the Blessed One three times, there fell from the sky above a rain of the powder of divine sandalwood, utpala, aloeswood, and tamāla leaves. There fell a rain of many kinds of asura incense powder.

There fell a rain of divine flowers: māndārava and great māndārava, mañjūṣaka and great mañjūṣaka, paruṣaka and great paruṣaka, white flowers and great white flowers, pale flowers and great pale flowers, variegated pale

flowers and great bright pale flowers, together with a rain of all kinds of emanated flowers. From the sky above there also fell a rain of flowers made of gold, silver, beryl, crystal, musāragalva, emerald, red pearl, and every kind of jewel. A rain of the scented water of the gods and asuras fell as well. As that rain of scented water fell, the land for sixty leagues all around the great city of Kapilavastu became a mire of scented water. The fragrance of that mire of scented water filled the whole of the great trichiliocosm, the thousandfold world system of a thousand million worlds. All the sentient beings who smelled that fragrance became irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

When the asura lord Vemacitrin was thus circling the Blessed One three times, the sounds of the divine cymbals of the asuras rang out from the sky. The sound of those cymbals resounded throughout the great trichiliocosm. All the sentient beings who had rightly entered the Great Vehicle and who heard that sound became irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

When the asura lord Vemacitrin had thus circled the Blessed One three times, hundreds of thousands of asura maidens, in order to make offerings to the Blessed One and to serve as the retinue of the asura lord Vemacitrin, did the following. Some sang songs. Some played cymbals. Some danced. Some made graceful movements of the body. Some scattered powdered sandalwood, blue lotus, aloeswood, and tamāla leaf. Some scattered divine flowers, māndārava and great māndārava, mañjūṣaka and great mañjūṣaka, paruṣaka and great paruṣaka, white flowers and great white flowers, pale flowers and great pale flowers, variegated pale flowers and great bright pale flowers, and emanated flowers, as well as flowers made of gold, silver, beryl, crystal, musāragalva, emerald, red pearl, and every kind of jewel, strewing them over the Blessed One.

Some scattered garments, anklets, belts, hand ornaments, finger rings, bracelets, heavy bracelets, three-pointed head ornaments, armlets, diadems, gold threads, pearl garlands, jeweled necklaces, double necklaces, chest chains, various neck ornaments, earrings, hoop earrings, strings of little bells, head ornaments, tassels of garlands, tassels of incense, and tassels of jewels; and they held up canopies of flowers, canopies of incense, and canopies of jewels. Some sent down a rain of scented water. Some sent down a rain of fragrant powder. Some filled their cupped hands with red pearls and strewed them over the Blessed One. Some filled their cupped hands with jewels, and some filled their cupped hands with gold, and strewed them over the Blessed

One. They also spoke this verse:

Relying on whom, and dwelling with whom,
one comes to make offerings to the Supreme Person,
with such a friend as that
may we always and continually meet.

Just as the asura lord Vemacitrin had done, so too the asura lord Fully Soothed made offerings to the Blessed One, mounted a chariot made of the seven precious substances, circled the Blessed One three times, and praised the Blessed One with these verses:

Homage to you of the ten powers, diligent and true!
Homage to you, fearless one, free from all fear!
Certain in the qualities that are unshared,
Guide of beings, homage to you!

Homage to you who cut the bonds of the fetters!
Homage to you who do not remain in the stream of saṃsāra!
Homage to you who have reached the end and stand firm!
Homage to you who rescue beings who are sinking!

Though you keep company with beings, you have no agitation;
your mind is free in the midst of all beings,
like a lotus unstained by water.
Homage to you of profound mind, beyond conception!

Buddha, Sage, you know emptiness;
in every way you have destroyed all signs;
you have no wishing for anything at all.
Homage to you who abide nowhere, equal to space!

Just as the asura lord Fully Soothed had done, so too the asura lord Excellent Chariot made offerings to the Blessed One, mounted a chariot made of the seven precious substances, circled the Blessed One three times, scattered gold dust, and praised the Blessed One with verses:

On the earth, in the sky, and in the realm of the gods,
there is none equal to you, Sugata, let alone one greater.
Beings who grasp at signs and so fall into error
you know to be like a mirage.

Here there is no agent, no feeler, no sentient being;
there is no person, and nothing to be claimed as mine.

All phenomena are empty and void of any agent;
you teach that they lack intrinsic nature, are unmoving and at peace.

Whoever has faith in this teaching of the Sugata
and follows the truth that all phenomena are unmade
becomes here a child of the Guide,
and practices just as was taught, like the father.

Whatever merit has arisen from my praising you, Guide,
just as the Victor knows it with his wisdom,
all those roots of virtue, entirely and without remainder,
I give here to beings: may all attain buddhahood!

The Third Fascicle.

Just as the asura lord Suratha had done, the asura lord Bali also made offerings to the Blessed One (the Buddha). Mounted on a chariot made of the seven precious substances, he circled the Blessed One three times and scattered silver flowers. Then he praised the Blessed One in these verses:

You have crossed the waters of the ocean of saṃsāra to the far shore;
Having crossed, you ferry over the people who follow the current,
And, Sugata, you set them on the far shore, at ease and free from fear.
Sugata of beautiful eyes, I touch my head to your feet.

Supreme intellect, you know all beings completely.
Those whose minds cling fiercely to the thicket of inverted views,
Who do not know delusion to be like a mirage,
You bring to understanding, moved by incomparable compassion.

Supreme among humans, you have taught that all phenomena are like illusions,
That they resemble mirages and are like tricks of the eye.
Excellent Sage, you have given birth to supreme heirs of the Dharma,
Who practice a conduct unattached to the three realms of existence.

Lord of humans, you know that things are false objects,
Devoid of intrinsic nature and empty of the nature of others.
Seeing the minds of deluded fools as like the joys of a dream,
Lord of humans, you and your heirs pursue your conduct in the grove.

Just as the asura lord Bali had done, the asura lord Rāhu also made offerings to the Blessed One. Mounted on a chariot made of the seven precious

substances, he circled the Blessed One three times and scattered flowers of pale and variegated hues. Then he praised the Blessed One in these verses:

Supreme among humans, your body
Outshines this world with its gods,
As Mount Meru outshines a mustard seed,
And the ocean the water in a cow's hoofprint.

Your beautiful form is adorned with the major marks.
By your form you outshine the most excellent of forms
And all forms whatsoever,
As the sun outshines a firefly.

Mass of splendor, by your splendor
You outshine all splendid beings;
Those you outshine no longer glow,
As the sun eclipses the firefly.

Ocean of wisdom, by your wisdom
You outshine all the three worlds;
Those you outshine no longer glow,
As the sun eclipses the light of the moon.

Just as the asura lord Rāhu had done, the asura lord Śambara also made offerings to the Blessed One. Mounted on a chariot made of the seven precious substances, he circled the Blessed One three times and scattered flowers of pale and variegated hues. Then he praised the Blessed One in these verses:

Guide whose intellect is peaceful,
Delighting in calm abiding, you settle
The dust of beings' desire, hatred, and delusion,
As rain settles the dust.

Blazing, you make the way of the Dharma blaze,
Like a fire fed with poured oblations.
As a forest fire let loose burns the trees of the forest,
So you burn up the net of afflictions.

For immeasurable billions upon billions of eons
You have upheld the roots of virtue.
You vanquish all afflictions,
As nectar smeared on the body overcomes poison.

You dispel darkness and gloom,
Like a lamp blazing in a dark cave.
You also reveal the way of the Dharma,
As a jeweler reveals the qualities of gems.

Just as the asura lord Śambara had done, the asura lord Delighting in Battle also made offerings to the Blessed One. Mounted on a chariot made of the seven precious substances, he circled the Blessed One three times and scattered jewel flowers. Then he praised the Blessed One in these verses:

You have tamed the mind, fierce and hard to tame,
Like a hero brave in battle at the front line of war.
Subduing it utterly, you brought it under your own control.
Tamed in mind and fearless one, I bow to you.

You have tamed the senses and conquered the foe;
Fearless and unshaken anywhere, you have found bliss.
You are not stirred even by the afflictions;
In every way you have destroyed the poisons without remainder.

Mighty one, you have cultivated loving-kindness well;
Your mind is the same toward enemy and friend.
Sage, you have overturned the notions of beings;
You do not go into any of the destinies of beings.

Liberated through wisdom, you have dried up the craving for existence;
Your wisdom is pure, and your mind is pure as well.
Your mind is unattached to any phenomenon at all.
Supreme Sage who outshines all, there is none like you.

Just as the asura lord Delighting in Battle had done, the asura lord Sunetra also made offerings to the Blessed One. Mounted on a chariot made of the seven precious substances, he circled the Blessed One three times, presented a great treasure to the Blessed One, and then praised the Blessed One in these verses:

Great hero, you
Know the true characteristic of phenomena.
Even what is spoken of as "dharma"
Is nothing but a conventional designation, a word.

Phenomena, by the essence of phenomena,
Are not apprehended in any way at all.

Even what is spoken of as "dharma"
Is nothing but a name, so you have taught.

A name is void of name,
And so too are characteristics.
Phenomena are without characteristics,
And there is no name either, so you have explained.

Even what is called "explaining fully"
Involves no explaining whatsoever.
Nothing is explained by anyone,
And nothing is explained to anyone.

Your heirs, supreme among humans,
Having understood phenomena in this way,
Conduct themselves without attachment
Even to phenomena, great Sage.

Just as the asura lord Sunetra had done, the asura lord Subduer of the Three Worlds also made offerings to the Blessed One. Mounted on a chariot made of the seven precious substances, he circled the Blessed One three times, presented a pearl necklace to the Blessed One, and then praised the Blessed One in these verses:

Matchless one without a rival, I praise you.
In moral discipline, in form, and in the power of wisdom
You have no equal in the three worlds;
Therefore, vanquisher of foes, you are unequaled.

Since your form was produced by the Dharma,
By the power of your form you outshine the three realms.
Through the power of generosity your major marks are perfect;
Your minor marks are perfect and your form is pure.
Through the power of moral discipline you are unshakable.

even the learned cannot, each for themselves, conceive of it.
You are endowed with moral discipline, and your mind is pure as well.
Lion among men, you have accomplished every deed.
In the power of wisdom there is no one at all your equal.
Undaunted there, having subdued the three worlds,
Roaring like a lion in the assembly,

You overwhelm the intellects of the hosts of sophists.

Just as the asura lord Subjugator of the Three Worlds had done, so too the asura lord Vairocana made offerings to the Blessed One (the Buddha). He mounted a chariot of the seven kinds of precious substances, circled the Blessed One three times, filled his cupped hands with jewels and scattered them, and then praised the Blessed One in verse:

Great Sage, this gathering of people
Gazes upon your face with a mind of faith;
Each of them sees the Victor seated before them.
This is the unique mark of the Victor, the Buddha.

When the Blessed One utters a single speech,
People each understand it according to their own inclinations.
Sage, your speech arises in just that way.
This is the unique mark of the Victor, the Buddha.

When the Blessed One utters a single speech,
The assembly understands it as many different speeches,
And beings understand it according to their own aims.
This is the unique mark of the Victor, the Buddha.

By uttering a single speech,
You establish one thing and refute another.
Guide, you bring the untrained to understanding.
This is the unique mark of the Victor, the Buddha.

Just as the asura lord Vairocana had done, so too the asura lord Release-and-Hold made offerings to the Blessed One. He mounted a chariot of the seven kinds of precious substances, circled the Blessed One three times, filled his cupped hands with red pearls and scattered them, and then praised the Blessed One in verse:

Those given to intoxication, pride, and sinful views,
When, joyful and deeply faithful, they delight
In the mind of the Sugata, lord of men, become heedful;
Those who render him peerless service are the Teacher's sons.

These phenomena do not exist by way of an essential nature;
They are like all the joys of a dream, which are not valid.
Though the enjoyments of a dream do not exist, perception is there.

In this way the Victor sees all phenomena.

Like autumn clouds and like the moon in water,
They delude the minds of those of childish intellect.
But those who are always heedful, who possess the Sugata's understanding,
The learned, are not deluded by this.

Those who are always heedful in your teaching, O Victor,
Those supreme and excellent among humans, will not fall into unfavorable states.
Having examined all phenomena as being like a dream,
Those who see correctly attain samādhi.

Then those six hundred million asura lords, Vemacitrin and the others, having made such offerings, with minds intent upon awakening, were gratified, satisfied, and delighted, overjoyed, and filled with joy and happiness. Joining their palms, they bowed to the Blessed One himself and sat down before the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One looked upon the offerings of those asura lords, and, understanding the superior intention of those asuras, at that moment he smiled. It is the nature of reality for the buddhas, the blessed ones, that whenever they smile, rays of light of various colors, of many colors, namely blue, yellow, red, white, crimson, crystal, and silver, issue from the Blessed One's mouth. Those rays filled the entire world with radiance, then returned, circled the Blessed One three times, and vanished into the crown of the Blessed One's head.

Then the venerable Aśvajit rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and placed his right knee on the ground. He bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One (the Buddha) was, and asked the Blessed One in verse the meaning of his smile:

"Without a cause, O you who wish to benefit the world,
The lion among men does not smile.
Great Sage, for what reason have you smiled?
The supreme being also tells the cause of his smile.
Having seen the vast offering of the asuras,
If you who wish to benefit the world now smile,
Please declare a prophecy for the asuras.
When we hear it, we shall rejoice.

Who today, free of doubt, has truly given rise
To a vast mind here in this assembly?
Knowing whose intention has the Tathāgata,
The lion among men, smiled?
Who today, with a fully purified mind,
Has given rise to faith in the supreme among men?
Knowing whose intention has the Tathāgata
Smiled this delightful smile?
Seeing that smile upon the Sugata's face,
This assembly today has come to wonder,
'This smile the Sugata has smiled in this way:
Whose is it that today has vanquished Māra with his army?'
Great Sage, Victor victorious over foes,
Please cut off the uncertainty of those who wonder.
Supreme among men, today, for beings,
Please swiftly and thoroughly cut off their doubt."

Then the Blessed One answered in verse the question the venerable Aśvajit had asked, and spoke again to the venerable Aśvajit:

"Aśvajit, you have asked your question well.
The smile that I smiled for the benefit of the world,
By it I shall show the result in full.
Listen to that teaching with a one-pointed mind.
Wishing for unsurpassed awakening,
The asuras made this offering to me.
Their minds are attached to nothing at all,
Like a palm that clings nowhere in the expanse of the sky.
The hosts of asuras made their minds full of faith,
And because they made this offering to me,
Those intelligent ones will leave the asura class behind,
Go to the higher realms, and rejoice there for long.
Later, having served and honored victors, lions among men,
As many as ten million times the sands of the Ganges River,
In the Delightful Eon,
All of them will become victors sharing a single name.
At that time those sixty trillion sugatas,
Lamps of the world, renowned in every direction,

Will teach the Dharma of non-abiding
And make it clear to the world with its gods.
The fields of those who know the world
Will be very vast and free of degeneration.
At that time the victors, a full sixty trillion,
Will purify the trichiliocosm.
They will dispel all the lower realms,
And beings will live in joy in those fields.
Those steadfast ones will purify all unfavorable states
And teach the unsurpassed vehicle.
As for the measure of their lives,
For a full sixty trillion eons
Those guides will live,
And they will teach the Dharma of non-attachment.
When those sages have passed into nirvāṇa,
When the knowers of the world have entered perfect peace,
For a full sixty trillion eons
The true Dharma of those self-arisen ones will remain.
Those sugatas will tame the hosts of beings,
People as many as the Ganges' sands.
They will share one name, Victor Victorious over Foes,
And their fields, their lifespans, and the duration of their Dharma will be alike.
Those sixty trillion sugatas
Will bring men and women to full maturity
And lead them by the unsurpassed vehicle.
Those wise ones will also uphold the lineage of the victors."

This prophecy that the Victor gave the asuras
The Great Sage spoke for the benefit of the world.
When the world with its gods heard it,
They rejoiced, and strength arose in them as well.

This is the fourth chapter, the Prophecy to the Asuras.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa, having seen this kind of offering by the asuras, was amazed and thought, "What sort of roots of virtue did the Tathāgata accumulate long ago, when he engaged in the conduct of a bodhisattva, that such a maturation has come about?" At that moment, settling his mind in such a way that he could recollect even incalculable eons,

he entered a meditative absorption of such a kind that he would recollect all of them: the roots of virtue the Blessed One accumulated as he died, transmigrated, and took birth in this and that continuum of existence; the roots of virtue by which he accomplished unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening; and the roots of virtue by which he attained irreversibility.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa, having recollected the Blessed One's great roots of virtue, thought, "Since the Blessed One has accumulated such great roots of virtue, then even for a single one of his generations of the mind, suppose all the beings dwelling in world systems as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River were to obtain human bodies, and each of them made offerings equal to all the offerings of the asuras for eons as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River. Even so, they could not repay even a single one of his generations of the mind."

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa arose from that samādhi. Filled with wonder and faith, he praised the Blessed One (the Buddha) at that time in verses:

O Sage, set on awakening,
even beside a single one of your resolves,
this offering of the asuras
does not amount to the smallest part, O Lion among Men.

You who have perfected such qualities,
honored by gods and humans,
Supreme among Humans, you are worthy to be honored
with sandalwood powder heaped as high as Mount Meru.

O Lion among Men, you are worthy
to be honored with scented water
filling oceans to the brim,
oceans more numerous than the sands of the Ganges.

You who possess great qualities are worthy to be honored
with heaps of flowers more numerous than the Ganges' sands,
equal in size to the supreme mountain
and to the great ring of the world's encircling mountains.

O Victor, self-arisen lamp,
you are worthy to be honored with lamps
whose wicks are the size of Mount Meru,
with sesame oil as plentiful as the waters of the ocean.

You who possess great might,
who have thus gone to the far shore of qualities,
are worthy to be honored with flower stupas
more numerous than the sands of the Ganges.

Compassionate one, honored by lords of men,
Supreme among Beings, you are worthy to be honored
with great jeweled parasols
for myriads upon myriads of eons.

You who possess boundless qualities
are worthy to be honored for inconceivable eons
with jeweled victory banners
filling the world realms of the ten directions.

O Lion among Men, you are worthy
to be honored for immeasurable myriads of eons
with multitudes of pennants
more numerous than the sands of the Ganges.

Great Sage, tiger among speakers,
gods and humans,
and whatever other beings are gathered here,
please listen to an illustration I propose.

Suppose all the beings
in the world realms of the ten directions,
as many as the sands of the Ganges,
were buddhas, supreme humans endowed with the ten powers,
and each of them had heads
as many as the Ganges' sands,
and each of those heads
had just as many mouths,
and each of those mouths
had tongues equal in number to the mouths;
even if they were to praise you
for eons as many as the sands of the Ganges River,
those Victors, unflagging in eloquence,
would not reach the end of your qualities.
O Victor, you have gone
to the far shore of such qualities.

Then the Blessed One said to the monks, "Excellent, monks, excellent! My śrāvakas, every one of them, abide as upright, as endowed with wisdom, as having become Dharma, as having gained mastery, as having become reliable authorities. Every one of them enters into the collection of my qualities. Why is that? Monks, the Tathāgata possesses immeasurable qualities; he possesses inconceivable qualities. Monks, the qualities of the Tathāgata, the perfection of the Tathāgata's qualities, and the collection of the Tathāgata's qualities are inconceivable.

"Monks, if the Tathāgata's qualities had form, the collection of qualities of even a single resolve would not fit into world realms as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River. Even if tathāgatas as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River were to try, for eons as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River, to state the collection of qualities of even a single resolve as a measure of number, they could not state it; even if they were to think about it, they could not conceive it. Why is that? When the Tathāgata formerly practiced the conduct of a bodhisattva, there was not a single resolve he generated that was not generated for the benefit and happiness of all beings, however many there are that are counted among beings. Since the realm of beings is immeasurable, merit as vast as the realm of beings arises from each single resolve of the Tathāgata. The realm of beings is inexhaustible; just as the realm of beings is inexhaustible, so inexhaustible merit arises from each single resolve of the Tathāgata. Since that mind arose for the benefit of all beings, even if all beings were to make offerings, they could not repay it. Why is that? Worldly offerings are bound up with material things, whereas the mind of the bodhisattva mahāsattva, which arises for the benefit of all beings, thinking, 'How can these beings who are bent on saṃsāra come to be bent on nirvāṇa?', is free of anything material. When the Tathāgata formerly practiced the conduct of a bodhisattva, he generated for the sake of beings immeasurable resolves free of anything material.

"Monks, long ago, in the past, immeasurable, incalculable, inconceivable, incomparable, unfathomable, inexpressible eons ago, at that time, on that occasion, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, endowed with knowledge and conduct, a sugata, a knower of the world, a guide who tames beings, unsurpassed, a teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a blessed one called Indraketu. Monks, with each single resolve, that Tathāgata Indraketu intended to benefit the beings of world realms as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River, and he also

accomplished their welfare. The buddha field of the Tathāgata Indraketu, moreover, comprised world realms as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River as a single buddha field. It was completely pure and entirely free of all lower realms and unfavorable states. In that buddha field of the Tathāgata Indraketu there was no birth whatsoever of beings fixed in wrongness. There were no kinds of views whatsoever. There was no one at all with overweening pride. There were no beings at all whose actions of body, speech, and mind were not completely pure. There was no arising whatsoever of the afflictions and karma that become causes of the lower realms. Why is that? Because for a long time that Tathāgata had placed beings in virtuous qualities, established them in them, instructed them, and trained them. Through the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha Indraketu, the beings dwelling in that buddha field also attained five kinds of happiness. Thus some came to possess the happiness of sense pleasures.

Some had the happiness of going forth from the household life. Some had the happiness of meditative concentration. Some had the happiness of meditative absorption. Some had the happiness of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. They enjoyed that happiness, yet they had no clinging to those kinds of happiness. A bee, for example, lives on the nectar of flowers, yet it has no clinging to it. In the same way, those beings fully enjoyed that happiness, yet they had no clinging to it. A bird that flies through the sky, for example, moves through the sky, yet it has no attachment to it. In the same way, those beings fully enjoyed that happiness, yet they had no clinging to it.

For the beings who dwelt in that buddhafield of the Tathāgata Indraketu, there was no displeasure that made the mind unhappy, and nothing that made them bewildered. Instead, they enjoyed nothing but the joy that makes the mind happy. This was because they had formerly cultivated such roots of virtue. Why was that? When the Tathāgata Indraketu was formerly practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva, he turned those beings away from nonvirtue and set them in virtue. They therefore had no nonvirtuous karma at all of the kind whose ripening comes about helplessly, through which painful feeling is experienced. Because they had not accumulated it, no ripening arose that brought painful feeling. Nor, even with a merely deluded thought, did they create any karma of the kind through which, for the deluded, a feeling that is neither painful nor pleasant arises. Because they had not accumulated it, that deluded feeling which is neither painful nor pleasant did not arise.

In that buddhafield of the Tathāgata Indraketu, the cause by which those beings would suffer from the change of seasons did not occur. So no harsh sun rose there, no harsh wind blew, and no harsh rain fell. When the Tathāgata Indraketu was formerly practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva, he taught and explained to those beings that all actions of body, speech and mind should be preceded by knowledge and should follow upon knowledge. Those beings heard that teaching from the bodhisattva, and they carried out all their actions of body, speech and mind preceded by knowledge and following upon knowledge. Through the ripening of that karma, they had no bewilderment and no unhappiness of mind. They had none of the causes by which, for the deluded, a feeling that is neither pleasant nor painful arises. So in that buddhafield those beings had no painful feeling, and no feeling that is neither pleasant nor painful.

The beings born in that buddhafield, whom that Tathāgata had gathered, lived devoted to the Dharma with great reverence. When they walked, they walked with their thoughts on the nature of reality, with minds intent on the Dharma through their devotion to it. For those who walked with minds devoted to and intent on the Dharma, no painful feeling arose. Likewise, when standing, sitting, lying down or waking, and in every posture, no suffering arose.

Among the beings of that buddhafield there was nothing dreadful left unabandoned. Therefore the suffering of what is dreadful and unabandoned did not arise. Because they had right abandonment, they had no weariness. Therefore they also had no suffering that would need to be rightly abandoned. Those beings had no suffering of change either, because they had no clinging to any phenomena. They had no suffering of meeting with what is unpleasant, because a mind of equality toward all beings was present in them. They had no suffering of separation from what is dear. Why is that? Because they had no clinging to any phenomena. The suffering of separation from what is dear arises from what is dear, and therefore they had no suffering of separation from what is dear. Those beings had no suffering of suffering either, because no painful feeling occurred there. Apart from this there was only the suffering of formations, namely the suffering of impermanence itself.

That Tathāgata taught the ultimate Dharma. Through all the time the Tathāgata Indraketu remained, for eons as many as the sands of the Ganges River, no being ever appeared in that buddhafield who contradicted what he taught, because he had formerly brought those beings fully to maturity.

"Monks, what do you think? With roots of virtue that are weak, low, timid and small, brought about through suffering, mixed with suffering, accompanied by suffering and gripped by suffering, ill-intended and ill-performed, could one act for the benefit of so many beings, or intend their welfare, or bring about their happiness, or remove their suffering, or purify so vast a buddhafield, or bring so many beings to maturity?"

They replied, "No, Blessed One, one could not."

He said, "Monks, what do you think? With a mind that is weak, a mind that is low, and so on up to a mind that is ill-performed, could one act for the benefit of so many beings, or intend their welfare, or bring about their happiness, or remove their suffering, or purify so vast a buddhafield, or bring so many beings to maturity?"

They replied, "No, Blessed One, one could not."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, what do you think? With faith ranging from weak faith to poorly accomplished faith, with moral discipline ranging from weak discipline to poorly accomplished discipline, with learning ranging from weak learning to poorly accomplished learning, with diligence ranging from weak diligence to poorly accomplished diligence, with mindfulness ranging from weak mindfulness to poorly accomplished mindfulness, with meditative absorption ranging from weak absorption to poorly accomplished absorption, and with wisdom ranging from weak wisdom to poorly accomplished wisdom, could one act for the benefit of so many sentient beings, or intend to help them, or bring about their happiness, or remove their suffering, or purify so vast a buddhafield, or bring so many sentient beings to maturity?"

They replied, "No, Blessed One, one could not."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, monks, excellent! With weak roots of virtue and a weak mind; with weak faith, moral discipline, learning, diligence, mindfulness, meditative absorption, and wisdom; with a wisdom that is inferior, faint-hearted, and small, that is wholly shaped by suffering, mixed with suffering, accompanied by suffering, and in the grip of suffering, a wisdom that is ill-conceived and poorly accomplished, one cannot act for the benefit of so many sentient beings, or intend to help them, or bring about their happiness, or remove their suffering, or purify so vast a buddhafield, or bring so many sentient beings to maturity.

"Monks, what do you think? Who do you suppose was the Tathāgata called Indraketu who appeared at that time, on that occasion?"

When he had said this, the monks sat there without saying anything.

At that time, in the eastern direction, beyond as many world systems as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges, there is a world system called Beautifully Adorned with Moonbeams. There the Tathāgata called King of Exalted Splendor is presently dwelling, living, and abiding, and he teaches the Dharma. Mañjuśrī the youthful, who had gathered there and was seated among the assembly, knew with his mind what the Blessed One intended, and he said this to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata King of Exalted Splendor: "Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni is teaching the Dharma in the Sahā world system. I too shall go there in order to serve and honor that Blessed One Śākyamuni."

When he had said this, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata King of Exalted Splendor, spoke these words to Mañjuśrī the youthful: "Mañjuśrī, if you know that the time has come, then go."

Then Mañjuśrī the youthful rose from his seat, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata King of Exalted Splendor, and circumambulated him three times. Then, in the time it takes a strong man to stretch out his bent arm or to bend his outstretched arm, Mañjuśrī the youthful vanished from that world system Beautifully Adorned with Moonbeams and came to be here, in the presence of the Blessed One Śākyamuni. He bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, Mañjuśrī the youthful said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, when the Blessed One said, 'Monks, what do you think? Who do you suppose was the Tathāgata called Indraketu who appeared at that time, on that occasion?', Blessed One, it was the Blessed One himself who at that time, on that occasion, was the Tathāgata called Indraketu. And why is that? Because the Blessed One possesses inconceivable skill in means. He is never satisfied in bringing sentient beings to maturity; he never ceases purifying buddhafields; he is never satisfied in establishing sentient beings in the qualities of a bodhisattva. If anyone, speaking truly, were to speak truly and say 'the chief Victor, the holy Victor, the supreme Victor, the most excellent Victor,' then, saying this of the Blessed One himself, they would be speaking truly."

Having said this, Mañjuśrī the youthful then spoke these verses:

The heroes are skilled in means
And loving toward sentient beings;
To bring sentient beings to full maturity,
The Great Hero works his magical displays.
Though in eight hundred million worlds you, the Victor,
Have shown yourself as a buddha,
You still dispel the thought that this is enough,
And your mind still turns to supreme awakening.
Since you purify the buddha fields
Of sixty-one great trichiliocosms,
All know you, Victor,
As the Sage skilled in means.
Even now, here and there,
You show the first arising of the mind of awakening;
And even now, O Guide,
You make many buddhas appear.
Through forms of various kinds
You carry out the conduct of the supreme person.
Unattached to the realm of phenomena,
You know whatever there is.
In the guise of Śakra (Indra) or of Brahmā,
And sometimes in the guise of Māra,
You work for the benefit of sentient beings,
In ways the worlds cannot fathom.
You act in the guise of a woman,
And dwell even in the births of animals;
Yet you are not stained by worldly concerns,
Just as a lotus is untouched by water.
O Guide, you conform yourself
To this world of many dispositions;
Therefore these beings
Proclaim your qualities day and night.
In some places you display your birth,
In some places you display nirvāṇa,
In some you turn the wheel of Dharma,
In some you take up the conduct of practice.
For the sake of taming sentient beings,

You rejoice, sing songs, and play,
And you even shed tears;
No sentient being whatever fully knows you.
Free of attachment, you take on the manner of attachment;
Free of fear, you seem afraid;
In order to tame sentient beings,
The Guide works his magical displays.
Without delusion, you show the manner of the deluded;
No child, you take on the manner of a child;
In order to tame sentient beings,
The Guide works his magical displays.
Not mad, you take on the manner of the mad;
Not lame, you seem to be lame;
Through magical displays of every kind
You tame sentient beings.
Thus, inconceivable Protector,
Your sublime Dharma too is beyond conception.
Great Hero, I bow down to you:
May sentient beings become like the Great Sage!

This concludes the fifth chapter, Past Events, Requested by Mahākāśyapa.

Then the eighty-six thousand garuḍa kings, having seen the offerings of those asura lords and heard the prophecy, felt immeasurable faith in the Blessed One (the Buddha). Eager to make offerings to the Blessed One, they magically emanated, as an offering to him, eighty-six thousand multistoried palaces of the seven precious substances, brilliantly colorful and beautiful to behold. The seven divine precious substances are these: gold, silver, beryl, crystal, agate, red pearl, and emerald.

Those multistoried palaces were surrounded on all sides by seven tiers of latticed railings of the four precious substances, brightly patterned and beautiful to behold. The four precious substances are these: gold, silver, beryl, and crystal. The posts and rails of the golden railings were of gold, and their slats of silver. The posts and rails of the silver railings were of silver, and their slats of gold. The posts and rails of the beryl railings were of beryl, and their slats of crystal. The posts and rails of the crystal railings were of crystal, and their slats were made of silver.

Those multistoried palaces were surrounded on all sides by seven tiers of nets of bells and small chimes, brightly colorful and beautiful to behold. These too were made entirely of the seven precious substances, namely gold, silver, beryl, crystal, agate, red pearl, and emerald. Those multistoried palaces were entirely covered with nets of the seven precious substances, brightly colorful and beautiful to behold: nets of gold, nets of silver, nets of beryl, nets of crystal, nets of red pearl, nets of agate, and nets of emerald.

They also emanated eighty-six thousand parasols, brightly colorful and beautiful to behold, all made of the seven precious substances, from gold up to emerald. They emanated eighty-six thousand victory banners as well, brightly colorful and beautiful to behold. Those banners too were all made from the four precious substances, gold, silver, beryl, and crystal. All the banners they emanated were such that the blue banners had yellow crests, the yellow banners had blue crests, and the red banners had white crests. They emanated eighty-six thousand pennants of many colors as well, brightly colorful and beautiful to behold. They emanated eighty-six thousand canopies as well, brightly colorful and beautiful to behold. Those canopies too, canopies of gold thread, canopies of silver thread, canopies of beryl, canopies of crystal, canopies of red pearl, canopies of agate, and canopies of emerald, were all made from the seven precious substances.

Then those garuḍa kings offered to the Blessed One those eighty-six thousand multistoried palaces, those eighty-six thousand parasols, those eighty-six thousand victory banners, those eighty-six thousand pennants, and those eighty-six thousand canopies, and all of them, floating in the sky above, circled the Blessed One three times. Just as the son of the elephant king Airāvaṇa carries the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three on his head and goes through the sky to the Pārijāta tree, so those multistoried palaces, those parasols, those victory banners, those pennants, and those canopies floated in the expanse of the sky and circled the Blessed One three times.

Then those eighty-six thousand garuḍas made offerings to the Blessed One, circled him three times, and sat down to one side. Joining their palms and bowing, they praised the Blessed One with these verses:

Homage to you, who are free from aging and death!
Homage to you, who are liberated from aging and death!
Homage to the guide of countless sentient beings!
There is none equal to you, nor any who surpasses you.

"May we too possess the body of Nārāyaṇa,
Our limbs adorned with the thirty-two major marks,
Made utterly beautiful by the eighty excellent minor marks;
May we become buddhas, guides, just like you.
May we have the brilliance of a fathom-wide aura of light,
Beautiful with a sublime and exalted form;
May we be endowed with supreme deportment,
Purifying beings and dispelling their sorrow.
May we be fully endowed with moral discipline and concentration,
And through wisdom become supreme;
Thus, just like you, O guide,
May we expound to people and accomplish buddhahood.
Just like you, the guide wise in the ways of the world,
May we become guides endowed with the ten powers,
Perfect in the eighteen unshared qualities,
Wise in the ways of the world, and omniscient.
May we all teach that beings are without substance,
Like dreams, like illusions, without any abiding,
Like echoes and like space,
Just as you, O guide, teach."

Then the Blessed One (the Buddha), knowing the superior intention of those kings of birds, the Suparṇas, smiled. Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"Victors, guides, chief ones, buddhas
Do not smile without a cause;
What is the cause and condition of this smile?
Benefactor of the world, compassionate one, please tell us.
The Suparṇas have worshipped the Victor
And displayed a canopy filling the vast sky,
Arousing wonder in this world with its gods;
Supreme among two-legged beings, please prophesy for them.
All beings, their palms joined together,
Sit with joyful minds and delighted minds,
Wishing to hear what will become of the garuḍa beings;
Supreme among two-legged beings, please prophesy for them.
Their coming to you, best of humans,
Frees all beings from doubt,

And being free of doubt, the assembly becomes fearless;
By this, it is said, the Buddha is pleased.
In this assembly, fearless, they will greatly rejoice.
Fully purified, their faults thoroughly removed,
Those prophesied by the Victor will rejoice,
As when a teacher instructs a supreme disciple.
Please cut the doubts of those who have doubts;
Bring them great joy, and make an aspiration for them.
Since this assembly has gathered with joyful minds,
Self-Arisen One, tell what will become of the garuḍa beings."

Then the Blessed One again addressed the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

The one who overpowers all, of ten powers and true diligence,
The Victor, lord of sages, the Tathāgata,
The guide, with a voice of eight qualities,
Spoke to Aśvajit about the Suparṇa beings:
"Aśvajit, you have asked your question well.
The smile that I displayed for the benefit of the world,
Hear its result with a joyful mind;
Dispel your doubts and give rise to great joy.
Seeking unsurpassed and peaceful awakening,
And in order to seek the powers and the four fearlessnesses
Through which a guide becomes fearless,
The lords of birds made fine offerings to me.
In order to seek thoroughly the very firm body of Nārāyaṇa
Of one who proclaims the eighteen unshared qualities,
And the thirty-two marks and the excellent minor marks,
They made offerings to me.
Seeking the moral discipline and concentration of the Victor,
And also wisdom, the domain of the buddhas,
Perfect fields, and the liberation of beings,
For the sake of seeking all these, they made offerings.
Because they have made offerings to me with joy,
When they die and pass from the state of animals,
They will go where their conduct accords with that of the gods;
This is their last existence in the lower realms.
For ten million eons, as many as the sands of the Ganges,

They will dwell among gods and humans,
And having worshipped endless multitudes of guides,
They will become victors who have tamed their senses.
In their fields no lower realms will arise;
No unfavorable states will arise, and none will lack the marks.
The names of those victors will be wholly beautiful;
In the eon Banner of Sumeru they will become self-arisen ones.
For eight hundred and forty million years
Those guides will remain for the benefit of the world.
Because the guides rest in meditative equipoise for the world's benefit,
They will work impartially for the welfare of embodied beings.
Those protectors, who have become free of stain,
Will have eighty assemblies of those who have abandoned pride.
At that time, of those stainless protectors,
Eight hundred million with thoroughly tamed minds will arise.
Those guides, in order to remove the pride of beings,
Will fully turn the wheel of Dharma.
Friends, it is thus that these had great pride
And took on garuḍa bodies of great strength.
At a certain time in the past,
These were a company of sages of fierce austerity,
Fully eighty-six thousand in number;
They practiced austerities and sought perfect miraculous powers.
Having gained miraculous powers, through their pride
They delighted in possessing fierce austerities.
Their moral discipline unbroken, in the forest groves
Their lives ran out, they died and passed on, and their bodies perished.
Because of that pride they became garuḍas flying in the sky;
Through their minds set on miraculous power, they were born with miraculous powers.
Because of their pure moral discipline, they have faith in the Victor's teaching;
And through pride they have also given rise to the mind of awakening."

This is the sixth chapter, the Prophecy to the Garuḍas.

The fourth fascicle.

Then nine hundred and sixty million nāga maidens saw the offerings of those lords of the asuras and of those lords of the garuḍas, and heard the prophecies

as well. A supreme and great joy arose in them; they were delighted, pleased, and overjoyed, and full of joy and gladness, they set about making offerings to the Blessed One. They emanated nine hundred and sixty million parasols of the seven precious substances, with spread nets of beryl, encircled by nets of red pearls, with golden handles, a hundred thousand spread ribs of beryl, and tassels of refined jewels. They emanated nine hundred and sixty million blue horses, blue in color, appearing blue, emitting blue light, adorned with blue ornaments, and bridled with bridles of beryl. In the sky above they emanated a canopy of star-colored jewels, sixty yojanas in circumference, which covered that entire assembly.

On it they magically produced nine hundred sixty million hanging pendants of the seven precious substances, bright, beautiful to the eye and lovely to behold, and hung them there. All around that canopy they magically produced nets of bells and small bells of the seven precious substances and hung them. They magically produced crane-foot ornaments of the seven precious substances. They magically produced nine hundred sixty million nāga musical instruments.

Then those nāga maidens mounted those blue horses and held parasols of the seven precious substances in the sky above. Moving through the sky, they played the music of those nine hundred sixty million instruments and circled the Blessed One three times. They scattered powdered divine sandalwood over the Blessed One. Over the Blessed One they also scattered divine aloeswood, tamāla leaves, powdered utpala and various flowers. They also scattered utpala flowers and garlands of campaka, and garlands of many different kinds of flowers. They also presented garlands of various incenses, garments and ornaments. Just as the asuras had done, they made vast offerings.

Then the sound of those nine hundred sixty million musical instruments they played entirely filled the great trichiliocosm, and all the beings who heard that music became irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. When the canopies of star-colored jewels, the pendants of the seven precious substances, the nets of bells and the crane-foot ornaments were stirred by the wind, there arose a sound as melodious, as pleasing and as delightful to hear as that of an instrument of eight parts played by a skilled musician. That sound too entirely filled the great trichiliocosm, and all the beings who heard the sounds of those ornaments became irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then those nāga maidens sent down a rain of many kinds of flowers and a rain of many kinds of scented water. As the rain of flowers fell, a sweet fragrance arose and drifted to and fro. As the rain of scented water fell, the ground for sixty yojanas all around the great city of Kapilavastu became a mire of scented water, and that fragrance entirely filled the great trichiliocosm. All the beings who smelled that fragrance became irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Then those nāga maidens, having made offerings to the Blessed One with those nine hundred sixty million parasols, nine hundred sixty million horses and nine hundred sixty million musical instruments, remained in the sky, adorned with every ornament. They bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and circled the Blessed One three times. With palms joined, they paid homage to the Blessed One and settled to one side. At that time they also spoke these verses:

Those wise nāga maidens, with joyful, delighted and contented minds,
Seeking peaceful awakening, there made a great offering to Śākyamuni.
They magically produced nine hundred sixty million parasols, beautifully adorned with ornaments,
And worshiped the Sugata, free of attachment, with thoroughly tamed minds.
They magically produced nine hundred sixty million horses, beautifully adorned with ornaments,
Horses blue in color, with blue trappings, adorned with blue banners.
Moving all together through the sky, they made offering to the Sage with the horses.
Those nāga maidens, with minds of faith, bowed their heads to the Sage.
To make offering to the Supreme One, from the abode of the nāgas, with nāga instruments,
They there made offering to the Guide Śākyamuni, who is worthy of offering.
The sound of those instruments offered to the Sugata resounded through the three realms.
Multitudes of beings who heard that sound truly entered upon awakening.
What they had magically produced there in the sky became a single great canopy,
Spreading sixty yojanas in the ten directions and covering all beings.
The splendor of precious star-colored jewels blazed and shone in every direction.
Joyfully, for the sake of beings, the nāga maidens made offering to the Victor.

Joyfully generating measureless resolve and seeking peaceful awakening,
May we attain buddhahood as sugatas who benefit the world, wise in the ways of the world!
Just as you who possess the ten powers free sentient beings from suffering,
So may we too teach the Dharma and free the multitudes of beings obscured by affliction and suffering!
Phenomena are like illusions and mirages, and frail like foam;
Like bubbles on water struck by streaming rain, they perish, and they have no owner.
Having examined all beings as like reflections in a mirror,
We shall teach beings the true reality of the nature of phenomena.
Like an illusory display, nonexistent and false, they delude the childish
And make unskilled people, who do not know things as they are, commit great wrongs.
You, Sinless One, see well these phenomena that delude the childish just as they are,
And just as you see them, so you teach them to sentient beings.
Just as when clouds gather over this great earth they appear like mountains,
Yet in truth no mountain exists there by its essential nature,
So all beings, lacking intrinsic nature, delude the senses;
But the wise, examining with knowledge, are not deluded.
Because you teach that in truth all beings lack intrinsic nature,
The wise become inseparable from you, Guide and Victor.
Your heirs, fully satisfied by the Dharma, are like bridges over a mire.
This is not the domain of childish people; these beings follow after mere sounds.
That being so, Sinless One, true Teacher, protector of childish people,
Refuge, ally, abode, support and mainstay, in you we take refuge.
To seek that immeasurable awakening, we make offering to you, the Leader.

"Having become buddhas, may we, who realize and are free of evil, accomplish the welfare of the world."

Then the Blessed One (the Buddha), understanding the superior intention of those nāga maidens, smiled. Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"In the world, O wise one of the world, supreme guide, you have smiled.
I have never seen you, so rich in glory, smile without a cause.

Sublime lord of men, truly declare the cause of your smile.
On hearing it, the hosts of gods, humans and asuras, the nāga maidens, the guhyakas,
And the gandharvas too, hearing the protector's intent, will rejoice in mind.
In the worlds, O guide of the world, you know every cause.
There is no phenomenon at all that the Victor does not know in its causes and its aspects.
Therefore, Sugata, Victor, declare the cause of your smile as you have understood it.
Hearing it, all beings will be delighted and their doubts will be cut off.
In the supreme teaching of the Sage, the Sugata, they will also attain the goal.
These assemblies, having experienced its meaning, will become deeply peaceful in mind.
They will not fall under the sway of conceptual thought, and with minds set on awakening they will listen to the conduct of the Victor.
Hearing the meaning of your smile, Sugata, they will surely go forth as self-arisen ones.
This assembly, seeing the smile upon your face, O Victor, has fallen into doubt.
Those anxious with suffering, unhappy, and uncertain about the Dharma:
For them, Sage and Teacher, please dispel the doubt and slay the uncertainty.
O sage, quickly declare why you showed a smile, and crush the doubt.
Which victor today has purified the mind and has vanquished and tamed Māra?
Who, with mind fully satisfied, has made a sublime offering to the Blessed One?
Whose power is this? Teacher, declare it before these beings.
Having heard it, we will be delighted, supreme joy will arise, and we will be happy.
These beings gathered at your feet are in doubt.
Declare the cause of the smile that brings forth joy; Sage, please dispel the doubt.
Hearing it, these beings together with the gods will be free of doubt.
Having truly heard the sound of the Victor's speech, their minds will rejoice."

Then the Blessed One replied once more to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

"Excellent, Aśvajit! You have asked well about this smile, the Victor's intent.
When the nāga maidens made offerings, I showed a smile for the benefit of the

world.
I shall show its fruit; listen with a mind that has abandoned doubt and hesitation.
Listen to my words about the reason for which I smiled here.
These nāga maidens, with minds free of attachment, have truly entered upon awakening.
Having analyzed all beings as empty, these wise ones abide well, free of doubt.
Here there is no agent, no experiencer, no person, and no one who is born.
These phenomena are false, like a mirage, like a reflection in a mirror.
I know that these, who have made offerings, are grateful and of true understanding.
They see well that the Victor's nature of reality and beings are empty and without an owner.
These offerings, so varied and so well arranged, are like illusions.
The immeasurable awakening for which they made their aspiration is likewise empty.
Because they made that immeasurable offering to me and know beings to be empty,
When they die and pass from the nāga realm, they will go to the abode of the gods, the abode of Śakra (Indra).
Having gone to the Heaven of the Thirty-Three and completed their lives in joy among the gods,
They will go to the divine abode of unblemished fame, the abode of the Yāma gods.
Dwelling among the Yāma gods, in that divine abode they will enjoy divine pleasures.
Having become gods, those children of the Sugata will remain there for the measure of their lives.
The Victor's children, having enjoyed the pleasures of Yāma, when their lifespan is exhausted,
Will go to the abode of Tuṣita, the city of the gods, and become like the gods in their way of life.
There, surrounded by goddesses, they will enjoy divine pleasures.
Like a lotus unstained by water, those sugata ones of nonabiding mind will dwell there.
Realizing all beings to be empty, they will never fall away from awareness and understanding.

The mindfulness of these protectors, like something carved in stone, will never decline.
Having dwelt in that abode of Tuṣita and enjoyed divine pleasures,
When their lifespan is entirely exhausted, they will then go to the Nirmāṇarati gods.
There too those sugata ones of unblemished fame will be honored by hosts of goddesses,
And, possessed of nonabiding understanding, they will remain for as long as their lifespan lasts.
Having become Nirmāṇarati gods in that abode and enjoyed divine pleasures,
The wise and understanding ones, when their lives are spent, having reached the culmination of the Dharma,
Guides of pure intention, with unattached minds, whose thoughts are set on the Dharma,
Those endowed with the Dharma will go to the assembly of the gods in the abode of the Paranirmitavaśavartin.
They will dwell in that divine abode and enjoy divine pleasures.
Those sugata ones, undeluded and understanding, will remain for their own lifespan.
Like nirvāṇa, they realize the divine pleasures of the senses to be sameness and peace.
Through meditative concentration they will go to the abode of Brahmā, of unblemished fame.
In the abode of Brahmā, skilled in meditative concentration, having enjoyed the fruits of concentration,
Dwelling there they will become incomparable, and with minds set on awakening they will remain for an eon.
For an eon they will dwell in harmony with the abode of Brahmā, seeking the aim of wisdom, of excellent discipline.
Those sages, wise and skilled in means, will accomplish boundless benefit for the world.
Those wise sages there, in the domain of meditative concentration, will be unattached to concentration.
Knowing the bliss of concentration as like sameness, their faculties will be stilled for the sake of awakening.
With minds wholly liberated, those sages, for the sake of awakening, will possess the mind of awakening.

Like nirvāṇa, their concentration will be single-pointed and bear the characteristic of peace.
Sugata ones and children of the Blessed One, seeking the peace of awakening,
With minds like Brahmā's, working for the welfare of the world, they will dwell in that abode of Brahmā.
All of them, possessed of Brahmā's understanding, perfected, wholly for the sake of awakening,
Will teach the deliverance of the self-arisen intent that passes beyond the path of the three realms.
Generating respect for Brahmā, beings will come to seek awakening.
Having understood Brahmā's intention, the self-arisen intention, the ultimate deliverance,
Those diligent in the supreme teaching of the Sugata will teach the Dharma to beings
In such a way that they swiftly come to know the fruit of the Dharma's way.
Dwelling in that abode of Brahmā, for the sake of the worlds' awakening,
Having benefited them, they will establish many tens of millions and trillions of living beings in awakening.
To make offerings to all the victors, they will go to many trillions of world systems.
Those of stilled faculties will become victors in the eon called Tārakopama, Like the Stars."

Gods, humans, nāgas, garuḍas, and asuras,
gandharvas, kumbhāṇḍas, hosts of kinnaras, and yakṣas, with all beings, were joyful and delighted.
The Blessed One, through the Dharma perfectly purified, has gained power in awakening.
All of them rejoiced, joined their palms, and bowed their heads to the Sugata (the Buddha).

This concludes the seventh chapter, the Prophecy of the Nāga Maidens.

Then Nanda and Upananda, kings of the nāgas, and nine hundred million nāgas with them, saw the offerings of those nāga maidens, heard the prophecy, and understood it completely. They were filled with wonder and thought: "That Tathāgata knows the thoughts of all sentient beings. There is nothing the Blessed One does not know, has not seen, has not heard, or has not directly realized. The Dharma of the Blessed One is well spoken, rightly

seen, free of fever, timeless, leading onward, meaningful to see here and now, and to be known by the wise for themselves. How wonderful and marvelous! That Tathāgata possesses great miraculous power and great might. Even those born as women, who are restless, unsteady and inconstant, fully understand the Dharma the Blessed One teaches. Likewise the Saṅgha of the Blessed One's disciples has entered well, entered uprightly, entered in accord with reason, and entered harmoniously. How very wonderful that even those born as women, possessed of fierce attachment, aversion and delusion, enter into the Blessed One's teaching!"

Filled with wonder, in order to make offerings to the Blessed One, they covered the whole of Jambudvīpa, as far as the mountains at the edge of the ocean, with great clouds of incense, and they filled this whole world with the fragrance of incense. That fragrance in turn filled all the buddhafields completely, and all the sentient beings who smelled it became irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

To make offerings to the Blessed One, they also filled the whole great city of Kapilavastu, for sixty yojanas around, knee-deep with red pearls. They heaped the Nyagrodha Park with priceless precious jewels. They conjured up assembly halls of nāga flowers, sixty yojanas wide, with pillars of the seven precious substances. They also conjured up countless nāga instruments and cymbals and made them resound. In those assembly halls of nāga flowers they hung nine hundred million garlands of many kinds of flowers. The pillars of the seven precious substances were beautifully adorned with nets of beryl. The floor of the assembly hall was covered with priceless precious jewels. That floor was smooth and yielding, just like the stone slabs of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three: smooth as polished stone, beryl in color, pleasant to the touch like kācilindika cloth, delightful, a solace to the eyes of all beings who saw it, and pleasing to the minds of humans and gods.

Among those many precious jewels, from some there came fire, and from some came only water. Of these, from some came blue water, from some yellow water, from some red water, from some white water, and from some water of many colors. From some jewels came a pleasant, cool breeze. From some jewels came, just as one wished, other requisites besides these. Some did the work of oil, and some the work of a mirror, so that the whole assembly appeared within those precious jewels. All the beings moving about in Kapilavastu, however many there were, also appeared within those precious jewels. And the whole assembly saw the Blessed One, who had produced those

miraculous displays of emanation, together with the Saṅgha of śrāvakas, seated within those precious jewels.

From beneath the floor of the assembly hall, by the power of the nāgas, parasols of many kinds emerged. Victory banners of many kinds, pennants of many kinds, flower garlands of many kinds, incense garlands of many kinds, jewel garlands of many kinds, pearl strands of many kinds, garlands of layered flowers of many kinds, horses of many kinds, and nets of bells and tinkling bells of many kinds emerged as well.

Then Nanda and Upananda, kings of the nāgas, and the nine hundred million nāgas led those horses before them and, going on foot, circumambulated the Blessed One three times. Then with precious jewels, pleasant to the touch like kācilindika cloth, they scattered, strewed and showered the Blessed One. All the jewels that had emerged from the floor of the assembly hall fell like rain upon the Blessed One and the Saṅgha of śrāvakas. Those countless nāga instruments and cymbals resounded from the sky above.

Then those nine hundred million nāgas circumambulated the Blessed One three times, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, and joined their palms. Without a word, they recollected the Blessed One in every aspect and gazed at him without blinking. Thus, longing for the qualities of a buddha, they set out truly for awakening with superior intention.

Then they remained silent for a moment and recollected the qualities of the Blessed One (the Buddha). Each of them draped his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, and bowed with joined palms toward where the Blessed One was. They prostrated to the Blessed One with the five limbs and praised him in these verses:

You whose hundred marks are complete, who kept your vows well,
Delighting in austerity, stainless and compassionate,
Abandoned the land that held a source of jewels.
You, Sugata, went forth from the city.
For six years you performed hard austerities,
And though you, Victor, did not yet find the deathless nectar,
Your heart, Sugata, never lost courage.
Sage, you practiced with the mind set on awakening.
How you, Guide, teacher of gods and humans,
Wishing to benefit beings, practiced austerities,
How the Protector of the world underwent suffering:

Even to hear of that leaves us unhappy.
That the Sage gave away his head and his eyes,
And how he brought the mind of awakening to fulfillment:
When we hear of the Sugata's hardships,
Even to hear of that, we are not at ease.
When the king of Kaliṅga cut off
The feet, the hands and the ears of Kṣāntivādin,
And likewise cut off his nose, the Victor remained unshaken.
Even to hear of that leaves us unhappy.
When you, Guide, would not give up the dove that had come to you for refuge,
And were weighed upon the scales,
Even to hear that of the Victor, we are not at ease.
The Sugata's conduct toward awakening was great suffering.
Should you ask why we find no pleasure in it:
Because beings who do harm to the Sugata
Fall into the darkness of the lower realms,
We are unhappy when we recall the Sugata's conduct of suffering.
Guide of the world, of exalted mind,
How may the Sugata's conduct become a mind of non-harming,
So that while one practices it no harm befalls it?
Guide of the world, please declare the easy conduct.
Sage of infinite understanding, in the Sugata's conduct
These hosts of nāgas strive with all their might.
So that they may practice in accord with your word,
Sugata, please teach the path to awakening.
Longing to attain the state where there is no aging and death,
These hosts of nāgas, O Sage, remain athirst.
Sugata, please declare the easy practice of discipline
By which these beings may be easily tamed.

Then the Blessed One looked upon those offerings of the nāgas, and, understanding the aspirations they had made with superior intention, at that moment he smiled. It is the nature of things that whenever the buddhas, the blessed ones, smile, rays of light of various colors, of many colors, issue from the Blessed One's mouth, rise up as far as the world of Brahmā, return, and vanish into the crown of the Blessed One's head. Then the venerable Aśvajit at that time addressed the Blessed One in verse:

Since the victors, sages among ascetics of excellent discipline,
Do not smile without a cause,
Guide, Sugata, possessed of great compassion,
Peerless Blessed One, please tell the cause of your smile.
Teacher of the assembly, these people
Long to hear the cause of the smile and gaze upon your face.
Their minds are downcast and they are held by doubt.
Wise one, please dispel their doubt.
Wise one of the world, Teacher Śākyamuni,
Who is it today whose mind is filled with joy?
Who has seen the lord of the māras,
Confounded him, and left him unhappy?
Teacher of the assembly, Guide, who is it
That has honored and served the Sugata, the father, the nature of reality itself,
And made a sublime offering to the Sugata?
Lion of the Śākyas, speak, and settle our doubt.
With their ten fingers joined in reverence and placed upon their heads,
These beings gaze upon the Sage's face.
Teacher of the assembly, please dispel their doubt,
And, Guide, tell also the cause of your smile.
Hearing it, these people will rejoice,
And they will understand the Victor's intent.
If the Sugata's retinue is satisfied,
They will not think otherwise and will abide in diligence.

Then the Blessed One again spoke to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

As the wise Sage, the Guide, the teacher of the assembly,
Speaks in a voice like Brahmā's, endowed with eight qualities,
Aśvajit, have faith with a flawless mind,
And listen to the cause of the smile.
These lords of the nāgas, having gained faith,
Outshone all beings and made offerings.
In order to ripen people with ease,
They seek this awakening of a buddha.
Seeing with great compassion beings who have no guide,
Why would they not take suffering upon themselves?
That beings may attain vast awakening,

Guides never grow weary.
Delighting in calm abiding, strong with the powers of wisdom,
Having fully cultivated the three gates of liberation,
Signlessness, emptiness, and likewise wishlessness,
Their minds utterly pure, they will go to bliss.
Realizing the sameness of all beings,
When they hear from the Victor the marks of wisdom,
They will gain an even mind, love and compassion.
Generating great compassion for beings,
Loving and supremely compassionate,
They will become unsurpassed knowers of the world.
Those victors, having liberated these beings equally,
Will become arhats and guides.
Always listening to the words of selflessness,
And never entering into the stream of worldly talk,
They will attain the deathlessness of the sugatas.
There, there will be no māras and no hosts of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas).
To those victors, the compassionate guides and sugatas,
All beings will be devoted.
They will be devoted to all the sugatas' teachings and words,
And to the intent of the sugatas.
Within existence they will practice the conduct of the sugatas,
And ripen beings with the greatest ease.
Attaining the peerless, easily and swiftly
They will fully awaken and attain deathlessness.
When they have attained it, beings too will be devoted,
And all people will be endowed with supreme form.
All beings will directly understand
The words of those sugatas' intent.
Those animals, birds, yakṣas and humans
Will not do the least thing of their own accord that is not their intent.
At all times they will realize the Dharma and possess mindfulness,
And they will attain the deathlessness of the sugatas.
Of the beings who hear their words,
There will be none at all displeased with that teaching.
Delighting in the speech of those sugatas,

Beings will truly attain the deathless.
At that time beings will rightly understand the Victor's intent.
From old age and sickness and death,
from sorrow and from lamentation, they will be wholly freed.
Hearing those words, they will be free of clinging to "I."
The nāgas' intention was fully laid before the Lion of the Śākyas,
and how they would attain immeasurable awakening
and enter the wisdom of the sages was taught thus to the son.
Hearing the Victor's words, the delightful prophecy of the nāgas,
the assembly rejoiced at heart.
Their minds became utterly peaceful in it,
and with joyful minds they went for refuge to the Victor.

This is the eighth chapter, the Prophecy of the Nāgas.

Then the one hundred eighty million kumbhāṇḍas saw the offerings of the asuras, the garuḍas, the nāga maidens and the nāgas, and also heard the prophecy. They were satisfied, pleased and delighted, overjoyed, joyful and happy, and they were filled with wonder, thinking: "So great is the Tathāgata's mastery of wisdom that even though such vast offerings have been made to the Blessed One, he does not regard them as anything wondrous. It is like the great ocean, which is vast and full, and so neither rises nor falls. In the same way the Blessed One has no doubt about any dharma, has perfected every quality, and possesses the vast wisdom of omniscience. So even when he accepts such offerings he is neither elated nor deflated, and does not regard them as wondrous. That is wondrous indeed!"

Then, in order to honor the Blessed One with an offering of their own, those one hundred eighty million kumbhāṇḍas emanated one hundred eighty million canopies of the seven precious substances: canopies of gold thread, canopies of silver thread, canopies of beryl, canopies of crystal, canopies of red pearl, canopies of mother-of-pearl, and canopies of emerald. On those jeweled canopies they also emanated pendants of garlands of various flowers. On the canopies of gold thread hung pendants of garlands of silver flowers. On the canopies of silver thread hung pendants of garlands of golden flowers. On the canopies of beryl hung pendants of garlands of crystal flowers. On the canopies of crystal hung pendants of garlands of beryl flowers. On the canopies of red pearl hung pendants of garlands of mother-of-pearl flowers. On the canopies of mother-of-pearl hung pendants of garlands of red pearl flowers. And on the canopies of emerald hung pendants of garlands of crystal

flowers. All these they emanated.

They also emanated one hundred eighty million splendid chariots, beautiful to behold, made of everything from gold to emerald. Above those chariots they emanated one hundred eighty million parasols of the seven precious substances, each with a hundred ribs, with handles of gold, handles of beryl, and handles of crystal. On those parasols too they emanated pendants of flowers of various kinds of jewels: pendants of golden flowers, pendants of silver flowers, pendants of beryl flowers, pendants of crystal flowers, pendants of red pearl flowers, and pendants of flowers of nāga jewels. They also emanated nets of red pearl, which held together those parasols and those flower garlands. They emanated the cymbals of kumbhāṇḍa music as well. And each of those chariots was followed by one of those canopies.

Then those kumbhāṇḍas mounted those chariots of the seven precious substances and honored the Blessed One by scattering over him those parasols, canopies and flowers of the seven precious substances, and they circled the Blessed One three times in the sky above. Having circled him, they descended from those chariots, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, sat down to one side, and praised the Blessed One in verses:

"Fearless in every way, possessed of mastery,
Great Sage, neither elated nor deflated,
like Meru, king of mountains:
please accept these vast offerings.

Sage, you know all beings as mere name,
mere sign and mere convention, and you have no attachment.
Guide, having accomplished your peaceful samādhi,
you who possess wisdom have no arrogance at all.

Victor, you know beings to be like illusions,
empty of intrinsic nature, like joy in a dream,
like the moon in water, like a mirage in the sky:
so the Sugata sees these beings.

However a city of gandharvas may appear,
that city exists nowhere in all the ten directions;
that city is otherwise merely a name:
just so the Sugata sees these beings.

All these offerings are just like echoes:
chariots, parasols, canopies and cymbals,
flowers, banners, and the joining of our palms.
Like echoes, so are they.

Guide, may we who have made these offerings
swiftly become buddhas, supreme among humans.
Having realized beings to be like dreams,
we shall teach as you, Victor, teach.

Seeing people tormented by sickness, old age and death,
we too will swiftly attain awakening
and teach to beings the state free of aging and death,
hearing which they will be freed.

Having awakened to the supreme path of awakening,
we shall teach it to beings who have lost their way.
Sage who teaches the undisturbed dharmas,
we shall teach beings the supreme nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the superior intention of those kumbhāṇḍas, smiled.

Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"The Teacher does not smile without a cause;
The Guide, wise in the ways of the world, has nothing that astonishes him.
When the Victor, who is never moved to wonder, smiles,
Please explain well the cause of that smile; I wish to hear it.
Having seen a smile break upon the Victor's face,
These beings are caught in doubt and hesitation.
Dispel the doubt of those who are in doubt;
Lord of humans, tell us the cause of your smile.
Who today has set their mind upon the Dharma?
Who today has also seen the King of Dharma?
Who now has made offerings in praise of the Buddha?
Best of humans, I wish to hear.
Who today, having understood the suffering of the conditioned,
Has overcome the single mind that has turned into formations?
Who abides unwavering in the true limit?
You whose mind is utterly pure, I wish to hear.
Who today has vanquished the māras with their hosts?

Who now has pleased the Sage, the Teacher?
What guide today has found the very depth?
I have doubts, and now I wish to hear of this.
In order to hear the meaning of that smile,
All beings stand with their palms joined.
Guide, remove the doubt of those in doubt;
Supreme among two-legged beings, please give the explanation."

Then the Blessed One again addressed the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

"Aśvajit, you have asked your question well.
Because you have fully asked the cause of this smile,
You have also accomplished the benefit of beings.
I shall explain its meaning; Aśvajit, listen.
The hosts of kumbhāṇḍas have made offerings to me,
And they have set their minds upon the Dharma of peace.
Having seen me, who am beyond wonder, they were satisfied,
And they have set their minds upon the Dharma of peace.
Today they have made offerings to me,
And have turned their understanding fully to the Dharma of peace.
Feeling tender love for people who have lost the path,
From the depths of their hearts they have given rise to great compassion.
Out of compassion they have made offerings to me,
And have thought with loving-kindness of those who have utterly lost the path.
Because those wise ones have done that deed,
When they die and pass from the kumbhāṇḍa state of birth, they, of excellent conduct,
Will go into the presence of Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods,
And will also go into the presence of the Protector, who acts out of compassion and love.
There the teaching will be shown to them a little, again and again,
And they will further become free of doubt about the Dharma.
For eons as numerous as the sands of the Ganges
They will roam from field to field,
Making offerings to the Dharma of the great-souled ones.
With minds that have fully donned the great armor,
Without weariness they will move through
Endless, teeming world systems.

Acting for the benefit of many people, they will become guides,
And will become victors called Beyond Wonder.
Wherever the fields may be to which they go and travel,
There beings will know that a victor has appeared.
Through skillful means, in times to come,
Beyond wonder, they will bring people to liberation.
The victors, Beyond Wonder, purifying fields,
Seek the unsurpassed peace of perfect awakening.
Yet they do not dwell even in that seeking,
For in this way they abide in unsurpassed awakening."

Thus the Victor explained the cause of his smile,
And the Sugata dispelled the misgivings of the world.
Having heard of that fruit of the kumbhāṇḍas' offering,
Beings, their doubts dispelled, were filled with joy.

This is the ninth chapter, the Prophecy concerning the Kumbhāṇḍas.

Then, at that time, three hundred sixty million gandharvas saw the offerings made by the asuras, the garuḍas, the nāga maidens, the nāgas and the kumbhāṇḍas, and heard the prophecies as well. They were satisfied, delighted and elated; supreme joy, happiness and gladness arose in them, and they were filled with amazement, thinking: "It is wondrous and marvelous how the Tathāgata has truly declared again and again that the realm of phenomena is unchanging, has also truly taught the deeds to be done, has taught the increase of the roots of virtue, and has truly taught again and again that there is no prophecy regarding any phenomenon whatsoever." They came to understand such a Dharma, and a vast resolve arose in them to serve the Tathāgata. They became devoted to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, and with minds filled with supreme joy they set about making offerings to the Blessed One.

They emanated three hundred sixty million Airāvaṇas, kings of elephants. Each of those Airāvaṇa elephants had three hundred sixty million heads, and each head had three hundred sixty million tusks. On each tusk there were seven ponds, in each pond seven lotuses, and on each lotus ten billion petals. On each petal there were seven goddesses, and they emanated each goddess surrounded by seven more, adorned with every ornament and holding divine incense, seated at the very edges of the lotus leaves.

On each head of those Airāvaṇa elephants they also emanated three hundred sixty million parasols of the seven precious substances, held in place with nets of the seven precious substances, the spaces between them hung with tassels of the seven precious substances. Over all the elephants' heads they also emanated canopies of divine incense, every one of them hung with tassels of many kinds.

Then those gandharvas mounted the three hundred sixty million Airāvaṇa elephants and, playing divine music and cymbals, moved through the sky. They circled the Blessed One thirty-six times and then scattered divine sandalwood powder over the Blessed One; they strewed it, and they strewed it all about. With divine aguru powder, divine tamāla leaves, utpala powder, divine gold dust, and divine flowers, mandārava and great mandārava, mañjūṣaka and great mañjūṣaka, paruṣaka and great paruṣaka, white-hued flowers and great white-hued flowers, they scattered over the Blessed One; they strewed them, and they strewed them all about. With flowers of gold, silver, beryl, crystal, agate, red pearl and emerald, and with emanated flowers, they scattered over the Blessed One; they strewed them, and they strewed them all about. From those canopies of incense a fragrance arose, spreading out and drifting back again. And a rain of many kinds of divine scented water fell from the sky above.

As that rain of perfumed water fell, the great city of Kapilavastu, for sixty yojanas all around, turned into a mire of perfumed water. The scent of that perfumed mire spread until it filled the entire great trichiliocosm world system, and every sentient being who smelled that fragrance and heard the sound of those musical instruments became irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

In the same way, each gandharva, in order to make offerings to the Blessed One (the Buddha), made offerings with thirty-six koṭis of elephants, sons of Earth Guardian, on whose heads sat divine maidens who sang and danced, and they filled all the people with longing. Some of those divine maidens changed the postures of their bodies. Some scattered powders of sandalwood, aloewood and tamāla leaves. Some scattered powders of the asuras' divine substances and powders of many kinds of incense. Some scattered flowers ranging from māndārava and great māndārava flowers to multicolored skyasnar flowers and great brilliant skyasnar flowers, and conjured flowers as well. Some took up in handfuls flowers ranging from golden flowers to emerald flowers, along with precious metal, gold and jewels, and scattered them over

the Blessed One. Some scattered garments. Some offered things ranging from anklets and girdles to golden garlands adorned with jewels. Some held golden nets. Some held banners of every kind of jewel, and jewel flags of many colors and many hues. Some rained down divine perfumed water, and so on as before, up to the asura maidens praising the Blessed One with verses.

Then those gandharvas, mounted on those royal elephants, the sons of Earth Guardian, circled the Blessed One again and again. Then they dismounted from the elephants, the sons of Earth Guardian, circled the Blessed One three more times, bowed their heads at his feet, joined their palms, sat down to one side, and praised the Blessed One in verses:

Blessed One, Sugata, who brings existence to its end,
You free beings from the bonds of existence.
Nowhere in the three realms of existence is there one like you.
Supreme bull, you possess the finest form and marks.

Supreme among humans, upon this great earth
You, of boundless fame, have shown a wonder.
Though there is no phenomenon whatever that causes change,
You establish beings in the accumulation of virtue.

Sugata, changeless suchness
Is mere expression; there is nothing else at all.
There is no designating of conventions, nor any who designates;
And yet, Sugata, you purify beings.

The Sugata has taught that there is no going and no coming,
No abiding, emptiness of intrinsic nature,
And that these phenomena are without intrinsic nature;
And the supreme Victor has also taught their functions.

No phenomenon whatever performs an action,
Yet the Lord of the World has fully taught action too.
Not thinking of the qualities of self or other,
The Blessed One has taught every deed.

The many and various parts of a chariot,
Though they do not think of the qualities of self or other,
Still carry out the work of a chariot.
Just so has the Sugata spoken of all phenomena.

A phenomenon does not urge on a phenomenon;
A phenomenon does not recollect a phenomenon;
Phenomena do not rely upon phenomena;
No phenomenon whatever is born or dies.

You have declared these beings to be conventional,
Yet that convention too is not found there.
"All these beings are just as convention is":
So you, teacher of the assembly, have proclaimed in perfect purity.

The intrinsic nature of the eye exists nowhere,
Yet the Sugata has set forth its function.
Because you have fully taught such a way of Dharma,
The Knower of the World has done a thing most wondrous.

So may we too become Sugatas ourselves,
And through the Dharma lead erring beings, who have lost their minds,
To take hold of the way of the Dharma,
And bring them to attain the peaceful, deathless state.

Just as you are, Guide,
Guide, Sugata of boundless fame,
Compassionate, wishing to benefit, Knower of the World,
May we possess the marks born of a hundred merits.

Just as you do, Sugata, so may we
Free beings who suffer, veiled by pride,
Following the stream of sensual pleasures,
Delighting in them, beset by the eight sufferings.

Just as you do, Sugata, so may we
Free beings who undergo the harms of suffering,
Caught in the noose of deceit, who see no end,
Utterly bewildered, restless as monkeys.

Just as you do, Sugata, so may we
Free beings who are unskilled and bereft of sight,
The hosts of gods, utterly weary and sunk in sleep,
Who squander the fruit of their own karma.

Then the Blessed One, perceiving the superior intention of those thirty-six koṭis of gandharvas, smiled.

Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"The Sugata, who sees the infinite, has smiled.
Since the Guide does not smile without a cause,
Sugata, tell us swiftly the cause of your smile,
And dispel the doubts of those troubled by hesitation.
Having seen the smile upon your face, O Sugata,
These people have come to doubt.
They long to hear the meaning of the smile.
Great Sage, please dispel the doubts of beings.
Who has entered the teaching of the Sugata,
And become free of doubt, with uncertainty removed?
Knowing whose thought has the Blessed One,
The Supreme among humans, displayed a smile?
Who, just as the Sugata has taught,
Has realized it with understanding and come to abide in accord with the Dharma?
Knowing whose understanding, mindfulness, realization and insight
Has the Sugata smiled amid beings?
These beings, having wholly set aside all other thoughts,
Are eager to hear from your own lips the meaning of the Sugata's smile.
With palms joined, all ten fingers placed upon their heads,
With joyful minds they gaze upon the Teacher's face.
Free of afflictions, having wholly abandoned sorrow,
Great Sage of joyful heart, eye of the world,
Please dispel the doubts and hesitation in the minds of beings.
Compassionate Victor, tell us the cause of the smile."

Then the Blessed One replied to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

"The smile I made was for the sake of beings.
Your question about its meaning is fitting and good.
Through the explanation of that smile's meaning,
The welfare of a great multitude of people will grow today.
Aśvajit, listen to the cause for which I smiled.
This smile that the Guide has made
I shall explain without error.
Listen to that teaching with a joyful mind.
These gandharvas, following the Dharma,
Have made these offerings to the Sugata.
The nature of reality has never come into being,

And the nature of reality will never be exhausted.
The Victor abides seeing conceptual thought as an illusion;
Those who do not understand this fall into delusion.
Whatever phenomenon one may express,
That very thing is empty, the Sugata has said.
Having understood these words of mine,
They made offerings with horses and the finest elephants.
Seeking awakening, free of aging and free of death,
The kings of the gandharvas have honored me.
Having given rise to compassion for beings who have gone astray,
They have set their aspiration on omniscience.
Because they have made this offering to me,
They will leave the gandharva realm with joyful minds,
And, of excellent understanding, dwelling in the abode and realm of the gods,
They will go to the assembly of the gods of Śakra (Indra).
They will make offerings to many koṭis of trillions
Of stainless buddhas, the sugatas.
Following them from field to field,
The wise will also hear the Dharma from them.
They will perfect the conduct of the sugatas,
And their own fields too will always be utterly pure.
Holders of the Victors' lineage,
They will teach awakening to many trillions of sentient beings.
Knowing these beings to be empty of intrinsic nature,
As sugatas they will teach beings.
As victors, omniscient and all-seeing,
Stainless, they will remain for trillions of eons.
As buddhas they will bear the name Infinite Realization,
And each buddha, stainless, will remain
For eons numbering many trillions,
Teaching in turn this path to omniscience."

Thus at that time the Victor, the Sage, destroyer of afflictions,
Prophesied the gandharvas who had made offerings.
Aśvajit asked the meaning of the smile,
And he gave the explanation, the prophecy of the gandharvas.
Hearing the prophecy of the gandharvas, which delighted the mind,

All beings rejoiced.
Having heard there the words of the Sugata,
All went for refuge to Śākyamuni.

This concludes the tenth chapter, the Prophecy of the Gandharvas.

The Noble Meeting of the Father and the Son, a Great Vehicle sūtra. Fifth section.

Then the eight hundred million yakṣas, having seen the offerings of all those from the asuras up to the gandharvas and having heard the prophecies, were delighted, pleased and glad. Supremely joyful, they gave rise to joy and happiness and developed great reverence for the Blessed One's way of wisdom. And because they had also heard of entry into the nature of reality, the perception of him as their Teacher arose in them. They also came to perceive the Blessed One as one whose understanding is inexhaustible, and recognizing him as the Blessed One of Inexhaustible Understanding, they conceived a longing for the qualities of the Buddha.

Having conceived a longing for the qualities of the Buddha, they became eager to make offerings to the Blessed One, and they praised the Blessed One in verses:

"Your power of higher knowledge is utterly boundless,
Like the ocean, which the clouds can never drain.
Therefore, peerless benefactor of the world,
Lion among men, we praise you thus.

One might perhaps weigh Mount Meru on a scale,
O one of great splendor, one might perhaps measure the sky,
But the power of the gnosis of the Sugata, who has supreme wisdom,
No one could ever grasp its extent or gauge it.

You comprehend the intentions of all beings,
Those who can be guided, those who cannot, and those not to be tamed.
You directly know the kinds of their karma.
Therefore, peerless one, you are utterly without limit.

To what kinds of elements they are devoted,
In what ways their mind-streams arise,
And what their inclinations are, you know without exception.
Therefore, peerless one, you are utterly without limit.

Those whose conduct is attachment, and likewise those whose conduct is aversion,
And people whose conduct is delusion, you know likewise;
The forms of jealousy too you know likewise.
Therefore, peerless one, you are utterly without limit.

Wherever these beings wander along the stream of paths,
You, the peerless one, fully know them.
Since gnosis flows forth for this unceasingly,
Therefore, peerless one, you are utterly without limit.

The Sugata fully sees all beings:
On what wasted streams of paths they have wandered,
And who have fallen away from the power of loving-kindness;
All of them without exception you fully see.

For how long beings remain in time,
What kinds of suffering befall them,
And what kinds of bodily form they bear,
All these, O Guide, you fully see.

What views there are, the Lion among men sees,
Through which they come to meet with kinds of suffering;
On what they rely in performing their actions,
These too the Guide fully sees.

They go forth into the teaching of the Victors;
Through which door of liberation,
Relying on what kind of path,
They attain what kind of peace, you know.

Those childish ones who go forth
Into the teaching of the Sugata, and through worldly cleverness
How they abandon the most subtle teaching,
These too the Guide fully sees.

Through contempt for the teaching that benefits the world,
For how long they remain in the great hells
And what kinds of suffering they experience,
These too the Guide fully sees.

Those who give rise to faith in the Victors,
Go forth and uphold the Victor's teaching,

Examine all phenomena as emptiness,
Demolish all signs,
Abandon all wishes for any destiny of beings,
Examine this body as like an illusion,
And realize the aggregates as like an echo,
Those who possess the awakening mind you fully see.

Whatever merit there is in praising you, O Protector,
Just as you, the peerless one, fully understand it,
By it may unexcelled buddhahood be accomplished,
And may all beings attain the Self-Arisen state!"

Then the Blessed One, at that time, perceiving the superior intention of those eight hundred million yakṣas, smiled. Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"The Lion among men has smiled this smile.
The Moon among men, who has become self-arisen,
Does not smile without a cause;
Please tell us the cause of this smile.

Having seen that smile on the Teacher's face,
Blessed One, these worlds are in doubt.
Protector, please dispel their doubts,
And these worlds will become joyful in mind.

Who today has given rise to faith in the Victor?
Who has fully realized the vast Dharma?
Whose mind has come to rest unmoving?
Victor, please reveal these to beings.

Today the assemblies are in great doubt,
And all sit gazing at the Victor's face.
So that all may become free of doubt,
O Hero, please dispel their doubts.

Whose miraculous display is this today?
Who has shown such excellent diligence here?
Who has had cause to meet with you here?
Please explain this well to beings.

Victor, who wish to benefit beings,
Please dispel well the uncertainty of those in doubt.
Hearing it, the worlds together with their gods
Will also attain joy and delight."

Then the Blessed One answered the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

"Aśvajit, you have asked a good question;
Today you have done great benefit for beings.
Since you asked the cause of the Self-Arisen's smile,
You have also clearly seen the Teacher's intent.
I shall reveal their prophecy in full.

Having seen the minds of the hosts of yakṣas,
I smiled for the sake of benefiting beings.
Aśvajit, listen with a faithful mind.

Having understood the peaceful awakening of the Victors,
The hosts of yakṣas gave rise to a mind of devotion,
Praised the Buddha amid the hosts of bhūtas,
And set their minds on the supreme Self-Arisen.

In order to know phenomena as emptiness
And to demolish all signs,
They abandoned all wishes for any destiny,
And set their minds on supreme awakening.

By the power of yoga they demolished the aggregates,
And knowing them to be merely conventional, they were unattached,
Like a lotus in water throughout all existence;
They set their minds on supreme awakening.

Whatever existence they might become attached to
They demolished as empty and realized everything well.
That itself is the unexcelled awakening of the Victors;
For the sake of awakening they know the discipline of solitude.

Birth, old age and death are wholly empty;
That is the unexcelled awakening of the Victors.
Having come to know the intrinsic nature of things as empty,
One attains peaceful, unexcelled awakening.

The intrinsic nature of the aggregates is void and empty;
The intrinsic nature of awakening is void and empty;

The one who practices is also empty by nature;
The wise know this, not the childish.

When they understand gnosis as empty by nature,
And understand the nature of the knowable as empty,
And realize it to be the same as the knower,
They are said to practice the path to awakening.

One should know the nature of emptiness to be empty;
Signlessness too is empty by its very nature;
Wishlessness too is empty by nature;

If they practice thus, they practice nothing other than this.
Hearing this, the worlds together with their gods
rejoiced, and they became endowed with strength.
They placed their faith in the self-arisen Dharma,
knew the state of peace, and set their minds on awakening.

"The hosts of yakṣas today have become devoted,
and because they have made such abundant offerings to me,
these great-minded ones, when they die and pass from the yakṣa lineage,
will go to the higher realms and rejoice for a long time.

"In times to come, by miraculous power,
they will go to buddhafields, and in a single instant
those great-minded ones will worship ten million Victors.
The Victors, knowing their forbearance, will give them instruction.

"By miraculous power, throughout the worlds of the ten directions,
they will move and travel without signs.
Knowing these worlds to be like emanations,
unattached to the world, the wise will practice the practice.

"Relying on this, having richly worshiped the Victors,
they will attain unsurpassed awakening.
Their fields will be limitless,
and they will set free limitless beings.

"As buddhas of limitless knowledge, renowned,
their name will be Wise in the World.
The lifespan of those Victors of peaceful mind
will be a full thousand eons.

"The Saṅgha of their śrāvakas that will arise,
and their many children of the Victors, as numerous as the hosts of stars,
will all attain their aspirations through bliss.
With those called Wise in the World there will be no suffering."

Hearing these words, the worlds together with their gods
sought awakening with minds full of joy.
Satisfied, they undertook diligence steadfastly,
and all became firm through the power of diligence.

This is the eleventh chapter, the Prophecy of the Yakṣas.

Then Druma, king of the kinnaras, together with eighty million kinnaras, saw those offerings of the asuras and the others, up to the offerings of the yakṣas, and heard the prophecies as well. He was filled with great amazement, and thought: "In this way you do not apprehend even a sentient being. There is no life, no one who is born, no human (manuja), no child of Manu (mānava), no person, no self, and nothing whatsoever belonging to a self. Even the aggregates, elements, and sense sources on which the designation 'sentient being' is imputed are not apprehended. Even the karma through whose existence maturation would be designated is not apprehended. Awakening is not apprehended, bodhisattvas are not apprehended, and buddhas are not apprehended. And yet the Blessed One makes prophecies concerning bodhisattvas. This is wondrous and marvelous!

"With what intention did the Blessed One prophesy that the bodhisattvas will become buddhas? With what intention did the Tathāgata make prophecies concerning the bodhisattva's genuine accomplishment, the greatness of the buddhas, the ripening of sentient beings, the arrangement of buddhafields, birth in them and their purity, the bodhisattvas' going from field to field, the worship of the tathāgatas, the power of that worship, and the establishing of sentient beings; prophesying 'one will become a buddha after so many eons,' 'the buddhas, the blessed ones, will remain for so many eons,' 'the assembly of śrāvakas of those buddhas, the blessed ones, will number so many,' and 'after they have passed into parinirvāṇa, the true Dharma will remain for so many eons'? With what intention did the Blessed One have in mind that sentient beings will pass into nirvāṇa through non-grasping?"

Then Druma, king of the kinnaras, these doubts having arisen in him, bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was, and put his question to the Blessed One in a song of verses:

"Having heard the speech of the Victor,
O you of great wisdom, doubt has arisen in me.
Emptiness and prophecy:
Sugata, these I do not understand.

"O moon among speakers, how is it
that you say the dharmadhātu is unchanging, empty,
and without intrinsic nature?
What then is this worship, O supreme among persons?

"There is no birth at all; how then
can there be the generation of the mind for awakening?
That cryptic speech spoken by the Supreme Person
I do not understand.

"Lord of the rulers of men, how is it
that where there is no cessation you speak of death and transmigration?
Through a true explanation of this,
O Sage, my doubt will be laid to rest.

"Being like an illusion, yet born as a god:
how is it that you say this?
These cryptic sayings too,
Lion of the Śākyas, I do not understand.

"There is no abiding at all,
yet you say to rely on a spiritual friend; how is that?
These cryptic sayings too,
Bull among men, I do not understand.

"There is no movement at all, yet you speak of deeds:
how is that, Supreme among two-footed beings?
These cryptic sayings too,
Blessed One who has dispelled the foe, I do not understand.

"Intrinsic nature is empty, and emptiness too
is to be realized, the Protector says; how is that?
Doubts of this kind have arisen in me;
O you of incomparable wisdom, I do not understand.

"You declared that peace exists,
and said that all dharmas are peace; how is that?
O Unequaled One, these cryptic sayings,

please explain them to me.

"Though your body is beautiful,
you say that dharmas are like space; how is that?
If one utterly abandons the Dharma,
how is it that the unwise fall into hell?

"O Steadfast One, you speak of the heavens, the world,
and the other destinies as well;
there is no doer of that karma,
yet you speak of one's own karma; how is that?
This manner of your teaching as well,
O Invincible One, I do not understand.

"Since I have doubts about this, O Protector,
Sugata, please dispel my doubt.
There has been no accumulation of virtue,
yet you speak of the genuine accomplishment of awakening.
This manner of speech of the king of ascetics,
what you have declared thus, I do not understand.

"You say that dharmas are inexhaustible,
yet you teach the exhaustion of karma through abandonment.
About this too, O you of immeasurable intellect,
I am torn by doubt.

"You have declared the true limit,
yet you also teach unerring generosity.
This too, O you whose eyes are free of film,
who have abandoned evil, please explain.

"Apart from the All-Seeing One,
no other is able to dispel
this doubt of mine; therefore
I place my faith in the supreme Victor."

Then the Blessed One, having heard these doubts that Druma, king of the kinnaras, had asked about, replied in verse to Druma, king of the kinnaras, in order to answer him:

"You said, 'Emptiness and prophecy,
these I do not understand.'

If something were not empty,
the Victors would not prophesy it.

Why is that? If in this way
things abided in their own intrinsic nature,
they would be changeless and permanent,
and in them there would be no increase and no decrease.
Just as in a perfectly clear mirror
a reflection appears
that has no intrinsic nature,
so, Druma, you should understand phenomena.

"If the dharmadhātu is changeless,
which limb of offering changes?"
So you ask. Examine the limbs,
and, Druma, investigate this offering.
The wise understand the dharmadhātu
as changeless in every respect.
The childish are confused about this;
those whose minds are trained know it as nonexistent.

You said, "There is no arising, and yet the mind is generated;
this I do not understand."
This is the intentional speech of the one endowed with the ten powers;
do not take it otherwise, but listen.
The childish who delight in saṃsāra,
who take great delight in saṃsāra, their minds attached,
with wrong minds and wrong perceptions,
come to experience the suffering of saṃsāra.
If I were to teach them the mindless Dharma
that they have never heard before,
those of childish understanding
would be utterly bewildered by it.
But once they have heard of the mind inclined toward awakening
and of the benefits of awakening,
they will attain that vast, self-arisen mind
that nothing can overpower.

You said, "There is no cessation, and yet there is death and transmigration;
this too I do not understand."
Death and transmigration were rightly taught;
do not take it otherwise, but listen.
To those who cling to permanence,
saying, "In this there is nothing changeless or permanent;
these things are impermanent,"
the Sugata teaches death and transmigration.

You doubted, "If things are like illusions,
how is there birth among the gods?"
To learners who have not reached the end
and to ordinary people, heaven was taught.

As for what you said: "There is no abiding,
and yet one should rely on spiritual friends,"
in order to become free of abiding,
rely on the spiritual friend who does not abide.

You said, "There is no movement, and yet
I do not understand the teaching of activities."
Understand that the assembly of a chariot's parts
and the function of a chariot are different.
To people who assert that a self exists
and that the act has been done by that self,
the Sugata taught
that there is no action and no movement.

As for what I said: "By intrinsic nature things are empty,
and emptiness too is to be understood,"
it is to teach the childish of wrong understanding
who do not know that intrinsic nature is empty
that the Sugata proclaims,
"Intrinsic nature is empty."

As for what you said: "Produced by the conceptions of imagination,
bound by false conception,
yet there is peace, and all phenomena
are seen as peace,"
those who are ignorant and deluded
give rise to craving from imagination.

Just as at a mirage
thirst arises in the thirsty through imagining,
so that unskilled one wrongly imagines
a cause of conception that does not exist.
Although he sees it as water,
in the mirage there is no water.
In the same way, stirred up by imagination,
the childish who are full of desire
conceive the unlovely as lovely.
What seems possessed of loveliness is by its nature
without loveliness, like the water of a mirage:
in the mirage there is no water,
and likewise in form there is no loveliness.
Though that form is not lovely,
the childish with wrong perceptions
are bound by conceiving it as lovely.

You said, "Phenomena are like space,
and to reject them is to fall into hell."
The unskilled, who have not seen nonexistence,
become afraid.
If intrinsic nature is empty of essential nature,
those who cling to self and do not understand,
when they hear "empty,"
grow afraid, thinking, "I will become selfless."
Clinging firmly to a self,
they tie a knot in empty space,
and rejecting excellent emptiness,
the unskilled in mind fall into the great hell.

I taught the heavenly worlds
and the other streams of beings' destinies,
and I also taught karma,
yet I thoroughly refuted an agent.
Understand that in reality beings
are explained to be like a dream.
In no dream whatever is there a real thing,
yet those with wrong understanding cling to it.

I taught the modes of karma,
yet in the ten directions there is no agent.
It is just as when fire arises
from trees stirred by the wind:
neither wind nor tree has the thought,
"We shall produce this fire,"
and yet fire arises.
So too is the agent of karma.

As for the claim, "There is no accumulation of merit,
and yet there is true accomplishment of awakening
and there is good conduct,"
listen properly to how this is.
A human lifespan is a hundred years,
and one says that a person lives that long,
yet the years are not piled into a heap.
Accomplishment, too, is just like that.

As for what was said, "There is no exhaustion,"
while I said, "Karma is exhausted":
in the way of emptiness there is no exhaustion;
in the way of convention, exhaustion is taught.
I have explained the limit of reality;
even the inverted is the limit of reality.
The childish of wrong understanding
do not know the limit of reality.

All characteristics are one and the same.
Druma, listen to the certainty
Of those who have entered the path of wisdom
That knows there are no characteristics.

The awakening that is entered through a single letter
I have taught to the wise.
That all phenomena are unmade
Is taught as the dhāraṇī of the door of a.

To those who practice in this way
I have taught the infinity of characteristics.
To enter into a way such as this

Is taught as the dhāraṇī of the door of a.

That all phenomena are unceasing
Is taught as entering the Dharma through a.
This teaching of the dhāraṇī of the door of a,
Druma, you should understand as well.

That phenomena are free of conceptual thought
Is also declared to be entering the Dharma.
That all phenomena are unchanging, too,
Is taught by a, the door to all phenomena.

These dhāraṇīs of the door of a,
Druma, understand them in this way.

Of what is spoken of as inexhaustible and as exhausted,
All phenomena are to be called inexhaustible.
All those who possess the ten powers
Teach this as the dhāraṇī of the door of the inexhaustible.

All phenomena have no door;
Since they do not exist, no door arises.
This too is a door of dhāraṇī;
Relying on a, one should enter it.

"All phenomena are inconceivable":
So the Sugata has taught, just as it truly is.
This teaching of the dhāraṇī of the door of a,
Druma, you should understand as well.

"All phenomena are bodiless; that is awakening":
What I have taught to the wise in this way
Is also a door of dhāraṇī;
Relying on a, one should enter it.

Phenomena have no coming;
Since they do not exist, they have no coming either.
This too is a door of dhāraṇī;
Relying on a, one should enter it.

Phenomena cannot be designated;
Since they do not exist, they cannot be designated.
This too is a door of dhāraṇī;

Relying on a, one should enter it.

Phenomena have no intrinsic nature;
Since they do not exist, they have no intrinsic nature.
This too is a door of dhāraṇī;
The Sugata has taught it as dhāraṇī.

Hear from me the door of dhāraṇī:
All phenomena are beyond mental engagement.
This too is a door of dhāraṇī;
The Sugata has taught it as dhāraṇī.

"Since they do not exist, all phenomena are without obscuration":
This, which the Tathāgata has taught,
Is also a door of dhāraṇī;
Relying on a, one should understand it.

All phenomena are unobstructed;
That which could be obstructed is not found.
This too is a door of dhāraṇī;
Relying on a, one should enter it.

The wise should know all phenomena
As unborn, as of a single characteristic.
Whatever phenomena are unborn
Should be known as nameless.

Phenomena are not real;
All of them without exception lack intrinsic nature.
This too is a door of dhāraṇī;
Relying on a, one should understand it.

Whatever is unborn and has not come to be
Should be taught as unseen,
Because there is no seer,
And because those things too do not exist.

Therefore all phenomena are equal in their nonexistence,
Of a single characteristic, with no basis for characteristics.
They are like space;
No phenomenon exists.

Thus there is no excess and no deficiency,
No meditative equipoise and no duality,
No torment, no coolness, and no heat;
It is beyond the range of sight, because it does not exist.

Not straight and not crooked,
Not darkness and not light,
Unseen and unheard:
Because it does not exist, know it as dhāraṇī.

Without guile and without uprightness,
Phenomena are not clear, nor do they move;
Without agitation and without anger,
They do nothing, and are not pacified.

There is no falling and no remaining,
No going, no turning back, no thought of going,
No sleeping and no not sleeping;
Know them to be without waking.

Not sighted and not blind,
Not seeing and not veiled in darkness,
Not hidden and not displayed,
Not tamed and not untamed,

Not excited and not calm,
Not saṃsāra and not nirvāṇa,
Not true and not false: in this way
Know the domain of the Victors.

This is for the sake of taming the world;
About this there is no doubt whatsoever.
The doubt that is to be cut off
Has never arisen in the ultimate sense.

Then Druma, king of the kinnaras, completely satisfied by the Blessed One's answer to his questions and by the definitive teaching of the dhāraṇī, became eager to make offerings to the Blessed One. He magically emanated eighty million multistoried palaces, some resting on trees, some on lotuses, and some on mountains, made of the seven precious substances, beautified with jeweled parasols, beautified with the fringes of the parasols, adorned with victory banners and pennants, and adorned with canopies and fringes. He also

emanated eighty million kinnara musical instruments and cymbals, and made offerings to the Blessed One with all kinds of flowers: flowers grown on mountains wafting with fragrance, flowers grown on the plains, and flowers grown in the water. Then, together with the host of kinnaras, seated in those eighty million multistoried palaces, he circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and he scattered, strewed, and showered those flowers grown on the plains and grown in the water upon the Blessed One. Then they descended from those palaces, went on foot, and circumambulated the Blessed One three times. They bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, joined their palms, and, gazing at the Blessed One without blinking and recollecting the qualities of the Buddha in every way, they sat down to one side.

Then the Blessed One, perceiving the superior intention of Druma, king of the kinnaras, and his retinue, smiled.

Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"Sugata, you whose eyes are free of stain,
You do not smile without a cause.
You who are truly honored by gods and humans,
Please declare the cause of your smile.
Seeing the Omniscient One smile,
The assembly has fallen into doubt.
As people gaze at the new moon,
They gaze upon the moonlike face of the Speaker.
Beautiful Sugata, who today
Has given rise to supreme knowledge of the nondual Dharma?
I have come to be in doubt;
Supreme and excellent among humans, dispel this doubt.
Sugata, who is it whose faith
In the nature of reality has made you,
Blessed One, smile in this way?
Supreme Speaker, remove my doubt.
This assembly, endowed with all,
Hearing the Blessed One's teaching, will rejoice in mind,
Be without doubt, its hesitation cut off,
And abide just as you have taught."

Thus the supreme among two-legged beings,
Out of love for beings,

And to cut off their doubt,
Spoke the prophecy of Druma and the kinnaras.

Then the Blessed One again spoke to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

"Among the great multitudes of people,
This will make the Buddha's qualities shine forth.
You have asked about Druma's prophecy;
Aśvajit, you have asked well.
Toward the unobscured vision of wisdom,
The wondrous wisdom of the Sugata,
Make your mind clear with faith,
And listen to me with an untiring mind.
For the benefit and happiness of the world,
I shall declare the fruit
Of the doubt that Druma raised;
Hear from me how that doubt is cut.

Druma and the other kinnaras,
Eighty koṭis who have come here,
Having made offerings to me,
Will die, pass from here, and go to the higher realms.
For ninety koṭis of eons there,
They will circle among gods and humans.
Having cultivated the five superknowledges,
They will become powerful, masters of their minds.
Those lions among humans
Will send forth emanations to countless buddha fields,
While they themselves, dwelling in the abodes of the gods,
Taste the bliss and joy of meditative concentration.
For a further ninety koṭis of eons,
Having circled among gods and humans,
In their own various fields
They will fully awaken to enlightenment.

In the eon called Ever Shining,
Those lions among humans, protectors of the world,
Will have unattached wisdom and immeasurable vision,
The ten powers, and boundless splendor.

In their fields no being
Who is not fully ripened will be born.
All who arise there through the śrāvaka vehicle
Will be in their final existence.
In those fields of the lions among humans,
Whatever bodhisattvas are born
Will be bound to but one more life,
And will attain the awakening of the supreme among humans.

Those among them who were foremost
Set out with this intention:
'We shall purify
Immeasurable buddha fields.'
These magnanimous beings
Long ago made vast aspirations.
When they have died and passed from here,
They will purify their own fields through that intention.
The array of the fields
Of those who have crushed the afflictions
Will have enjoyments like those of Tuṣita,
And every lower realm will be entirely purified.
In their fields, in any way at all,
No unfavorable condition will ever arise.
Those who have purified their fields
Will lead beings, too, to happiness."

Thus the Protector of the World
Spoke the prophecy of the kinnaras.
Hearing that prophecy, those in the assembly
All rejoiced.

This was the twelfth chapter, the Prophecy of the Kinnaras.

Then the eighty thousand Mālādhara gods called the Elephant Bearers saw the offerings made by all, from the asuras up to the kinnaras, and heard their prophecies. Satisfied, pleased and delighted, overjoyed, full of joy and gladness, they became devoted to the qualities of the Buddha and set about making offerings to the Blessed One. They filled the whole surroundings of the great city of Kapilavastu, for up to sixty yojanas, knee-deep with māndārava

flowers. Then they circumambulated the Blessed One three times and praised him in these verses:

"Lord of peace with smiling face,
Loving toward all living creatures,
Compassionate Sugata,
Lord of the world, tiger among humans,
For as long as this assembly,
Devoted to the Buddha's Dharma, remains here,
We bow our heads to the Compassionate One,
Whose supreme feet are beautiful and joyful.
Just as at the full moon in the sky
People pay homage to the moon,
So too these hosts of gods
Gaze upon the face of the Blessed One.
You who practiced immeasurable virtue,
Endowed with an immeasurable mass of wisdom,
Possessing an immeasurable mass of splendor,
Supreme in intellect, we bow our heads to you.
Possessor of the ten powers, dense with glory,
Fearless in the four truths, dispeller of the three stains,
Endowed with the eighteen qualities of a Victor,
Free of doubt, supreme Speaker,
Possessor of the thirty-two major marks,
Endowed with the eighty excellent minor marks,
Your mind a peerless banner of Indra,
Sugata, homage to you.
You have reached the perfection of the power of moral discipline,
Abide in the power of samādhi, unshakable,
Bear the weapon of the power of wisdom,
And are the Victor, the Sage who crushed the power of Māra.
Your supreme power of wisdom has grown full;
You are without stinginess, and have trained the śrāvakas;
You act with a peaceful mind
And tame the world with its gods.
Lion among men, Sugata,
You have found the Dharma that pacifies delusion;
May we too, here,

Attain the qualities of the ten powers.
Just as you, Sage, know the thoughts
Of beings and act accordingly,
So may we too, illuminating the world,
Do likewise for beings, gods and humans included.
Thus, for the sake of beings,
Taking up compassion,
We shall free beings sunk in the ocean of saṃsāra
From the stream of existence.
May we become guides and great guides
Of the world with its gods;
We shall release beings tormented by hundreds of sufferings
From the stream of existence."

Then the Blessed One, knowing the intentions of the Elephant Bearer gods, smiled at that time. Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"Sugata, Guide,

Without a cause you do not smile.
You of the ten powers, what is the cause
Of the smile you have shown? Please declare it.
Seeing the smile upon the Victor's face,
Beings and the whole assembly have come to doubt,
And we long to hear the meaning of the smile.
Great-purposed one, the meaning of your smile,
Declare it, declare it, supreme Guide!
You who are king of the ascetics,
Please declare it, so that our doubt is cut off.

Who has pleased the Victor?
Who today has done what is supreme and unsurpassed?
Who today has reached the depths?
Sugata, resolve my doubt.
Who today has made the abode of Māra
Shaken, distracted, and utterly thrown into turmoil?
Who today has filled all the abodes of the gods
With minds of the greatest joy?

Victor, Sage, explain this,
And quickly resolve the doubt of beings.
Hearing it, Sugata, all of your assembly
Will be filled with joy of mind.

Then the Blessed One replied to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

Aśvajit, because you have asked
About the prophecy of the Garland-Bearing Elephant gods,
Great benefit for many beings
Will today indeed be accomplished.
Unless asked, the Victor of the ten powers
Does not prophesy the awakening of his supreme heirs.
So for the benefit of many beings
You have today put your question to the Victor.

The host of the Garland-Bearing Elephant gods,
Setting their minds on me and honoring me,
After countless eons have passed,
Will defeat the afflictions and become victors.
When they die and pass from here,
They will be born in harmony among humans,
And will honor immeasurable billions of victors
With the finest flowers.
Everywhere they will give rise to the mind of a sugata
And make it grow.
They will praise the self-arisen lion among humans
With verses.

In the future all of these
Will honor countless, immeasurable myriads of victors
With flowers, and with verses
Will praise those supreme among humans.
Having honored those sugatas
And praised the bodies of the mighty ones,
In the eon called Supreme Joy
They will appear in the world as guides.
These eighty thousand of unblemished fame,
Who wander in the forests, all of them,

Will become sugatas within a single eon,
Each called Possessor of the Flower Banner.

There will be no hells there, no animals,
No lower realms, no world of Yama.
In that field there will be no asuras;
All unfavorable states will be utterly destroyed.
For the Garland-Bearing Elephant gods,
Enjoyments will be just like those
Of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.
The lifespan of beings will be immeasurable.
At that time the word "nonvirtue" will not be heard,
So what need is there to mention doing nonvirtue?
There the people of those supreme guides
Will all be devoted to the Dharma.
Living beings by the myriads of billions,
As many as the sands of the Ganges,
Those of the ten powers will set free,
And they will teach the Dharma of non-abiding.

The relics of those of unblemished fame
Will spread far and wide,
And from their relics as well
Many bodies of victors will emerge.
Seeing the miraculous bodies from the relics
Of those endowed with boundless fame,
Many myriads of billions of living beings
Will give rise to the mind set on awakening.

When they had heard and understood the prophecy
Of the Garland-Bearing Elephant gods declared by the Guide,
The whole assembly at that time
Was supremely joyful at heart.

This concludes the thirteenth chapter, the Prophecy of the Garland-Bearing Elephant Gods.

Then the ninety thousand gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings, having seen the offerings of all those beings, from the asuras up to the Garland-Bearing Elephant gods, and having heard the prophecies, were

satisfied, delighted, and overjoyed. Supremely glad, filled with joy and happiness of mind, they developed an intense aspiration to attain the qualities of a buddha. It was like this: a man riding in a boat of unbaked clay who has reached the middle of the water, thinking, "The boat is going to break," develops an intense aspiration to get from this shore to the far shore. In the same way, those ninety thousand gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings developed faith in the greatness of the Buddha's Dharma and came to have an intense aspiration to attain the qualities of a buddha. Seeking the Buddha's Dharma, they set about making offerings to the Blessed One.

Together with the Four Great Kings they emanated ninety thousand jeweled canopies, brilliant and beautiful to behold. Most of these were made entirely of red pearl, star-colored gems, beryl, gold, and vajra. They also emanated ninety thousand divine musical instruments and cymbals. Holding those ninety thousand canopies of various precious jewels and playing those ninety thousand instruments and cymbals, they descended from the sky above and circled the Blessed One three times. They scattered upon the Blessed One, scattered widely, and scattered very widely, māndārava flowers and great māndārava flowers, mañjūṣaka flowers and great mañjūṣaka flowers, paruṣaka flowers and great paruṣaka flowers, and emanated flowers. Having made these offerings, they again circled the Blessed One three times and praised him with these verses:

Having seen the qualities of the Victor,
We, the gods, ninety thousand in all,
Have come into your presence, Guide,
With palms joined together.
Free of agitation, free of dejection,
Free of desire, free of regret,
Not foolish, free of astonishment,
To the supreme among two-legged beings we bow.

You have destroyed the streams of existence,
Fully purified unknowing,
Pulled out the stake of craving,
And toppled the banner of pride.
You have drawn out the thorn,
And cast off the poison in the wound.
You act just as you know;
Guide, you have healed the wounds.

You have abandoned all afflictions
And severed all bonds.
Free from every fetter,
Sage, you have passed beyond all attachment.
Victor, your sphere of activity
Is emptiness and signlessness.
Blessed One, in you there is
No wishing of any kind at all.

You have pulled craving out by the roots,
And drawn your mind out of ignorance as well.
The four kinds of distortion
You have abandoned completely, in every way.
The limit of reality, which the world does not fathom,
And before which it grows frightened and afraid
As a deer before the hunter,
You have seen.
Beings have fallen into the view of the perishing aggregates;
Because they do not understand emptiness,
They are wrapped in the darkness of ignorance
And take delight in the prison of saṃsāra.
Truly, just as it is,
You see that world as like an empty fist.
You have taught the light of wisdom
Through which the eye becomes pure.
You have taken the aggregates apart as empty;
Name and form, too, are hollow,
And the elements and the sense sources
You have taken apart as selfless and empty.
Whatever phenomenon is designated
By whatever phenomenon and whatever name,
That phenomenon is empty of that phenomenon:
So you, the Sage, have taught it to be empty.
When a magician conjures
A great crowd of people where there are none,
No sentient being can be designated there,
Just as there is no life-force and no person.
In the same way, the aggregates, the elements,

The faculties and the sense sources
Are not real, they are illusions:
So the holy being has taught.
Just as a painter
Paints the figure of a woman,
And though he shows the level and the uneven,
The heavy and the light,
It deceives the eyes of the childish,
While nothing in it is uneven at all,
So, though the dharmadhātu is even,
The childish are confused about it.
Those who know, well trained in your training,
Do not become confused:
This you, the Omniscient One, have taught
Like a myrobalan fruit in the palm of the hand.
You of great wisdom
Have lit the lamp of wisdom,
Turned the wheel of Dharma,
And taught the Dharma to beings.
So may we too swiftly
Attain unsurpassed and peaceful awakening,
And, just like you, O Guide,
Turn the wheel of Dharma.
To beings who wander
On these wrong paths of saṃsāra,
Just as the Guide has taught,
We too shall swiftly teach the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, understanding the superior intention of the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings, smiled. Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

Perfect Buddha, the Guide
Does not smile without a cause.
Great Hero, please explain
The cause of the smile you have smiled.
Holy Being, this assembly,
Seeing the Sugata smile today,

Has fallen into great uncertainty;
All of them have come to doubt.
Who today has defeated Māra?
By whom has hesitation been cut off?
Who today has realized the Dharma?
Supreme Being, please explain.
Who today has made offerings to you?
By whom has the Teacher been served and honored?
Since all beings have come to hesitation,
Guide, please explain.
Supreme among two-legged beings,
Guide, please explain in such a way
That when they hear these explanations
The doubts of beings will be cut off.
Guide, please teach in such a way
That those who abide on the path
To omniscience in every way
May swiftly attain awakening.

Then the Blessed One again addressed the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

For the benefit of beings
You thought, "The perfect Buddha, the protector,
Should be asked the causes of his smile."
Aśvajit, it is good that you have asked.
For the benefit of the whole world
I shall explain what will be a teaching
Pleasing and delightful:
Bring forth mindfulness and listen.
Fully ninety thousand gods
Today have made this kind of offering
To the Tathāgata
With minds of deep faith.
They have praised the Buddha,
They have come to know emptiness,
They have found certainty about phenomena,
And they abide firmly in my teaching.
In the past, too, these gods

Made offerings to eighty koṭis of buddhas,
And in the future as well
They will make offerings to endless koṭis of buddhas.
As long as those guides-to-be
Have not made offerings to koṭis of buddhas
And have not served and honored them,
So long they will not attain awakening.
Then, a very long time after,
All of them will become supreme persons;
Their name will be Bearer of Light Rays,
And they will become sages who know the whole world.
Those lamps of the world
Will have gatherings of śrāvakas:
Eighty gatherings will take place
Of those endowed with supreme understanding.
In the time of those of unobstructed vision,
Human beings will live,
Their life faculty enduring
For a full eighty koṭis of years.
Those of infinite wisdom
Will have śrāvakas free of desire,
Bearers of their final bodies,
Appearing in measureless koṭis.
Of those glorious protectors of the world,
Compassionate toward beings,
When they have passed into nirvāṇa
The relics too will spread most widely.
After the lords of men,
Those glorious guides, have passed into nirvāṇa,
With the stūpas of the Victors
The buddha fields will be beautifully adorned.
To all those stūpas
Of the protectors and saviors of the world,
Hundreds and thousands and hundreds of billions
Of living beings will make offerings;
They will raise the mind toward supreme awakening
And will attain nirvāṇa.

Even after those self-arisen ones have passed into nirvāṇa,
Their holy Dharma will endure,
Remaining for a full eighty koṭis
Of hundreds of billions of years.
Upheld and fully protected
By the sons of the Dharma King, it will remain.
Out of compassion for the world,
And to bring the Śākyas to maturity,
The Lamp of the World gave this prophecy
To those of the realm of the Four Great Kings.
When they had heard it, all the people
Rejoiced and were utterly delighted;
Their hearts content and their minds gladdened,
They praised the Teacher.

This concludes the fourteenth chapter, the Prophecy concerning the Realm of the Four Great Kings.

The sixth fascicle.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, together with the rest of the eight hundred million gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, saw the offerings made by the asuras, the garuḍas, the nāga maidens, the nāgas, the kumbhāṇḍas, the gandharvas, the yakṣas, the kinnaras, the garland bearers with their elephants, and the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings. They also heard the prophecies. They were satisfied, delighted, and pleased with the teachings of the Buddha. Supreme joy, delight, and gladness arose in them, and they were deeply moved. Of their own wish, Śakra, lord of the gods, and the others set about making offerings to the Blessed One.

They emanated eight hundred million jewel mansions. These were bright and beautiful to behold, made of the seven precious substances, and adorned with garlands of red pearls and garlands of beryl. They were adorned with various garlands of gold and with garlands of star-colored precious jewels. They were adorned with eight stories, with balconies, with pavilions rising tier on tier, and with windows. They were adorned with parasols, victory banners, and flags, and with lion thrones made of divine substance. They were adorned with great canopies and with nets of bells and tinkling bells, made beautiful by hosts of goddesses, and filled with the resounding music of divine instruments and

cymbals.

They also emanated eight hundred million chariots drawn by thoroughbred horses, finely adorned with divine features and made beautiful with parasols, victory banners, and flags.

The whole great city of Kapilavastu and the country around it, for sixty yojanas in every direction, they filled completely with māndārava flowers and with those divine offerings.

They also emanated eight hundred million Airāvaṇa elephants. Each of these Airāvaṇa elephants had eight hundred million heads. Each head of these Airāvaṇa elephants had six tusks. Each tusk held seven ponds. Each pond held seven thousand lotuses. Each lotus had eighty thousand petals. On each petal stood seven goddesses, and each of these goddesses had a retinue of seven. All of them were adorned with every kind of ornament.

Having emanated all this, they placed the jewel mansions in front, set the Airāvaṇa elephants in the middle, and arranged the chariots behind. Then they set out and made offerings to the Blessed One.

From those jewel mansions there rained down powders of divine sandalwood, aloeswood, utpala, and tamāla leaf, and a rain of gold dust. There also rained down divine flowers: māndārava and great māndārava, mañjūṣaka and great mañjūṣaka, paruṣaka and great paruṣaka, white flowers and great white flowers, and emanated flowers. There also rained down flowers of gold, silver, beryl, crystal, red pearl, coral, emerald, and all the seven precious substances.

Of those goddesses, some sang, some danced, some played music, and some moved their bodies in graceful postures, just like the offerings of the asuras. Having made offerings with those Airāvaṇa elephants and those jewel mansions, they then mounted the eight hundred million chariots drawn by thoroughbred horses, circled the Blessed One three times, and presented a great many divine articles of every kind. Eight hundred million divine instruments and cymbals also resounded from the sky. On each of those eight hundred million chariots they emanated eight hundred million further goddesses, and of these goddesses too, some sang, some danced, some played music, and some moved their bodies in graceful postures, just as in the offerings of the asuras.

Then those eight hundred million gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three thought, "Since these emanated goddesses are making offerings to the

Blessed One, all phenomena must surely be like emanations." They thought, "All these phenomena are just as the Tathāgata has taught: they are like emanations." Knowing all phenomena to be like emanations, they gained freedom from doubt about the Dharma. Free of doubt and without hesitation, they circled the Blessed One three times, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, and sat down to one side.

They contemplated all phenomena as like emanations. They saw themselves too as like emanations, saw those offerings too as like emanations, and saw the Blessed One too as like an emanation. Then they knew correctly that the teachings the Blessed One had taught were also like emanations. Knowing that all phenomena are like emanations, they were free of doubt and without hesitation, and at that time they praised the Blessed One in verse:

"Whatever offerings all beings have made,
And whatever these emanated offerings have done,
And the worship the gods have offered to the Buddha,
All these phenomena are likewise just emanation.

Whatever teachings the Guide has spoken,
And all the prophecies the Tathāgata has made,
'All these are like emanations':
Such understanding arose in these hosts of gods.

Blessed One, just as these emanations are,
So too the Teacher is like an emanation.
Since we have understood the Victor's prophecy,
About this we have no doubt.

Knowing ordinary beings, the Victor
Designated them as having reached the stage of the childish.
All of these too are just like emanations;
So too is the Sugata's prophecy of beings.

Those in training and those beyond training,
The Blessed One's śrāvakas who have reached the stage of the tamed,
All of them too, Blessed One, are like emanations.
About the Blessed One's teaching we have no doubt."

"Blessed One, those who are devoted to silence,
who, like the rhinoceros, are without a companion and have abandoned the afflictions,

they too, Blessed One, are like the emanation.
I have no doubt about the Sugata's teaching.

"Those who, for the happiness and benefit of all beings,
carefully practice the conduct of the Victor's awakening,
the bodhisattvas, the Sugata's heirs, they too
are no different: they are like this emanation.

"The Sugatas, self-arisen, supreme guides,
with the ten powers, boundless wisdom and compassion,
exalted in the power of gnosis, lords of the world,
they too share the nature of an emanation such as this.

"Whatever dharmas the Guide has taught here,
without abode, peaceful and cool, free of afflictions,
pacifying suffering, final, beyond all counting,
they too are just like these emanations.

"Blessed One, here there are no dharmas whatsoever
that are not of the nature of emanation.
Now that we have understood this teaching of Gautama,
we have abandoned every doubt.
Seeing all dharmas as like this emanation,
we too shall become protectors of the world.
Those who practice in this domain of the Sugata
will without doubt become self-arisen guides."

Then the Blessed One, perceiving at that time the superior intention of those eight hundred million gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, smiled. Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"You of measureless fame and boundless splendor,
the Sugatas do not smile without a cause.
Since the Guide has smiled here,
Victor, speak words about the smile and dispel our doubt.
Knowing that this smile has come from the face of the self-arisen Sugata,
the world is filled with wonder.
Sage, please clear away the doubts of beings;
make these beings free of doubt.

"These hosts of gods, with minds full of delight,
have praised the Victor and worshipped him with divine substances.
Sugata, you have smiled for their sake;
Victor, please speak and gladden this assembly.

"You whose light is stainless like the moon, of boundless splendor,
so that, by hearing this word of the Sugata,
all beings, O Protector, may be gladdened,
Victor, knower of the gods' offering, please speak.

"Sugata, these hosts of gods
have fully realized all dharmas to be like emanations.
Possessor of the ten powers, declare this meaning;
you who are free of all dimness of vision, tell of the training of the gods.
These beings, freed from doubt,
will undertake the conduct of awakening, as the Sage did.
When this most heroic assembly has heard it,
understanding your intent, they will undertake the vast."

Then the Blessed One replied to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

"Knowing that these hosts of gods are filled with delight,
Aśvajit, the timely words you have spoken
have come at the proper time.
The smile you asked about I now explain.

"Knowing the gods' thoughts, you asked about the smile,
and by that you have done great good for beings.
I shall reveal the cause of my smiling;
listen to me with a joyful and faithful mind.

"These hosts of gods have understood
all these dharmas without exception to be like emanations;
with unattached gnosis and boundless vision
they will become protectors of the world, free of all dimness.

"In the stream of existence, formerly, wandering in saṃsāra,
they worshipped lords of men as many as the sands of the Ganges,
yet in that stream of existence, from those sages,
they did not see dharmas to be like emanations.

"Because they have made this supreme offering to me here,
they directly see dharmas to be like emanations.

Whatever is done for this teaching of the Sugata
is never wasted and will meet no obstacle.

"These hosts of gods have made offerings to me,
and because they know all dharmas to be like emanations,
when the eon called Padma comes,
they will become moons among speakers, supreme among men.

"The supreme name they will bear, those foremost of the herd,
will be Sugata Indraketu King, the supremely skilled.
Teaching all dharmas to be like emanations,
they will free countless multitudes of beings.

"Those who are careful in the teachings of those Sugatas
contemplate these dharmas as like emanations.
Whoever relies carefully on that calm abiding
will swiftly attain the unsurpassed, supreme, peaceful awakening."

This was the fifteenth chapter, the Prophecy to the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

Then, at that time, four hundred million Yāma gods saw the offerings of all those beings, from the asuras up to the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and heard the prophecies. They were satisfied, pleased and delighted, and joy, gladness and happiness arose in them. They knew that the Blessed One is unobstructed in giving prophecies, and that the qualities of a buddha are delightful: once these are attained, there is nothing whatsoever that is unknown, unseen, unrealized or unactualized, and there is no arising, no ceasing, no karma and no ripening of karma. Thus they developed a longing for the qualities of a buddha.

For the Tathāgata has fully comprehended the two, the conventional and the ultimate, and what is to be known is contained entirely within the conventional and the ultimate. Moreover, because the Blessed One has thoroughly seen, thoroughly known and perfectly actualized emptiness, he is therefore called the Omniscient One. Of these, the conventional the Tathāgata has seen as the conduct of the world.

The ultimate is inexpressible. It is not to be known, not to be cognized, and not to be thoroughly known. It is not shown, not taught, not heard, and not made to be heard. It is not known, not cognized, not shown, and not seen. It is not examined, it does not allow itself to be grasped, it is not realized, not attained,

and not obtained. It is not approached, not cast off, not set down, and not abandoned. It is without activity, without agent, and without pacification. It is not reviled and not praised. It is not gain and not loss, not pleasure and not pain, not fame and not disrepute. It is not form and not formless. It is without number and without counting, without world and without separation from the world, without affliction and without purification, without going and without turning back. It is not examined and not analyzed, unmoved, not thought, unstirred, uncompounded, unelaborated, and free of conceptual elaboration.

That is to say, the sign of form is not apprehended. The signs of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are not apprehended. The signs of the eye, ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind are not apprehended. The signs of forms, sounds, smells, tastes, tangibles, and mental phenomena are not apprehended. The signs of eye consciousness, and of ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind consciousness, are not apprehended. The signs of eye contact, and of ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind contact, are not apprehended. The sign of feeling arising from eye contact is not apprehended, and so on up to the sign of feeling arising from mind contact, which is not apprehended. The sign of the perception of form is not apprehended, and so on up to the sign of the perception of mental phenomena, which is not apprehended. The sign of intention toward form is not apprehended, and so on up to the sign of intention toward mental phenomena, which is not apprehended. The sign of attention is not apprehended. The signs of the earth, water, fire, wind, space, and consciousness elements are not apprehended. The signs of the desire, form, and formless realms are not apprehended. The signs of the conditioned and the unconditioned are not apprehended.

Thus, whatever phenomenon is expressed, and whatever intrinsic nature it is expressed by, that phenomenon is not expressed by that nature which expresses it. Since the qualities of a buddha are delightful in this way, when childish ordinary people who lack learning and understanding hear of them, they become afraid, terrified, and frightened. Having become afraid, they fall away from the wisdom of omniscience. They are to be mourned by the world with its gods, for they are a stream of suffering in saṃsāra.

Thinking in this way, the gods generated aspiration for the qualities of a buddha, and for the sake of those qualities they strove to make offerings to the Blessed One. They made offerings to the Blessed One surpassing the offerings of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and sat down to

one side. Having sat down to one side, those Yāma gods praised the Blessed One in verse:

"Victor, you see the aggregates as void,
And likewise the elements and the sense sources.
The town of the senses, void of signs,
All of it, O Sage, you see just as it is.

Knower of the world, there are two truths,
Which you did not hear from others but saw yourself:
They are conventional truth and the ultimate.
There is no third truth whatsoever.

That through which beings come to give rise
To faith in the Sugata for the sake of happiness,
That convention the Victor taught
For the sake of beings, to benefit the world.

The six destinies of the hosts of beings that were taught,
Hell-beings, animals, hungry ghosts,
The asura class, humans, and gods,
The Lion among Humans designated as convention.

Low castes and likewise the high castes,
Wealthy households and poor households,
Hosts of slaves and likewise hosts of servants,
Hosts of women, men, and eunuchs,

Whatever distinctions there may be among beings,
Which you, the Incomparable, have taught the world,
The world's benefactor, expert in conventional truth,
Understood and taught to humankind.

For beings in saṃsāra who delight in that,
The eight worldly concerns do not arise:
Gain and loss, fame and disrepute,
Praise and blame, pleasure and pain.

When gain is found, attachment to it arises;
When it is not gained, that too brings agitation.
The others, not stated, should be known in this way.
By these eight diseases one's being is harmed.

Those who proclaim that convention to be ultimate
Should be known as having mistaken minds.
Those who call the unattractive attractive, suffering happiness,
And speak of the selfless as being by nature a self,

Who declare impermanent things permanent,
And, delighting in that, abide in signs,
When they hear the speech of the Sugata,
Become afraid, do not understand it as it is, and reject it.

Having rejected the speech of the Sugata,
Those beings experience unbearable suffering in the hells.
Although they seek happiness in improper ways,
The childish experience the eight sufferings.

Whoever, with an unmistaken mind,
Fully understands the teaching of the world's benefactor
Casts it off completely, like a snake its old skin,
Passes beyond all existence, and attains peace.

All these phenomena are void by nature;
Empty and signless: this is the ultimate.
Those who, hearing this, give rise to joy
Will attain unsurpassed awakening.

In the Dharma as taught by the Sugata
The gods have no doubt at all.
In order to liberate all beings
They seek unsurpassed awakening.

Supreme Being, we pray you, give rise to joy
In those with minds of awakening, those with pure minds.
Hearing that, in order to benefit all beings,
They will attain unsurpassed awakening."

Then, at that time, the Blessed One, understanding the superior intention of the four hundred million gods of the Yāma class, smiled.

Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"Benefactor of the world, the smile that you have smiled
Has caused your assembly to fall into doubt.
Supreme among humans, please declare the cause of that smile;
It will make this assembly rejoice greatly.

If they hear that prophecy about the gods,
This assembly will be exceedingly joyful and pleased,
And to this very teaching, endowed with reason,
They will happily apply themselves with diligence.
Victor, this assembly of yours is endowed with excellence.
Great sage, Buddha, vessel of good qualities,
In order to gather these beings,
Please utter well your pleasing speech.
If they hear of the qualities and powers of the Buddha,
It will be of great benefit to all creatures.
If they hear that prophecy made by the Sugata,
The wise will apply themselves properly.
Here, may the best of humans, supreme among speakers,
Dispel well the hesitation of doubt.
The whole assembly sits, delighting to hear;
Please declare the prophecy about the gods.
All, respectfully lending their ears in service
To the joyous prophecy that you will give,
Have fully cast off obscurations and listen to it.
For the benefit of the world, the supreme person speaks."

Then the Blessed One replied once more to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

"The wise one smiles for the benefit of the world.
Aśvajit, your question is timely.
If they hear of the power of the Buddha's qualities,
It will be for the benefit of great multitudes of people.
Those whose understanding of the Buddha's many qualities is weak,
Those with minds of attachment and minds of aversion,
Those whose minds have been contentious for a hundred lifetimes,
And those with deluded minds will not come to feel joy.
Those who delight in what the Victors have taught,
Those who in the past questioned the Victors,
And those who are endowed with great compassion,
All of them will come to possess the qualities of a buddha.
Those lions among humans who have seen beings seized by grahas
And have given rise to compassion,
Having heard these qualities of the Buddha,

Will carry them on their heads like a garland of utpala flowers.
This assembly of mine that will rejoice so greatly
In the past served the Victors of former times.
These delightful qualities of the Buddha
They regard correctly, like a garland of flowers.
The Yāma gods served all the Victors of the past
And abandoned attachment.
They censure the afflictions and will possess a buddha's understanding,
Compassionate, with an understanding free of afflictions.
In the past they served all the Victors, lions among humans,
As many as the sands of the Ganges.
Aspiring to unsurpassed awakening,
They all have performed these boundless virtues.
Knowing sentient beings to be sunk in the mire of afflictions,
They give rise to compassion for those who suffer.
Of the supreme humans, the benefactors of beings,
They have fully inquired into boundless modes of the Dharma.
Having heard these, they will become guides,
And will teach the way to enter the guides' Dharma.
Knowing well the afflicted conduct of humans,
They will teach them the vast Dharma as well.
Those guides, most excellent of holy beings,
Will also teach emptiness, the absence of intrinsic nature.
Having heard that speech of the Victors,
They fully realize all beings to be empty.
If one asks, empty of what? Empty of the aspect of signs.
They proclaim the absence of intrinsic nature and the absence of signs.
Having understood the Victors' teachings in this way,
All of them abide in the qualities of the buddhas.
They have made vast offerings to me.
Since I have prophesied in accordance with the Dharma,
In the excellent eon called Equal to the Hosts of Stars
They will attain unsurpassed awakening.
That eon will be completely filled with peerless sugatas,
Twenty koṭis upon twenty.
They will be known by the name Pure Intellect,
And they will fully purify inconceivable sentient beings.

The intentions of the gods who dwell in the Yāma heaven
Were fully inquired into by Aśvajit;
At the prophecy of the Victor, the great sage who has conquered the foe,
The world together with its gods rejoices."

This concludes the sixteenth chapter, the prophecy to the Yāma gods.

Then eighty koṭis of gods of the Tuṣita realm, having seen the offerings of all those beings from the asuras up to the gods of the Yāma realm, and having heard the prophecies as well, thought: "What is that dharma which the Blessed One has prophesied to unsurpassed, perfect awakening? Is it form? Or is it feeling? Or perception? Or formations? Or is it consciousness that the Blessed One has prophesied to unsurpassed, perfect awakening?" Having wondered this, they thought: "The Blessed One has not prophesied form to unsurpassed, perfect awakening. Nor has the Blessed One prophesied feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness to unsurpassed, perfect awakening."

Why is that? Since form is unborn and awakening too is unborn, how could the unborn fully and perfectly awaken to the unborn? Since feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are also unborn, and awakening too is unborn, how could the unborn there fully and perfectly awaken to the unborn?

Form is without cessation, and awakening too is without cessation. Everything up to consciousness is without cessation, and awakening too is without cessation. Form is free of conceptual elaboration, and awakening too is free of conceptual elaboration. Everything up to consciousness is free of conceptual elaboration, and awakening too is free of conceptual elaboration. Form is nondual, and awakening too is nondual. Everything up to consciousness is nondual, and awakening too is nondual. Form is unmoving, and awakening too is unmoving. Everything up to consciousness is unmoving, and awakening too is unmoving. Form cannot be observed, and awakening too cannot be observed. Everything up to consciousness cannot be observed, and awakening too cannot be observed. That being so, how could what is without cessation, free of elaboration, nondual, unmoving, and unobservable fully and perfectly awaken to what is without cessation and so on, up to what is unobservable?

When, in this way, no phenomena are observed, what here is a buddha? What is a bodhisattva? What is awakening? What is a prophecy? Form is empty of form. Feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are empty of consciousness. A buddha is empty of the essential nature of a buddha. A

bodhisattva is empty of the essential nature of a bodhisattva. Awakening is empty of the essential nature of awakening. A prophecy is empty of the essential nature of a prophecy. Since all phenomena are thus empty by their intrinsic nature, "form" and so on up to "consciousness," and "buddha" and so on up to "prophecy," are mere conventions, mere names, mere signs, mere relative truths, mere expressions, mere designations. The wise should not cling to them.

It is like this. Suppose a man, asleep and dreaming, is enjoying himself, endowed with the five qualities of sense pleasure, and then wakes from sleep. He no longer sees those sense pleasures, and even when he recalls them he cannot find them, and because he cannot find them he suffers. In the same way, those who have truly entered the bodhisattva vehicle, when they seek awakening, will not meet with awakening; not finding awakening and not tasting its flavor, they suffer. Why is that? Because all phenomena are deceptive, like a dream. The meaning of those phenomena is one way, and ordinary beings cling to them in another way. Since those phenomena are to be understood like this, which phenomenon there is a buddha? Which is a bodhisattva? Which is awakening? Which is a prophecy?

Thus no phenomena can be observed. An ordinary being cannot be observed, nor can the qualities of an ordinary being. A śrāvaka cannot be observed, nor can the qualities of a śrāvaka. A pratyekabuddha cannot be observed, nor can the qualities of a pratyekabuddha. A bodhisattva cannot be observed, nor can the qualities of a bodhisattva. A buddha cannot be observed, nor can the qualities of a buddha. Awakening cannot be observed, and nirvāṇa cannot be observed.

"Blessed One, we have no doubt about this, no hesitation," they declared. Then those gods of the Tuṣita realm became free of doubt and wavering concerning these teachings. Eager to make offerings to the Blessed One, they made offerings to him that far surpassed the offerings of the Yāma gods. They bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, circled the Blessed One three times, and sat down to one side.

Having sat down to one side, they praised the Blessed One in verses:

"Those who are firmly established in the qualities of the Buddha,
How they enter in, the Tathāgata has taught:
Because they have found the three doors of liberation,
They come to move within a domain beyond compare.

Where there is no form, no feeling, no perception,
And likewise no mind and no thought,
That is the domain of those whose understanding is unattached.
The Lion among Humans delights in the aggregates' isolation.

For those excellent and learned persons,
Even the mind of awakening never arises.
Having tasted the quality of the aggregates' isolation,
Their minds have cast off hesitation about the Buddha's intent.

They make no aspiration for awakening,
Yet neither do they disparage the mind of awakening.
Without becoming elated or dejected,
They carry out the conduct practiced by the Sugata's heirs.

The Sugatas see all phenomena as equal.
Therein the fearless heirs of the Victor,
Truly awakened, practice well,
And those learned ones live in this world.

They have taken apart the signs of form,
And have wholly abandoned every kind of sign;
They do not aspire at all to the three realms of existence,
And make their aspiration toward the emptiness of things.

They have realized that these aggregates are unborn,
That even the Sugata who is prophesied is unborn,
That the bodhisattva and awakening, too, are unborn.
Whoever understands thus is not deluded about it.

The qualities of ordinary beings and the qualities of the Buddha,
All of these, and the Sugata too, are unborn.
O Lion among Humans, whoever understands thus,
He is your son, and you are his father.

O Blessed One, whoever understands all these as unceasing,
That the aggregates do not cease,
Nor the elements and sense sources, nor likewise the Victor's qualities,
Nor awakening, nor the Victor, nor likewise the prophecy;

And those who seek awakening and practice it,
Those learned ones of the world, do not cease.
When one's understanding is that all beings are unceasing,

For one so minded, awakening is not hard to find.

The aggregates, the sense sources and the elements,
Awakening, the Victor and the Victor's heirs,
Whoever understands them as unmoving, those are the Victor's heirs;
It is they who uphold this Dharma of the Victor.

The aggregates as without mind, and likewise the sense sources,
The elements, awakening, the Victor and the Victor's heirs,
And likewise the prophecy, as without intention:
Whoever understands them thus, those are the Victor's heirs.

O Self-Arisen One, the aggregates are empty in their very being,
And the elements, the sense sources, the Victor,
Awakening, the prophecy and the Victor's heirs:
Whoever practices them as empty of essential nature,

And whoever practices the aggregates, alike in being elaborations, and likewise the elements,
The sense sources, the Supreme among Bipeds, awakening
And the prophecy, as free of conceptual elaboration,
Whoever understands them thus, those are the Victor's heirs.

Not abiding, yet not non-abiding,
Not existent, yet not at all nonexistent,
Not conditioned, yet not unconditioned:
Whoever understands thus, those are the Victor's heirs.

When one sees the Victor and these beings fully in this way,
And understands the Teacher's intent in this way,
If one acts thus, one honors the supreme person,
And this is service to the Guide together with his retinue.

Whatever merit lies in praising the Guide,
Benefactor of the world, who knows all that there is,
By that virtue may beings be accomplished
As self-arisen Victors endowed with the supreme marks."

Then the Blessed One, perceiving the superior intention of those gods of the Tuṣita class, smiled. Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verses:

"O Guide, by what power of cause
Do you, who have attained the ten powers, smile in this way?
Guide, please declare the cause of this smile;
By it these worlds will be filled with joy.

The smile that shone from Śākyamuni's face
These beings have seen, and they have come to doubt;
Wishing to listen, thinking of nothing else,
All gaze at the face of the world's benefactor.

Just as, for example, a sick man weary of his illness
Holds fast to what the physician prescribes,
So this assembly longs to hear the prophecy
And gazes at the face of the Sugata, lord of bipeds.

This entire assembly is possessed of vastness,
With minds devoted to the Buddha's intent;
They long to hear the prophecy from the Victor,
And all of them sit gazing at the Sugata's face.

Therefore, Victor, bringing forth great compassion,
So that this assembly may be filled with delight,
And their thoughts may be settled on the Buddha's intent,
Please cut through their doubts by the power of wisdom.

Bull among men, the time for the prophecy has come;
Please dispel the doubts of those who doubt.
Since the Buddha has no opponent in debate,
Please break the ranks of the hosts of sophists."

Then the Blessed One replied to the venerable Aśvajit in verses:

"Aśvajit, you have asked the lamp of the world
The meaning of the smile, and it is timely.
Because you have questioned the one wise in the world in this way,
Today you have done great good for these beings.

This smile, displayed for the benefit of the world,
I made, knowing the thoughts of the Tuṣita gods,
Who have come to understand these supreme teachings
And who have made this vast offering to me.

They see beings just as they truly realize them,
And through the Victor's intent they have attained the nature of reality.

The three doors of liberation, about which all beings are deluded,
They have fully realized.

They rendered surpassing service to the Victors of the past,
And with single-minded resolve they asked their questions well;
In that very place they meditated well on emptiness;
What they did before is shown here as well.

Today they have met the Tathāgata,
And have gained the company of the supreme person;
Because they praised the Guide by means of emptiness,
Today they have done exceedingly great good for beings.

Just as all beings are unborn,
So too are awakening, the Victor and the prophecy;
And those who practice having attained peace,
And likewise awakening, are unborn.

Such is the nature of reality of all beings;
Knowing this, one will attain awakening:
About that, not one of the gods has any doubt.
Those with the mind of awakening always practice in this way.

Likewise, just as beings are unceasing,
So these hosts of gods possess the understanding that realizes it;
Since these learned ones are free of hesitation,
These will therefore become self-arisen Victors.

Having become certain of non-abiding,
They have no hesitation about the unmoving;
That beings have no intention,
About that, too, the gods have no doubt at all."

Phenomena have no intrinsic nature by way of essential nature.
The mind of awakening, and likewise awakening itself,
All of these have no intrinsic nature by way of essential nature.
On this as well the doubts of the gods are wholly purified.
These gods of Tuṣita, endowed with supreme intelligence,
All abide firmly in that which has no abiding.
Therefore awakening is not hard for these gods to find;
They will swiftly attain the state of the Self-Arisen One.

As guides, in the eon Tārakopama,
They will expound the teaching to limitless beings.
The names those Victors will bear
Are Kings Gentle in the Self-Arisen Dharma.
Thus the Victor, knowing the intentions
Of the gods of Tuṣita, proclaimed this to beings.
Hearing it, the world together with its gods
Rejoiced and gained strength as well.

This concludes the seventeenth chapter, the prophecy concerning the gods of Tuṣita.

Then, at that time, seven hundred million gods of Nirmāṇarati, led by Sunirmita, had seen the offerings of all those gods, from the asuras up to the realm of Tuṣita, and had heard the prophecies. They were satisfied, pleased and delighted. Joy, delight and happiness arose in them. Abiding in the true limit (bhūtakoṭi) and free of doubt about suchness, they rose from their seats, bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, bowed toward him with palms joined, and said to the Blessed One:

"As we understand the meaning of what the Blessed One has taught, all phenomena are the true limit, the limit free of obscuration, the limit of the limitless, the limit of non-abiding, the limit of the inexhaustible, and the limit of nonduality. They are without limit. Blessed One, it is called the true limit because it is unerring. It is called the limit of the limitless because it is without measure. It is called the limit free of obscuration because it is without attachment. It is called the limit of non-abiding because it is without essential nature. It is called the limit of the inexhaustible because there is a continual coming forth. It is called the limit of nonduality because it is of a single taste. It is called without limit because it has no limit.

"Blessed One, this true limit pervades everything; there is no phenomenon whatsoever that is not the true limit. Blessed One, what is called awakening is the true limit. If one asks what awakening is: Blessed One, it should be understood that the absence of intrinsic nature in all phenomena is awakening. Even the deeds of immediate retribution are awakening. Why is that? Blessed One, awakening is without intrinsic nature, and the deeds of immediate retribution too are without intrinsic nature; therefore the deeds of immediate retribution too are called awakening.

"Blessed One, the sphere of nirvāṇa in which no aggregates remain is without intrinsic nature, and the deeds of immediate retribution too have that very nature. Why is that? Blessed One, all phenomena are the sphere of nirvāṇa in which no aggregates remain, and the deeds of immediate retribution too have that very nature.

"Blessed One, whoever wishes to pass into complete nirvāṇa is subject to harm. Why is that? If there were someone who had entered saṃsāra, he would seek nirvāṇa. But since in the true limit no one at all has entered saṃsāra, what nirvāṇa would anyone seek? Blessed One, the true limit is nondual. Blessed One, we have no hesitation and no doubt about it. Blessed One, whoever has no wavering and no doubt about this Dharma should be understood to have been prophesied to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening by the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly awakened buddhas of the past."

Then, at that time, the Blessed One, having heard those seven hundred million gods of the Nirmāṇarati realm, led by Sunirmita, king of the gods, make their own prophecy about themselves, smiled at that moment in order to delight all beings.

Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"Wishing to benefit the world, you smiled,
Yet you have not taught the cause of that smile.
Since none of the self-arisen, the holy beings,
Ever smiles without a cause,

The world with its gods, seeing the smile
That you displayed upon your face, is in doubt.
Self-Arisen One, tell us what the cause of the smile is;
Please dispel the doubts of those who doubt.

If they hear the cause for which you smiled,
This whole assembly will be filled with wonder,
And so that they may accomplish supreme awakening,
Their supreme path will become utterly pure.

Those who doubt will never
Accomplish awakening with ease, as they wish;
The wise, once doubt and hesitation are dispelled,
Come to possess the cause and the fortune of supreme awakening.

Lord of two-footed beings, this assembly of yours
Has wholly abandoned evil and possesses the mind of awakening.
If they hear those prophecies about the gods,
They will attain the vast state of a Victor.

Therefore, Victor, arouse your great compassion,
And out of love for those who doubt,
Give your prophecy to all these hosts of gods,
And bring delight to all these beings."

Then the Blessed One spoke again in verse to the venerable Aśvajit:

"I smiled for the benefit of the world.
Aśvajit, the question that you have asked,
That prophecy I shall explain to you in full.
Listen, all of you, with faith.

These hosts of gods of the Nirmāṇarati realm
Have prophesied of themselves, 'We shall be omniscient.'
Overpowering the thinking of the hosts of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas),
They have proclaimed a great lion's roar in this assembly.

Just as a stone thrown into the sky falls to the ground,
And no one doubts that this will happen,
So they, having gained the way that is free of doubt,
Know that they themselves will come to have the ten powers.

When the sun has set and night has fallen,
People know the moon will soon rise.
Likewise the Victor's sons, who have gained the way,
Know that they themselves will come to have the ten powers.

That the moon dwells amid the hosts of stars
Is something no being at all has doubts about.
Likewise the Victor's sons, who have gained the way,
Know, 'We shall become omniscient.'

Just as, when the sun has set,
Beings know that they will not see the sun,
Likewise the Sugata's sons, who know the way,
Know that they will attain supreme wisdom.

Just as rivers flow along the downward slope,
And the wise know that they flow into the ocean,

Likewise the Sugata's sons, who know the way,
Know that they will attain vast awakening.

Just as a clod of earth thrown into the sky
Will fall to the ground without a doubt,
Likewise those wise sons of the Victor
Will swiftly become Knowers of the World and enter into wisdom.

Having heard this, they become free of doubt,
And know themselves to abide in the qualities of a buddha;
In their own ground, its approaches not left empty,
The wise clearly see the nature of reality.

Even if ten million hosts of Māra
Should take on the forms of buddhas and speak to obstruct them,
Those skilled in the Dharma, who clearly see the nature of reality,
Cannot be turned back from awakening.

Thus, firmly abiding in the qualities of a buddha,
They declare their prophecy, each about themselves,
And the Guide, who knows the rite and the way,
The Lord of Men, will rejoice in that prophecy.

So these hosts of gods, in this way,
Not depending on others, know it directly,
And declare of themselves, 'We shall become sugatas,'
And the Knower of the World rejoices with them.

Therefore, Aśvajit, those wise ones
Who resolve to attain unsurpassed awakening
Should attend upon wise noble persons
Who have come to know this way.

Those who clearly see how to enter the way,
The wise who serve and honor the sugatas,
For them awakening is as plain as the palm of the hand;
Those who know the way become self-arisen by themselves.

Compared with one who practices austerities for a thousand eons,
Paying no heed to flesh, blood and skin,
If someone realizes this way in a single instant,
That is what excels; austerity is not like this.

Whatever self-arisen ones have appeared in the past,
Whatever ones who wish to benefit beings will appear in the future,
And whatever guides dwell in the present time,
All of them attained sugatahood through the way.

These hosts of Sunirmita gods, who know the Sage's way,
Have made supreme offerings to me,
And when they have thoroughly served and honored all the guides,
Through the way they will attain the state of the Self-Arisen.

Whatever is the concentration of the Knower of the World,
Through it the Victors abide as self-arisen ones;
All of that is the domain of the Victors,
And those who have gained the way swiftly attain it directly.

Thus, Aśvajit, the sons of the buddhas
Have no hesitation about that abiding of the buddhas.
Beings who delight in the way of the buddhas,
Those who know the way, practice the Teacher's path.

Therefore, make your mind one of faith in the way,
And exert yourself in that, not in practices of suffering.
If one always attends upon wise spiritual friends,
One will swiftly attain unsurpassed awakening."

Having heard the supreme speech of the Sugata,
The whole assembly rejoiced in the Victor's awakening,
And rejoicing, they became free of doubt
And entered into the intelligence of those who have reached the culmination.

This concludes the eighteenth chapter, the Prophecy of the Nirmāṇarati Gods.

Scroll seven.

Then, at that time, eighty trillion gods of the Vaśavartin realm, led by Vaśavartin, king of the gods, having seen the offerings made by all, from the asuras up to the Nirmāṇarati gods, and having heard the prophecies, were satisfied, pleased and delighted. Overjoyed, joyful and happy, they said to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, as for what the Nirmāṇarati gods have called the limit of reality, we do not even apprehend reality, so what need is there to speak of its limit? Why is that? Blessed One, if anyone apprehends reality, he will also apprehend its limit, and that is to engage in duality. Such a thing is not the domain of

sons and daughters of good family who have truly entered the vehicle."

"Blessed One, someone may not practice the view that nondual phenomena are nondual, and may have no devotion to it. Even if such a person thinks, 'I shall fully and perfectly awaken to awakening,' he should be known to have entered a wrong path. Why is that? Blessed One, whoever aspires to awakening has entered a wrong path, for, Blessed One, there is no phenomenon whatsoever to be fully and perfectly awakened to. Why is that? Blessed One, if any phenomenon at all is apprehended, one cannot fully and perfectly awaken to awakening. Blessed One, phenomena are not past, not future, and not present. They are not conditioned and not unconditioned. They are not entities and not non-entities. They are not to be directly known, not to be fully understood, not to be abandoned, not to be cultivated, and not to be actualized.

"Blessed One, what is called awakening is not the antidote to any phenomenon, nor is any phenomenon the antidote to it. Why is that? That phenomenon is neither afflicted nor purified. A phenomenon that serves as the antidote to another phenomenon is not apprehended by way of intrinsic nature, and the other phenomenon that serves as its antidote is not apprehended by way of intrinsic nature either. Why is that? Blessed One, all phenomena are free of signs. They are not to be directly known, not to be fully understood, not to be abandoned, not to be cultivated, and not to be actualized.

"Blessed One, form is free of the sign of form. Feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are free of the sign of consciousness. Whatever arising there is, from the sign of the arising of form up to the arising of consciousness, is also free of the sign of arising. Whatever cessation there is, from the cessation of form up to the cessation of consciousness, is also free of the sign of cessation. Blessed One, the past, the future, and the present are free of past, future, and present. The conditioned is free of the sign of the conditioned. The unconditioned is free of the sign of the unconditioned.

"Blessed One, whatever is included in the aggregates, or included in arising and cessation, or included in the past, in the future, or in the present, or included in the conditioned or the unconditioned, is in every respect not apprehended. Such non-apprehension is not to be directly known, not to be fully understood, not to be abandoned, not to be cultivated, and not to be actualized. Blessed One, the sons and daughters of good family who have

entered in this way are said to have properly entered the bodhisattva vehicle."

Then those gods of the Vaśavartin class, having explained the Dharma as they understood it, praised the Blessed One with these verses:

"Blessed One, you have well taught how existence is brought to an end.
Since the Guide found no essence in existence,
Those unskilled people, out of fear,
Set out to cross to the far shore of saṃsāra.

"The aggregates are never apprehended at all;
The aggregates are empty of the sign of aggregates.
Whatever phenomenon serves as antidote to another
Is empty of sign; nothing whatsoever exists.

"Since all is empty of essential nature, whatever entity
Is to be fully known, abandoned, cultivated, or actualized,
None whatsoever exists, none is apprehended anywhere;
The Self-Arisen One says entities are non-entities.

"Awakening is not apprehended as a sign at all,
And so it is with the factors that lead to awakening.
No buddha at all is apprehended as a sign;
Bodhisattvas are not realized through signs.

"Those unskilled ones who cling to signs,
Even though they set their minds on awakening,
Practice in signs, and their domain is mistaken;
With poor understanding they do not travel the path of awakening.

"Those who have abandoned signs and practice
In the domain of the buddhas are skilled in the buddhas' teaching.
Having abandoned signs, and signlessness as well,
Apprehending neither empty nor not empty,
Those wise ones travel the path of awakening;
They attain supreme and peaceful awakening.

"It is not the domain of any opponents;
That state cannot be reached by the śrāvakas;
Nor do the pratyekabuddhas go there.
Those with liberated minds, undefiled and stainless,
The arhats who strive in this teaching,
And likewise the pratyekabuddhas who have become protectors,

Have no access to that domain of the wise.

"That state cannot be attained by those who practice signs,
Nor by those who meditate on partial emptiness,
Nor by those who speak of emptiness, saying 'empty through emptiness,'
Nor by those who assert that all phenomena have intrinsic nature.

"In the training of the blameless buddhas,
Those who train, free of trainee and training,
Those wise ones realize awakening by not realizing;
They bring delight, just as the Teacher taught.

"Through praising the Buddha, lord of two-legged beings,
We have gained no small merit; by that,
May beings awaken to supreme awakening,
And attain buddhahood, which teaches those who do not know!"

Then the Blessed One, at that time, understood the superior intention of those eighty trillion gods of the Vaśavartin class, led by Vaśavartin, king of the gods, and in order to generate roots of virtue for that great multitude of beings, he smiled.

Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"Knowing the thoughts of the god Vaśavartin,
You, chief of all two-legged beings, have smiled.
Since the Sage has not declared the cause of this smile,
Victor, please reveal the cause of your smile.

'Guides do not smile without a cause':
So the sublime Victor, supreme bull among men, has said.
The cause of the smile you made for the sake of the world,
Guide, please declare it and dispel our doubt.

Having seen the smile upon the great sage's face,
Great Sage, your assembly harbors doubt.
Gautama, Victor, Guide, for their sake,
For the world's benefit, please explain the cause of your smile.

These have turned their backs upon the stream of saṃsāra;
With minds set on nirvāṇa they sit with palms joined.
This assembly, vast of mind, harbors doubt;
You of meaningful renown, please dispel their uncertainty.

They have no doubt about the Sugata's teaching;
Again and again they arouse faith and show great reverence.
So that they may be free of doubt and their minds be liberated,
May the Victor fully quell the doubts of these people.

In the Sugata's teaching these dwell at ease,
And on the path by which the self-arisen Victors have gone,
On that path they go forth without doubt.
Therefore please cut through the doubts of these people."

Then the Blessed One replied once more to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

"Relying on the welfare of this great multitude,
What you have spoken in verse at the proper time,
Fully asking the cause and meaning of the smile,
These words of yours are timely indeed.

Aśvajit, by asking the meaning of that question,
You have acted for the good of this great multitude.
Because you asked it, this great multitude
Will truly set out for supreme awakening.

I knew the thoughts of Vaśavartin;
Aśvajit, therefore I showed this smile.
On the path of the teaching of the Knower of the World,
Those who seek the goal aspire in just this way.

Those who see these beings as without marks,
Just as one sees water in a mirage,
Who see the delusion of the childish in the manner of the wise:
Those who seek awakening should train by following them.

Abandon the perception of marks, for those people
Who always delight in marks will come to ruin.
The perception of marks leads onto a wrong path;
Through marklessness supreme awakening is attained.

Conceiving what does not exist, they imagine it as marks,
And just as they imagine, so are they bound.
The peaceful wise, who see that marks are empty,
Attain the highest renown.

With perception of marks and an uneven stream of mind,
The unwise commit hundreds of evil deeds,
And in every destiny they undergo no small suffering:
Thus do the unwise imagine marks.

Those who perceive in terms of marks see the aggregates,
The buddhas, awakening, and bodhisattvas as marks.
If one sees in this way, without marks and empty,
One attains immeasurable, unsurpassed awakening.

For those who perceive marks, afflictions increase;
Marklessness abandons the fetters.
There is no fetter other than marks,
And that very fetter is itself without marks.

Those who conceive that awakening is something to attain:
That very conception is the obstacle of the unwise.
When the wise attain the various kinds of enjoyment,
That very enjoyment becomes markless.

No phenomena whatsoever exist by intrinsic nature;
All phenomena that arise from conceptual thought are empty.
Through non-conception there comes to be marklessness;
That itself is awakening; the wise do not speak otherwise."

Having heard these words spoken by the Victor,
The fearless assembly dispelled its doubts.
Just as one would hold a garland of campaka flowers,
The wise held to what the Sage had said, calling it excellent.

These fearless hosts of gods
Made noble and unsurpassed offerings,
And having fully understood the phenomena that are the Victors' domain,
They will become omniscient guides of beings.

This is the nineteenth chapter, the prophecy concerning Vaśavartin.

Then six hundred million gods of the Brahmakāyika realm saw the offerings made by all those from the asuras up to the gods of the Paranirmitavaśavartin realm, and they also heard the prophecy. They were satisfied, pleased, and delighted; joy, rapture, and happiness arose in them. Because they had accumulated roots of virtue in the past, had served and honored Victors of the past, and were of thoroughly pure intention, they became averse to worldly

meditative concentration and gained illumination in this teaching of the Tathāgata. Having attained acceptance of the profound Dharma, they came to know all phenomena as neither made nor unmade. Likewise they came to know them as neither born nor unborn, neither arisen nor unarisen, neither established nor unestablished, neither ceased nor unceased, neither abiding nor non-abiding, neither afflicted nor purified, not attached, not angry, neither deluded nor undeluded, neither a knower nor without a knower, neither a seer nor without a seer, neither a feeler nor without a feeler, neither a teacher nor without a teacher, neither existent nor nonexistent, neither an entity nor a non-entity, neither apprehended nor unapprehended, neither going nor coming, neither gone nor come, neither empty nor non-empty, neither having marks nor markless, neither having aspiration nor without aspiration.

In this way, with minds that did not abide in any phenomenon at all, they did not abide even in names, did not abide in conventions, and did not abide in expressions. They had no perception of expression, and no perception of the inexpressible. They had no perception of activity, and no perception of non-activity. They had no perception of ordinary beings, and no perception of those who are not ordinary beings. They had no perception of the qualities of ordinary beings, and no perception of qualities that are not those of ordinary beings. They had no perception of śrāvakas, and no perception of those who are not śrāvakas. They had no perception of the qualities of śrāvakas, and no perception of qualities that are not those of śrāvakas. They had no perception of pratyekabuddhas, and no perception of those who are not pratyekabuddhas. They had no perception of the qualities of pratyekabuddhas, and no perception of qualities that are not those of pratyekabuddhas. They had no perception of bodhisattvas, and no perception of those who are not bodhisattvas. They had no perception of the qualities of bodhisattvas, and no perception of qualities that are not those of bodhisattvas. They had no perception of buddhas, and no perception of those who are not buddhas. They had no perception of the qualities of buddhas, and no perception of qualities that are not those of buddhas. They had no perception of nirvāṇa, and no perception of what is not nirvāṇa. They had no perception of saṃsāra, and no perception of the absence of saṃsāra.

Thus, with minds wholly free of conceptual thought in every respect, they became pure and unstained like space. Because they were pure and unstained, at that time, being at peace, they praised the Blessed One with these verses:

Peaceful, with a peaceful mind, you practiced peace and went to the far shore of peace.
You cultivate peace, and you teach beings to cultivate peace.
You delight in the domain of peace; your awakening is peaceful, stainless, undisturbed.
Swiftly you found the deathless peace, where all the streams of rebirth are exhausted.

You rightly rely on peace, the supreme and peaceful path that brings the attainment of peace.
Through the eightfold path you calm the floods of affliction and draw out all beings,
And you establish them in that peaceful, immeasurable awakening relied upon by the Victors of the past.
Relying on it, you proclaim, "Today, enter the city of peace that the buddhas and noble ones rely upon."

Thus, Guide, you have taught these beings the training relied upon by the Victors.
If these beings train in that training, they will attain immeasurable awakening.
Having trained, peaceful, with peaceful minds, gone upon the path of peace, their senses at peace,
They will become wise in the world, pacifiers of beings, of great power, knowers of peace.

Guide, those supreme heirs of yours, peaceful, who bring peace to beings,
Who have discerned the deathless peace in which all signs are exhausted,
Will become guides skilled in method, honored with supreme offerings.
Their afflictions pacified, all signs abandoned, they will ever teach peace.

All beings are at peace and free of signs; that itself is nirvāṇa.
Those sages who intend a peace apart from what is at peace become afflicted.
Victor, your awakening, all beings and all phenomena are inconceivable.
Wise Sage who has crossed the mire, in this we have no doubt.

Those who cast off the aggregates to seek a peaceful awakening, and conceive of peace in that,
Those destroyers of the aggregates take no delight in the teaching of Śākyamuni.
Those of solitary mind who seek peace have minds that are disturbed;
The Teacher has said that those whose domain is the signs of phenomena are

childish.

The Omniscient One has spoken of these bonds of peace and of signs.
Those sages who find no sign in the aggregates in any way at all,
Who delight in signlessness, are the ones who adorn the teaching of Śākyamuni.
They will attain awakening, faultless and peaceful, the domain of the wise.

Victorious in the contest with Māra, they attain omniscience, where afflictions are at peace.
Whatever merit we have gained by praising the Guide who brings peace,
Which the Sugata of unattached mind knows to be just so much,
By it may all beings rely on the supreme path relied upon by the Omniscient One,
And relying on the peace that brings peace, become self-arisen ones, sinless, honored by the wise.

Then Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, knowing that the brahmās and the gods had praised the Blessed One, himself praised the Blessed One with verses in a similar manner:

Lord of men, you know all phenomena
To be false, deluding, like an empty house,
Like autumn clouds, like magical illusions;
O Victor, you know them to be without the qualities of desire.

Just as a man who is hungry in a dream
Eats food of a hundred flavors yet is not satisfied,
Since there is no hunger, no food and no being there,
So you see all phenomena as like that dream.

A thirsty man, in a dream as he sleeps,
Drinks cool water, clear and unclouded,
Yet is not sated, and his heat is not allayed:
Just so you see all phenomena.

Here there is no agent, no one who feels, no being;
Likewise there is no deed done, and no ripening;
There is no one who will experience the fruit:
Knowing phenomena to be thus, you have no doubt at all.

When a man speaks pleasing words,
One is delighted, yet nothing passes over in the words;

The words themselves do not exist, nor is there any thing that delights:
Knowing this, you have no doubt about it at all.

When one hears the sweet sound of a lute, it pleases the ear,
Yet that sound has no intrinsic nature whatsoever.
When the Wise One looks at these aggregates in this way,
He observes no intrinsic nature of the aggregates at all.

A precious jewel, by nature clear and pure,
Placed beside a cloth, takes on its various colors.
Likewise phenomena, though wholly pure by nature,
Become so through false conceptual thought.

Sandalwood, too, stainless and free of fault,
When joined with conditions, takes on a different fragrance.
Likewise phenomena, though wholly pure by nature,
Appear just as each one imagines them.

Just as a man who hears the sound of a conch
Examines, "Where has this sound come from?"
Yet finds no such thing, for it is empty of intrinsic nature,
Just so, lord of men, you see all phenomena.

Just as a man, regarding delicious food,
Examines how it comes to benefit the limbs and life,

It has no real existence; so too with limbs and life.
The great sage sees all phenomena in this way.
Just as when a man sees a rainbow in the sky,
And, analyzing and examining its parts, finds it empty, without intrinsic nature,
So, like the rainbow in the sky, your limbs are empty.
The great sage sees all phenomena in this way.
Even a splendid city, when its parts are analyzed,
Has no nature of a city to be found, nor even its name.
Just as with the city, so your limbs are empty.
Lord of men, you see all phenomena in this way.
When a drum is beaten for people's delight,
Though it gives rise to joy, the sound is empty of intrinsic nature.
Just as with the sound, so the limbs are empty.
Lord of men, you see all phenomena in this way.
When a man beats that drum,

The sound does not go off in any direction, nor does it arise from one,
And likewise it does not cease in any direction.
Lord of men, you see all phenomena in this way.
When a man beats that drum,
Its sound is unobstructed and pleasing by nature;
Your limbs are like the sound of that drum.
Lord of men, you see all phenomena in this way.
When a man beats that drum,
The sound has no thought of delighting the world.
Just as with the sound, your limbs are empty.
Lord of men, you see all phenomena in this way.
When a man beats that drum,
There is no stirring, and no state of stillness either.
Just as with the drum, your limbs are empty.
Lord of men, you see all phenomena in this way.
When a man beats that drum,
The sound does not arise from its parts, nor is it independent.
Just as with the sound, your limbs are empty.
Lord of men, you see all phenomena in this way.

Then the Blessed One understood the superior intention of those gods of Brahmā's assembly and of Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world. Seeing that the assembly too had accumulated roots of virtue by praising him with that praise of seeing calm abiding and wisdom, he smiled at that moment.

Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

Seeing the stainless smile appear upon the face of Śākyamuni,
The whole world with its gods, its humans, its nāgas and yakṣas,
All beings who have seen the Protector's smile, are filled with doubt.
Gazing at the Sugata's fair face, they wait, eager to hear.
Victor, you who smiled, please speak well and dispel their doubt.
The guides, supreme sages, omniscient buddhas, leaders,
Who work for the world's benefit, are never seen to smile without a cause.
Sugata, tell the cause for which you smiled, the cause of their doubt.
Hearing the cause of the Victor's smile, beings will rejoice.
This assembly, full of doubt, joins its palms and turns its mind to you.
Since they long to hear the Sugata Sage's supreme speech that cuts through doubt,

Guide and Sage, tell them the cause of your smile.
Hearing it, beings will rejoice and, free of doubt, will flourish.
This assembly, possessed of essence and untroubled, longs for the qualities of a buddha.
Teacher, they gaze upon your lovely face, like the beautiful moon.
Guide, free of attachment, perfect one, please proclaim your Brahmā-like voice.
Hearing it, the assembly's doubts will be cut, and they will abide in the Dharma.
Knowing your supreme Brahmā voice, rich in meaning and beyond the world,
People, their minds joyful and delighted, will be satisfied by the Omniscient One.
With minds purified, their doubts dispelled, they will strive for omniscience.
Generating great strength of diligence, they will set about a powerful aspiration.
That being so, guide of the world, benefactor, please proclaim your speech.
So that this assembly, which has gained virtue,
Having heard the unwavering supreme speech of the best of two-legged beings,
May turn its mind toward omniscience,
You who possess the ten powers, benefactor of all beings, consider it well.

Then the Blessed One spoke again to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

Aśvajit, the beneficial smile that I have shown to all beings,
Its beautiful and praiseworthy meaning, listen to it attentively with one-pointed mind.
Hearing it, beings who gather good qualities will swiftly work for the world's benefit,
And will apply their diligence to the beneficial activity the Buddha has declared.
These, Brahmā and his entire retinue, are joyful and have no doubt about the teachings.
For countless eons, as many as the sands of the Ganges, they have practiced virtue well.
Their minds have become unattached to any forms at all, and their perception is like space.
Yet even so, they have not generated the mind to fully awaken to the Sugata's

awakening.
In the future, after immeasurable hundreds of millions of eons,
As many as the sands of the Ganges, free of the dust of defilement, they will abide in the power of omniscience.
After that they will become sugatas, great ones, buddhas, great guides,
Blessed Ones who clear away existence and teach that beings are empty.
As those protectors practiced, so will the measure of their lifespans be.
Sugatas of boundless fame, they will remain, relieving the suffering of the world.
Their buddhafields will possess immeasurable riches;
Even if the great guides, the boundless buddhas, were to describe them
For countless eons in many ways, they could not exhaust the account of their arrays.
At that time they will all be alike, as victors called Possessor of the Power of Wisdom.
They will teach beings the Dharma that is unmoving, without mind, and nonabiding.
In those supreme fields not a single being will appear
Who has not trained in the protectors' path of omniscience, and in that existence most will pass into nirvāṇa.
In those fields, at that time, those beings will know only one kind of suffering:
Through the suffering of impermanent formations, intensely fearful, beings will grow weary of existence.

There the suffering of change and the suffering of suffering will not exist.
All of them will be of one mind, and swift upon the easy path.
There no other kind of sound or speech will arise among the people.
Unattractive, impermanent, suchness, suffering, and likewise selflessness,
Peace, emptiness, signlessness, the deathless, nirvāṇa, and awakening, peace:
These sounds and words will arise again and again and will remain in their ears.
A sound which, once heard, would not lead them to attain the state of freedom from saṃsāra,
Such a sound will not exist anywhere at all, in trees or in walls,
Nor in open places, nor in the sky, nor in temples, nor in dwellings.
Then, by the power of the Buddha, a voice endowed with eight qualities will arise.

Then, with no fault of confusion, in the ears of those tormented
By attachment, aversion, and delusion, the sound of virtue will resound.
All beings will emerge from saṃsāra and go on to nirvāṇa.
Then all the empty supreme fields will be filled with joyful people.
Those holy beings, having striven for awakening for countless eons,
Those great sages, through their aspirations, brought this abundance into being,
And whatever hosts of sentient beings are in that supreme field will all become sugatas.
If beings see the vast, extensive, and peaceful aspiration of Brahmā,
Which, just as the Buddha declared, the hosts of Brahmā have followed,
Then, having trained in it, all beings will become unobstructed guides.
Having attained the state of Victors, they will teach that all these beings are without substance.
Therefore, teach the conduct skilled in entering every mode.

This is the twentieth chapter, the Prophecy of Brahmā.

Then fifty-eight times ten million Ābhāsvara gods saw the offerings of those gods, from the asuras up to Brahmā, and heard the prophecy. They were satisfied, delighted, and glad. Supreme joy, delight, and happiness arose in them. They rose from their seats, draped their upper robes over one shoulder, and placed their right knees on the ground. Bowing with joined palms toward the Blessed One, they said to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, there is a meditative absorption called Illumination of All Dharmas. A bodhisattva who trains in it in order to enter the mode comes to see all dharmas illuminated, and by it he realizes the entry into the mode of all dharmas. Through that realization he comes to possess inconceivable eloquence, unobstructed eloquence, empowered eloquence, varied eloquence, gentle eloquence, virtuous eloquence, reasoned eloquence, liberated eloquence, fitting eloquence, profound eloquence, subtle eloquence, and uncommon eloquence, and he also attains the eloquence of a buddha.

"What is that meditative absorption called Illumination of All Dharmas? Blessed One, here a bodhisattva great being, in order to enter the mode of all dharmas, does not bring to mind any conceptual thought or analysis. He thinks: 'All dharmas are without conceptual thought; conceptual thought is completely cut off. What is free of conceptual thought pervades everything,

and no dharma whatever can be conceptualized. Why is that? Because they are without intrinsic nature. How could one conceptualize a dharma that has no intrinsic nature?' In this way he fully attains the eloquence of entering into a, which is nonconceptuality toward all dharmas. Having entered the door of a, they come to have infinite eloquence.

"a means infinite, wholly infinite, unmade, uncompounded, not fully established, without substance, nonabiding, unmoving, without gathering, without dispersing, without thought, without conceptual thought, unaccomplished, without any final limit, unexamined, formless, indemonstrable, not to be looked upon, unseen, not to be thought, not abiding in any way, unknown, uncognized, unspoken, untaught, inconceivable, unthinkable, without going, without coming, not near, not far, unexamined, of a nature without designation, nameless, without conventional expression, without antidote, without obscuration, without transference, without disturbance, not to be investigated, inexhaustible, nondual, not come into being, not false, not true, not deceptive, unborn, unceasing, not purified, not fit to be purified, not to be designated, unmoved by signs, ungrasped, undiscarded, without grasping, without full grasping, not to be entrusted, not to be fully entrusted, unrelinquished, and not fully relinquished.

"a is made by no one; it is not the agent of any dharma. a is unborn; it does not produce any dharma. a is unborn; it is not the cause of the arising of any dharma. a is unceasing; it is not the cause of the cessation of any dharma. a is also not unceasing; it is not the condition for the noncessation of any dharma. a neither abides nor does not abide. a is neither designated nor undesignated. a is neither abandoned nor unabandoned. a is neither known nor unknown. a is neither an object of focus nor a non-object of focus. a is neither empty nor not empty. a is neither apprehensible nor inapprehensible. a is neither a sign nor signless. a is neither aspiration nor aspirationless.

"Blessed One, thus the characteristic of all dharmas is the mode of a. All dharmas have a single mode: the mode of a. All dharmas have a single course: the course of a. All dharmas have a single entry: the entry into a. All dharmas have a single designation: designation by a. All dharmas have a single conventional expression: the expression of a. All dharmas have a single utterance: utterance by a.

"Blessed One, those phenomena that are unborn are to be understood by way of not being understood. Those phenomena that have not arisen are to be

understood by way of there being no real entity. Those phenomena that are not established are to be understood by way of not being established. Those phenomena that have not ceased are to be understood by way of there being no cessation. Blessed One, those phenomena that are not conditioned are to be understood by way of being unconditioned, and that is the way of all phenomena.

"Blessed One, if one asks how those unborn phenomena are to be understood in conventional terms, it is like this. Just as all kinds of activities take place in a dream, so should all phenomena be viewed. And why? Blessed One, the activities of a dream are unborn, have not arisen, and have no real entity, yet designations are spoken of for them. In the same way, the activity of all phenomena should be understood.

"Blessed One, just as there is a conventional expression for an echo, so too should the conventional expressions for all phenomena be viewed. Blessed One, just as there is a designation for an illusory person, so are the designations of all phenomena to be viewed. Blessed One, just as there is the conventional expression that designates a mirage as water, so should the conventional expressions for all phenomena be viewed. Blessed One, just as in the disk of a mirror there is the conventional expression 'the form of a woman' or 'the form of a man,' so should the conventional expressions for all phenomena be viewed.

"Blessed One, to please the childish, the activities of a dream are spoken of in conventional terms, but those activities of a dream do not exist. Blessed One, in the same way, to please the childish, the activities of optical illusions, mirages, and echoes are also spoken of in conventional terms, yet there is no activity in an echo. Blessed One, this is how we understand the meaning of what the Blessed One has taught. Blessed One, this is the samādhi called Illumination of All Phenomena."

When they had said this, the Ābhāsvara gods praised the Blessed One in verses:

"Sugata, you know a single way, yet you teach it in this way and in that.
O Sage, so too is the display of your heirs, the wise ones of the world.
The foolish world, who view things as a self, do not comprehend it.
That 'self' is nowhere in the ten directions; beings are empty in themselves.

"Illusions are hollow, and a mirage has no water, yet they perceive water;
Just so, those childish ones of distorted mind are deluded and construe a self.

They do not know what is real; unskilled, they rely on what is no ground and cling to it.
Just so, childish people do not fully know the aggregates, which are like a mirage.

"Delighting in saṃsāra, pierced by thorns, their faculties are driven by that suffering.
Where the unskilled surely experience suffering, there is no real entity.
The bewildered, of mistaken mind, wrongly perceive their sufferings as happiness,
And afflictions, great fears, and the three poisons follow after them and pursue them.

"Attachment, aversion, and delusion, the great poisons, the matchless afflictions, pursue them.
Those bewildered ones are pained, made to suffer by whatever suffering afflicts them.
Following after these, the childish and unskilled bear a burden of harm as well.
When they hear of this emptiness, the gateway to the Victors' way that brings liberation,

"Those base people of feeble understanding are frightened by the very truth of the teaching's words.
Sugata, you have thus taught the single gate of the great way, the letter A.
Those of right understanding make their minds grow there, as trees grow from the earth;
They subdue ten million māras with their armies and fully awaken to peaceful awakening.

"With the boat of the eightfold path they ferry people across the great ocean of afflictions.
Sugata, all-knowing one, the gentle, through that sublime way,
Swiftly clear away the poison of afflictions and attain immeasurable, peaceful awakening;
Liberated and free of poison, they gain the knowledge that sees other beings with certainty,

"And swiftly reaching the other shore, poison-free and at ease, they vanquish all that is vicious.
Sugata, though all is empty, those who conceive a self imagine what is proper

and improper.
Among all beings, the wise who have trained in what is proper and improper,
Being liberated, see with minds unattached to any being the dharma of essential nature;

"Seeing its way and skilled in that way, they become mighty protectors.
There is no binding and nothing bound, O Sugata; phenomena have no nature of reality.
Suchness, unerring suchness, is peace, neither cleansed nor afflicted;
There is no mark of affliction, no one who pacifies, and no afflictions either.

"Those who see this sublime great way will all become omniscient.
Liberated and liberating, of peaceful nature, bringer of peace, wondrous one, you are without change.
Blessed One, the world with its gods is deluded, like a mirage in spring;
Overpowered by conceptions of self, though there is no self or other, they imagine man and woman.

"Beings in suffering there are produced by diverse causes, and mind is produced by mind,
Yet there is no karma and no result, nor anyone who comes to experience them.
Sugata, thus do we understand the way that is the domain of the buddhas.
Therefore, now, the Sugata, of peaceful mind, with faculties pacified and gentle,

"Possessed of virtuous understanding, pure, clean and stainless, is perfectly honored with the Dharma.
Whatever merit has arisen from praising the Buddha, chief of the noble ones of the world,
Whose full ripening the glorious lord of two-legged beings fully knows,
By that root of virtue of ours, may all these beings attain omniscience.
We dedicate all this merit for the sake of all beings; may all become Victors!"

Then the Blessed One perceived the complete purity of the superior intention of those Ābhāsvara gods and the excellence of their eloquence in keeping with the way, and knowing that the assembly too would attain distinction, he smiled at that time.

Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"You who act for the world's benefit, supreme guide, omniscient one who outshines all,
Since compassionate sugatas never smile without a cause,
Victor of dense splendor, supreme among humans, out of love for the world, please speak.
You who have passed beyond the world, why did you smile? Tell us the cause.
Lord, when they hear it, all beings will have minds filled with faith,
And, O Guide, they will perform immeasurable deeds of renunciation and gain its fruits.
Thereby this world with its gods and humans, worn down by suffering in saṃsāra,
Shown the noble eightfold path, will be ferried across this ocean of existence.
Hearing this excellent, supreme speech of the great sage, endowed with eight qualities,
All beings will seek buddhahood itself and strive in virtue with joy.
Freed from doubt, with purified minds, they will generate the strength of fierce diligence,
And acting according to the Sugata's teaching, they will become your heirs, in harmony with you.
These assemblies, having no other refuge, gaze upon your face, O Guide.
Support of beings, dispel their conceptual doubts and please grant your instruction.
Blessed One, these worlds stand in attendance at your feet and long to listen.
Rain down the nectar of your well-spoken teaching; those who thirst will long for it.
Great Guide, these assemblies of yours seek the qualities of a buddha.
Like a child looking to a mother long gone away, they gaze upon your face.
Sugata, please give the gods their prophecy, and explain the meaning of your smile.
If they hear the Protector's supreme speech, the world will gain great benefit.
Sage, who today will grow in virtue and pursue renown?
Who will find the treasure of the Guide's qualities? We long to hear it.
When the Victor's assemblies hear what you say and rejoice,
They will teach this way and will cultivate powerful concentration and wisdom as well."

Then the Blessed One replied to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

"Aśvajit, it is most excellent that your eloquence has arisen so well and so timely.
Like an emanation of the Sugata, your intelligence comes forth in this way,
And great eloquence arises. Therefore, whatever you have asked,
I shall explain it all in answer; all of you, listen with calm faculties.
The gods of Ābhāsvara, pure of mind, have seen the Victors of the past,
And seeing these beings of the world without a protector, they have truly entered upon awakening.
Practicing the supreme path of renunciation toward awakening, truly practiced by the Victors,
When they wish to go to awakening, they will teach those without a teacher who have lost the path.
When they hear this sacred, unshared, utterly clear sound of the way,
Those of trained minds who seek the qualities of a buddha will attain the peace of awakening.
They gained strength, grew skilled in what is the way and what is not, and their minds became certain of awakening.
With joy like a mother who has borne a child, they made aspirations for supreme awakening.
These Ābhāsvara gods will show the door of the way to those who wish for awakening,
And having taught this subtle way for inexpressible trillions of eons,
And having made beings more numerous than the stars delight in awakening,
After that they will become knowers of the world, self-arisen, flawless, omniscient.
Their supreme fields, beyond expression, as many as a billion fields,
Will be vast and most delightful, adorned with every kind of array.
In all their fields there will never be lower realms, nor any unfavorable states.
Those sugatas, out of love, will make all beings self-arisen ones.
In none of those fields will the Śrāvaka Vehicle be taught;
All beings will be turned toward self-arisen buddhahood, never to be diverted.
There the knowers of the world, who teach self-arisen buddhahood,
Will have life spans of a billion eons, as many times as the sands of the Ganges.
Aśvajit, compared with bringing the śrāvakas of trillions of world realms beyond sorrow,
If anyone causes a single man or woman truly to delight in awakening,
The former cannot match that merit, either in number or by any example.

Therefore, holy beings who have entered upon awakening, inspire delight in awakening.
Aśvajit, in this world the appearance of an omniscient guide is not easy to find.
The buddhas of infinite intelligence have said it is like the udumbara flower.
Therefore any person who desires the unsurpassed peace and bliss of awakening
Should rely on a guide of very subtle intellect, steady and excellent, wise and skilled in the way."

When they had heard such beneficial words from the mouth of the Tathāgata,
The entire assembly rejoiced, supremely delighted and truly joyful.
Trillions of gods, stationed in the sky, waved their garments,
And in their joy they cried out, "Lord of buddhas, we pay homage to you!
Peaceful one of peaceful mind, you pacify people made wild by the wildness of afflictions.
You teach the nectar and quell the three poisons; please make beings vomit out their poison.
Hearing your wisdom, beings become free of poison and free of enemies.
Those in suffering, hearing the way from the Guide, are freed from the unbearable continuum of existence."

This concludes the twenty-first chapter, the Prophecy to the Ābhāsvara Gods.

Fascicle eight.

Then twelve trillion gods of the Śubhakṛtsna class, having seen the offerings made by all, from the asuras up to the Ābhāsvara gods, and having heard the prophecies, were satisfied, pleased, and delighted. Overjoyed, filled with joy and happiness, they declared, "We too have become perfect in the way," and said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, there is a meditative absorption called Going Blissfully Amid All Phenomena. By attaining that absorption, the bodhisattva great being experiences nothing but pleasant feeling toward every object of focus. He does not experience painful feeling, and he does not experience the feeling that is neither painful nor pleasant either.

"Even when he is harmed by the harms of the hells, the perception of bliss stays present in him. Even when he is harmed by the harms that humans inflict, the perception of bliss stays present. Even if his hands are cut off, or his feet are cut off, or both hands and feet are cut off, or his ears, or his nose, or

both ears and nose are hacked off, the perception of bliss stays present. Even if he is lashed with canes, or flogged with split canes, or beaten with whips, the perception of bliss stays present.

"He may be thrown into prison, or put in iron fetters and wooden stocks, or sealed into tight shackles. He may be bound up like a child's topknot, or heated like a warming pot, or pounded as sugarcane is pounded, or crushed as reeds are crushed. He may be set ablaze like a sesame-oil lamp, or set ablaze like a butter lamp, or boiled like curds. Even then the perception of bliss stays present.

"He may be thrown into a fire, or fed into a lion's mouth, or fed into a tiger's mouth. He may be rolled up like a dried ball, or mutilated with the punishment of an adulterer. He may be paraded and proclaimed as a criminal is proclaimed, or hacked into pieces the size of a kārṣāpaṇa coin, or boiled as rice flour is boiled, or trampled by elephants. Even then the perception of bliss stays present.

"His eyes may be gouged out, or he may be set on the point of a stake, or he may be led to the place of execution and put to death in every possible way. Even then the perception of bliss stays present. In no way at all does a perception arise in him that is neither pleasant nor unpleasant.

"And why is this? It is because, long ago, while that bodhisattva great being was engaged in the conduct, he made this aspiration:

"'May those who give me food attain the bliss of peace. May all those who give me drink, who serve me, who honor me, who show me respect and who make offerings to me also attain the bliss of peace. And may all those who revile me, who make me unhappy, who beat me, who strike me with weapons, even those who take my life in every way, also attain the bliss of awakening and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.'

"He made this aspiration. Endowed with those attitudes, and endowed with such actions and such aspirations, he relies on the perception of bliss that extends to all sentient beings. He cultivates it, meditates on it, and makes much of it. Then, through its ripening, he fully attains the absorption of Going Blissfully Amid All Phenomena.

"When a bodhisattva has attained the absorption of Going Blissfully Amid All Phenomena, he cannot be carried off or disturbed by any of the deeds of Māra. At that time, one should understand, he has attained the five masteries:

mastery over life span, mastery over birth, mastery over karma, mastery over conceptual thought, and mastery over requisites. If he wishes, he fully awakens to awakening immediately after this life. If he wishes, he remains for countless eons.

"And why is this? It is because that bodhisattva great being has truly entered the Great Vehicle. He accomplishes what bodhisattvas accomplish and is embraced by bodhisattvas. He has cleared away all the lower destinies and has taken birth throughout the six destinies. He has trained in all the trainings of a bodhisattva, is upheld by the Perfection of Wisdom, and is endowed with skill in means. He is victorious over the deeds of Māra, and he understands all phenomena so that he comprehends them fully. Blessed One, whatever enables a bodhisattva to gain certain realization of all phenomena is, all of it, the power of the Tathāgata."

Then, having spoken of this samādhi, the gods of Śubhakṛtsna praised the Blessed One at that time with these verses:

All these assemblies of the Śubhakṛtsna gods have reached the culmination of the Dharma;
Bowing our heads, we go for refuge to the Teacher, the lord, who is peaceful and knows peace.
They praise the Buddha honored by the wise, who knows the meaning and has crossed saṃsāra,
The Sage, the guide of humankind, skilled in method, the Victor, the guide, the leader.

Here, O Sage, no phenomenon with a fixed intrinsic nature abides anywhere;
Just as a master illusionist knows an illusion, so you, O Sage, know this well.
Just as the wise understand the echoes of many kinds that arise in mountain retreats,
So you, Sugata, O sage, behold the world with its gods and humans.

Here there is no sentient being, no life, no human, no nourisher, no person;
Supreme among humans, you dismantle perception and establish it as emptiness,
Yet, excellent among bipeds, chief of beings, you also cultivate immeasurable loving-kindness.
This intent of the Victor, the Buddha, is hard for any being to fathom.

The Guide declared, "Loving-kindness, the cultivation of virtue, takes sentient beings as its object,"

Yet you dismantle sentient beings and know all beings to be without any being.
Thus, excellent among bipeds, you are free of turbidity, your mind free of doubt;
Therefore, Sugata of discerning intellect, worthy of offerings, we would make offerings to you.

Sugata, though you nowhere perceive any suffering abiding in the ten directions,
You, who have become the god of gods, have taught that compassion should be shown to beings.
Thus, supreme Victor, we fully understand the Victor's intent just as it is;
Therefore, chief of bipeds, supreme among humans, worthy of offerings, we would make offerings to you.

Sage, you see neither sentient beings nor any suffering to be removed,
Yet, joy having arisen, with a mind of utter joy you dispel all joylessness.
Thus we understand just as it is this inconceivable way, the way of the Buddha;
Therefore, supreme among humans, by making offerings to you we shall attain the fruit you have found.

Faultless one, you nowhere perceive beings, nor suffering, nor nirvāṇa,
Yet seeing beings in saṃsāra, you bring forth the power to work for their good.
There are no beings, no suffering, no going, no sage, no nirvāṇa, and no abiding;
Having understood this way of the Buddha, O Sage worthy of offerings, we would make offerings to you.

The Guide beholds the four immeasurables and teaches that they are nondual;
He sees no one tamed by them, nor does he see anyone abiding in the immeasurables.
The Sage sees no one at all who is heedless, nor does he see anyone heedful;
Having understood this way of the Buddha, we have made offerings to you, the Sage, the Teacher.

The Sage, having fully abandoned the body, does not find the body when he searches for it,
Yet even so the Guide has not failed to teach mindfulness, and in him there is no forgetfulness.

The Sugata said, "Cultivate the meditation of mindfulness directed to the body."
Having understood this way of the Buddha, we have made offerings to the Sugata, the protector.

When the Guide searched for the intrinsic nature of feeling, it was not found,
And when the Sage searched thoroughly for one who feels a feeling, none was found;
Thus whatever meditation of mindfulness there may be, even the Buddha has never seen it.
Having understood this way of the Buddha, we have made offerings to the Teacher.

When the Sage reflected and searched for mind and mental factors, he did not find them,
And though he knows full well that that by which one establishes it is likewise without mindfulness,
He said, "Those who seek liberation should cultivate mindfulness focused on the mind."
Having understood this intent of the Sugata, we have made offerings to the Teacher.

Wishing to benefit the world, he saw neither phenomena nor anyone who engages with phenomena,
And the mindfulness he taught us to cultivate has here no intrinsic nature,
Yet he said, "Those who seek liberation should cultivate mindfulness focused on phenomena."
Having fully understood these four ways of the Buddha, we have made offerings to the Protector.

There is not even a single foundation; how then could there be two, three, or four?
The mindfulness that is spoken of as a foundation exists nowhere at all;
Therefore no one's pleasure or suffering truly exists anywhere.
Having understood this way of the Teacher, we therefore would make offerings to you.

Whatever monks uphold these four supreme ways of the Teacher,
For them these are the very path of liberation, and they will emerge from saṃsāra.

Yet thus, in this way, there is no one bound, no one freed, no awakening, and no guide.
The Blessed One has not demolished what is examined; therefore we would make offerings to you.

To bring liberation, the Blessed One taught the peaceful path, the bases of miraculous power;
If people cultivate them, they become heroes, tamed, and pass into nirvāṇa.
Yet in reality neither miraculous power, nor its bases, nor their cultivation is perceived;
He teaches that action is not annihilated, yet perceives no agent at all.

In this teaching of the Omniscient One the assembly of gods has no doubt whatever;
They have no hesitation about it, and likewise no uncertainty.
"This is the excellent, supreme offering," say the buddhas who are worthy of offerings;
Therefore, Sugata of incomparable conduct, worthy of offerings, we would make offerings to you.

To bring liberation, the Wise One of the world also taught the five faculties for renunciation,
Teaching, "Be always heedful, and cultivate this path that leads to nirvāṇa."
The Sage perceives neither faculties, nor meditator, nor even liberation;
The divine assembly has no doubt about this; therefore we would make offerings to you.

The five powers are the straight path by which the buddhas go to nirvāṇa;
"They exhaust the afflictions and bring liberation," so said the Teacher, the Sage.
They have no intrinsic nature; there are no afflictions and there is no Victor;
Sage, we have no doubt about any of this; therefore we make offerings to you.

These seven limbs of awakening are the supreme virtuous path;
"They are the supreme straight path by which the buddhas go to nirvāṇa," so the Sage declared.
There is no bondage and no freedom, and no one bound;
Jewel among beings, we have no doubt about this; we make offerings to you.

Chief of bipeds, you taught beings the path that is twice four,
Saying, "With diligence cultivate the noble path that brings suffering to an

end."
Supreme among humans, the path and likewise the afflictions, these two do not move;
Since the divine assembly has no doubt about this, we make offerings to you, worthy of offerings.

As the antidote to attachment you declared calm abiding; as the antidote to aversion you taught loving-kindness;
As the antidote to delusion the supreme Sage taught beings insight.
None of these moves; they are not momentary and are not afflictions;
The divine assembly has no doubt about this, and always strives to make offerings to the Sage.

To pacify suffering, you taught that one should cultivate the path of calm abiding and insight as well.
By this the Blessed One has pacified the stains of beings' afflictions, together with their habitual tendencies.
The Sage's calm abiding and insight, likewise, are empty of every stain.
In this the hosts of gods have no doubt whatsoever; to you, the flawless one, we offer worship.

The One with the Ten Powers taught sentient beings the ten paths of virtuous action.
Killing, sexual misconduct, taking what is not given, slander, lying, harsh words, idle talk,
Malice, improper craving, and likewise wrong views:
These paths of nonvirtuous action, too, the Blessed One taught to sentient beings.
Since sentient beings are not observed, how could there be killing? The rest are just the same.
There is no virtuous antidote; it is empty of essential nature.
The Sugatas, the sages free of defilements, are also empty of essential nature.
Guide, we have no doubt or hesitation; therefore we wish to worship you.

Whatever child of the Buddha, of virtuous mind, relies upon this conduct,
That wise one experiences only virtue at all times and will never come to experience suffering.
Blessed One, Sugata, by that wisdom you attained this way with ease.
In this the hosts of gods have no doubt; you who are worthy of worship, we wish to worship you.

Having thus praised the Blessed One, the gods of Śubhakṛtsna sat in silence. Then the Blessed One, knowing that the gods of Śubhakṛtsna were sitting in silence and understanding their practice undertaken with superior intention, smiled at that time. Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

All these people are outshone by the splendor of your knowledge, Blessed One.
Sugata, supreme Victor, you have shown this smile to the world.
Since those skilled in all dharmas do not smile without a cause,
Wise one of the world, please speak to these sightless ones who seek the reason for the smile.
All of these without exception think of nothing else; they sit in hope concerning your smile.
O you, dense with glory, they remain with minds that wish to praise you and to listen.
Having heard the Buddha, the lord of speech, their minds will be filled with delight,
And they will be born as teachers endowed with virtuous minds, certain about all dharmas.

Sugata, supreme among humans, of virtuous heart, who today has given rise to understanding?
Who today has realized the deathless peace and made the directions shine?
Who will become a Victor, a guide compassionate toward the world, beyond measure?
Speak of them, and satisfy this assembly of sages with your excellent words.
Victor, supreme bull, excellent śramaṇa, who today has given rise to faith in the Venerable One?
Which wise one, not to be carried off by Māra, abides perfectly in the Dharma?
Which child of the Buddha, skilled in method, will today attain certainty?
Lord of two-legged beings, speak of them; free these beings from doubt.
Sugata, who today has inspired faith in beings and become loving toward all creatures,
Gone to the culmination of awakening, of steadfast intellect, abiding in omniscience?
Who is it to whom you have shown your smile today, the holder of the Sugata's teaching?
You who bear the marks born of a hundred merits, speak of them, and dispel

my doubt.
Guide, if we hear your speech endowed with eight qualities, well spoken,
Then by the Sugata's words we ourselves shall go first and lead other beings as well.
If it comes about thus, this excellent teaching of the Sugata will abide among his heirs,
And the minds of these worlds will swiftly come to abide in the Sugatas.

Then the Blessed One again spoke to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

Aśvajit, you have seen the smile I made for the benefit of the world,
And you, holy person, have asked at the proper time and acted for the benefit of beings.
The increase of your merit cannot be expressed, and it will never be exhausted.
I shall explain it to you; you and these beings, listen with joy.
These hosts of Śubhakṛtsna gods have no doubt about my true nature.
All of them, rejoicing, with deeply peaceful minds, have praised me with verses.
They worshipped thousands of countless billions of former buddhas worthy of worship,
And, asking about the way with minds free of doubt, became wholly free of hesitation.
Through that former cause, here too they praise me in verse.
They will also praise all the Victors of the Fortunate Eon who are worthy of praise.
In the eon Utpala these will become Victors, conquerors of the foe, of great might.
They will bring inconceivable billions of beings to complete nirvāṇa.
Those buddhas, great sages, what pleasing name they will bear,
That too I shall teach; with clear minds, cast off dullness of mind and listen.
All those Victors will become immeasurable guides called Dharmaketu.
Each one of them, too, will lead inconceivable billions beyond sorrow.
At that time the relics of all the Sugatas will spread far and wide,
And at that time, throughout all the fields, the Victors' stupas will bloom with flowers.
When those sages of great renown have passed into complete nirvāṇa,
The spread of the relics of all those protecting sages will bring great benefit.
Inconceivable billions of beings will then make offerings to the relics,

And having worshipped those relics, they will attain nirvāṇa, the peaceful deathless state.
The renown of those sages, lords of two-legged beings, will never be interrupted,
And inconceivable billions of trainees will then gather in the presence of the Victors.
Just as those who have served me well through hundreds of millions of lives
Will go with vast minds into Maitreya's assembly in order to see Maitreya,
So those assemblies of the Victors' śrāvakas and trainees will go from Victor to Victor's assembly
In order to make offerings to the relics of all those lords of two-legged beings.

All beings were amazed on hearing the Sugata's melodious speech,
And the great beings of the Śubhakṛtsna class of gods, having heard it at that time,
All the assemblies were overjoyed, and most of them also gave rise to the mind of awakening.
Those great beings, having understood, touched their heads to the feet of the Sage.

This concludes the twenty-second chapter, the Prophecy concerning the Śubhakṛtsna Class.

Then the eight hundred million gods of the Bṛhatphala realm, having seen the offerings made by all, from the asuras up to the Śubhakṛtsna gods, and having heard the prophecies, were satisfied, delighted, and overjoyed. Great joy, delight, and happiness of mind arose in them. They entered a single approach, and they clearly saw that from each and every dharma there come forth endless doors of Dharma. They knew that from every entry into these approaches there also come forth endless eloquence, unbroken eloquence, reasoned eloquence, liberated eloquence, unobstructed eloquence, apposite eloquence, subtle eloquence, profound eloquence, varied eloquence, gentle eloquence, and coherent eloquence. Joy toward the Blessed One (the Buddha) arose in them, and, declaring the nature of reality, they said to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, there is a meditative absorption called Endless Approach of Doors. If one strives in it, the bodhisattva, the great being, obtains eloquence and comes to obtain unbroken eloquence, and becomes free of confusion

regarding every object and every meditative attainment. In it, by way of not apprehending any object as being form, one does not become obscured.

"Through entry into the aggregates, one obtains the dhāraṇī of the Endless Approach of Doors. Through entry into the elements, entry into the sense bases, entry into the faculties, entry into the truths, entry into dependent origination, entry into sentient beings, entry into the absence of sentient beings, entry into entities, entry into the absence of entities, entry into objects, entry into the absence of objects, entry into self, entry into emptiness, entry into signs, entry into signlessness, entry into wishes, entry into wishlessness, entry into abiding, entry into non-abiding, entry into the conditioned, and entry into the unconditioned, one likewise obtains the dhāraṇī of the Endless Approach of Doors, and comes to possess eloquence that is unobstructed with regard to everything.

"Through entry into the aggregates, one fully obtains the dhāraṇī in this way: this dharma called 'aggregate' is not established. Why is that? Form is not established in any way at all. Earth is not established as earth. Likewise water, fire, and wind: wind is not established as wind. Why is that? Earth has no intrinsic nature, and any dharma that has no intrinsic nature is not established. Water, fire, and wind have no intrinsic nature, and any dharma that has no intrinsic nature is not established.

"Form that is thus not established should not be designated as past, should not be designated as future, and should not be designated as present. Why is that? Because form is not an entity, and since it is not an entity, it has no arising. Whatever has no arising has no cessation, and whatever neither arises nor ceases cannot be designated.

"The Tathāgata too declared: 'Whatever form there is, past, future, or present, all of it gathered together is the aggregate of form.' Yet if the intrinsic nature of form cannot be apprehended, how could it be past, how could it be future, how could it be present? Therefore the aggregate of form cannot be designated. The aggregates of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are likewise. For that reason the aggregates cannot be apprehended. Because the aggregates cannot be apprehended, the dhāraṇī cannot be apprehended. Thus through entry into the aggregates one comes to enter the dhāraṇī.

"Apart from being a mere name, a mere convention, a mere sign, a mere conventional truth, a mere expression, and a mere designation, that dhāraṇī

too, the entry into the dhāraṇī, is not apprehended. Here the aggregates are not apprehended, the dhāraṇī is not apprehended, and the entry is not apprehended. The dhāraṇī is not apprehended by way of intrinsic nature.

"Why is that? What is called an 'aggregate' is an unmade dharma, and how could there be any heaping up in a dharma that is unmade? An aggregate is called an aggregate because it is heaped up. For example, when many things are gathered together, houses, mansions, cool chambers, multistoried buildings, latticed windows, turrets, lattices, terraces, battlements, windows, porticoes, enclosures, wooden latticework, and moats, that is called a city. What is called an aggregate is just like this. If form is not apprehended by way of its essential nature, how could there be any heaping up in it? Since there is no heaping up, there is no form, and there is no aggregate of form. Likewise, if feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness cannot be apprehended by way of intrinsic nature, how could there be any heaping up in them? Since there is no heaping up, there is no consciousness, and there is no aggregate of consciousness. In this way, through entry into the aggregates one obtains the dhāraṇī, and through obtaining the dhāraṇī one obtains eloquence.

"As for obtaining the dhāraṇī through entry into the sense bases: what is called the eye sense base, the sense base of what is it called? It is the sense base of suffering. And what is the eye? It is the clear sensitivity of the four great elements, that is, the clear sensitivity of the earth element, the water element, the fire element, and the wind element. The clear sensitivity of the earth element has no intrinsic nature, and any dharma whose intrinsic nature is not apprehended is not established. Likewise, the clear sensitivity of the water element, the clear sensitivity of the fire element, and the clear sensitivity of the wind element have no intrinsic nature, and any dharma whose intrinsic nature is not apprehended is not established.

"The eye sense base that is thus not established should not be designated as past, and should not be designated as future or present. Why is that? Because the eye sense base is not an entity, and since it is not an entity, it has no arising. Whatever has no arising has no cessation, and whatever neither arises nor ceases cannot be designated."

Thus the eye too is unborn and unceasing, and the sense sources and suffering too are unborn and unceasing. That which is unborn and unceasing cannot be designated, except as a mere name, a mere conventional term, a mere symbol, a mere convention, a mere expression; and that name too does

not exist as a name. Why is that? Because no phenomenon at all is found to which the designation "eye," or "sense source," or "suffering" could be applied, and the name too cannot be expressed as a name. The ear, the nose, the tongue, the body and the mind, and forms, sounds, smells, tastes, tangibles and mental phenomena are likewise. Therefore, by entering into the sense sources one obtains dhāraṇī, and by entering into dhāraṇī one obtains eloquence.

Now, obtaining dhāraṇī by entering into the elements is as follows. The eye does not exist as an eye, and the element does not exist as an element. Why is that? Because the eye is devoid of the intrinsic nature of an eye, and the element is devoid of the intrinsic nature of an element. A phenomenon that has no intrinsic nature has no real entity. That which has no real entity is not established at all. That which is not established at all has no arising. That which has no arising has no cessation. That which is unborn and unceasing cannot be designated as "past," except as a mere name, a mere conventional term, a mere symbol, a mere convention, a mere expression. It cannot be designated as "future" or as "present." That name too does not exist as a name, and so on, up to: that expression too does not exist as an expression. A phenomenon that has no intrinsic nature has no real entity. That which has no real entity is not established at all, and because it is not established at all, it has no arising. That which has no arising has no cessation. That which is unborn and unceasing cannot be designated as "past," nor can it be designated as "future" or as "present."

That which cannot be designated in the three times is without name, without characteristic, without sign, without conventional term, without symbol, without real entity, without association, inexpressible, without coming, without going. It is not shown and not revealed. It is not to be directly known and not to be fully understood. It is not white and not black. It is not an abode and not a support. It is not attained and not to be attained. It is not realized and not to be realized. It is not actualized and not to be actualized. It is not the ground of ordinary beings, not the ground of śrāvakas, not the ground of pratyekabuddhas, not the ground of bodhisattvas, and not the ground of buddhas. It is neither a ground nor a non-ground. It is suchness, unerring suchness, suchness that is not otherwise, peace, and without characteristic; it is designated merely as a conventional term. Therefore it is conventionally called "Tathāgata," but not ultimately. Why is that? Because the phenomenon that is called "Tathāgata" is not found.

Likewise, one should enter into the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu) through all the elements in full: the form element, the eye-consciousness element, and so on up to the mind element, the mental-phenomena element, and the mind-consciousness element. Blessed One, even when the dharmadhātu is designated as the aggregates, it does not abandon its very nature as the dharmadhātu. Even when it is designated as the elements, the sense sources, the faculties, the truths, or dependent origination, it does not abandon its very nature as the dharmadhātu. Whatever name the dharmadhātu is designated by, that name does not make it abandon its very nature as the dharmadhātu.

Blessed One, it is like this: whatever name the earth element is conventionally called by, that name does not make it abandon its very nature as the earth element. Blessed One, in the same way, whatever name the dharmadhātu is conventionally called by, that name does not make it abandon its very nature as the dharmadhātu. Blessed One, it is like this: whatever names the water element, the fire element, the wind element and the space element are conventionally called by, those names do not make them abandon their very nature as the elements of water, fire, wind and space. Blessed One, in the same way, whatever name the dharmadhātu is conventionally called by, that name does not make it abandon its very nature as the dharmadhātu. Thus, by entering into the elements one obtains dhāraṇī, and by entering into dhāraṇī one obtains eloquence.

Blessed One, entering into the dharmadhātu by entering into the faculties is as follows. There are twenty-two faculties, namely: the eye faculty, the ear faculty, the nose faculty, the tongue faculty, the body faculty, the mind faculty, the female faculty, the male faculty, the life faculty, the faculty of pleasure, the faculty of pain, the faculty of mental pleasure, the faculty of mental displeasure, the faculty of equanimity, the faculty of faith, the faculty of diligence, the faculty of mindfulness, the faculty of meditative absorption, the faculty of wisdom, the faculty of coming to know what is not yet known, the faculty of knowing, and the faculty of one who possesses full knowledge.

Among these, the eye does not exist as an eye, and the faculty does not exist as a faculty. Why is that? Because the eye is devoid of the intrinsic nature of an eye. A phenomenon that has no intrinsic nature has no real entity. That which has no real entity is not established at all. That which is not established at all does not arise, and what does not arise does not cease. That which is unborn and unceasing cannot be designated as "past," nor can it be

designated as "future" or as "present." That which is not found in the three times is not an eye and not a faculty. For that which is neither an eye nor a faculty, how could one know a conventional term? It is like this: an empty fist, for example, is false, unreal and nonexistent; it is designated by name in this way, but ultimately neither the emptiness nor the fist is found.

In the same way, the eye and its faculty too, like an empty fist, are false and nonexistent. They are not real. They are hollow, vacuous and false, deceptive by nature, deluding the childish and bewildering fools. They are designated in this way by name, but ultimately neither the eye nor the faculty is apprehended. That being so, after the Blessed One attained the wisdom of omniscience, he designated them "faculties" in order to guide sentient beings, however many abide in error. Ultimately, though, they are not so.

A faculty is free of intrinsic nature and empty of the essential nature of a faculty. Whatever phenomenon is empty of whatever phenomenon, to designate it conventionally by that is false and nonexistent. It is hollow, vacuous and false, deceptive by nature, deluding the childish and bewildering fools, and free of intrinsic nature. It does not arise and does not cease. What has not arisen and has not ceased cannot be designated "past," and it cannot be designated "future" or "present."

What does not exist in the three times is nameless and signless. It is false and without characteristics. It cannot be designated and is not a designation. It is not known and cannot be known. It is not cognized and cannot be cognized. It is not heard and cannot be heard. It is not discerned and cannot be discerned. It is not realized and cannot be realized. It is not attained and cannot be attained. It is not seen and cannot be seen. It is not found and cannot be found. And why is that? Because it does not exist and is not existent.

It is like this. Suppose a man, in a dream, laughs and rejoices, plays and indulges in delights. Then he wakes from sleep and recalls them. Yet although he recalls them, they are not found and they are not obtained. And why is that? If even in the dream that man did not obtain or find that laughter, rejoicing, play and delight, what need is there to mention the time when he has woken from sleep? There is no basis for obtaining or finding them.

Blessed One, in the same way the faculties are like a dream. Just as in a dream that laughter, rejoicing, play and delight cannot be apprehended, so too all phenomena cannot be apprehended in their essential nature. They cannot be designated "past," and they cannot be designated "future" or "present."

Whatever cannot be apprehended in the three times is called inexpressible, and all the faculties too should be understood in the same way. Thus, by entering the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu), one enters all phenomena, and by entering all phenomena, one also enters the realm of phenomena.

Now, if one asks how, by entering the truths, one enters the realm of phenomena: these four are the truths, namely suffering, origin, cessation and the path. The Blessed One too has declared, "All phenomena are empty. They are without a sentient being, without a life principle, without a person, without signs and without characteristics." About that we have no doubt and no hesitation.

Blessed One, since in that there is no sentient being, one should understand that there is no suffering. And why is that? Where there is no sentient being, there is no suffering either. Blessed One, since there is no suffering, one should understand that there is no origin either. And why is that? Because where there is no result, there is no cause. Blessed One, since there is no origin, one should understand that there is no cessation. And why is that? Because where there is no origin, there is nothing to abandon. Blessed One, since there is no cessation, one should understand that there is no path. And why is that? What does not abandon is not a path. The result of the path is not cessation, and the afflictions to be abandoned, whose cessation it would be, are not apprehended. If cessation cannot be apprehended, it is not tenable as a path, and since there is no path without a result, those four noble truths are therefore imputed and fabricated. What is imputed and fabricated does not exist. What does not exist cannot be conventionally called "past," and it cannot be conventionally called "future" or "present."

That which is not apprehended in the three times is unborn and unceased. It is without characteristics and without signs. It is not designated and cannot be designated. It is not taught, not fully taught, not to be taught, not to be fully taught. It is not expressed and not to be expressed, not declared and not to be declared. It is not seen and not to be seen, not known and not to be known, not comprehended and not to be comprehended, not realized and not to be realized, not found and not to be found, not attained and not to be attained, not heard and not to be heard, not seen and not to be seen, not accomplished and not to be accomplished, not actualized and not to be actualized.

It is not white and not black, not light and not darkness, not going and not coming, not clear and not deep, not turbid and not limpid, not perishing and

not blissful, not bondage and not liberation, not attachment and not anger, not affliction and not purification, not wisdom and not consciousness, not the path and not a wrong path, not destruction and not disintegration, not something grasped and not something ungrasped, not something discarded and not something thoroughly discarded, not an object of apprehension and not without an object.

It is not a sentient being and not the absence of a sentient being, not a life-force and not the absence of a life-force, not a person and not the absence of a person, not a self and not the absence of a self, not a thing and not the absence of a thing. It is not empty and not non-empty, not a sign and not signless, not wishing and not wishless, not abiding and not without an abode, not conditioned and not unconditioned, not annihilation and not permanence, not wrong and not correct, not true and not false, not clinging and not non-clinging, not a support and not without support, not a basis and not without a basis.

It is not to be directly known and not to be fully understood, not to be abandoned, not to be cultivated, and not to be actualized. It is not gained and not to be gained. It is not saṃsāra and not nirvāṇa, not a buddha and not something to be awakened to. It is not the domain of ordinary beings, not the domain of the noble ones, not the domain of the śrāvakas, not the domain of the pratyekabuddhas, not the domain of the bodhisattvas, and not the domain of the buddhas. It is not a domain, nor is it a non-domain. It is not made and not unmade, not pure and not to be purified.

Thus, by entering into the truth, one comes to enter the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu). By entering the realm of phenomena, one comes to obtain dhāraṇī. By obtaining dhāraṇī, one comes to obtain eloquence.

How, then, does one enter the realm of phenomena by entering into dependent origination? "With ignorance as condition, there are formations; with formations as condition, consciousness," and so on, up to "Thus this entire great mass of suffering alone comes to arise." This is dependent origination.

Blessed One, here ignorance does not exist as ignorance. Why is that? Because ignorance is devoid of intrinsic nature. A phenomenon that has no intrinsic nature is without substantial existence. That which has no substantial existence is not established at all. That which is not established at all does not arise. That which does not arise does not cease. That which is unborn and

unceased cannot be designated as "past," nor can it be designated as "future" or "present." That which is not apprehended in the three times is without name, without characteristics, without signs, and cannot be designated.

Otherwise, apart from its being treated as mere name, mere sign, mere convention, mere expression, and mere designation for the sake of guiding sentient beings, that ignorance is not apprehended in the ultimate sense. A phenomenon that is not apprehended in the ultimate sense cannot be designated, cannot be made a convention, and cannot be expressed. Blessed One, what is called mere name, and so on up to mere designation, these too are not correct. They are false, wrong, imagined, fabricated, wholly imagined, conceptualized, analyzed, unpeaceful, and thoroughly elaborated.

As for what is said, "With ignorance as condition, there are formations," how could a phenomenon that does not exist by its essential nature produce formations? Therefore ignorance is the nonexistence of ignorance. Since ignorance thus does not exist, formations too are unborn. Those that are unborn do not age, do not fall ill, do not die, do not pass away and transmigrate, and are not born. Why is that? Blessed One, how could a phenomenon that is unborn have aging? That which has no aging does not fall ill, does not die, does not pass away and transmigrate, and is not born.

This is the awakening of the buddhas, the blessed ones of the past, the future, and the present; it is so in mere name, but not in the ultimate sense. Whatever is ignorance, that itself is awakening. In the same way, all the links of existence should be understood. Thus, by entering into dependent origination, one comes to enter the realm of phenomena.

Blessed One, the Tathāgata is unborn, and all phenomena too are unborn. Therefore all phenomena are the Tathāgata. Blessed One, the Tathāgata is unceased, and all phenomena too are unceased. Blessed One, likewise the Tathāgata is without characteristics, without signs, without any object of apprehension, without affliction, without purification, without attachment, and without anger. He is the realm of phenomena, suchness, and the limit of reality; and all phenomena too are the limit of reality.

Therefore all phenomena are the Tathāgata. Blessed One, that being so, whatever phenomena make the Tathāgata exist, those very phenomena make all phenomena exist. Therefore all phenomena are the Tathāgata.

Blessed One, if anyone should say, "The Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, has fully and completely awakened to awakening," all of

them are clinging to a form of view. Why is that? The Tathāgata is nondual, and awakening too is nondual. Therefore the nondual does not fully and completely awaken to the nondual.

Likewise, Blessed One, if anyone should say, "The Tathāgata has turned the unsurpassed wheel of Dharma," all of them are clinging to a form of view. Why is that? The Tathāgata neither turns it back nor turns it forward.

Blessed One, if anyone should say, "The Tathāgata has led countless sentient beings to final nirvāṇa," all of them are clinging to a form of view. Why is that? Blessed One, all phenomena are without sentient beings, and so there is no final nirvāṇa whatsoever.

Blessed One, if anyone should say, "The Tathāgata has acted for the benefit of countless sentient beings," all of them are clinging to a form of view. Why is that? Blessed One, the Tathāgata does not abide in any mode of helping or harming any phenomenon at all.

Blessed One, if anyone should say, "The Tathāgata has relinquished the formations of life," all of them are clinging to a form of view. Why is that? Blessed One, the dharmadhātu neither discards nor takes up anything at all.

Blessed One, if anyone should say, "The Tathāgata has passed into final nirvāṇa in the element of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates," all of them are clinging to a form of view. Why is that? Blessed One, the dharmadhātu is neither saṃsāra nor final nirvāṇa.

Blessed One, whoever becomes certain about such a Dharma as this, all of them are irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Blessed One, there is no alteration in the dharmadhātu, and it is likewise impossible that those sons or daughters of noble family will not fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

The ninth fascicle.

Then eight hundred million gods of the Bṛhatphala heaven, having declared before the Blessed One their certainty regarding the nature of reality, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, joined their palms, and sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, they then praised the Blessed One with these verses:

Sugata, mighty guide, who knows what is the way and what is not, homage to you!
Sage, loving toward all beings, who teaches exactly as things truly are,

Guide skilled in the way, you rightly taught the way as reality itself.
Possessor of boundless qualities, surpassing in wisdom, we bow our heads to you!

You taught the single straight path to travel, that leads with certainty to awakening.
You attained sublime awakening, immeasurable, peaceful, auspicious and unmoving.
You free countless myriads of living beings tormented by the sufferings of saṃsāra.
Possessor of boundless qualities, surpassing in wisdom, we bow our heads to you!

The aggregates are empty of essential nature, utterly devoid of aggregates.
What deludes the childish you have fully discerned to be utterly void.
Ordinary people lacking understanding are bound here, like a monkey caught in a trap,
But the wise who are free are held to be unattached, like the wind in the sky.

The Omniscient One declared the elements empty of element in every way,
Like an echo, which in every way is utterly devoid of sound.
By this, many unskilled people who do not know things as they truly are are bound,
But the wise who are free, who truly understand, have no attachment to the three realms.

The Omniscient One taught that the sense bases are always empty of essential nature,
Unreal and false, deceiving the childish, like an empty fist.
Many unskilled people, not set single-mindedly on the path, cling to them,
And like travelers wandering on the great ocean, they fall into saṃsāra.

Guide, these faculties are utterly empty of being faculties;
Sage, they are utterly empty, like the image of a face in a mirror.
Many unskilled people who do not know rightly cling to them,
Like birds, fish of the lakes, and other creatures caught in a net.

Beings are empty of being beings, devoid of beings, empty of essential nature.
Sage, since beings do not exist, like a figure drawn by a painter,
Many unskilled people who do not know things as they truly are cling to them,
But the wise who truly understand are freed, like birds emerging from the egg.

Dependent phenomena are momentary, empty, and without any object of reference.
Like joy in a dream they cannot be grasped, yet they delude the childish.
Because of ignorant conceptual thought, many unskilled people are bound by them too,
But the wise who fully and truly understand are freed, like birds released from a cage.

Just as the Sage's nature of reality is inconceivable, all phenomena are inconceivable.
Just as the Sage is peaceful, passed beyond sorrow, all phenomena are free of characteristics.
Just as the Sage is unattached to the three realms, all phenomena have no abiding.
Therefore, if this single way is understood, all beings will become sugatas.

Just as the Sage does not perceive self and other, all phenomena are unmoving.
Just as the Sage's wisdom and the Victor's teaching are, all phenomena are inconceivable.
Just as the Sage is not the domain of the childish, all phenomena are not conceptually imputed.
This domain of the buddhas should be known to be perfectly clear in just this way.

Those unskilled ones who say the Victor attained immeasurable awakening,
And those who say the Victor turned the sublime, immeasurable, supreme wheel,
And those who say the Sugata, the Protector, led myriads of beings to nirvāṇa,
All of them, not knowing rightly, are wholly wrapped in a dense fog of views.

Those who say that the Sugata released and held back the formations of life,
and those who say that the One of Ten Powers, having worked for beings' welfare, passed into complete nirvāṇa,
all of them have fallen into views, are attached, and are in the hands of Māra.
They do not know the suchness of phenomena; one should know it just as the Guide knows it.
Those who are skilled in this, in what is the way and what is not the way, know the Guide.
They will become Victors, foremost of two-legged beings, rich in splendor,

loving toward the world.
This suchness holds the power of change; it itself is the nature of reality.
Having understood it in this way, those skilled in the way become the best of humans.

Thus the hosts of gods of Bṛhatphala, having definitively realized the dharmas, spoke in the presence of the Teacher, and when they had also shown their superior intention,
some, rejoicing, with minds free of doubt, saw themselves as buddhas,
and those children of the Guide, in this very way, made prophecies about themselves.

Then the Blessed One, perceiving the perfect superior intention of those gods of Bṛhatphala and their definitive realization of the dharmas, smiled at that time in order to generate roots of virtue in beings.

Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"The Guides rich in splendor smile when they have seen some cause;
they do not do so without a cause. So you have declared, and I heard it from the Sugata directly.
Since you, O Guide, have smiled in this way a smile that is peaceful, blissful and cool,
O Victor, highest among gods, humans and asuras, tell us the cause of your smile.
Today, having seen the cool smile on your face, O Guide,
all these beings are in doubt and gaze upon your face, O Sugata.
Supreme among humans, compassionate one, quickly tell the cause of the smile.
When they have heard it, supreme Victor, these beings will be free of doubt.
Holy Guide, those hosts of gods who made prophecies about themselves:
who are they, through what will they attain what? Tell their transformations to the end.
Supreme among humans, sounding your Brahmā voice, please dispel every doubt.
Hearing it, this assembly of the Victor will be overjoyed and attain supreme contentment.
All those lofty banners of the Sugata, not thinking of anything else,
children of the Guide, abide contemplating the immeasurable, peaceful, holy awakening.

Sage, supreme Guide, quell the doubts of those who are in doubt.
Through that, all endowed with the power of wisdom, skilled in what is the way and what is not, will become Victors.
Having heard the eight-limbed speech of the Foremost of Two-Legged Beings, they will greatly rejoice,
will act as the Sugata has taught, and become skilled in following what was spoken.
For their sake I request the Sugata, the Guide, to speak.
By that they will rejoice, and beings will reach the far shore of the Dharma.
Great Guide, when they have heard of those gods' former conduct
and heard the Victor's speech, their hesitation entirely stilled, they will be overjoyed;
those who have entered the way and are skilled in the way will swiftly become omniscient.
They will completely liberate beings and teach truly, just as things are."

Then the Blessed One again addressed the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

"For the sake of the hosts of gods I displayed a smile to the world.
Aśvajit, you who know time and measure, you have questioned me very well.
The manner and the cause for which I smiled,
that I shall explain to you; you and all beings, listen with one-pointed mind.
The Omniscient Ones see three kinds of results of causes,
and seeing from the cause, the holy two-legged ones rich in splendor smile.
Some of weak intellect, thinking, 'We shall become śrāvakas,' set out for nirvāṇa;
some, delighting in remaining silent, set out wishing for the awakening of a pratyekabuddha;
and some, thinking, 'We shall become mighty guides of the world
and free the people fallen into suffering,' set out. Knowing the intentions of those who have set out,
a small smile, when it appears, should be known as made for the sake of śrāvakas;
a middling smile, when it appears, should be understood as made for the sake of pratyekabuddhas;
the supreme smile that I have made should be known as made for the sake of guides.
These three kinds, highest, middling and lowest, are declared the causes of

smiling.
Knowing this world, in which some seek liberation and have entered the three paths,
therefore the holy Guide, skilled in the world, smiles.
Aśvajit, the smile made for the sake of śrāvakas vanishes beneath the feet;
the smile made for the sake of pratyekabuddhas vanishes in the middle of the body;
the smile the Guide makes for the sake of the ten powers vanishes into the crown of the head.
Thus, Aśvajit, you should know the three kinds of causes of smiling.
Whatever smiles are for the sake of supreme Victors, all of them vanish into my crown.
Know that I have shown the smile in this way as a means of destroying evil.
Again I shall explain the three causes of the smiles of the Guides;
all of you, make your minds one-pointed and listen well to me.
For the first, the smile that I, the Guide, make quickly vanishes first;
for the middling, it remains a little while and vanishes afterward;
because of possessing supreme intelligence, the smile that I, the Victor, make remains very long.
Aśvajit, the smile that remains for the sake of śrāvakas is made according to the vehicle.
Again I shall explain three causes of smiling; Aśvajit, listen.
Those that circle the upright Victor endowed with the ten powers,
when they circle me swiftly, will quickly become most skilled.
For the sake of the middling, it is thin and large and circles slowly;
having slowly circled to the right, it becomes vast and settles down.
When one sees the Sugata as if a white overlay were laid upon a golden ornament,
then it remains pervading the entire body of the Sage, holy among two-legged beings.
This smile shown by the Omniscient One should be known as concerning the buddha field.
When, like a parasol with endless eyes, it covers that Guide,
when, like flowers, it hovers in the sky above the Guide,
when, like a doorway, it circles the Sugata three times,
that should be known as a smile made concerning the life span of the one beyond the world.
The Sugatas, the Victors, have taught just these three kinds of causes of

smiling.
Aśvajit, you should understand those three causes of smiling.
Therefore, wishing to show the world its aim, the Guide of the world smiles.
Having heard this, be free of doubt about the teaching of the Omniscient One."

These gods of the Bṛhatphala class, a full eighty koṭis of them,
Will become victors in pure fields, proclaiming the vast way of the Dharma.
Those wise ones will have immeasurable lives and will remain for many eons.
That is why the Sugata displayed this supreme and vast portion of a smile.

They have also seen the victors of thirty-six eons past,
And for thirty-six eons they served and honored the Omniscient One.
Further still, these ones skilled in method, for thirty-six countless eons,
These great beings will remain, making offerings to the supreme bull among victors.
Everywhere, perfect in conduct and realization, they will make offerings to the supreme Victor.
Having worshiped the lord of bipeds and thoroughly sought peaceful awakening,
After that they, of dense glory, holy among bipeds, supreme among persons,
Guides of great power, endowed with qualities, will appear in the eon Golden Banner.
Those victors will dwell in various fields, each having purified his own field,
And all those holy beings will be called Glory of the Disk of Sunlight.
At that time the assemblies of those endowed with qualities will be countless.
As for the gatherings of śrāvakas of each of those sages at that time,
Even if one with the ten powers were to count those śrāvakas for trillions of eons,
The gatherings of śrāvakas of those who have done well could never be counted to the end.
What are they like, all those assemblies, that countless gathering?
Twice as many as those will at that time genuinely enter upon awakening.
At that time they have entered upon victorhood, yet are not victors with omniscience;
All of them, having practiced in thoroughly pure fields, will all become victors.
Whatever the conduct of those sugatas, that very same will be theirs as well.
When those wise ones of the world have passed into nirvāṇa, the holy Dharma
Will then be upheld by their heirs and will remain for eighty koṭis of eons.
After they have passed, within that scripture of the Teacher, those who

generate the mind of awakening
Will be far more numerous even than the sands of the river Ganges.
After they have passed, within the scriptures of the teachers, the protectors,
Śrāvakas measureless as the sands of all the oceans will pass into nirvāṇa.
Thus the teaching of all those self-arisen ones who accomplish the welfare of the world
Will be perfectly endowed with the Dharma,
And will rise in full; that is the very nature of teachings.
Having heard the scriptures of that supreme human, all beings without exception will gain faith,
And saying, "We shall become holy bipeds, measureless ones who work the welfare of the world,"
All will rejoice and bow at the Victor's feet, and people will be overjoyed.
Having generated measureless joy toward the Sugata, they honored him with the Dharma.
Therefore, rejoice, and practice as though your head were on fire;
Always rely on the perfection of wisdom and on spiritual friends,
And constantly cultivate this virtuous conduct of right vision.
Monks, become lords of bipeds who have compassion for the world.

This concludes the twenty-third chapter, the prophecy concerning the Bṛhatphala gods.

Then, at that time, the gods of the Pure Abodes class, knowing that immeasurable beings had genuinely entered upon awakening and knowing that they had become free of doubt regarding the qualities of the Buddha, were satisfied, pleased, and delighted; they were overjoyed, and joy and happiness of mind arose in them. Each one individually then praised the Blessed One with these fitting verses.

The god Devoted to Generosity said:

You gave away your beloved sons,
Your queen, and your precious life;
What need to mention giving up a kingdom?
I bow to you who perfected generosity.

The god Devoted to Moral Discipline said:

You purified moral discipline;
In every respect you were free of dread.
Through thorough training you reached perfection.

I bow to you who perfected discipline.

The god Devoted to Patience said:

Because you relied upon patience,
You endured even the cutting of your limbs.
Toward the profound you never lost heart.
I bow to you who perfected patience.

The god Devoted to Diligence said:

Never forsaking effort, diligent,
Mighty one, endowed with diligence,
You attained supreme and perfect awakening.
I bow to you who perfected diligence.

The god Devoted to Meditative Concentration said:

You relied on meditative concentration;
The world cannot find its depth.
You attained the equality of the three times.
I bow to you who perfected concentration.

The god Endowed with Splendor said:

The hero, by meditating again and again
On the perfection of wisdom,
Attained omniscience itself.
I bow to you who perfected wisdom.

The god Intelligence of the Elements said:

Through giving and through pleasant speech,
Through beneficial conduct and consistency,
You have tamed these worlds.
Guide, I bow to you.

The god Virtuous Intelligence said:

Great love and great compassion
You cultivated over a long time,
And you have delivered measureless beings.
I bow to you who hold all embodied beings.

The god Pure Mind said:

Having gone beyond to freedom from afflictions,
Great Sage whose mind is tamed,
You tame all the untamed.
I bow to the charioteer.

The god Vimalamati said:

Your mind is pure and gentle,
Your mind is tamed, your senses at peace;
You know the minds of all beings.
Knower of minds, I bow to you.

The god Thoroughly Pure Intelligence said:

Intelligent one endowed with wisdom,
You have fully entered supreme intelligence;
Your mind is clear, your understanding perfect.
I bow to you who bring the unskilled to understanding.

The god Mind Ornament said:

Your mind is thoroughly purified;
You have purified the buddhafield as well;
You have purified the minds of beings too.
All-delighting one, I bow to you.

The god Aparājita said:

Your intention is never defeated;
You have vanquished the army of Māra;
And you have turned all the hosts of gods
To minds filled with great joy.

The god Swift Action said:

You know phenomena swiftly;
You swiftly purify beings;
Regarding profound and hard-to-see dharmas
You act swiftly; I bow to you.

The god Firm Diligence said:

Freed and completely freed,
Having crossed the flood, you have abandoned the defilements;

Having gone to the far shore, you dwell on dry land;
To you of steadfast diligence I bow.

The god Endowed with Good Conduct said:
You have abandoned attachment, abandoned aversion,
Abandoned delusion, and are undefiled;
You have become worthy of gifts, a field of merit;
Worthy of the world's offerings, to you I bow.

The god Most Steadfast said:
Your sublime Dharma is most steadfast,
Highly honored throughout the three worlds;
Journeying alone, you have found bliss;
Therefore to you I bow.

The god Imperturbable said:
A mountain that has become one solid mass
Cannot be moved by the wind;
Just so, by praise and blame
The Sugata cannot be moved.

The god Attainer of Equality said:
Great hero, profound and impartial,
Bearer of the thirty-two excellent marks,
Possessed of profound wisdom and intellect,
To you, beautiful Victor, I bow.

The god Profound Intelligence said:
Great-bodied one, you have no body;
You abide fully in suchness;
You fully teach the true limit as well;
There is no person at all who equals you.

The god Clear Intelligence said:
Through nonduality you teach what is true;
Hero, by your heroism you prevail;
Those who are not daunted by the profound
Reach the far shore of your Dharma.

The god Utterly Joyful said:
Those supremely joyful, of steadfast mind,
Who have trained in your training,

Just as snakes cast off their old skins,
Cast off these three realms of existence.

The god Peaceful Mind said:
Just as a lamp, its oil exhausted
And its wick consumed, goes out,
So, having swiftly heard your teaching,
Those of great wisdom pass into nirvāṇa.

The god Abiding in Calm said:
People who have seen you, the Omniscient One,
Even though bound by attachment,
Being wise, with the weapon of wisdom
Will cut the noose of attachment.

The god Abundant Calm said:
Possessing a peaceful mind, you engage in peace;
Your rites and your sphere of conduct are utterly peaceful;
All afflictions have been pacified;
To you whose foes are pacified I bow.

The god Fearless Calm said:
The bodhisattvas of great renown
Who have trained in your calm abiding
Will come forth through calm abiding itself,
And, their minds at peace, will become tathāgatas.

The god Nourished by Calm said:
The peace of all phenomena
You, hero, have fully taught;
If they understand it with great wisdom,
They will become tathāgatas.

The god Ever Contemplating said:
You always behold sentient beings;
The wise who train as you did,
Resting in equipoise through supreme wisdom,
Will attain supreme awakening as well.

The god Holder of Light said:
Those who have gone to the far shore of wisdom,

Who train under you, Great Sage,
Will illuminate the world
And see without obscuration.

The god Light Maker said:
Lamp of the world, having heard your speech,
That ocean of wisdom,
They attain stainless bliss,
And inconceivable light arises as well.

The god Stainless Light said:
All phenomena are free of conceptual thought;
Skilled in means, you have taught them;
Those who teach such wisdom
Become supreme among persons.

The god Utterly Nonabiding said:
There is no abiding and no taking up;
All phenomena are without mind;
The transformations of self and other,
These you know just as they are.

The god Abodeless Intelligence said:
Guide, you see all phenomena
As without any ground;
Reversing their way,
You teach them to sentient beings.

The god Unsupported Intelligence said:
All phenomena are without support;
There are no sentient beings, neither self nor other;
Like a myrobalan fruit placed in the palm of the hand,
You teach things truly, just as they are.

The god Moving through Space said:
Sugata, you see phenomena
As appearing like space,
Without arising and without cessation;
Therefore you have no attachment to the world.

The god Without Grasping at I said:
You see all these beings
Through the very nature of the body
As unmoving and without grasping at I,
Without activity and without effort.

The god Fully Cultivated Intelligence said:
When a variety of well-made illusions
Are displayed by a master illusionist,
They are not so, yet so they appear;
Thus, O Sage, you are without equal.

The god Fully Awakened Disposition said:
Just as a reflection in a mirror
Appears yet does not exist in that way,
So you see phenomena;
Therefore you are not deluded about the world.

The god Destroyer of Doubt said:
The Buddha is like a reflection,
And so too are the qualities of the Buddha;
Thus you have taught,
And thus you know all beings as well.

The god Unimpeded Eloquence said:
Concerning the nature of reality,
Eloquence ceaselessly arises;
Because you have attained that nature of reality,
Therefore you are endowed with eloquence.

The god Unattached Intelligence said:
All these dharmas of yours
You know truly, just as they are,
As without intrinsic nature or characteristic;
Therefore, Sage, you have cleared away the blurred vision.

The god Free of Sorrow said:
Without sorrow, without appropriation,
Without elaboration, without turbidity,
Phenomena are wholly unafflicted;
You know their nature.

The god Perfect Realization said:
Phenomena are not real;
They have no going and no coming;
You know them truly
And teach them just so.

The god Supreme Intelligence said:
Spontaneously present, without taking up,
Without bewilderment and without knowing,
Phenomena do nothing whatsoever;
You have realized their nature.

The god Attainer of the Unobscured said:
There is no light and there is no darkness;
They are not formless, nor do they have form;
There is no grasping and no liberation;
You have realized their nature.

The god Brave Eye said:
Not abiding in any place or direction,
Being neither existent nor nonexistent,
Just like desires in a dream,
You see their nature.

The god Unblinking Eye said:
The deluded minds of the childish
Are unborn and unceasing,
And do not abide in between either;
You see their nature.

The god Abiding in Emptiness said:
There is no person and no sentient being;
Being nonexistent, there is no convention;
What is spoken for the sake of teaching,
You see its nature.

The god Abiding in Signlessness said:

The signs by which conventions are designated
Do not exist;
That all phenomena are without signs,
O Guide, you see.

The god Abiding in Wishlessness said:
Just as signs are empty,
And wishes cannot be apprehended,
So too whoever has aspirations,
You know to be of just this kind.

The god Intent on Samādhi said:
Though one relies on the doors of liberation,
There is no one who is liberated;
Likewise the thoroughly afflicted,
You see their nature.

The god Irreproachable said:
You have abandoned all wrongdoing
And have gathered all merit;
O Sugata, there is nothing in you to reproach;
Those who reproach you are not wise.

The god Lightning Cloud said:
Just as a mass of clouds with lightning
Satisfies the great earth with rain,
So the Guide, with the rain of Dharma,
Satisfies the worlds.

The god Meaningful Intention said:
O Sage, your speech is meaningful;
You have turned the wheel of Dharma;
Because you act having examined thoroughly,
That is the mark of the Omniscient One.

The god Perfect Intelligence said:
All phenomena, by their very nature,
Are unborn and do not cease;
O Sugata, you know them,
And you lead others to realize them likewise.

The god Lion's Roar said:
You taught emptiness,
Proclaiming the lion's roar,
So that all the non-Buddhists are terrified,
As small animals are by a lion.

The god Conscientious Action said:
Putting conscientiousness first,
You practiced the conduct;
You, the guide to the Buddha's Dharma,
Have gone forth to deliverance through conscientiousness.

The god Well Established in Conscientiousness said:
Well established in conscientiousness,
You have increased your own qualities too,
And the ten powers and the other qualities of a buddha,
Inconceivable, you have greatly increased.

The god Born of Conscientiousness said:
Through striving at conscientiousness
The factors of awakening truly arise;
Great Sage, having yourself been freed,
You explain them to the world.

The god Gone Forth through Conscientiousness said:
However many bodhisattvas and śrāvakas
Rely on liberation,
All of them have trained under you,
And go forth to deliverance through conscientiousness.

The god Abiding in Conscientiousness said:
Because they never give up conscientiousness,
O Guide, your heirs,
Unattached to this world,
Go forth to omniscience.

The god Guarded by Conscientiousness said:
Relying on the path of awakening,
Because you guarded yourself with care,
Skilled in great compassion,
You attained supreme awakening.

The god Diligent in Conscientiousness said:
Striving greatly at conscientiousness,
Realizing the single characteristic,
Great hero, your heirs
Will also obtain the father's treasure.

The god Delighting in Conscientiousness said:
The steadfast ones who delight in conscientiousness,
Through the wisdom of the Buddha,
Heroes destroying the mountain of afflictions,
Likewise level the mountain of pride.

The god Holding to Conscientiousness said:
When you were seeking the wisdom of a buddha,
Because you held fast to conscientiousness,
For countless tens of millions of eons
Your mind never grew weary.

The god Diligent in Calm Abiding said:
Those phenomena are by nature at peace;
That is the domain of the buddhas;
Those who have truly entered awakening,
And the Omniscient One, have no fear of it.

The god Truly Abiding in Calm Abiding said:
The Buddha dwells in calm abiding,
Yet has no attachment to it;
He brings the afflictions of beings to peace,
As rain settles the rising dust.

The god Firmly Abiding in Calm Abiding said:
The Buddha dwells firmly in peace,
Like a mountain that no one can shake;
No one is able to harm you;
To you whose mind is at peace I bow.

The god Tamed by Calm Abiding said:
Your irreproachable heirs
Are thoroughly tamed by calm abiding;
Even ten million māras cannot overcome them,
And desire does them no harm.

The god Gone Forth through Calm Abiding said:
With a peaceful mind, in calm abiding,
You, great hero, meditate;
Abiding in what do you practice meditative concentration?
No one knows your way.

The god Calm Abiding Goes Before said:
The Teacher said that, of the qualities of a buddha,
Calm abiding goes first;
The other qualities by which awakening is accomplished
Follow after it.

The god Following Calm Abiding said:
The calm abiding of the Lamp of the World
Settles the turbidity of the mind;
Those of peaceful mind are held by it;
You have mastered it without limit.

The god Domain of Calm Abiding said:
The domain of all phenomena
Is calm abiding, so the Guide has said;
One who practices it without attachment
Becomes a buddha, a guide.

The god Moistened by Calm Abiding said:
First moistened by meditative concentration,
You cultivated the mind with wisdom;
Therefore you attained perfect awakening,
And likewise you guide beings as well.

The god Devoted to Calm Abiding said:
Among all the qualities of a buddha,
I see no other path;
If one attains calm abiding and great wisdom,
One surely goes forth as the Self-Arisen One.

The god Delighting in Insight said:
Great hero, insight
Reveals all phenomena;
Your heirs who practice it
Will attain the state of the Self-Arisen One.

The god Arisen from Insight said:
Abiding in the perfection of wisdom,
One becomes a guide;
The Teacher is the king of physicians;
Therefore insight is virtuous.

The god Well Established in Insight said:
Having investigated all phenomena,
If one sees them truly as they are,
The steadfast one attains perfect awakening
And wishes to abide in awakening itself.

The god Gone Forth through Insight said:
The supreme persons, through wisdom,
Go forth to supreme awakening;
For one who has attained perfect awakening through wisdom,
No recollection of that attainment arises.

The god Delighting in Insight said:
Because you have looked upon phenomena
Truly as they are, in reality,
You attained immeasurable awakening;
Therefore, O Guide, you are a buddha.

The god Intensely Diligent in Insight said:
The wise who strive at wisdom
And practice many austerities
Can never be defeated
By all the hosts of opponents.

The god Arisen from Insight said:
In order to see phenomena clearly,
Those heirs of the Victor who have entered the path
Seek the essential nature of phenomena, and

will attain the very state of the Self-Arisen One.

The god Relying on Insight said:
Guide, because for a long time
you relied on wisdom,
you attained omniscience
and set ten million living beings free.

The god Endowed with Distinction said:
The Buddha, through his knowing, knows all;
the supreme Guide is exalted above all.
The world carried off by the ocean of existence
he delivers to the far shore.

The god Abiding in Insight said:
By abiding in insight
and clearly seeing all phenomena,
the qualities of a buddha increase,
like a nyagrodha tree growing in good soil.

The god Never Separated from Insight said:
Guide, your children,
wholly embraced by wisdom,
attain supreme awakening
and set many people free.

The god Playing in Insight said:
The Buddha delights in knowledge;
he has no fear of any phenomenon.
Without dejection, without dread,
the Sage knows the whole world.

The god Fully Entering Insight said:
Great hero, all phenomena
are gathered entirely into insight itself.
When one sees them as without intrinsic nature,
that is self-arisen awakening.

The god Essence of Insight said:
The Buddha is the essence of insight;
he has no fear of any phenomenon.
Seeing this suffering of the world,
he brings forth great compassion in full.

The god Gait of Insight said:
For the sake of awakening, the wise of the world,
who go forward by knowledge, have truly gone forth.
They too attain supreme awakening,
and, themselves free, they free these beings.

The god Relying on Emptiness said:
The wise who rely on the Dharma of emptiness
awaken to enlightenment.
They free sentient beings from bondage
and cut through every bond.

The god Devoted to Emptiness said:
Those devoted to emptiness
see these beings as without a life-force,
without any object, without essential nature,
and so they teach living beings.

The god Domain of Emptiness said:
The domain of all the buddhas
is phenomena, empty of intrinsic nature.
Out of love for living beings
the Hero engaged in it.

The god Intent on Emptiness said:
Free of faults and without bonds,
you have wholly abandoned all fear and terror.
Not abiding in any phenomenon,
you move like the wind in the sky.

The god Delighting in Emptiness said:
Those who rely on the Dharma of emptiness
and are devoted to the domain of the buddhas
make offering to the Teacher,
and that offering is unsurpassed.

The god Perfectly Exalted by Emptiness said:
That by which the Guide became exalted
is called perfect exaltation.
Those who rely on the Dharma of emptiness
become blameless buddhas.

The god Guided by Emptiness said:
Great hero, of all phenomena whatever,
you teach none as not having passed into nirvāṇa;
you lead them all to nirvāṇa.
This is the awakening of the great sage.

The god Shining Forth Perfectly through Emptiness said:
Relying on peaceful emptiness,
your disciples shine forth perfectly.
Those who rely on emptiness
are the ones who truly serve you.

The god Depending on Emptiness said:
Those who rely on emptiness,
those wise ones, do not become confused.
Without afflictions and without views,
they attain stainless awakening.

The god Perfected in Emptiness said:
Those who rely on emptiness
are perfect in the qualities of a buddha.
Self-arisen, they become undefeatable,
and they also accomplish the benefit of the world.

The god Fully Entered into Emptiness said:
Whoever has entered the Dharma of the Buddha
and relies on emptiness
cannot be shaken
even by a thousand times ten million māras.

The god Delighting in Signlessness said:
Rejoicing in signlessness,
having dismantled all things,
the Buddha has come forth from the worlds;
he has no attachment to signs.

The god Abiding in Signlessness said:
Those who practice signlessness,
who practice peace within peace,
who have dismantled all signs:
their way Māra cannot know.

The god Domain of Signlessness said:
In the domain of all the buddhas
you, the Guide, practice.
Without signs, hard to realize,
you who practice peace, to you I bow.

The god Thirsting for Signlessness said:
This whole assembly of the Sage
thirsts for signlessness.
Seeking their father's treasure,
they pay homage to the Tathāgata.

The god Practicing Signlessness said:
Because the supreme person
practices signlessness day and night,
even gods, gandharvas and humans
do not know your way.

The god's son Liberated through Signlessness said:

"Having demolished all phenomena,
Great hero, lamp of the world,
You abide in the signless;
Therefore I bow to you."

The god's son Playing in the Signless said:

"Great Sage, great hero,
You sport in the signless;
Bringing human beings to maturity,
You have entered the supreme wisdom of the buddhas."

The god's son Perfected through Signlessness said:

"Those who have abandoned signs
Have accomplished awakening;
Keeping the vow of the Father's Dharma,
They honor the perfect buddhas."

The god's son Delighting in the Signless said:

"Those who have demolished signs
Delight in the Buddha's Dharma;
They abide in the highest state
And are shrines for all sentient beings."

The god's son Relying on the Signless said:

"Practicing peace and fully liberated,
Buddha, unsurpassed in the world,
You are the refuge and support of all beings,
Their ally, and likewise their abode."

The god's son Devoted to the Signless said:

"Devoted to the signless,
Peaceful, victorious over foes,
Buddhas who have crossed over and ferry beings across:

How could there be any measure to them?"

The god's son Realizing Wishlessness said:

"Those protectors who do not apprehend
Aspiration in any way at all
Are free from the world;
They are buddhas who have emerged from within the world."

The god's son Resorting to Wishlessness said:

"You whose mind is peaceful
Make no wish for any existence;
Because craving is completely cut,
Buddha, you are never stained by the world."

The god's son Born of Wishlessness said:

"Those who have completely destroyed existence
Are born of supreme splendor;
They are the sons of the Protector of the World,
And they bow to their own father."

The god's son Generated by Wishlessness said:

"Your irreproachable sons,
Having entirely cut off craving,
Destroy existence, and toward existence
They make no wish."

The god's son Fully Liberated through Wishlessness said:

"Those who make no wish,
Your sons, O splendid one,
Having given up hope and freed from bonds,
Will become fully liberated."

The god's son Arisen from Wishlessness said:

"Those who have utterly destroyed craving
Have crossed the wilderness of sorrow;
They are without thirst and free of worldly things.
Great hero, today I bow to you."

The god's son Certain of Wishlessness said:

"Those who have meditated on existence, suffering,
And happiness as without entity:
Protector, you are their father,
And they are your sons."

The god's son Retinue of Wishlessness said:

"Those who see the suffering of existence
Are tamed in your teaching.
Charioteer, dispeller of existence,
You whose mind is tamed, I bow to you."

The god's son Arisen from Wishlessness said:

"Those who have emerged from the wilderness of existence
Attain happiness and calm abiding.
To the Protector of the World, who defeats the foes, the afflictions,
I bow."

The god's son Marvelous through Wishlessness said:

"Victorious in battle,
You are the complete victor, never defeated;
You defeat the armies of Māra
And make no wish for any existence at all."

The god's son Powerful in Wishlessness said:

"Being powerful in the Dharma of liberation,
They have entirely cut through the noose of Māra;
Your sons do not entertain
The notion of needing protection from the māras."

The god's son Examining the Body said:

"Those who have seen this body
As bodiless and deathless in nature
Delight in the domain of the buddhas;
Guide, they follow after you."

The god's son Reflecting with Certainty on the Body said:

"Having reflected with certainty that this body
Is impure, rotting, oozing pus, and unbearable,
And having understood it correctly, just as it is,
Guide, I bow to you."

The god's son Understanding the Body said:

"Having examined the body as impure
And analyzed mindfulness of the body,
Freed from the sufferings of the body,
Gentle one, I bow to you."

The god's son Giving Up the Body said:

"Like a snake's old skin,
Having cast off this body full of pus,
Tathāgata of majestic form,
Bodiless one, I bow to you."

The god's son Reviling the Body said:

"Always reviling the rotting body,
Impure, foul-smelling, and oozing pus,
And having cast off what is full of impurity,
Guide, I bow to you."

The god's son Wearied of the Body said:

"Those children of the Victors who are weary of the rotting body
And who know what is pure
Are sons born of the Dharma;
They will pay homage to the buddhas."

The god's son Frightened of the Body said:

"Those who have fully understood
The great elements to be like venomous snakes
Have gone beyond the body;
I bow to the lord of two-footed beings."

The god's son Seeing the Faults of the Body said:

"Directly perceiving the faults of the body,
Possessing the eye that sees with wisdom,
The buddhas, wise through their knowledge,
Behold the whole of the three realms of existence."

The god's son Free of Attachment to the Body said:

"Free of attachment to the notion of a body,
Not abiding in the notion of phenomena,

You have transcended all the fetters;
Buddha who expounds, I bow to you."

The god's son Mind Hostile to Existence said:

"You who destroy existence within existence
Know it to be an enemy;
Your sons meditate on this,
And the wise fully awaken to awakening."

The god's son Dispelling Existence said:

"They see the dangers of existences
And see nirvāṇa as free of fear;
For the benefit of beings, your sons
Practice the conduct of awakening."

The god's son Having Abandoned Existence said:

"Those who have abandoned existence
And take no delight in what perishes
Are detached, their minds pure.
Wise one, I bow at your feet."

The god's son Existence Dispelled said:

"Most excellent of humans, your sons
Have entirely dispelled what leads into existence;
Having trained in your training,
They shine forth in this trichiliocosm."

The god's son Crossed Beyond Existence said:

"For the supreme protectors of the world, the saviors,
Who have crossed the ocean of existence,
A number by which they could be counted without end
Does not exist in this world."

The god's son Conqueror of Existence said:

"Having completely destroyed all existence,
Those who always practice mindfulness
Honor the perfect buddhas
And also teach the Dharma to living beings."

The god's son Fully Freed from Existence said:

Fully liberated from the stream of existence,
The Guide has crossed beyond existence.
Buddha, you bring existence to an end;
I bow to you who dispel existence.

The god Utterly Pacifying Existence said:
You have fully pacified what leads into existence,
And departed, having defeated existence.
You who bring to an end the existence that beings rely on,
There is no one equal to you.

The god Going to the End of Existence said:
You have reached the end of existence and are utterly at peace;
Protector, yours is the end of existence.
Omniscient One, you cast existence out;
Buddha, you fully understand the world.

The god Holding the Final Body of Existence said:
Having entirely abandoned the cause of existence,
You hold your final existence.
The fetters through which existence is taken up,
These you have seen.

The god Who Has Attained the Utter Peace of Existence said:
You know existence to be empty,
And the cause of existence likewise.
You have neither dejection nor utter dejection;
I bow to you who have become sameness itself.

The god Going to the Far Shore of Existence said:
You have crossed to the far shore of existence,
And thoroughly removed what leads into existence.
The Guide, out of compassion,
Brings other beings across.

The tenth fascicle.

The god Tormented by Feeling said:
You do not take feeling to be a self;
For you there is no mind and no striving.
You, great meditator,

Know feeling to be like a water bubble.

The god Who Shows Feeling said:
You know fully that feeling,
By its essential nature, has no real existence.
It is like the pleasure of a lover in a dream,
Yet ordinary beings cling to it.

The god Who Fully Understands Feeling said:
When it is examined with wisdom,
Feeling has not gone and does not come;
That it has no real existence,
Great Sage, you have seen.

The god Free from Feeling said:
Feeling and the one who feels
You see to be without intrinsic nature.
That profound word, so hard to see,
You have taught to sentient beings.

The god Certain about the Continuum of Feeling said:
Feeling is merely conventional;
Ultimately it is not apprehended.
Because you have trained sentient beings in this,
Beings have become free of doubt.

The god Skilled in Feeling said:
O skilled one, the aggregate of feeling
Is like a sphere of wind in the sky;
That which deludes those of childish mind
You have seen correctly.

The god Who Directly Knows Feeling said:
You directly know the aggregate of feeling;
You have knowledge and have reached the end of knowledge.
You, supreme among the wise,
Clearly see that feeling is selfless.

The god Who Has Crossed Beyond Feeling said:
Supreme lord among two-legged beings,
You have crossed the ocean of feeling, so hard to cross.

Having crossed the mire, free of evil,
You became a buddha in this supreme awakening.

The god Arisen from Feeling said:
The Guide, knowing how feelings
Arise in the world,
Has fully crossed the aggregate of feeling;
The Buddha has no attachment to the world.

The god Who Knows Feeling said:
All the feelings
That bind human beings you know.
Those bound by the noose of the afflictions,
Their nature you see.

The god Skilled in Mind said:
Your mind has defeated the afflictions,
And the māras too have lost heart.
That this mind is without intrinsic nature,
Great Sage, you see.

The god Who Fully Knows Mind said:
Just as a master illusionist
Conjures various illusions,
So, Sugata, you know the mind;
Therefore the world honors you.

The god Who Correctly Understands Mind said:
Like a master illusionist or his student,
The mind by which these beings are bound
You have correctly examined;
You know it just as it is.

The god Engaging in the Domain of Mind said:
You know the domain of the mind.
Guide, you see how, like counting a crowd in a dream,
It deludes the minds of the childish.

The god Lord of Mind said:
The nature of mind, tamed and workable,
Free of conceptual thought,

Whose depth the world cannot find,
You, steadfast in character, see.

The god Heroic in Mind said:
Those who know that in the mind there is no mind,
The wise who do not grow faint-hearted,
And who utterly subdue the hosts of Māra,
Are here called heroes.

The god Truly Exalted by Mind said:
Those who know that in the mind there is no mind
Are children of the Buddha;
In the qualities of the Buddha, the great hero,
Those persons are truly exalted.

The god Peaceful Mind said:
Those who have gained mastery over the mind,
Those beings are peaceful, utterly peaceful.
Being fully freed from the noose of Māra,
They do not come under Māra's power.

The god Pliant Mind said:
Those people whose minds are pliant,
Who are hard to approach and heroic,
And who have faith in your teaching,
Do not lose heart in their aspiration.

The god Pure Mind said:
Those whose minds are pure and whose actions are clean,
Who conduct themselves with true realization,
Having heard the teaching of the Victor,
Do not lose heart before the profound.

The god Abiding in the Nature of Reality said:
Those whose minds delight greatly
In the nature of reality, unobstructed,
Are the sons of the Lord of Men;
They have reached the ground of peace.

The god Reflecting on the Dharma said:
Those who have trained in the Guide's teaching

That all phenomena are within the dharmadhātu,
And who reflect upon the nature of reality,
There is nothing that is not their domain.

The god Definitely Emerged in the Dharmadhātu said:
Supreme among humans, your sons
Have definitely emerged in the dharmadhātu.
Guide, those sons of yours
Have emerged through the single characteristic.

The god Domain of the Dharmadhātu said:
"The domain of all phenomena
Is the dharmadhātu," the Victor taught.
Hero, the wisdom
In which you engage is inconceivable.

The god Who Has Entered the Dharmadhātu said:
Those who have entered the dharmadhātu
Have inconceivable wisdom;
They have no doubt about the qualities of the Buddha,
And they are skilled in the thoughts of beings.

The god Who Has Alighted in the Dharmadhātu said:
Those who have alighted in the dharmadhātu,
The single characteristic of phenomena,
Develop the power of eloquence
And will attain the inconceivable.

The god Fearless in the Dharmadhātu said:
For those who abide in it,
Through a fearlessness in which nothing is attained,
Their eloquence and their strength
Arise unequalled.

The god Skilled in the Dharmadhātu said:
You are skilled in the dharmadhātu,
Supremely skilled in all phenomena.
Like an emblic myrobalan placed in the palm of the hand,
You reveal the dharmadhātu in full.

The god Abiding in the Dharmadhātu said:
Because you see that phenomena lack intrinsic nature,
You abide in the dharmadhātu.
You do not dwell anywhere and you are never disheartened;
You do not grasp, and you do not let go.

The god Practicing in the Dharmadhātu said:
You practice in the dharmadhātu,
Which is the domain where buddhas move.
To the Protector of the World,
Who is like the expanse of the sky, I pay homage.

The god Relying on the Dharmadhātu said:
Through whatever doors
The holy being teaches,
Through those very doors he teaches the dharmadhātu;
Therefore it has neither sign nor form.

The god Diligent in the Dharmadhātu said:
Through intense diligence, O holy being,
You have come to know the dharmadhātu.
Through diligence the perfect buddhas
Have reached the far shore of wisdom.

The god Satisfied by the Dharma said:
Hero, you satisfy these people
Completely with the Dharma.
Because he fully knows the dharmadhātu,
The Guide abides in supreme awakening.

The god Who Found the Depth of the Nature of Reality said:
All beings who have found the depth
Gaze upon your face, O Guide.
To you, Guide, who fully knows the dharmadhātu,
I pay homage.

The god Well Established in Knowing the Abode said:
This abode of the wisdom of the Buddha,
The Guide, the supreme among humans, is the dharmadhātu.
It is the sphere in which
The Leader's ten powers are exercised.

The god Abiding in the Abode said:
The dharmadhātu is the great abode,
The path traveled by the Omniscient One.
It is the knowing that all phenomena
Have a single characteristic.

The god Directly Knowing the Abode said:
You directly know the dharmadhātu,
Skilled in the single characteristic;
And the intentions of all sentient beings
You know as well, O lord of two-legged beings.

The god Gone Forth from the Abode said:
Your heirs, O Leader,
Know the dharmadhātu as the abode to be taken up.
The wise who seek clarity
Go forth into the state of the Self-Arisen One itself.

The god Trained in the Abode said:
Those beings who have trained in the dharmadhātu
Have entered upon awakening.
Having found the abode of the Self-Arisen One itself,
They become supreme among two-legged beings.

The god Skilled in the Abodeless said:
Those who seek the abodeless
Are devoted to the intent of the Sugata.
Even a thousand koṭis of māras
Cannot bewilder them.

The god Directly Knowing the Abodeless said:
Of those who have come to know the abodeless,
"We hosts of Māra, even by the koṭi, cannot shake them from awakening," it is said,
And those wise ones rejoice greatly.

The god Skilled in the Intent of the Abodeless said:
The wise one who perceives the abodeless
Is firmly established in the nature of reality;
He drags off the evil māras
As a horse drags a chariot.

The god Skilled in the Abodeless said:
O you who are skilled in the single characteristic,
The works of Māra that create obstacles in the dharmadhātu
Have no abode there.
"They have no abode," the Victor declared.

The god Who Realized the Possible and the Impossible said:
What is possible and likewise what is impossible
Has been taught to those of childish mind;
Having realized it yourself,
You taught it to sentient beings.

The god Skilled in Giving said:
The causes of former times, unknown to others,
From which like karma arises:
That cause you have realized,
And you fully know the basis of karma too.

The god Skilled in Karma said:
Desire, aversion, and delusion,
You know, are the causes of karma.
By what cause each deed was done,
That too the supreme person has realized.

The god Skilled in the Future said:
In times to come,
Whatever karma humans will perform,
Its cause and its appropriation,
Its basis and its karma, you know.

The god Viewing the Present said:
The sentient beings of these worlds of the ten directions,
Their causes and their karma,
Their bases and their appropriation of karma,
All of these, O Guide, you know.

The god Domain of the Powers said:
Lord of men, there is no karma and no cause
That you have not seen;
There is no basis and no birth either.

Therefore you are the supreme person.

The god's son Delighting in Power said:
Karma, its cause, and likewise its basis,
Ripening in the three kinds of time,
And also how it is undertaken:
Because you know these, you are honored.

The god's son Mind of Power said:
Cause, karma and undertaking,
Ripening, condition and basis,
You know to be free of intrinsic nature;
Therefore, Victor, you have no equal.

The god's son Arisen from Power said:
Cause, karma and undertaking,
Basis, condition and the causes,
And each ripening you discern distinctly,
And you fully know them all to be empty.

The god's son Joy in Power said:
Cause, karma and undertaking,
Basis, condition and the continua,
You yourself directly know,
And you teach them to be without intrinsic nature.

The god's son Sporting with Power said:
Cause, karma and undertaking,
Basis, condition and the continua
Have no transference and no sovereign lord;
You know them to be dependently arisen.

The god's son Exalted by Power said:
Causes, conditions and karmas,
And those who undergo ripening:
"All these are empty of intrinsic nature,"
You proclaimed with a lion's roar.

The god's son Follower of Power said:
Whatever beings in the world
Have developed whatever element,
These the Chief of Two-Legged Beings knows;
Therefore you have no equal.

The god's son Endowed with Power said:
On which element one relies,
Through which one performs karma,
And what its ripening is like:
All this the One Endowed with Eyes knows.

The god's son Truly Exalted by Power said:
On which element they rely,
And what nature they have come to have:
All sentient beings you know
Like the five fingers of your hand.

The god's son Engaged in Power said:
On which element they rely,
What kind of spiritual friend they have found,
And what sort of company they keep:
These the Unsurpassed One knows.

The god's son Blessed by Power said:
Blessed by the powers, knowing all, O Guide,
The elements and the company kept,
The spiritual friends and the various groups:
These, supreme among humans, you know.

The god's son Certain of the Elements said:
That element and that undertaking,
That spiritual friend and keeping company with him:
Through that knowledge of yours concerning them,
You have no doubt whatsoever.

The god's son Relying on the Elements said:
Wherever sentient beings dwell,
That cycle of existence and that element,
Their conduct, languages and destinies,
Supreme among humans, you fully know.

The god's son Skilled in the Elements said:
The wisdom by which the Guide
Directly knows the elements:
"That knowing is empty of a knower,"
So the One Possessing the Highest truly taught.

The god's son Emerging from the Elements said:
Relying on which element
One remains how long among conditioned things:
This you know exactly as it is;
There is no one equal to you.

The god's son Following the Elements said:
By relying on which element
How many good qualities are produced,
And their ripenings and fruits:
All of these without exception you know.

The god's son Truly Entered into the Elements said:
Relying on which element
One longs for what kind of destiny:
This too you know without obstruction;
Therefore the wise pay homage to you.

The god's son Directly Knowing the Path said:
By relying on which element
One goes to what kind of destiny,
And the paths of sentient beings as well,
You, skilled in wisdom, know.

The god's son Fearless on the Path said:
Beings fixed in wrongness,
Without the fortune of going to nirvāṇa:
Into those three groups
Your wisdom surely penetrates.

The god's son Emerged through the Path said:
Beings fixed in rightness,
Without the fortune of going to lower destinies:
Into them you, lamp of the world,
Penetrate with unobstructed realization.

The god's son Devoted to the Path said:
To those persons, whoever they are,
Who remain in the undetermined group,
You teach the lower realms, the bad destinies,
And nirvāṇa as well.

The god's son Sign of Power said:
A buddha is merely a convention;
Likewise the powers and wisdom,
And the four fearlessnesses as well,
Are conventional, so the Sage declared.

The god's son Seeing Truly said:
There is no buddha and there are no buddha qualities,
Nor is there any other abiding of wisdom:
"This is taught as the ultimate":
So you know, O Tathāgata.

The god's son Abiding in Power said:
Since the powers abide in the qualities of a buddha,
There is therefore no fear in that;
The heirs of the Victors, the Tathāgatas,
Display magical emanations however they wish.

The god's son Fearless in the Dharma said:
Although the conventional and the ultimate
Have been fully taught,
The conventional and the ultimate,
And convention too, are not found as objects.

The god's son Devoted to Wisdom said:

All expression is one thing,
The defining mark of phenomena is another.
There is no defining mark and no expression:
You have seen the defining mark of phenomena.

The god's son Diligent on the Path said:

For beings who are certain of the right,
There is no ground for going by another's guidance;
Those certain of the wrong will wander on.
Great Sage, this you have seen.

The god's son Power of Inclination said:

Relying on whatever element,
Whoever comes to incline in whatever way,
And suffers in the element of desire,
All these, Great Sage, you have seen.

The god's son Renounced through the Unattractive said:

Through imagining what does not exist,
The element of desire arises.
The inclination toward it, and release from it,
These you see just as they are.

The god's son Renounced through Loving-Kindness said:

Through imagining what does not exist,
The element of aversion arises.
The inclination toward it, and release from it,
These you see just as they are.

The god's son Renounced through This Condition said:

Through imagining what does not exist,
The element of delusion arises.
The inclination toward it, and release from it,
These you see just as they are.

The god's son Renounced through Giving said:

Fear of having no livelihood, and gain,
Make avarice grow ever greater.
The inclination toward it, and release from it,
These, Great Sage, you have seen.

The god's son Renounced through the Spiritual Friend said:

By keeping company with evil friends,
A matching element arises.
The inclination one comes to acquire for it,
All this the Guide fully knows.

The god's son Holding Consciousness as Essence said:

Those who circle in saṃsāra,
Whatever kind of element they rely on,
And inclinations brought to their culmination,
You know completely, without remainder.

The god's son Making Earnestness the Essence said:

Those who circle in saṃsāra,
The earnestness that arises from whatever cause,

And the inclination that comes from it,
You see without disparaging.

The god's son Inclined to the Faculties said:

When a being relies on a certain element,
The cause by which it turns out as it does
You know thoroughly;
Therefore you bring joy.

The god's son Practicing with the Faculties said:

The application by which birth occurs,
That by which vast birth occurs,
The objects of focus and the fields,
And the faculties, you thoroughly know.

The god's son Renounced through the Faculties said:

The harm wrought by the suffering of desire,
The full onset of craving,
And the aim of bringing existence to peace,
All these the Supreme of Speakers knows.

The god's son Domain of the Faculties said:

Those of weak faculties, when purified,
Seek seclusion from attachment to form;
And the destruction of existence as well
The Excellent One among bipeds has practiced.

The god's son Victorious Faculties said:

Those of dull faculties frequent charnel grounds
And so pacify their own attachment;
Having seen the face of the Lord of Bipeds,
Those still with craving gaze upon you.

The god's son Realizing the Faculties said:

The one with attachment, and attachment,
Peace, knowing and not knowing,
The pacifying of existence, and the faculties:
When you examine them, they were never found.

The god's son Abiding in the Faculties said:

Non-malice, the antidote to aversion,
And solitude as well:
When those of dull faculties rely on these,
You see the intentions of beings.

The god's son Diligent in the Faculties said:

You teach loving-kindness as the antidote to aversion;
Understanding then arises in beings,
And the element of aversion is pacified.
All this, Supreme of Humans, you know.

The god's son Seeking the Faculties said:

In non-malice, loving-kindness,
And peace, you see no essential nature;
You apprehend neither purity nor affliction;
Therefore you surpass the world.

The god's son Following the Faculties said:

Wrong conceptual thought
And wrong teaching as well
Are fetters that bind the afflictions tight;
By reversing them, you see, liberation comes.

The god's son Wisdom Truly Dawned said:

Attachment, aversion, and delusion,
And grasping at things, are darkness;
By reversing them, there is great illumination.
This, Greatly Renowned One, you know.

The god's son Wisdom Severing Attachment said:

Attachment, aversion, and delusion,
Darkness, light, and things
Do not exist by their own nature.
This the Lord of Bipeds has seen.

The god's son Holder of Light said:

Which being has which understanding,
To what extent it has been brought to completion,

And of how much each is a fit vessel,
All this, Supreme of Humans, you know.

The god's son At Odds with the Faculties said:

The knowing by which, to abandon the afflictions,
One examines that very knowing,
This too, O Teacher, you know;
Therefore one rejoices in you.

The god's son Delighting in the Faculties said:

Places, times, and abodes,
Conduct and meditation,
Affliction and purification:
Sage, you see them all as empty.

The god's son Banner of Wisdom said:

Sharp, dull, and middling faculties,
The intentions of persons,
Bondage and liberation, exhaustion and knowing,
You know unwaveringly.

The god's son Banner of the Faculties said:

Faculties superior, middling, and dull,
Afflictions, wisdom, and feelings,
Those to be trained and those who train:
You have declared them without characteristics.

The god's son Examining the Faculties said:

The meditative concentrations of beings,
The liberations, affliction,
The attainments, samādhis, emergence,
And purification, Sage, you know.

The god's son Force of Power said:

Relying on the samādhi of peace,
You know that all phenomena, in their essential nature,
Are without intrinsic nature;
Therefore you are called the Omniscient One.

The god's son Armor of Power said:

What phenomena are and what their nature is,
And the phenomenon by which they are expressed,
You have realized just as it truly is;
Therefore you have no attachment in the three times.

The god's son Desiring Power said:

Through wrong imagining, affliction
Of four kinds comes to arise;
You know that these are born of karma;
Therefore you have no equal.

The god's son Knowing Power said:

The antidotes to the afflictions and to karma,
Purification,
And the teaching as well, you thoroughly know;
Therefore you have no equal.

The god's son Light of Power said:

Meditative concentrations, liberations, emergence,
Attainments and samādhis,
Affliction and purification:
You have taught that these are mere names.

The god's son Arisen from Power said:

"Meditative concentration, liberation, purification,
meditative attainment and samādhi
all arise from conscientiousness,
and your wisdom engages with them."

The god's son Unfolding Power said:
"Hero, your knowledge
engages with concentration and the rest,
with emergence and with purification,
and like the wind it has no attachment."

The god's son Skilled in the Past said:
"For countless tens of millions of eons,
when you dwelt in this existence long ago,
you were never mixed with the faults of existence;

therefore you have no equal."

The god's son Abiding in the Past said:
"For countless tens of millions of eons
you sought immeasurable awakening,
and the Guide practiced it completely;
therefore you are the Hero."

The god's son Realizing the Past said:
"In the past you gave various gifts
and made requests when those of supreme mind taught;
therefore that Guide has surely come forth
fully endowed with manifold eloquence."

The god's son Purified in the Past said:
"When formerly you practiced in saṃsāra,
skilled in method among all the ways,
you beheld the lamps of the world;
therefore you are skilled in method."

The god's son Who Has Completed the Past said:
"In the past the Hero practiced long
under many Dharma kings;
now, certain to be omniscient,
I bow to you, the wise one among beings."

The god's son Perfect in Past Conduct said:
"In order to seek supreme awakening,
for countless tens of millions of eons,
with infinite tens of millions of buddhas
you planted the seed."

The god's son Certain of Past Conduct said:
"Having investigated for tens of millions of eons,
you know with certainty that all phenomena
are without a sentient being;
the Victor says they are mere coming together."

The god's son Reflecting on the Past said:
"For countless tens of millions of eons
the Guide practiced so as to know fully

what is possible and what is impossible;
therefore he is not deluded about the world."

The god's son Investigating the Past said:
"Relying on what is possible and impossible,
you investigated actions and their causes;
thus you know elements, faculties and inclinations,
the concentrations, and also the past."

The god's son Thoroughly Examining the Past said:
"Having thoroughly examined your past,
the Great Hero unfolded
the ten wisdoms of the powers;
with these he beholds this world."

The god's son Domain of the Past said:
"Hero, because you know
the past conduct of all beings
and the courses of virtue and nonvirtue,
you bring healing to the world."

The god's son Discerning Past Conduct said:
"The Sage fully knows
the past conduct of beings of old,
and knows their elements and inclinations;
therefore he brings healing to beings."

The god's son Mighty in Inclination said:
"Even if one examines the past
for infinite tens of millions of eons,
your mind holds no attachment;
therefore I have faith in the Protector."

The god's son Devoted to Wisdom said:
"Even if one contemplates past existences
for countless tens of millions of eons,
there is no one able to reach the far shore
of the qualities of the Lord of the two-legged."

The god's son Skilled in the Future said:
"The various beings, endowed with karma,

of these worlds of the ten directions,
who die, pass on and are born again,
you behold with the eye of a buddha."

The god's son Delivered from the Future said:
"By what cause one performs what action
and so goes into the six streams of existence,
all this the Victor knows;
therefore he is called the Omniscient One."

The god's son Directly Knowing Death and Birth said:
"By which element which being
is imbued and performs actions,
the habitual tendencies, the actions and the beings,
you know without wavering."

The god's son Aware of Death and Birth said:
"What kind of spiritual friend one relies on,
what action one forms,
and to which destiny one thereby goes,
Sage, that too you know."

The god's son Skilled in Purpose said:
"Whatever is to be done by that action,
its purpose you fully know;
for whose sake the action was done,
that too you fully know without remainder."

The god's son Skilled in Things said:
"Whatever things are taken as objects
and whatever action is formed,
the Omniscient One knows;
that is the domain of the Buddha."

The god's son Knower of Things said:
"How the things that beings cleverly conceive
abide, and the action
by which they come to be established,
you directly know."

The god's son Skilled in Cognition said:
"By which cognition a thing
has been conceived, you fully know,
and how one has become attached to it,
Sage, you know perfectly."

The god's son Skilled in Formation said:
"By which attachment, by which affliction
those actions have been formed,
those afflictions you truly know;
therefore you are my protector."

The god's son Skilled in Destinies said:
"To which destiny one goes by which action,
and what obscuration one meets
so that one does not attain the fruit,
all this, One with Eyes, you know."

The god's son Skilled in Objects of Focus said:
"For those born into the destinies,
the object through which their actions ripen
you fully know,
and your intelligence engages with it."

The god's son Skilled in Habitual Tendencies said:
"Of the evil deeds that people have done
in one destiny after another,
and likewise of their virtuous deeds,
you fully know the habitual tendencies."

The god's son Skilled in Karma said:
"Of all creatures in the destinies,
the three kinds of karma, old, new and later,
you know;
about these ordinary beings are confused."

The god's son Skilled in Maturation said:
"Small with great maturation,
great with small maturation,
or small, great or equal:
about these the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) are deluded."

The god's son Skilled in Karma said:
"Whatever actions belong to this life,
whatever actions belong to the next birth,
and whatever belong to other times,
these, One with Eyes, you know."

The god's son Skilled in What Is Experienced in This Life said:
"The maturation of actions done in this very life,
which certain people come to experience
and about which ordinary beings are deluded,
you know."

The god's son Skilled in What Is Experienced After Rebirth said:
"Who has accumulated what action
that ripens after one is born,
of which the world cannot find the depth,

You of great wisdom know exactly that.

The god's son Skilled in What Is Experienced in Other Lifetimes said:
Karma that ripens at a later time,
After ten million eons have gone by,
And that comes forth at other times as well:
All this you know exactly as it is.

The god's son Skilled in What Is Experienced Unripened said:
Whatever actions have been done,
So long as they have not fully ripened,
For that long they yield no fruit;
This too the Supreme among humans knows.

The god's son Examining What Is Experienced Unripened said:
Endowed with whatever karma
This being comes to take birth:
The Undefeated knows it,
And, having examined it thoroughly, knows it fully.

The god's son Skilled in What Is Experienced Fully Ripened said:
How karma, once it has fully ripened,
Turns into a white result, you know.
Your wisdom penetrates it,
And you discern all these as empty.

The god's son Certain about What Is Experienced Fully Ripened said:
The Omniscient One fully knows
The heaviness and lightness of actions,
And comprehends the intentions of beings;
Therefore the Blessed One is my master.

The god's son Skilled in Heavy and Light said:
The karma by which sentient beings
Go to the lower realms,
Heavy and light alike, you see;
Knowing this, the Knower knows it fully.

The god's son Skilled in the Conduct of Beings said:
Taking full account of beings' conduct,
The heaviness and lightness of their karma
You, O Hero, fully know;
About this the non-Buddhists are confused.

The god's son Investigating the Conduct of Beings said:
Investigating the conduct of beings,
You teach the ripening of karma,
Just as the water in a cup and the water of the Ganges
Are told apart by salt.

The god's son Skilled in Karma said:
The supreme among humans teaches
The ripening for those in training and those beyond training,
And teaches how, once afflicted karma has been experienced,
Karma comes to be exhausted.

The god's son Touching the Wisdom of the Buddha said:
With the buddha eye you see, throughout the three realms,
The fools and the wise
Who rely on the fruits of karma.
Homage to you who see the subtle!

The god's son Exhausting Karma said:
You, the Guide within the worlds,
Your wisdom penetrates the death, transmigration,
And every birth of sentient beings.
Knowing this, Fearless One, I bow to you.

The god's son Engaging in the Nonreferential said:
Death and transmigration, birth and karma,
Destinies, and likewise beings,
And ripening are taught to be like a dream;
So the Guide, supreme among humans, knows.

The god's son Examining Afflictions said:
Just as a thirsty person in a dream
Drinks water that is perfectly cool,
So, supreme among humans, in you attachment,
Aversion and delusion are exhausted.

The god's son Free from Conceptualization said:
Attachment, aversion and delusion
Are born from conceptualization,
Like joyful play within a dream.
Supreme of speakers, I bow to you.

The god's son Pacifying Conceptualization said:
Through the complete pacifying of conceptualization
You fully teach the exhaustion of afflictions;
Like a cloudless sky within a dream,
Supreme of humans, you fully know.

The god's son Examining Defilements said:
Like a great rain falling in a dream,
So do the defilements arise.
Skilled in the arising of defilements,
Great Hero, you have taught this.

The god's son Examining Dreams said:
Like a great rain falling in a dream,
So do the defilements arise;
That defilements arise in those who err,
Great Hero, you have taught.

The god's son Examining Things as They Are said:
Just as a girl, in a dream,
Gives birth to a son who then dies,
And feels both joy and suffering,
So you see the beings of the world.

The god's son Realizing Dreams said:
Like being beheaded in a dream,
So you see the exhaustion of defilements;
This you teach to the wise.
Homage to the All-Seeing One!

The god's son Mind of Certain Examination said:
You who know all phenomena
See that, as in a dream, meeting with friends
And parting from them have no true existence,
And you satisfy beings according to their needs.

The god's son Wisdom Mind said:
When one hears you teach the sublime Dharma,
The mind becomes joyful;
Just as a dream is shown within a dream,
So the Victor gives his teaching.

The god's son Wholly Joyful Mind said:
Since you see all beings
As reflections appearing in a mirror,
In you, possessor of meditative concentration,
The world with its gods rejoices in mind.

The god's son Certain Intellect said:
O Sage, when they hear your sublime Dharma,
Which is like the sound of a lute,
Even the sons of the gods cast off their doubts
And bow down to the supreme Victor.

The god's son Satisfied by Illusion said:
When a magician displays illusions
That bewilder the childish,
The unskilled are confused by them;
You teach that things are like an illusion.

The god's son Contemplating Emanation said:
Just as one sees an illusion in a dream,
So you see the beings of the world.
Having heard this teaching of the Protector,
We have no doubt at all.

The god Released from Illusion said:

"Though a magician conjures an illusion,
Since he knows it to be an illusion,
He is not deluded by it.
In just this way do you see beings."

The god Following Thought said:

"Just as one who strives, in a dream,
Imagines the form of a buddha's body,
So conceptual thought gives rise to the world.
This, O Guide, is what you see."

The god Destroyer of Conceptualization said:

"Conceptualization is the cause of attachment;
Attachment is not produced by things.
From wrong thinking attachment arises.
This, O Guide, is what you see."

The god Endowed with Full Understanding said:

"The sound that arises in mountain ravines,
The echo, is not the sound of a sentient being.
In just this way do you see the world;
Therefore you have no attachment to the world."

The god Skilled in Teaching said:

"There is no sound whatsoever;
Sound is like an echo.
Yet, lord of men, you have taught,
And led many childish beings in."

The god Skilled in Diligence said:

"Though the meaning of phenomena is one thing,
The childish imagine it as another.
With diligence one should come to know it from the Dharma;
In this my doubts are cut away."

The god Follower of the Meaning said:

"Whatever is the true meaning of the Dharma
Has been realized by no one,

Taught by no one, and known by no one:
So the supreme Sage has said."

The god Understanding the Conventions of the Dharma said:

"Defilement, stain, and affliction,
Habitual tendency, thought, and examination,
Total affliction and complete purification:
O Sage, these are merely conventional words."

The god Skilled in Conceptualization said:

"Total affliction and complete purification,
Defilements and afflictions,
Purity, explanation, kinsfolk,
And Teacher: all these are mere names."

The god Nonabiding Intelligence said:

"Unattached to the three realms,
You whose mind is like space,
Freed, and worthy of offerings,
To the peaceful mind I bow."

The god Unstained said:

"O Sage, your mind
Abides neither in form nor in the formless;
In desire and in nirvāṇa
It does not abide; it is like the sky."

The god Without Hope said:

"Hope for the desire realm abandoned,
In neither the form nor the formless realm,
Freed from all busyness,
You whose craving is exhausted, to you I bow."

The god Craving Uprooted said:

"Toward arising and perishing
Your craving is completely severed;
You have no attachment to any of the three realms.
To the Guide I bow."

The god Overpowering Craving said:

"Having outshone these worlds,
You act as the sublime and supreme bull,
And liberate the sentient beings of the world.
Compassionate one, to you I bow."

The god Free of Craving said:

"Free of the fetters,
Peaceful, having put an end to further existence,
Pure in nature, pure in mind,
To you who are free of time I bow."

The god Knowing Things as They Are said:

"That all phenomena are without entity,
You, O hero, know just as it is.
There is no bondage and no liberation.
To you who see truly I bow."

The god Crossed Beyond the Swamp said:

"You have crossed beyond the swamp of desire,
And likewise beyond the swamp of existence.
You have no views, you have no grasping.
To you whose further existence is exhausted I bow."

The god Material Things Abandoned said:

"You have abandoned material things, abandoned stains,
Abandoned hope, and abandoned evil as well.
Buddha who has wholly abandoned the obscurations,
You who realize the meaning, to you I bow."

The god Hope Abandoned said:

"You have abandoned what is meaningful and what is not;
Without attachment, with certain realization,
You have passed wholly beyond the noose of Māra.
You who are without grasping, to you I bow."

The god Wishing to Benefit said:

"The path, for oneself and for others,
That is free of the fever of the afflictions,

You who see without obscuration,
Great hero, see that as well."

The god Attained Renown said:

"Guide renowned throughout the world,
Those who strive in your wisdom,
If they contemplate just as you have taught,
Will see their afflictions subside."

The god Fearless said:

"Because you are certain about all phenomena,
You see no cause for dismay whatsoever.
Ocean of wisdom, undaunted,
You roar the lion's roar."

The god Fearless of Anything said:

"You have utterly crossed beyond all fears,
And drawn out every thorn.
You have no trepidation and no faintheartedness.
Overpowering all, to you I bow."

The god Abodeless said:

"The gods and the gandharvas,
Together with Māra and Brahmā,
Are unable to challenge your Dharma;
Therefore you have no trepidation."

The god Lion's Prowess said:

"Because you fully know all phenomena,
Having become a buddha, you have no fear.
'Who could challenge me on the Dharma?'
Such a doubt, O Sugata, you do not have."

The god Unafraid said:

"The lion that dwells in mountain ravines
Is without fear and without terror.
Having subdued the small beasts,
Undaunted, he roars in the forest.
Likewise the Omniscient One

Strikes terror into the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas),
And in the world of gods, nāgas, and gandharvas,
Seeing no equal, proclaims his speech."

The god Overpowering All said:

"Guide of the world, in the world
There is no one in the three worlds
Who could make the Buddha himself afraid;
Therefore the Victor is my refuge."

The god Lion Intelligence said:

"Omniscient One, all-seeing,
Fearless with regard to all phenomena,
There is none like you in the world.
To you, wholly undaunted, I bow."

The god Born in Accord said:

"When you proclaimed your buddhahood,
No one here challenged you.
Guide of the world, there is no one
Who can challenge you on the Dharma."

The god Treasury Holder said:

"Proclaiming the lion's roar,
Because the treasury of your Dharma was upheld,
A thousand koṭis of living beings
Have given rise to the mind of supreme awakening."

The god Conduct in Accord said:

"Those whose conduct accords with the Buddha,
Those great heroes, attain the great attainment.
With minds bent toward supreme awakening,
They become supreme persons."

The god Delighting in the Concordant Dharma said:

"Those who hear your teaching
And bend their minds toward supreme awakening
Are great beings in the world;
They become supreme persons."

The god Pure Mind said:

"Having heard the speech of the perfect Buddha,
Unchallenged in all the worlds,
A thousand koṭis of living beings
Have given rise to the mind of supreme awakening."

The god Completely Pure Mindstream said:

"For a long time, Lord of Men,
You trained well in the Buddha's training;
Therefore your mind-stream is pure,
And you possess the thirty-two excellent marks."

The god's son Undefiled Mind said:
"The Buddha, whose defilements are exhausted,
Proclaims the lion's roar;
Since you abide openly in your pledge,
No challenge to this could ever arise."

The god's son Following Suchness said:
"Gods, sons of gods, or humans
Who could speak against your words
Do not exist in the three worlds;
Therefore, Sage, you are endowed with the powers."

The god's son Skilled in the Exhaustion of Defilements said:
"The defilements of the supreme renunciant
Are entirely removed, without remainder;
Here there is no one who challenges you;
Therefore the Buddha is my father."

The god's son Ever Diligent said:
"'Afflictions remain in you':
Anyone who would challenge you so, Lord of Men,
Cannot be found in any way at all;
Therefore the Buddha has no fear."

The god's son Peaceful Mind said:
"Attachment and aversion are pacified,
Delusion, with its habitual tendencies, is pacified,
And you are pacified even of the karma of misconduct;
Therefore, peaceful-minded one, I bow to you."

The god's son Practice of Yoga said:
"When one looks to see by which yoga
Which affliction is removed,
All your knowledge enters into that;
Therefore I bow to you."

The god's son Skilled in Yoga said:
"The collections of yoga
In which the Guide trained are limitless;
Therefore, Omniscient One,
You have removed all afflictions without remainder."

The god's son Yogic Intelligence said:
"Lamp of the world, your mind
Never falls away from yoga;
Therefore all your afflictions,
Together with their habitual tendencies, are completely cleared away."

The god's son Knowing Peace said:
"All afflictions have been pacified,
The habitual tendencies cleared away without remainder;
Fearless one, together with the children of the Victor,
You act without fear in any way."

The god's son Contemplating Exhaustion said:
"Sage, Omniscient One,
You have removed the afflictions together with their habitual tendencies;
Lamp of the world, for you
No equal at all is found."

The god's son Uprooter of Latent Tendencies said:
"You have cleared away habitual tendencies without remainder;
In you there is no stain of fault at all;
Therefore, Buddha, Omniscient One,
You are the sage among the sages of all the gods."

The god's son Abiding at the End said:
"Because the defilements have been abandoned,
Your birth is not a birth leading to rebirth;
Sage, yours is the final birth;
Therefore, Protector, you have no fear."

The god's son Guardian of Measure said:
"Hero, you have abandoned the seeds;
The sprouts of suffering are burnt up;
The creeper of sorrow is withered away;
I bow to the one free of torment."

The god's son Remover of Stakes said:
"Sage, Omniscient One,
You have also removed the stakes of ignorance;
You have purified the Buddha's conduct;
Therefore, Teacher, you have no fear."

The god's son Gone Beyond Existence said:
"You have truly crossed the ocean of existence;
Guide, you have done what was to be done;
You have brought forth the light;
Fearless one, you have accomplished the aim."

The god's son Going to Nirvāṇa said:
"Omniscient One who has become peace,
Who has utterly destroyed all afflictions,
In whom not even a particle of habitual tendency remains,
Protector, I bow to you."

The god's son Banner of Dharma said:
"You raised the banner of the Dharma;
You cast down the banner of pride;
The limitless highway of the Dharma,
Great hero, you have shown."

The god's son Source of Dharma said:
"The Buddha is the source of the Dharma;
Sage who knows all phenomena,
Spiritual friend of all sentient beings,
Ocean of wisdom, I bow to you."

The god's son Robed in Dharma said:
"Though your fearless sons
Proclaim the lion's roar,
Those children of the Victor are never satisfied;
They thirst for the meaning of the Buddha's Dharma."

The god's son Seeking the Dharma said:
"To seek the qualities of the Buddha,
Your sons give rise to the resolve;
Having heard of your fearlessness,
Those wise ones seek awakening."

The god's son Thirsting for Dharma said:
"Having heard of your fearlessness,
In order to seek the qualities of the Buddha,
Ten million living beings became thirsty
And took up steadfast diligence."

The eleventh fascicle.

The god Exalted by Dharma said:

"Having seen you, Buddha, exalted by the Dharma,
Who tame beings fearlessly,
Supreme among all speakers,
Those of supreme discipline seek awakening."

The god Dharma Holder said:

"Sage, the Dharma you have taught
Is profound and hard to see.
When your heirs have heard it,
They seek unsurpassed awakening."

The god Free of Views said:

"Having heard your lion's speech,
Your sons, the heroes,
Without regard for body or life,
Strive for the sake of awakening."

The god Intelligence That Thinks of Nothing Else said:

"Sage free of all timidity,
Having heard this sacred Dharma of yours,
Thinking of nothing else at all,
Those of supreme discipline seek awakening."

The god Not Going Elsewhere said:

"Lord of men, having heard your speech,
They abandon the two vehicles,

And, going by no other path,
They seek unsurpassed awakening."

The god Abiding Near said:

"When the heirs of the Victor hear
This lion's roar you proclaimed,
They draw near to supreme awakening
And become the best of two-legged beings."

The god Eloquence Drawn Near said:

"Having heard the eloquence
With which you, of great renown, have spoken,
All your heirs give rise
To great joy in the qualities of the Buddha."

The god Attained Eloquence said:

"When your blameless heirs hear
What you, fearless one, have proclaimed,
Their eloquence never at any time
Turns back from buddhahood."

The god Ever Joyful said:

"Through what you, fearless one, proclaimed,
Your sons, O one of great strength,
Are ever filled with joy,
And those blameless ones seek awakening."

The god Undaunted Mind said:

"Having heard what you proclaimed,
Your sons, O best of two-legged beings,
Joyful and undaunted,
Seek supreme awakening."

The god Unobstructed Mind said:

"Through hearing what you proclaimed,
Their hearts are gladdened and their minds rejoice;
And never at any time
Are their minds obstructed toward awakening."

The god Skilled in What Does Not Obstruct the Dharma said:

"Whatever dharmas one relies upon
By which the bright side does not wane,
And no obstacle to it arises,
That ground, O Sage, you know."

The god Skilled in Teaching the Dharma Definitively said:

"For one who practices the bright side,
No obstacle will ever arise;
The Sage knows there is no possibility of it.
Therefore the Teacher is free of timidity."

The god Skilled in the Essential Nature of Dharmas said:

"Virtue tainted by affliction
Has the nature of the dark side.
Your mind is not stained by it;
The Sage knows there is no possibility of that."

The god Skilled in Reasoning said:

"That dark dharmas never at any time
Keep company with bright dharmas,
You, Blessed One, have rightly declared.
Therefore, Blessed One, you are my master."

The god Knower of Virtue and Nonvirtue said:

"Great hero, you know all dharmas
Without confusing them with one another:
When one takes up what is afflicted,
One declines from the bright side."

The god Skilled in the Path said:

"When one engages in affliction,
The bright side does not arise;
Not to understand it in this way,
You have said, becomes an obstacle."

The god Desiring Liberation said:

"You have said that relying on the dark side
Obstructs the many

Who long for liberation.
Therefore, Victor, you are omniscient."

The god Pure Mind said:

"Whoever wishes to liberate the mind
Must understand affliction:
So you, great hero, have said.
Thus you are a shrine for the world."

The god Seeing Affliction said:

"If one engages in affliction
Yet does not understand affliction,
One cannot know the sacred Dharma:
So the Sugata has said."

The god Seeing Wrongdoing said:

"Whoever claims that though one indulges in wrongdoing,
Virtue does not diminish,
Has no share in the Dharma of liberation:
So you, best of two-legged beings, have said."

The god To Be Tamed said:

"Whoever wishes to tame attachment,
And whoever wishes to tame aversion and delusion,
Should strive in just the way
The Sage's eloquence sets forth."

The god Purified of Affliction said:

"Those unskilled ones who do not know
Purity and affliction,
For them the Buddha is not their teacher:
So the supreme sage has said."

The god Diligent in Liberation said:

"The Dharma by which afflictions wane,
Which the Victor has taught:
That relying on it, afflictions are not exhausted,
No one can ever raise such an objection against you."

The god Turned Toward Liberation said:

"Regarding the Dharma the Sage taught,
By which all afflictions are exhausted,
The objection that, though one strives rightly, they are not exhausted,
Is not to be found at all."

The god Intent on Yoga said:

"Victor, whatever the purpose
For which you taught the Dharma to the śrāvakas,
That striving for it, one does not attain it:
No one here can raise this objection against you."

The god Fearless Glory said:

"You taught the unattractive
For the sake of abandoning attachment;
That if one strives rightly in it, attachment is not exhausted,
No one can ever raise such an objection against you."

The god Fully Knowing No Going said:

"You who are utterly free of timidity
Taught love for abandoning aversion;
That practicing it does not dispel aversion,
No one can object to you, vanquisher of foes."

The god Pure Eye said:

"Wisdom, which you taught
For the sake of abandoning delusion:
That though one relies on it, delusion is not dispelled,
No one here can raise this objection against you."

The god Destroyer of Conceptuality said:

"As the antidote to conceptual thought
You taught mindfulness of breathing out and in;
That though one strives in it, thought is not stilled,
No one here can raise this objection against you."

The god Devoted to Signlessness said:

"In order to abandon the thought 'I am,'
You taught emptiness;

That it does not bring this to peace,
No one here can raise this objection against you."

The god Who Has Abandoned the Pride of Thinking "I Am" said:

"In order to abandon the pride of thinking 'I,'
You taught signlessness;
That though one relies on it, it does not bring peace,
No one here can raise this objection against you."

The god Pure Mind-Stream said:

"Through purity of superior intention
All afflictions are destroyed;
That by it afflictions are not exhausted,
No one here can raise this objection against you."

The god Dismantler of Perception said:

"In any respect, in the forms of antidote,
In afflictions, the path, or entering the path,
One who could fearlessly dispute with you,
Great Sage, has never been seen."

The devaputra (a son of the gods) Thorough Knower of Conventions said:
"Blessed One, side and no side,
Exhausted and unexhausted, are mere conventions.
The one who disputes without fear,
That sage, is a name and nothing more."

The devaputra Disciplined in Bodily Action said:
"Having fully known through your knowledge,
The activity of your body sets forth.
Because you know all without remainder,
The Guide is therefore the Omniscient One."

The devaputra Fully Knowing Bodily Action said:
"Out of loving care for sentient beings,
Hero, the activity of your body
Is in every way entirely certain.
To the Protector of the World I bow."

The devaputra Utterly Certain in Bodily Action said:
"With the activity of your body wholly certain,
For the benefit of all who have bodies
You act, O lamp of the world;
Therefore you are the supreme person."

The devaputra Clearly Seeing the Limit of Bodily Action said:
"For the benefit of all sentient beings
The Guide, the Omniscient One,
Possesses bodily activity that is pure
And well and thoroughly examined."

The devaputra Well Composed in the Limit of Bodily Action said:
"Possessed of a body perfectly composed
And of bodily activity utterly pure,
For the happiness of sentient beings
The supreme person acts."

The devaputra Accomplished Speech said:
"Speech that is pleasant and full of good qualities,
Speech entirely free of harshness,
Thoroughly examined by your knowledge,
Such, O Protector, is the speech you utter."

The devaputra Speaking at the Right Time said:
"Speech that is timely and meaningful,
Speech entirely free of the pointless,
Fit to be spoken and fit to be accepted,
Such, O Guide, is the speech you utter."

The devaputra Reconciling Intelligence said:
"Shunning entirely what brings division,
Speech that reconciles and pleases,
Whose ripened fruit is freedom from discord,
Such speech you uttered in the past."

The devaputra Undeceiving said:
"Even for the sake of your life
You spoke no lie in any of your existences.
Therefore all your renown
Spreads unhindered through the worlds."

The devaputra Speaking Truly said:
"That all beings in this way,
Seeking the qualities of the Buddha,
Praise the speech of the Sage
Is the result concordant with your speaking truly."

The devaputra Emerged from the Limit of Reality said:
"Supreme among humans, through truth
You accomplished this perfect awakening,
And the true nature of phenomena as well
You know, O best of two-legged beings."

The devaputra Steadfast in Reality said:
"Seeing the phenomena of the conditioned
Correctly, just as they are,
And the true characteristics of phenomena too,
The Lord of Humans fully knows."

The devaputra Examining Action said:
"Through wisdom that is utterly pure
You fully know the actions of speech
Both of yourself and of others;
Therefore, Victor, you have no equal."

The devaputra Examining the Mind said:
"Whatever actions of the mind
Of the Lord of Humans set forth, however many,
They proceed toward beings with compassion.
Benefactor of beings, to you I bow."

The devaputra Skilled in Mental Conceptuality said:
"Having given rise to compassion for beings,
Toward whomever you engage,
Toward them your mind has become gentle.
Benefactor of beings, to you I bow."

The devaputra Skilled in Means said:
"Having examined the dispositions of beings,
The Guide's activity of mind sets forth.
The manifold wisdom of the Sage
Engages everywhere, just as he knows."

The devaputra Dismantler of Mind said:
"The buddha ground and the actions of the mind
Arise from looking on beings with compassion.
In buddhahood itself you fully know
Wisdom and means to be without intrinsic nature."

The devaputra Skilled in the Past said:
"In generosity, moral discipline, patience,
Diligence, and meditative concentration too,
Who practiced them in the past toward whom,
And the former times as well, you fully know."

The devaputra Examining the Past said:
"Seeking supreme awakening,
Wherever you practiced in the past,
Having thoroughly examined that former conduct,
You fully know the buddhas by the ten million."

The devaputra Excellent in Former Ways said:
"For countless ten millions of eons,
Wherever you practiced in the past,
Though you call to mind those former ways,
Your mind meets with no obstruction."

The devaputra Thoroughly Examining Former Ways said:
"The samādhis arisen from many buddhas,
Which are to be brought to full realization,
From countless ten millions of buddhas,
O Guide, you requested."

The devaputra Emerged from Former Application said:
"In the presence of the buddhas of the past,
Doors of samādhi, countless and immeasurable,
The Guide requested
And then meditated upon them."

The devaputra Examining Former Abodes said:
"Seeing the many faults of saṃsāra
And the various kinds of honor,
You teach them to sentient beings,
And you make them plain even to beings who are blind."

The devaputra Conjuring in Former Times said:
"Others and still others ate and drank,
Played and made great merriment,
And did unbearable harm;
These others and others too you behold."

The devaputra Truly Arisen from Former Conduct said:
"Omniscient One, who understands beings,
Your wisdom concerning the past,
Its actions, meditative concentrations and absorptions,
And its beings, meets no obstruction."

The devaputra Skilled in the Later Limit said:
"O Guide, your knowledge
Of the deaths and transmigrations of future times,
Of births, and of the ripening of actions,
Meets with no obstruction at all."

The god Domain of the Future said:

"O wise one, refuge of beings, your knowledge
Of the thoughts of beings in times to come,
Of the fruits of their karma, and of their destinies,
Meets with no obstruction."

The god Moved Beyond Existence said:

"Wise in these three realms
And in all three times,
Your supreme wisdom is unattached;
You know the domain of existence."

The god Engaged in Convention said:

"Karma, sentient beings and their destinies,
And those who experience karmic ripening:
All of these, O supreme among two-footed beings,
You have taught to be mere names."

The god Rightly Examining the Present said:

"Hero, your knowledge
Meets with no obstruction in the present.
The countless buddha fields

The Protector of the World fully knows."

The god Analyzing the Present said:

"Having analyzed, the Lord of Men
Sees the things of the three times,
Which bewilder the minds of the childish,
As nonexistent, and surely as sameness."

The god Nonabiding Intelligence said:

"There is no abiding in the three times,
Nor any abiding in essential nature.
All things are without entity:
So you, the Guide, see."

The god Urging On the Three Times said:

"The aggregates of the past,
Of the future, and of the present,
Do not exist and are not things:
So the Holy Being has taught."

The god Unattached Mind said:

"You have not taught that any being
Of the three times has an essence;
You have taught them to be like illusions,
Mirages, optical illusions, and echoes."

The god Gauging the Three Times said:

"Guide, since your knowledge
Knows all three times entirely
To be like illusions,
Your faculties have no attachment."

The god Knower of Resolve said:

"From the night on which you, hero,
Made awakening manifest,
From that time on, your resolve
Has never diminished at all."

The god Attained Right Resolve said:

"The resolve of the Savior of the World
Is never interrupted in between;
Through that constant resolve of yours,
Your heirs have great resolve."

The god Exalted by Resolve said:

"Just as a lotus rises from the water,
So you are exalted by your resolve;
You are not stained by the worlds,
Just as a lotus is not stained by water."

The god Liberated by Resolve said:

"The Protector of the World and resolve
Are spoken of as the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu);
Nondual, they are not made into two:
So you, the blameless one, see."

The god Attained Right Diligence said:

"Through diligence, one of great splendor,
You attained perfect awakening.
Although you have done what was to be done, Protector,
You have never given up diligence."

The god Perfect Mindfulness said:

"The mindfulness of the Great Hero
Follows upon all things.
Although you have done what was to be done, Protector,
Your mindfulness never diminishes."

The god Mind in Equipoise said:

"The Protector, ever in meditative equipoise,
Knows the conduct of sentient beings,
And according to their conduct
The Guide teaches beings the Dharma."

The god Devoted to Wisdom said:

"The farther shore of the ocean of wisdom
Of you who have become the lamp of the world
The buddhas could not explain,
Even if they spoke for ten million eons."

The god Skilled in Liberation said:

"Because you have found
Neither liberation nor non-liberation,
In you, the unequaled one,
Liberation never declines."

The god Striving for the Wisdom of Liberation said:

"Sage, since, once liberated,
You know the absence of essential nature,
Your vision of the wisdom of liberation,
Your correct knowledge, never declines."

The god Analyzing Former Existences said:

"From Dīpaṃkara onward,
Hero who sees correctly,
There has been no error in your conduct;
Therefore the buddhas praise you, saying, 'Excellent!'"

The god Engaged in the Profound said:

"Sugata, you have no attachment
Such as other living creatures have.
Since you know the nature of phenomena,
You are not confused about that nature."

The god Vast Intelligence said:

"In you, the Omniscient One,
There is no forgetfulness in any way.
Because the Protector's mindfulness is closely set,
The Sage is like a vessel of sesame oil."

The god Undistracted Mind said:

"In you, the Lamp of the World,
There is no mind that is not in equipoise.
The unshared qualities of a buddha
Are hard for any living creature to understand."

The god Firmly Established in Wisdom said:

"In you, the Sugata,
There is no unexamined equanimity.

The unshared buddha qualities
Of the Lord of Men are inconceivable."

The god All-Overpowering said:

"Bull among men, for you
There is no equal in the three worlds.
Omniscient and undefeated,
You know all phenomena."

The god Grasper of the Essence said:

"Unsurpassed essence of sentient beings,
Fearless with regard to all phenomena,
You who have attained equality with all buddhas,
Buddha, Awakened One, I bow to you."

This was the twenty-fourth chapter, the chapter of the gods of the Pure Abodes.

Then, at that time, other non-Buddhists, sixty thousand ascetics and wandering mendicants, saw the offerings made by the asuras, garuḍas, nāga maidens, nāgas, kumbhāṇḍas, gandharvas, yakṣas, kinnaras, the garland-bearing elephant riders, and the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings, of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, of Yāma, of Tuṣita, of Nirmāṇarati, of Vaśavartin, of Brahmā, of Ābhāsvara, of Śubhakṛtsna and of Bṛhatphala. They also heard the prophecies, and they heard the praises spoken by the gods of the realm of the Pure Abodes. They were filled with wonder. Having heard this entry into the way of the Dharma, a way of the Dharma such as they had never heard before, they became of two minds, wavering and doubtful, and they said this to the Blessed One:

"O Gautama, having heard this teaching of the Dharma that we had never heard before, we no longer want the life of wandering ascetics (parivrājakas), nor do we want the life of householders. Having heard this way of Dharma never heard before, we have become hesitant and doubtful about this Dharma, and our minds have not become clear. Even so, ascetic Gautama, we have trust in you. Why is that? Because you, ascetic Gautama, have displayed such a performance of miraculous power. Through your display of that miraculous power, we have seen these vast assemblies of gods, and most of this entire assembly, understanding and rejoicing in what you, Gautama, have

so well spoken. That is why we have come to have faith in you, ascetic Gautama.

"O Gautama, the gods of Bṛhatphala said, 'All phenomena are the Tathāgata,' and we have great doubt about this, wondering how all phenomena could be the Tathāgata. We think, 'May the ascetic Gautama teach us the Dharma in such a way that we understand the meaning of what he has so well explained, become free of darkness, and then rise from this seat.' It is with this confidence that we have come to the ascetic Gautama."

When they had said this, the Blessed One spoke to the other non-Buddhists, the caraka ascetics and the wandering ascetics: "Wandering ascetics, therefore I shall question you yourselves. Answer as seems right to you."

"Excellent, ascetic Gautama," they replied, and the wandering ascetics listened to the Blessed One. The Blessed One then said to them, "Wandering ascetics, do you know how entry into the womb takes place?"

They replied, "O Gautama, as we have heard from the treatises, entry into the womb takes place through the coming together of three things. When the father and mother have come together, have become attached, and, having become attached, desire has arisen through their imagining with thoughts of desire, at that time entry into the womb takes place."

The Blessed One said, "Wandering ascetics, what do you think about this? When the father and mother engage in conceptual thought, does that desire arise from the mother's mind?"

They replied, "O Gautama, it does not."

"Does it arise from the mother's conceptual thought?"

"O Gautama, it does not."

"Does it arise from the father's mind?"

"O Gautama, it does not."

"Does it arise from the father's conceptual thought?"

"O Gautama, it does not."

"Wandering ascetics, what do you think about this? Does the father's desire enter the mother's womb?"

"O Gautama, it does not."

"Wandering ascetics, what do you think about this? Does the father's mind enter the mother's womb?"

"O Gautama, it does not."

"Wandering ascetics, what do you think about this? Does the father's imagining enter the mother's womb?"

"O Gautama, it does not."

"Wandering ascetics, what do you think about this? Does the one who dwells in the womb die and pass from among the gods and enter the mother's womb?"

"O Gautama, we do not know."

"Wandering ascetics, what do you think about this? Does the one who dwells in the womb die and pass from among humans, from among asuras, from among hell beings, from the realm of animals, or from the world of Yama, and enter the mother's womb?"

"O Gautama, we do not know."

"Wandering ascetics, what do you think about this? Does the one who dwells in the womb enter the mother's womb as something with form, or as something without form?"

"O Gautama, we do not know."

"Wandering ascetics, what do you think about this? Do form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness enter the mother's womb?"

"O Gautama, we do not know."

When they had said this, the Blessed One spoke to those other non-Buddhist wandering ascetics: "Wandering ascetics, this Dharma is profound and subtle. It is to be understood by the wise, by those who know, by the intelligent. It is beyond examination and is not an object of examination. It is hard to see and hard to know. Therefore it cannot be known by those like you, who for a long time have looked elsewhere, been inclined elsewhere, placed your faith elsewhere, striven elsewhere, and dwelt in the ground of other views. And yet, wandering ascetics, sons or daughters of good family who rely on a spiritual friend suited to them will have the eye for the profound dharmas arise.

"Wandering ascetics, it is like this. Suppose a person's eye faculty is impaired. If he relies on a good friend who treats him in a way suited to him, then in this very life his eye will become completely clear, and with that eye he will see

forms in this very life. In the same way, wandering ascetics, if a son or daughter of good family whose eye of wisdom is impaired relies on a suitable spiritual friend, the eye of wisdom will become fully purified, and with it they will see the profound dharmas.

"Wandering ascetics, you too have for a long time looked elsewhere. You have been deceived by earlier wrong instructions. You perceive what is not Dharma as Dharma, what is not liberation as liberation, and what is not deliverance as deliverance. You have been ruined by those who are themselves ruined. Wandering ascetics, it is like this. If, for example, a blind man takes a blind man as his guide, it should be understood that both the one who is led and the one who leads will, in that improper way, meet with suffering."

Wandering ascetics, in the same way, some monks or brahmins who are not teachers claim, "We are teachers." Not being perfectly complete buddhas, they claim, "We are perfectly complete buddhas." Not being skilled in the way out, they claim, "We are skilled in the way out." Not having seen the way out, they claim, "We have seen the way out." Not being ford-makers, they claim, "We are ford-makers." Because they claim to be teachers when they are not teachers, whomever they instruct is instructed wrongly. Not being perfectly complete buddhas, whomever they bring to understanding is brought to a wrong understanding. Not being skilled in the way out, whomever they lead out is led out wrongly. Not having seen the way out, to whomever they show the way out it is shown wrongly. Not being ford-makers, whomever they ferry across is ferried across wrongly, and those people meet with suffering for no good reason.

Wandering ascetics, it is like this. Suppose a cowherd who is not skilled in fords drives his cattle across where there is no ford. His cattle, finding neither the far bank nor the near bank, will swirl about and meet with suffering right there, for no good reason. Why is that? Because that cowherd is not skilled in fords. Wandering ascetics, in the same way, when someone who is not a ford-maker claims to be a ford-maker, whoever he ferries across will meet with suffering for no good reason.

Wandering ascetics, I am truly a teacher and claim to be a teacher, so whomever I instruct is instructed correctly. I am truly a perfectly complete buddha and claim to be a perfectly complete buddha, so whomever I bring to understanding is brought to correct understanding. I am truly skilled in the way out and claim to be skilled in the way out, so those whom I lead out are

led out correctly. I have truly seen the way out and claim to show the way out, so to whomever I show the way out it is shown correctly. I am a ford-maker and claim to be a ford-maker, so whomever I ferry across is ferried across correctly. Having fully understood the qualities of a teacher, I instruct. Having fully understood the qualities of a buddha, I bring others to understanding. Having fully understood the way out, I lead out. Having seen correctly, I show. Having fully understood the ford, I ferry across, and whomever I ferry across, I ferry across by a safe ford.

So, wandering ascetics, you too long for liberation, and I am a Teacher present before you, one who instructs correctly, who brings to correct understanding, who has seen the way out, a perfect way out, and who is a true ford-maker. Therefore lend your ears, give rise to faith, establish mindfulness, and make your minds eager. In order to attain the qualities not yet attained, to travel a path not traveled before, to go in a direction not gone before, to keep company with companions on the path whose company you have not kept before, to seek a path not sought before, and to obtain a treasury of Dharma not obtained before, take up diligence correctly!

Wandering ascetics, concerning what was said, "Entry into the womb takes place when three things are present," listen well and closely, and keep it in mind. I shall explain to you this Dharma discourse called Entry into the Womb.

Wandering ascetics, what is called "the mother" is taught to be the condition of previously accumulated karma. What is called "the father" is taught to be the cause of previously accumulated karma. What is called "the gandharva" is a synonym for consciousness projected by karma. What is called "the embryo" is the abode and basis of the consciousness projected by karma. What is called "the mother's womb" is the basis of the consciousness projected by karma, for consciousness abiding in the mother's womb is born, grows, and develops.

Wandering ascetics, it is like this. Grasses, trees, medicinal plants, and forests that rest upon the great earth sprout, grow, and develop. In the same way, consciousness abiding in the mother's womb is born, grows, and develops. Having grown, it is born. Once born, it develops further. Having developed, its conduct becomes apparent: from whatever destiny one has died and transmigrated, having been born here or there, one behaves in a manner resembling that destiny. These things are to be known by the wise, not by fools. They are to be known through long association, not in a short time. They are to be known through careful reflection, not by the negligent.

Wandering ascetics, the signs by which the wise can recognize a person who has died and transmigrated from among the hell beings are these. The voice is hoarse. The voice sounds like broken pottery. The speech has to be puzzled out. The voice is loud. The voice is booming. Such a person is always frightened, always trembling, and always has goose bumps. In dreams he sees a heap of fire blazing. He sees mountains moving. He sees embers blazing. He sees beings boiled in cauldrons of iron and copper. He sees men holding clubs. He sees himself being hurled about by rākṣasas. He sees himself impaled alive on a stake. He sees himself overpowered by dogs. He sees himself surrounded by dogs. He sees himself harassed by elephants and snakes. He flees in the four directions and does not know which way to go. He does not trust any being. Wandering ascetics, by these twenty features one should know a person to have died and transmigrated from among the hell beings.

Wanderers, the signs of a person who has passed away from the animal realm and been reborn are these. Such a person is dull and sleeps a great deal. He is very lazy. He eats a great deal. He drags himself along the ground. He has no courage. He speaks indistinctly. He delights in stupidity. He delights in darkness. He delights in mud and mire. Again and again he bites off grass with his teeth. He constantly digs at the ground with his big toe. Again and again flies gather on his head. Again and again he snaps his teeth at the air. He sleeps all curled up. He sleeps on the ground. He is not repelled by filth. Again and again he sniffs at the air. Again and again he eats things before they are ripe. He says one thing and does another, and so is deceitful. He behaves haphazardly. In dreams he dreams that he is smeared with mud. In dreams he dreams that he has gone into a forest and is eating grass. He sees himself surrounded by venomous snakes. He sees himself entering a mountain wilderness. Wanderers, these and other signs, of many kinds, should be recognized as the signs of a person who has passed away from the animal realm. Even if one were to describe them for an eon, or for more than an eon, one could not exhaust them.

Wanderers, the signs of a person who has passed away from the world of Yama are these. His hair is tawny. His eyes are like a fox's eyes. He is always hungry. He is always thirsty. He is very miserly. He has great craving, and does not obtain what he seeks. He sets his hopes on what belongs to others. He is angry. His eyes are red. He craves every kind of food. He is attached to all his possessions, and he does not want to see those who are worthy of gifts. Toward every object he has the thought of stealing it. He delights even in

worthless things. He is intent on gain. He delights in impure food and drink. He is jealous of the good fortune of others. He develops craving for the wealth of others. Whatever wealth belongs to others, he thinks of it as "mine." When food is scattered, his mind is displeased. He takes fruit even from the streets of the marketplace. Wanderers, the particular signs of a person who has passed away from the world of Yama should be known to be endless: these and others.

Wanderers, the signs of a person who has passed away from among the asuras are these. He is conceited. He is very quarrelsome. He holds grudges. He is very proud. His body is large. His eyes are large. His eyes are white. His fangs are visible. He is powerful. He has a warlike mind. He delights in sowing discord. He is very proud in all his activities. His teeth are visible. He regards the whole world with contempt. His weapons are sharp. His words are hurtful. He is boastful. He has the strength of ignorance. He has the strength of the afflictions. Wanderers, these and others should be recognized as the signs of a person who has passed away from among the asuras.

Wanderers, the signs of a person who has passed away from among humans are these. He has a sense of wonder. He associates with noble ones. He censures those who are not noble. He does what is virtuous. He desires distinction. He desires fame. He desires renown. He delights in the crafts. He delights in knowledge. His afflictions are slight. He has conscience and a sense of shame. He is perfect in the conduct of a son of good family. He is grateful. He is affectionate toward his friends. He is endowed with generosity. He is discerning. He examines what has been done and what has not been done. He has power of speech. He has the ability to take counsel. He is highly skilled at making peace and at making war. He is capable as a messenger. He has the ability to master every language. He clearly knows what is possible and what is impossible. Wanderers, these and others are the signs of a person who has passed away from among humans.

Wanderers, the signs of a person who has passed away from among the gods are these. He is beautiful. He is very fastidious about cleanliness. He delights in garlands. He delights in perfumes. He delights in incense. He is fond of singing. He delights in ointments. He is not satisfied with paltry sense pleasures, and delights in vast ones. He delights in the sound of every kind of music. He delights in every kind of song. He delights in keeping company with great gatherings of people. He delights in houses, in many-storied mansions, in homes, and in vast wealth. His mind is led by loving-kindness. He has a

lighthearted, merry disposition. He speaks gently. He is skilled at giving delight. He delights in ornaments. He has a grand disposition. He is fond of going about. He is fond of exerting his bodily strength. He knows the signs of attachment and the signs of nonattachment. He is skilled at helping others. Wanderers, by these and other signs one should be recognized as a person who has passed away from the heavens.

Wanderers, in order to pass completely beyond these signs, sons or daughters of good family should rely on, attend upon, and serve such spiritual friends as teach the Dharma for the sake of passing completely beyond these signs.

Now, the person who has passed away from the hells, when he was formerly a human being, indulged in aversion, and so he accumulated karma arising from aversion; because of that he was born in the hells. Thus, having found a dwelling in the hells, he took on the conduct of a hell being, and then he is born among humans. On hearing these signs of conduct, he should recognize for himself, "I have passed away from the hells," and in order to abandon the karmic cause of the hells, he should seek a spiritual friend. Those spiritual friends then teach loving-kindness as the antidote to aversion. They teach the factors of awakening endowed with loving-kindness, and the perfection of moral discipline endowed with loving-kindness. Through this he will abandon the latent tendency of aversion, and by cultivating great loving-kindness he will bring all six perfections to completion.

Wanderers, in this regard, consider the person who has died and passed from the animal realm. When formerly a human being, he indulged in delusion, and so he formed karma arising from delusion. Because of that, he was born in the animal realm. Then, having come to dwell in the animal realm, he took on the conduct of the animal realm. So even when he dies and passes from the animal realm and is born among humans, he engages in those very behaviors of the animal realm. From those behaviors he should recognize for himself, "I have passed from the animal realm and been born among humans." In order to transcend those actions of the animal realm completely, he should seek a spiritual friend. Those spiritual friends then teach him dependent origination so that he may abandon delusion, and through this he abandons his latent tendency toward delusion. They also teach the perfection of wisdom, the sameness of the three times, and through this the understanding arises in him that delusion is without intrinsic nature. Or else they teach him the sameness of all phenomena, and through this he perfects the perfection of wisdom and attains omniscience.

Wanderers, in this regard, consider the person who has died and passed from the world of Yama. When formerly a human being, he relied on miserliness, cultivated it, and practiced it often, and so he formed karma arising from attachment bound up with miserliness. Because of that karma, which he committed, accumulated, appropriated, completed, and took on, he was born in the world of Yama. Dwelling in the world of Yama, he took on the conduct of those who live in the world of Yama. So even when he dies and passes from the world of Yama and is born among humans, he engages in those very behaviors of the world of Yama. From those behaviors he should recognize for himself, "I have passed from the world of Yama." In order to transcend those behaviors completely, he should seek a spiritual friend. Those spiritual friends then teach him giving away so that he may abandon miserliness, and through this he abandons his latent tendency toward miserliness. Or else they teach him the factors conducive to awakening that are endowed with giving, and they teach the perfection of generosity. By cultivating it, he perfects the six perfections.

Wanderers, in this regard, consider the person who has died and passed from among the asuras. When formerly a human being, he formed vast roots of virtue, but he also indulged in pride. Because of the karma bound up with pride, which he committed, accumulated, appropriated, completed, and took on, he was born as an asura. Dwelling among the asuras, he took on the conduct of the asuras. So even when he dies and passes from among the asuras and is born among humans, he engages in those very behaviors of the asuras. From those behaviors he should recognize for himself, "I have passed from among the asuras." In order to transcend those behaviors completely, he should seek a spiritual friend. Those spiritual friends then teach him the sense bases, so that he may abandon pride and destroy the pride that thinks "I am," and through this he abandons his pride. Or else they teach him emptiness, and through this he abandons his latent tendency toward pride and the self is destroyed. Or else they teach how whatever comes about arises from a combination of conditions, and through this he abandons his latent tendency toward pride. Or else they teach him the single characteristic of phenomena, and through this he perfects the perfection of wisdom, and by cultivating it he achieves omniscience.

Wanderers, in this regard, consider the person who has died and passed from among humans. When formerly a human being, he relied on the ten virtuous courses of action, cultivated them, and practiced them often. Because of that

karma, which he committed, accumulated, appropriated, completed, and took on, he was born as a human being. Dwelling among humans, he took on the conduct of humans. So when he dies and passes from among humans and is born again among humans, he engages in those very behaviors of humans. From those behaviors he should recognize for himself, "I have passed from among humans." In order to transcend those human behaviors completely, he should seek a spiritual friend. Those spiritual friends then teach him the perception of impermanence, and through this he abandons those behaviors together with their latent tendencies. Or else they speak to him in dispraise of saṃsāra and in praise of nirvāṇa, and through this he takes no delight in saṃsāra and strives for nirvāṇa. Or else they teach him the six perfections, and on hearing them he generates the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. They also teach him skillful means, and through this he holds those six perfections firmly and quickly attains omniscience.

Wanderers, in this regard, consider the person who has died and passed from the heavens. When formerly a human being, he practiced pure conduct while holding it to be supreme, gave gifts while holding giving to be supreme, and guarded moral discipline while holding it to be supreme. Because of that karma, which he committed, accumulated, appropriated, completed, and took on, he was born among the gods. Dwelling among the gods, he took on the conduct of the gods. So even when he dies and passes from among the gods and is born among humans, he engages in those very behaviors of the gods. From those behaviors he should recognize for himself, "I have passed from among the gods." In order to transcend those behaviors completely, he should seek a spiritual friend. Those spiritual friends then teach him the fault of holding pure conduct to be supreme, and they speak of the qualities of pure conduct that does not abide in anything. They disparage giving that is held to be supreme and praise giving that is free of holding it to be supreme. They censure moral discipline that is held to be supreme and praise moral discipline that is free of holding it to be supreme.

Through this he will abandon his clinging to his own moral discipline and ascetic vows as supreme, together with its latent tendencies. Or else one teaches him the perfection of moral discipline, and by cultivating it he will bring the six perfections to completion. One also teaches him skill in means, and endowed with that he will swiftly go forth to omniscience.

Wanderers (parivrājakas), among these, the person who has died and passed on from the hells should rely on a spiritual friend and listen to the teaching on

the sameness of the three times. Having heard it, he should mostly dwell in villages, cities, market towns, provinces, districts, and the precincts of royal palaces, in places where many of the fourfold assembly are present: monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen. He should dwell there and keep company with them. As he goes about there and follows it through with familiarization, the sameness of the three times, namely that all phenomena have the essential nature of being without entity, will become manifest to him.

Wanderers, among these, the person who has died and passed on from the animal realm should rely on a spiritual friend and, as an antidote to delusion, dwell joyfully together with people skilled in treatises. Through this he will abandon his delusion, and he should correctly examine those treatises and that knowledge of the treatises as to their intrinsic nature. Therefore, for him, the treatises and the knowledge of the treatises are also without intrinsic nature. They will appear to him as "without intrinsic nature," and thereby the sameness of the three times will become manifest to him, and he will swiftly go forth to omniscience.

Wanderers, among these, the person who has died and passed on from the world of Yama, lord of the dead, should attend upon a spiritual friend in reliance on whom the thought of generosity arises in him, through whom the sameness of the three times becomes manifest to him, namely the single characteristic that is the absence of characteristics, and through cultivating which he will swiftly go forth to omniscience. He should attend upon good qualities.

The twelfth fascicle.

Wanderers, among these, the person who has died and passed on from the asuras should attend upon a spiritual friend and do battle with the Māra of the afflictions. That is to say, when one searches correctly, asking, "What is this phenomenon called pride? By what is it grasped? In whom does it arise? Who abandons it?", that pride is not found. That by which it is grasped, that in which it arises, and that which strives to abandon it are not found either. He correctly sees that by grasping it wrongly, oneself and the world are deceived. He correctly sees all phenomena as without intrinsic nature, and he fully understands that a phenomenon which has no intrinsic nature is without entity. He fully understands that, being without entity, it is not established. Being not established, it is unborn, and what is unborn does not cease. He fully understands that what is neither born nor ceases cannot be designated. What

cannot be designated is neither past, nor future, nor present. He fully understands that what is not found in the three times is neither attained nor lost.

Wanderers, thus this is the nature of reality of all phenomena. That nature of reality by which all phenomena are suchness, unerring suchness, suchness that is not otherwise, is such that the Tathāgata too is suchness, unerring suchness, suchness that is not otherwise. Therefore all phenomena are the Tathāgata.

Wanderers, I have taught, formerly and now as well, that the designations of the world have pride as their nature. Through pride, dying and passing on from the human state is designated. Through pride, dying and passing on from the heavens is designated. Through pride, dying and passing on, down to the hells, is designated. Where there is no pride, there is no designation. Wanderers, this should be known as the wisdom free of pride. It can be known by one who is endowed with skill in means and with the perfection of wisdom, and who is embraced by a spiritual friend.

Then those sixty thousand wandering ascetics (parivrājakas), having heard this teaching, attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena. Having attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena, they rose from their seats, bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, and sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, they then praised the Blessed One in verse:

Protector, through the power of wisdom you are truly exalted;
Among all beings you depend on no other.
You see the conduct of all beings
Like a myrobalan fruit placed in the palm of the hand.

The world is churned up by the many kinds of views,
Like the sky covered over by dense clouds.
Because of them the childish go about deluded,
Like a crowd of blind people who have lost their way.

Some say the world is permanent, the world is impermanent,
Both permanent and impermanent,
Neither permanent nor impermanent;
They are ruined like a lord of elephants tied up in a house.

Some say the world has an end, the world has no end,
Both has an end and has no end,

Neither has an end nor has no end;
They are like, for example, a bird shut in a cage.

Some say that this body is the self;
Some say that this body is other;
Bound up in conceptions, they lie helpless,
Like a bird caught and trapped in a snare.

Some say the world was emanated by Īśvara;
Some declare it arose without a cause.
Entangled all around by the many kinds of views,
They are seen by the Victor as plainly as the moon in the sky.

Just as a foolish bird shut in a cage
Hopes for escape at every hole,
The unskilled are bound by the many kinds of views;
They gain no liberation, like one bound at both feet.

To Brahmā, Prajāpati, and Skanda,
And also to Cakradhara and Vaiśravaṇa,
To the directions and the oceans they all bow down,
Like a thief seized at night by the king.

Like a poor man in debt who, when seized by his creditor,
Pleads for a respite,
The childish who dwell in the many kinds of views
Seek happiness from Īśvara.

Like gangs of thieves consigned to prison,
Beings undergo a hundred sufferings.
You, Tathāgata, see them
As clearly as the five fingers on the palm of your hand.

Lord of men, having brought forth compassion for them,
Knower of beings, you act among beings;
Supreme intellect, you free beings life after life,
Like, for example, a king releasing prisoners.

For the world's benefit, through inconceivable eons,
You performed austerities and attained supreme awakening;
Knowing that sentient beings wander in the many kinds of views,
You set them free from their bonds.

Sugata, lion among humans, foremost of two-legged beings,
Sovereign over the whole collection of dharmas,
You have no delusion about the many kinds of views, which are like illusions;
Sugata, we long to become like you.

The powers by which the Victor gained his strength,
The fearlessnesses by which he dispelled the foes who challenged him,
Roaring the lion's roar in the assembly:
O supreme bull, may we attain these!

That by which the Victor shakes the three worlds,
That by which he sends forth infinite light,
That by which the supreme human gives prophecies to beings:
May we attain that today, in an instant!

Then the Blessed One, understanding the superior intention of those wandering ascetics, smiled. Then the venerable Aśvajit addressed the Blessed One in verse:

You who wish to benefit the world, as for this smile you have made,
Has this assembly of non-Buddhists become greatly exalted?
Supreme human, Self-Arisen One, why have you smiled?
Please declare the cause of that smile.

Seeing that the Sugata has smiled,
O you who wish the world's benefit, these beings are in doubt.
Like beings gazing at the full moon,
They are gazing; Victor, tell the cause of your smile.

Who has made a supreme offering to the Victor?
Who has pleased the Father today?
Who today has beheld the qualities of the Victor?
Wise One, please declare it quickly and well.

On hearing the prophecy concerning the non-Buddhists,
The whole world will greatly rejoice.
Since these have thus been tamed by the Sugata,
You are therefore the guide of all beings.

Victor, please dispel this doubt well;
Please destroy the uncertainty of those who are uncertain.
By that these assemblies will rejoice
And have faith in your intention, O Buddha.

Then the Blessed One replied to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

Aśvajit, knowing that this was the time,
You did well to question the Victor, victorious over foes.
Because you asked this of the Guide, the Self-Arisen One himself,
Words that benefit the world will also be spoken.

As to how I came to make this smile,
I shall now reveal to you the cause of the smile.
To what I teach, just as it truly is,
Make your mind joyful and listen now!

This assembly of non-Buddhists has been thoroughly tamed;
Abandoning the many kinds of views, they will come to hold the good view.
Seeing the world wandering in the many kinds of views,
They have become compassionate and fully entered upon awakening.

Having completely abandoned the many kinds of views,
They have realized the straight and untroubled view,
And having heard my unobstructed prophecy,
All of them have brought forth the mind set on omniscience.

Having brought forth faith in the Victors of the past,
The compassionate ones, supreme among two-legged beings,

For a full two hundred million Victors,
Seeking unsurpassed awakening, they made offerings and gave service.
To the Victors they offered no small gifts;
They purified discipline and peaceful concentration;
They made the power of wisdom and diligence blaze;
In the presence of the compassionate ones they practiced patience.
Having sought supreme awakening for a long time,
Their minds entered into the six perfections as well.
They put questions to the Victor Victorious over Foes,
And they gladdened the minds of a full hundred buddhas.
Yet through the influence of evil friends,
They had come to dwell in grievous kinds of views.
Having seen the Sugata, the Self-Arisen One,
Through nonattachment they abandoned those kinds of views.
They have rightly understood the Teacher's intent;
Faith abides in them toward the Teacher's intentions.
In the future they will seek awakening,

And they will serve ten million Victors.
In the future eon called Tārakopama,
They will be Victors all of the same name, Destroyer of Pride,
Renowned in every direction with great fame,
Knowers of the World who will set beings free.
Their buddha fields will be perfectly pure,
Their arrays manifold and without equal.
In those buddha fields there will be no one of evil mind;
Only those alike in purity of intellect will dwell there.
That will purify all the lower realms,
And remove the states without leisure. At the end of that time,
Those Victors will possess the strength of long life,
Able to live for eighty thousand years.
The people there, having heard of this awakening,
Will not then act in ways that give displeasure.
If they hear the names of those whose minds are free of attachment,
Even women will obtain a male body.
Thus the Teacher, the Victor who destroyed pride, the great sage,
Proclaimed the prophecy concerning the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas).
When they heard it, the worlds together with their gods
Rejoiced, and strength arose in them.

This concludes the twenty-fifth chapter, the Prophecy concerning the Non-Buddhists.

Then King Śuddhodana and his retinue, having heard the prophecies concerning the asuras, the garuḍas, and so on up to the wandering ascetics, thought, "It is wondrous how the Blessed One, by speaking so excellently, has satisfied all beings." Having thought this, he became entangled again by attachment to his son.

Then the Blessed One, knowing the mind of King Śuddhodana, said to King Śuddhodana, "Great King, I shall teach you the pure conduct, a Dharma that is virtuous in the beginning, virtuous in the middle, and virtuous at the end, excellent in meaning, excellent in wording, unmixed, complete, fully pure, and fully cleansed: namely, the Dharma discourse called The Analysis of the Six Elements. Listen to it well and attentively, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain it."

Saying, "Excellent, Blessed One," King Śuddhodana listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One then spoke to him as follows: "Great King, what is the Dharma discourse called The Analysis of the Six Elements? Great King, this person consists of six elements, of six sense bases of contact, and of eighteen mental engagements.

"On what basis was it said, 'This person consists of six elements'? Great King, these are the six elements. What are the six? They are the earth element, the water element, the fire element, the wind element, the space element, and the consciousness element. Great King, these are the six elements, and it was on this basis that I said, 'This person consists of six elements.'

"On what basis was it said, 'This person consists of six sense bases of contact'? Great King, these are the six sense bases of contact. What are the six? The eye as a sense base of contact, for seeing forms; the ear as a sense base of contact, for hearing sounds; the nose as a sense base of contact, for smelling odors; the tongue as a sense base of contact, for tasting flavors; the body as a sense base of contact, for touching tangible objects; and the mind as a sense base of contact, for cognizing mental phenomena. Great King, these are the six sense bases of contact, and it was on this basis that I said, 'This person consists of six sense bases of contact.'

"Great King, on what basis was it said, 'This person consists of eighteen mental engagements'? Great King, these are the eighteen mental engagements. What are the eighteen? Here, when a person sees a form with the eye, he engages with the form in a way that gives rise to mental pleasure, to mental displeasure, or to equanimity. When he hears a sound with the ear, he engages with the sound in a way that gives rise to mental pleasure, to mental displeasure, or to equanimity. When he smells an odor with the nose, he engages with the odor in a way that gives rise to mental pleasure, to mental displeasure, or to equanimity. When he tastes a flavor with the tongue, he engages with the flavor in a way that gives rise to mental pleasure, to mental displeasure, or to equanimity. When he touches a tangible object with the body, he engages with the tangible object in a way that gives rise to mental pleasure, to mental displeasure, or to equanimity. When he cognizes a mental phenomenon with the mind, he engages with the phenomenon in a way that gives rise to mental pleasure, to mental displeasure, or to equanimity.

"Great King, the six engagements accompanied by mental pleasure, the six engagements accompanied by mental displeasure, and the six engagements

that give rise to equanimity, when gathered together, make eighteen mental engagements. Great King, these eighteen are the mental engagements, and, Great King, it was on this basis that I said, 'This person consists of eighteen mental engagements.'

"Great King, of these, the earth element is of two kinds: there is the internal and there is the external. Great King, what is the internal earth element? It is whatever, within this body, internally, is hard and solid in nature, belonging to it and appropriated by it.

What is that? It is the hair of the head, body hair, nails, teeth, dirt, grime, skin, flesh, vessels, sinews, bones, marrow, heart, liver, lungs, kidneys, stomach, pleura, intestines, mesentery, bladder, spleen, feces, rectum, brain, and brain membrane. Whatever else within this body, inside it, is hard or of a solid character, belongs to the body and is appropriated, is called the internal earth element.

Great King, what is the external earth element? Whatever outside is hard or of a solid character, does not belong to the body and is not appropriated, is called the external earth element.

Great King, when the internal earth element arises, it does not come from anywhere, and when it ceases, it does not go anywhere to accumulate.

Great King, a woman inwardly imagines, "I am a woman." Having inwardly imagined herself as a woman, she outwardly imagines a man to be a man. Having outwardly imagined a man to be a man, she becomes attached and wishes to unite with the external man. The man too inwardly imagines, "I am a man." Having inwardly imagined himself as a man, he outwardly imagines a woman to be a woman. Having outwardly imagined a woman to be a woman, he becomes attached and wishes to unite with the external woman. Because they wish to unite, they unite. Then there comes a time when, through the condition of their union, the embryo arises.

Great King, both what is imagined and what imagines do not exist: in a woman there is no woman, and in a man there is no man. Thus, though they do not exist, false imagination arises, and that imagination too is without essential nature. Just as with imagination, so the union and the embryo are also without essential nature. How could what has no essential nature produce hardness?

Great King, having thus understood imagination, one should understand hardness itself, so as to know that when hardness arises it does not come from

anywhere.

Great King, there comes a time when this body ends up in the charnel ground. When its hardness is destroyed and ceases, it does not go to the east, nor does it go to the south, the west, the north, above, below, or the intermediate directions. Great King, this is how the internal earth element should be viewed.

Great King, there comes a time when, where this world had stood, there is only space, and the mansion of Brahmā, made of the seven kinds of precious substance, stands there. Great King, when its hardness arises, it does not come from anywhere. And when the mansions of the Vaśavartin gods, made of the seven kinds of precious substance, come into being, Great King, their hardness too, when it arises, does not come from anywhere.

Though the Cakravāla and the Great Cakravāla ranges stand, mountains made of vajra, hard, firm and massive, their hardness, when it arises, does not come from anywhere. Though there stand the Sumerus, kings of mountains, the Yugaṃdharas, the Nimiṃdharas, the Īṣādharas, the Vajra Holders, the Khadirakas, the Vinatakas, the Aśvakarṇas, the Sudarśanas, the Mahāsudarśanas, the Bare Peaks, the Gandhamādanas, the snow mountains, and the other black mountains; though there stands the trichiliocosm, the great thousandfold world system, complete in every respect; and though there stands the great earth, eighty-four thousand yojanas deep and sixty thousand yojanas wide, Great King, that hardness, when it arises, does not come from anywhere.

Great King, when this world is destroyed, there comes a time when this great earth is burned by fire, or dissolved by water, or scattered by wind. When it is burned by fire, not even smoke appears, and no remnant of ash appears. It is just as when butter or sesame oil is burned by fire in open space: not even smoke appears, and no remnant of ash appears. In the same way, when this trichiliocosm, the great thousandfold world system, is burned by fire, not even smoke appears, and no remnant of ash appears.

When it is dissolved by water, no remnant whatever appears. It is just as when salt dissolves in water, not the slightest remnant appears. In the same way, when this trichiliocosm, the great thousandfold world system, is dissolved by water, not the slightest remnant appears.

When it is scattered by wind, not the slightest remnant appears. It is just as when a little bird is overtaken by a scattering gale, not the slightest trace of it appears. In the same way, when this trichiliocosm, the great thousandfold

world system, is scattered by wind, not the slightest remnant appears.

Great King, thus the arising of the earth element is empty, and the destruction and arising of the earth element are empty of essential nature. Great King, apart from mere convention, the earth element is not apprehended as the earth element itself, and that convention too is neither female nor male. Great King, understand this thus, as it truly is, with wisdom.

Great King, the water element is of two kinds: internal and external. What is the internal water element? Whatever within this body, inside it, is water, watery, wateriness, moisture, moist, moistness, or wetness, belongs to the body and is appropriated. What is that? It is tears, sweat, saliva, nasal mucus, lymph, fat, bile, phlegm, pus, blood, milk, and urine. Whatever else within this body, inside it, is water, watery, wateriness, moisture, moist, moistness, or wetness, belongs to the body and is appropriated, is called the internal water element.

What is the external water element? It is whatever is external water, watery, the nature of water, moisture, moist, the nature of moisture, wetness, that does not belong to the body and is not appropriated. This is called the external water element.

Great King, when the internal water element arises, it does not come from anywhere. Great King, tears arise on seeing someone dear; tears arise when one is afflicted by suffering, or through the force of the Dharma; and tears arise when one is struck by wind, or in other ways too. Even on examination, there is a time when the internal water element increases, yet, Great King, when that water element arises, it does not come from anywhere.

Great King, there is a time when the internal water element dries up completely, and when it dries up and ceases, it does not go anywhere. Great King, there is a time when the internal fire element becomes predominant and scorches the internal water element, and when it is scorched, it does not go anywhere. Great King, in the same way, when the internal water element arises it does not come from anywhere, and when it ceases it does not go anywhere.

Great King, there is a time when this world comes into being. When this world system comes into being, thirty-two masses of very dense cloud gather throughout this sky, and by their gathering this entire great trichiliocosm, complete in every part, is covered over. Then for five intermediate eons a stream of rain falls, each stream as thick as a plough-pole. For five

intermediate eons rain falls in streams as thick as an elephant's member. For five intermediate eons rain falls without interruption. For five intermediate eons rain falls in great drops. By this, everything from this great earth up to the world of Brahmā is filled and pervaded with water. Yet, Great King, even when that great mass of water arises, it does not come from anywhere.

Great King, there is a time when this world is destroyed. When this world system is destroyed, two suns appear in the world, and because two suns have appeared in the world, the springs and streams dry up. Then three suns appear in the world, and because three suns have appeared in the world, the great springs and the great rivers dry up. Then four suns appear in the world, and because four suns have appeared in the world, even the great lake Anavatapta, from which these four great rivers flow, dries up completely, sinks away, and vanishes. Then five suns appear in the world, and because five suns have appeared in the world, the water of the great ocean is depleted and diminished by as much as one yojana. It is depleted and diminished by as much as two yojanas, three, four, five, ten, twenty, thirty, forty, and fifty yojanas. The water of the great ocean is depleted and diminished by as much as a hundred yojanas, two hundred, three hundred, four hundred, five hundred yojanas, a thousand yojanas, two thousand, three thousand, and four thousand yojanas.

Great King, there is a time when forty thousand yojanas of water remain in the great ocean; when thirty thousand yojanas, twenty thousand, nine thousand, eight thousand, seven thousand, six thousand, five thousand, four thousand, three thousand, two thousand, and one thousand yojanas of water remain; when nine hundred yojanas of water remain; when eight hundred yojanas, seven hundred, six hundred, five hundred, four hundred, three hundred, two hundred, and one hundred yojanas of water remain; when fifty yojanas, forty, thirty, twenty, ten, nine, eight, seven, six, five, four, three, two, and one yojana of water remain; when water to the height of ten palm trees remains, nine, eight, seven, six, five, four, three, and as much as two palm trees; when water to the height of ten men standing remains, nine, eight, seven, six, five, four, three, and as much as two men standing; when water remains only deep enough to reach the neck, only deep enough to reach the armpits, only deep enough to reach the navel, only deep enough to reach the knees; down to the time when there remains only as much water as fills a cow's hoofprint.

Great King, there is a time when nothing but scattered patches of moisture remain of the great ocean. It is like this: when great drops of rain have fallen,

at first there are only scattered patches of moisture on the great earth. Great King, in the same way there is a time when nothing but scattered patches of moisture remain of the great ocean. Great King, there is a time when there does not remain in the great ocean even enough water to wet the tip of a finger.

Great King, even when the water element ceases to that extent, it does not go anywhere: it does not go to the east, the south, the west, the north, above, below, or the intermediate directions. Great King, that water element is empty in its arising and empty in its destruction, and even while it abides, that water element is empty of intrinsic nature. Great King, apart from mere convention, that water element is empty of the water element and is not apprehended, and that convention too is neither female nor male. Understand it in this way, truly as it is, with correct wisdom.

Great King, the fire element is of two kinds: internal and external. What is the internal fire element? It is whatever there is in this body that is fire, fiery, warmth, or warm, that belongs to the body and is appropriated.

And what is that? It is that by which this body is heated, thoroughly heated and completely heated; that by which what is eaten, drunk, chewed and tasted is well and comfortably digested; that which, when it predominates, comes to be reckoned as "fever, fever"; and, besides these, whatever in this body, internally and within, is fire or fiery, warmth or warm, belonging to the body and appropriated. This is called the internal fire element.

What is the external fire element? It is whatever is external fire or fiery, warmth or warm, not belonging to the body and not appropriated. It is this: people take a fire-drill, or grass, or powdered cow dung, or balls of cotton, and produce fire. Once it has arisen, it burns a village and the area around a village, a town or the area around a town, a country or a region of a country, an island, a heap of grass, a forest, trees, grass or cow dung, and spreads. This, and whatever else is of a similar kind, is called the external fire element. Great King, when the external fire element arises, it does not come from anywhere, and when it ceases, it does not go anywhere to be gathered. Because it is devoid of intrinsic nature, it comes into existence from nonexistence, and having come into existence, it becomes nonexistent again.

Great King, the wind element is also of two kinds: internal and external. What is the internal wind element? It is whatever in this body is wind or windlike, lightness and mobility, belonging to the body and appropriated. And what is

that? Namely: the upward-moving wind, the downward-moving wind, the wind moving across, the wind moving toward the back, the wind dwelling in the back, the wind dwelling in the belly, the cutting winds, the splitting winds, stabbing pains, trembling, nasal sounds, wind tumors, the winds of exhalation and inhalation, and the winds dwelling in the major and minor limbs; and, besides these, whatever in this body, internally and within, is wind or windlike, lightness and mobility, belonging to the body and appropriated. This is called the internal wind element.

What is the external wind element? It is whatever is external wind or windlike, lightness and mobility, not belonging to the body and not appropriated. As for this external wind, there is the east wind; there are the south, west and north winds. There are dusty winds and dustless winds, small winds and great winds. There are also all-pervading winds, scattering winds and whirlwinds. Great King, when a great mass of wind arises, it breaks trees, and it topples the tops of walls and the peaks of mountains, and having toppled them leaves no trace of them. And there are times when beings stir up a breeze with the hem of a garment, or with bellows, or with fans. This, and whatever else is of a similar kind, is called the external wind element. Great King, when the internal and external wind elements arise, they do not come from anywhere, and when they cease, they do not go anywhere to be gathered. Because they are devoid of intrinsic nature, they come into existence from nonexistence, and having come into existence, they become nonexistent again.

Great King, the space element is also of two kinds: internal and external. What is the internal space element? It is whatever in this body, internally and within, is present in the body and appropriated, and is reckoned as space, spacelike and "internal": what is unfilled and is not to be filled by skin, flesh and blood. And what is that? In this body it is what is called the inside of the eye, or the inside of the ears and nose, or the mouth, or the inside of the mouth, or the opening of the mouth, or the throat, or the gullet; that place where one swallows and where things remain, and that by which what is eaten, drunk, chewed and tasted passes downward. And, besides these, whatever in this body, internally and within, is present in the body and appropriated: the space and spacelike quality of what has become the aggregates, the elements or the sense sources, what is unfilled and not to be filled by skin, flesh and blood, reckoned as internal, the hollows and what are called the orifices. That is the internal space element.

What is the external space element? It is whatever is external space or spacelike, unfilled, not to be filled by anything that has become form, unmixed, hollow, become an opening. This is called the external space element.

Great King, there comes a time when, conditioned by karma, the sense sources arise. They come to obscure the space element, and it comes to be reckoned as what is called the internal space element, yet it has not come from anywhere. Great King, there comes a time when form is destroyed and everything becomes space. Why is that? Because the space element is inexhaustible. It should be understood that this is what is called the internal space element: abiding and unmoving.

Great King, just as the unconditioned is the realm of nirvāṇa, so too the space element should be seen as pervading everything.

Great King, suppose a man were to dig a well, or a pool, or a long well, or a tank on level ground. Great King, what do you think of that? From where did its space come?

He replied, "Blessed One, it did not come from anywhere."

"Great King, suppose that man were to fill them in again, from the well to the tank. Great King, what do you think of that? Where did that space go?"

He replied, "Blessed One, it did not go anywhere. And why is that? Because the space element is not established as going or coming, and is not established as the state of being female or the state of being male."

The Blessed One declared, "Great King, thus the external space element is unmoving and unchanging."

Why is that? Because the space element is empty of the space element, and the space element is devoid of the space element. The space element does not abide as the state of a woman, nor does it abide as the state of a man. Understand it in this way, as it really is, with correct wisdom.

Great king, what is the consciousness element? The eye faculty is the dominant condition, and form is the object. It is the cognizing of each form: cognizing blue, or cognizing yellow, red, or multicolored; or cognizing long, short, thick, or thin. Great king, in this way the cognizing of any color or shape whatever is called the eye-consciousness element.

Likewise, from "the ear faculty is the dominant condition" up to "the mind faculty is the dominant condition, and phenomena are the object": the cognizing of sound, the cognizing of smell, the cognizing of taste, the cognizing of touch, or the cognizing of phenomena, these are the elements from the ear-consciousness element up to the mind-consciousness element. Thus the six faculties are the dominant conditions and the six sense-objects are the objects, and this cognizing of objects is called the consciousness element.

Great king, that consciousness element does not rest on the faculties. It does not come from the objects, and it does not abide in the middle between them. It is not inside, it is not outside, and it is not in what is neither. That consciousness element ceases once it has cognized each thing. When it arises it does not come from anywhere, and when it ceases it does not go anywhere. The arising of that consciousness element is empty, and its perishing too is empty. Even though that consciousness element arises, it is empty of intrinsic nature.

Great king, in this way, apart from mere convention, that consciousness element is empty of the consciousness element itself, and that convention too is neither male nor female. Understand it in this way, as it really is, with correct wisdom.

Great king, what is the eye sense base? It is the clear matter of the four great elements, namely the earth element, the water element, the fire element, and the wind element. Among these, the clear matter of the earth element is not the eye sense base. Nor is the clear matter of the water element, nor the clear matter of the fire element, nor is the clear matter of the wind element the eye sense base. Why is that? The clear matter of the earth element does not abide as a sense base for any phenomenon, nor as something through which a sense base is to be attained. Likewise, the clear matter of the elements up to the wind element does not abide as a sense base for any phenomenon, nor as something through which a sense base is to be attained. Why is that? Those phenomena are without volition, without agency, and capable of nothing. Great king, when phenomena are searched for one by one, apart from mere convention, no eye sense base is found.

Why is that? The clear matter of the earth element is empty of the clear matter of the earth element, and so on up to the clear matter of the wind element, which is empty of the clear matter of the wind element. How could

phenomena that are empty of intrinsic nature become either clear or turbid? And how could those in which neither clearness nor turbidity is found look at forms? Thus the eye sense base is utterly empty of the intrinsic nature of the eye sense base. Because it has no coming and no going, it is not found at the prior extreme, and it is not found at the later extreme. Because it has no intrinsic nature, its abiding is not found either. What has no intrinsic nature is neither female nor male. How could what is neither female nor male give rise to conceit? Great king, conceit is the domain of Māra. Freedom from conceit is the domain of the buddhas. Why is that? All phenomena are free of conceit.

Great king, when one understands as it really is, the eye sense base is empty of the eye sense base. Why is that? This eye sense base has no sign; therefore this sign of the eye sense base is empty of the eye sense base, and this is emptiness. The eye sense base is free of signs, and this is signlessness. It makes no aspiration, and so this is wishlessness. Great king, in this way the eye sense base is the three doors of liberation; the eye sense base is directed toward liberation.

Great king, what then are the sense bases from the ear sense base up to the body sense base? They are the clear matter of the four great elements. Great king, in this way everything, up to all phenomena, is directed toward liberation, certain in the dharmadhātu, reaching to the limits of the space element, impossible to designate, beyond convention, inexpressible, and not to be spoken of.

Great king, that on which the faculties impinge is called the objects. Because the eye impinges on forms, forms are therefore called the objects of the eye. Likewise the ear impinges on sounds, the nose on smells, the tongue on tastes, the body on tangibles, and the mind on phenomena; therefore phenomena are called the objects of the mind.

Here, the statement "the eye impinges on forms" teaches impingement by way of alighting. That is, the eye alights on forms in three ways: it alights on agreeable forms with the perception of attractiveness, it alights on disagreeable forms with the perception of anger, and it alights on those that are neither agreeable nor disagreeable with the perception of equanimity.

Likewise, the statement "the mind impinges on phenomena" teaches impingement by way of alighting. That is, the mind alights on phenomena in three ways: it alights on agreeable ones with attachment, it alights on disagreeable ones with anger, and it alights on those that are neither

agreeable nor disagreeable with delusion. Those objects on which it alights are called the domain of the mind; because the mind moves and ranges among them, they are therefore called the domain of the mind.

"Great King, when the mind engages with agreeable forms with attachment, desire arises in it. When it engages with disagreeable forms with anger, aversion arises in it. When it engages with forms that are neither agreeable nor disagreeable with bewilderment, delusion arises in it. In the same way, with sounds, smells, tastes, and tangible objects too, one comes to experience these three kinds of phenomena as objects: one becomes attached, angered, or bewildered. When the mind engages with agreeable phenomena, the objects of mental cognition, with attachment, desire arises in it. When it engages with disagreeable phenomena with anger, aversion arises in it. When it engages with phenomena that are neither agreeable nor disagreeable with bewilderment, delusion arises in it.

"Great King, the sense faculties should be understood to be like an illusion, and their objects like a dream. Great King, suppose, for example, that a man asleep dreams that he is enjoying himself with the most beautiful woman in the land, and that when he wakes from sleep he remembers that woman, the most beautiful in the land. Great King, what do you think of that? Does the most beautiful woman in the land whom he saw in the dream exist?"

He replied, "Blessed One, she does not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, what do you think of that? Would a man who dreams of the most beautiful woman in the land, and who becomes fixated on playing and delighting with that woman, be of a wise disposition?"

He replied, "Blessed One, he would not. Why is that? Blessed One, the most beautiful woman in the land seen in the dream does not exist at all and cannot be found, so how could there be any enjoying oneself with her? Otherwise, the man who is fixated on her would be one whose lot is only want and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, when ignorant, unlearned ordinary beings see forms with the eye, they become fixated on those that make the mind happy. Being fixated, they become attached. Having become attached, they become thoroughly attached. Having become thoroughly attached, they perform actions born of desire: three kinds with the body, four kinds with speech, and three kinds with the mind. Yet the actions so performed are, from the very first, exhausted, ceased, departed, and transformed. They do not abide resting in the east. They do not abide resting in the south, the

west, the north, below, above, or the intermediate directions. They are not here, not over there, and not in between.

"At another time, when the time and moment of death draw near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is exhausted, and the actions of the same kind as that life are exhausted too. When the final consciousness ceases, the mind takes those actions as its object, just as, for example, one remembers the most beautiful woman in the land on waking from sleep. Great King, then, through two conditions, the final consciousness as the governing condition and those actions as the object, the first consciousness, belonging to rebirth, arises. It arises either among the beings of hell, or in the womb of an animal, or in the world of Yama, or in the realm of the asuras, or among humans, or among the gods. Immediately after that first consciousness belonging to rebirth ceases, without interruption, there arises a mental continuum of the same kind, in which the karmic maturation is evidently experienced.

"Here, the ceasing of the final consciousness is counted as what is called death. The arising of the first consciousness is called birth. Great King, thus no phenomenon at all passes from this world to the next world, and yet death and birth do appear. Great King, when that final consciousness arises, it comes from nowhere, and when it ceases, it goes nowhere. When those actions arise, they come from nowhere, and when they cease, they go nowhere. When that first consciousness arises, it comes from nowhere, and when it ceases, it goes nowhere. Why is that? Because they have no essential nature. The final consciousness is empty of the final consciousness. Action is empty of action. The first consciousness is empty of the first consciousness. Death is empty of death. Birth is empty of birth. And yet actions do not become fruitless, and the experience of karmic maturation does appear. Yet apart from mere names and conventions, there is no agent and no experiencer at all.

"Great King, suppose, for example, that a man asleep dreams that he is fighting with an enemy, and that when he wakes from sleep he remembers just that. Great King, what do you think of that? Does that enemy he dreamed of in the dream, or the fight with that enemy, exist?"

He replied, "Blessed One, it does not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, what do you think of this? Would a man who is fixated on the enemy in the dream, or who fights with that enemy, be of a wise disposition?"

He replied, "Blessed One, he would not. Why is that? Blessed One, even the enemy seen in the dream does not exist at all and cannot be found, so how could there be any fighting with him? Otherwise, the man who is fixated on him would be one whose lot is only want and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, the immature ordinary person who lacks learning also becomes fixated on the forms that make him unhappy when he sees them with his eye. Having become fixated, he becomes angry. Having become angry, he becomes hostile. Having become hostile, he performs actions born of aversion: three kinds with the body, four kinds with speech, and three kinds with the mind. Yet the action so performed is, from the very first, exhausted, ceased, gone, and transformed. It does not abide in the east, nor does it abide in the south, the west, the north, below, above, or the intermediate directions. It is not here, it is not there, and it is not in between. Then, at another time, when the time of death draws near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is wholly exhausted, and the actions that share its lot are also exhausted. When the final consciousness ceases, that action appears to the mind as an object, just as the enemy fought in a dream appears to one who has woken from sleep.

"Great King, then, through two conditions, the force of the final consciousness and that action which has become its object, the first consciousness belonging to the birth arises, and it is counted as 'being born.' Immediately after that first consciousness ceases, there arises without interruption a mental continuum of similar kind in which the karmic maturation is evidently experienced. Here, the cessation of the final consciousness is counted as 'death,' and the arising of the first consciousness is called 'birth.' Thus, Great King, no phenomenon whatsoever passes from this world to the world beyond, and yet death and birth are evident.

"Great King, when that final consciousness arises, it does not come from anywhere, and when it ceases, it does not go anywhere. That action, that birth, and that first consciousness belonging to the birth likewise do not come from anywhere when they arise, and do not go anywhere when they cease. Why is that? Because they lack any essential nature. The final consciousness is empty of all consciousness; the first consciousness is empty of the first consciousness; action is empty of action; death is empty of death; and birth is empty of birth. Yet actions do not go without results, and the experience of karmic maturation is evident. Even so, apart from the conventions of names, there is no agent and no one who experiences."

The thirteenth section.

"Great King, suppose, for example, that a man, while asleep, dreams that he is seized by a demon, and he becomes utterly bewildered with fear. Then, on waking from sleep, he remembers that demon and his utter bewilderment. Great King, what do you think? Do the demon seen in the dream and that utter bewilderment exist?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, they do not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, what do you think? In that case, is the man who is fixated on the demon seen in the dream and utterly bewildered by it someone of wise disposition?"

He replied, "Blessed One, he is not. And why? Blessed One, since the dream demon does not exist at all, how could there be utter bewilderment? Otherwise, the man who is fixated on it will become one whose lot is only distress and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, the immature ordinary person who lacks learning also becomes fixated on the forms toward which he feels equanimity when he sees them with his eye. Through that fixation he becomes utterly bewildered. Having become utterly bewildered, he becomes thoroughly afflicted. Having become thoroughly afflicted, he performs actions born of delusion: three kinds with the body, four kinds with speech, and three kinds with the mind. Yet the action so performed is, from the very first, exhausted, ceased, gone, and transformed. It does not abide in the east, nor does it abide in the south, the west, the north, below, above, or the intermediate directions. It is not here, it is not there, and it is not in between. Then, at another time, when the time of death draws near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is wholly exhausted, and the actions that share its lot are also exhausted. When the final consciousness ceases, that action appears to the mind as an object, just as the demon and the utter bewilderment appear to one who has woken from sleep.

"Great King, then, through two conditions, the force of the final consciousness and the action that has become its object, the first consciousness belonging to the birth arises. Immediately after that first consciousness ceases, there arises without interruption a mental continuum of similar kind in which the karmic maturation is evidently experienced. Here, the cessation of the final consciousness is counted as 'death,' and the arising of the first consciousness

is called 'birth.' Thus, Great King, no phenomenon whatsoever passes from this world to the world beyond, and yet death and birth are evident.

"Great King, when that final consciousness arises, it does not come from anywhere, and when it ceases, it does not go anywhere. That action also does not come from anywhere when it arises, and does not go anywhere when it ceases. That first consciousness also does not come from anywhere when it arises, and does not go anywhere when it ceases. Why is that? Because they lack any essential nature. The final consciousness is empty of the final consciousness; action is empty of action; the first consciousness is empty of the first consciousness; death is empty of death; and birth is empty of birth. Yet it is evident that actions do not go without results, and the experience of karmic maturation is also evident. Even so, apart from mere conventions of names, there is no agent and no one who experiences."

"Great King, it is like this. Suppose, for example, that a man asleep dreams that he hears the sweet song of the fairest woman in the land as she sings, and the sweet sound of her playing the lute, and he dreams that he enjoys that song and music. Then, waking from sleep, he remembers that very song and music. Great King, what do you think of that? Do the fairest woman in the land, the song, and the sound of music seen in the dream exist?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, they do not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, then would the man who clings to the fairest woman in the land, the song, and the sound of music seen in the dream be of a wise disposition?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, he would not. Why is that? The fairest woman in the land seen in the dream does not exist at all and cannot be found. How then could the sound of her song and music exist? Were it otherwise, the man who clings to them would be one whose lot is frustration and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, the childish, ordinary person without learning, hearing sounds with the ear, clings to those that are pleasing. Clinging to them, he becomes attached. Having become attached, he becomes utterly enamored. Having become utterly enamored, he performs karma born of desire: three kinds with the body, four kinds with speech, and three kinds with the mind. And that karma, once performed, is from the very outset exhausted, ceased, departed, and transformed. It does not abide resting in the east. It does not abide resting in the south, the west, the north, below, above, or the intermediate directions. It is not here, not beyond, and

not in between. Yet at another time, when the hour of death draws near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is fully exhausted, and the karmas that share its lot are exhausted too. Then, as the last consciousness ceases, that karma appears to the mind as its object, just as the song and music of the fairest woman in the land appear to one who has woken from sleep.

"Great King, then, through two conditions, the dominance of the last consciousness and that karma as its object, the first consciousness belonging to rebirth arises. Immediately upon the cessation of that first consciousness belonging to rebirth, there arises a mind-stream of corresponding kind, in which the experiencing of maturation becomes evident.

"Here, the ceasing of the last consciousness is reckoned as what is called death and transference, and the arising of the first consciousness is called birth. Great King, thus no phenomenon whatsoever transfers from this world to the world beyond, and yet death and transference and birth are evident. Great King, when the last consciousness arises, it comes from nowhere, and when it ceases, it goes nowhere. When that karma arises, it comes from nowhere, and when it ceases, it goes nowhere. When the first consciousness arises, it comes from nowhere, and when it ceases, it goes nowhere. Why is that? Because they are empty of intrinsic nature. The last consciousness is empty of the last consciousness. Karma is empty of karma. The first consciousness is empty of the first consciousness. Death and transference are empty of death and transference. Birth is empty of birth. And yet karmas do not go without result, and the experiencing of their maturation is evident too. Yet apart from mere conventional designation, there is no agent and no experiencer whatsoever.

"Great King, it is like this. Suppose, for example, that a man asleep dreams that he is separated from his dead mother, or his dead father, or any loved one whatever, and that, separated from his loved one, he grieves and weeps in distress. Then, waking from sleep, he remembers that separation from his loved one and his weeping in suffering. Great King, what do you think of that? Does that separation from the loved one in the dream exist?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, it does not."

He said, "Great King, then would the person who clings to the separation from the loved one in the dream and to the weeping in suffering be of a wise disposition?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, he would not. Why is that? Blessed One, since even the loved one seen in the dream does not exist at all, how could

separation from them, grieving, weeping, and lamenting exist? Were it otherwise, the man who clings to the separation from the loved one, the suffering, and the weeping seen in the dream would be one whose lot is frustration and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, the childish, ordinary person without learning, hearing sounds with the ear, clings also to those that are displeasing. Clinging to them, he becomes angry. Having become angry, he becomes hostile. Having become hostile, he performs karma born of aversion: three kinds with the body, four kinds with speech, and three kinds with the mind. And that karma, once performed, is from the very outset exhausted, ceased, departed, and transformed. It does not abide resting in the east. It does not abide resting in the south, the west, the north, below, above, or the intermediate directions. It is not here, not beyond, and not in between. Yet at another time, when the hour of death draws near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is fully exhausted, and the karmas that share its lot are exhausted too. Then, as the last consciousness ceases, that karma appears to the mind as its object, just as the separation from the loved one and the weeping in suffering appear to one who has woken from sleep.

Great King, then, by the power of the last consciousness and by that karma as its object, these two conditions, the first consciousness belonging to the portion of birth arises. Immediately after that first consciousness has ceased, without interruption, there arises a mental continuum of similar type, in which the experiencing of the ripening becomes manifest. The ceasing of the last consciousness is reckoned as what is called "death-transition," and the arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as what is called "birth." Thus, Great King, no phenomenon whatsoever transfers from this world to the world beyond, and yet death-transition and birth do manifestly occur.

Great King, the last consciousness, when it arises, comes from nowhere, and when it ceases, goes nowhere. Karma, ripening, and the first consciousness likewise, when they arise, come from nowhere, and when they cease, go nowhere. Why is that? Because they are empty of intrinsic nature. The last consciousness is empty of the intrinsic nature of a last consciousness. Karma, ripening, and the first consciousness are empty of the intrinsic nature of a first consciousness. Death-transition is empty of the intrinsic nature of death-transition. Birth is empty of the intrinsic nature of birth. Saṃsāra too is empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra.

Great King, this emptiness of all phenomena in this way is the gateway to liberation that is emptiness. That which, being emptiness, is empty of signs is the gateway to liberation that is signlessness. Where there are no signs, there is no wishing; this is the gateway to liberation that is wishlessness. Thus, Great King, all phenomena are gateways to liberation: they incline toward nirvāṇa, converge in emptiness, are settled in the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu), and reach to the very limit of the element of space.

Great King, suppose, for example, that a man asleep hears in a dream a sound whose words he does not understand, and that on waking from sleep he remembers that sound. Great King, what do you think? Does that sound heard in the dream exist?

The king replied, "No, Blessed One, it does not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, what do you think? In that case, would one who clings to having heard in a dream a sound whose meaning he did not understand be of a wise disposition?"

The king replied, "No, Blessed One, he would not. And why? Blessed One, if the very sound heard in the dream does not exist at all and cannot be found, how could there be any understanding or not understanding the meaning of its words? Otherwise, the man who clings to it would become one whose lot is only deprivation and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Likewise, Great King, ignorant ordinary beings who lack learning, when they hear sounds with the ear, cling even to those sounds toward which they are indifferent, and having clung, they become utterly confused. Being utterly confused, they perform karma born of delusion: three kinds by body, four kinds by speech, and three kinds by mind. And that karma, once performed, is from the very outset exhausted, ceased, gone, and changed. It does not abide located in the east; it does not abide located in the south, the west, the north, below, above, or the intermediate directions. It is not here, not beyond, and not in between. Rather, at another time, when the time of death draws near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is wholly exhausted, and the karmas of corresponding type are also exhausted; then, as the last consciousness ceases, that karma becomes an object of the mind, just like the sound whose words one did not understand, recalled on waking from sleep.

Great King, then, by the power of the last consciousness and by that karma as its object, these two conditions, the first consciousness belonging to the

portion of birth arises. Immediately after that first consciousness has ceased, without interruption, there arises a mental continuum of similar type, in which the experiencing of the ripening becomes manifest. The ceasing of the last consciousness is reckoned as what is called "death-transition," and the arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as what is called "birth." Thus, Great King, no phenomenon whatsoever transfers from this world to the world beyond, and yet death-transition and birth do manifestly occur.

Great King, the last consciousness, when it arises, comes from nowhere, and when it ceases, goes nowhere. Karma, ripening, and the first consciousness likewise, when they arise, come from nowhere, and when they cease, go nowhere. Why is that? Because they lack essential nature. The last consciousness is empty of the intrinsic nature of a last consciousness. Karma is empty of the intrinsic nature of karma. Ripening is empty of the intrinsic nature of ripening. The first consciousness is empty of the intrinsic nature of a first consciousness. Death-transition and birth are empty of the intrinsic nature of death-transition and birth. Saṃsāra is empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra. And yet karmas are not wasted, and the experiencing of their ripening does manifestly occur. Yet in this, apart from mere conventional designations by name, there is no agent or experiencer whatsoever.

Great King, suppose, for example, that a man asleep dreams that he anoints his body with sandalwood, or tamāla leaves, or any other kind of fragrance, and that on waking from sleep he remembers that sandalwood, or those tamāla leaves, or whatever other kind of fragrance it was. Great King, what do you think? Do the sandalwood, the tamāla leaves, or whatever other kind of fragrance he saw in the dream exist?"

The king replied, "No, Blessed One, they do not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, what do you think? In that case, would one who clings to the sandalwood, the tamāla leaves, or whatever kind of fragrance he saw in the dream, and to having anointed his body with them, be of a wise disposition?"

The king replied, "No, Blessed One, he would not. And why? Blessed One, if the dream sandalwood, tamāla leaves, or whatever kind of fragrance it was do not exist at all and cannot be found, how could there be any anointing with them? Otherwise, the man who clings to it would become one whose lot is only deprivation and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, when childish, unlearned ordinary people smell odors with the nose, they become fixated on those that please the mind. Being fixated, they become attached. Having become attached, they become thoroughly infatuated. Having become thoroughly infatuated, they perform karma born of desire: three kinds with the body, four kinds with speech, and three kinds with the mind. Yet the karma so performed is, from the very first, exhausted, ceased, gone, and transformed. It does not abide resting in the east. It does not abide resting in the south, the west, the north, below, above, or the intermediate directions. It is not here, it is not beyond, and it is not anywhere in between.

"At another time, when the hour of death is near and its moment has arrived, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is wholly exhausted, and the karma that sustained it is also exhausted. Then, when the last consciousness ceases, that karma appears to the mind as an object, just as sandalwood, or tamāla leaves, or any other kind of fragrance appears to one who has awakened from sleep. Great King, there, through two conditions, the last consciousness as the dominant condition and that karma as the object, the first consciousness belonging to the side of birth arises. Immediately after that first consciousness ceases, there arises without interruption a continuum of mind of similar kind, in which the experience of karmic maturation becomes manifest.

"In this, the cessation of the last consciousness is reckoned as what is called death, and the arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as what is called birth. Thus, Great King, there is no phenomenon whatsoever that passes from this world to the world beyond, and yet death and birth do appear. Great King, when the last consciousness arises, it comes from nowhere, and when it ceases, it goes nowhere. Karma, karmic maturation, and the first consciousness, too, when they arise, come from nowhere, and when they cease, go nowhere. Why is that? Because they have no essential nature. The last consciousness is empty of the intrinsic nature of a last consciousness. Karma is empty of the intrinsic nature of karma. Karmic maturation is empty of the intrinsic nature of karmic maturation. The first consciousness is empty of the intrinsic nature of a first consciousness. Death and birth are empty of the intrinsic nature of death and birth. Saṃsāra is empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra. And yet karma is not lost, and the experience of karmic maturation does appear. In this there is no agent and no experiencer whatsoever, apart from mere names and conventions.

"Great King, suppose, for example, that a man asleep dreamed that the corpse of a dog, or the corpse of a human, or the corpse of a snake had been hung around his neck, and that when he awoke from sleep he remembered it. Great King, what do you think of that? Do those corpses of a dog, a human, and a snake in the dream exist?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, they do not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, then would a man who is fixated on the corpses of a dog, a human, and a snake hung around his neck in a dream be of a wise disposition?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, he would not. Why is that? Blessed One, since the very corpses of a dog, a human, or a snake seen in the dream do not exist at all and cannot be apprehended, how could there be their being hung around his neck? Rather, the man who is fixated on that would only reap weariness and exhaustion."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, when childish, unlearned ordinary people smell odors with the nose, they become fixated on those that are unpleasing to the mind as well. Being fixated, they become angry. Having become angry, they become hostile. Having become hostile, they perform karma born of aversion: three kinds with the body, four kinds with speech, and three kinds with the mind. Yet the karma so performed is, from the very first, exhausted, ceased, gone, and transformed. It does not abide resting in the east. It does not abide resting in the south, the west, the north, below, above, or the intermediate directions. It is not here, it is not beyond, and it is not anywhere in between.

"At another time, when the hour of death is near and its moment has arrived, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is wholly exhausted, and the karma that sustained it is also exhausted. Then, when the last consciousness ceases, that karma appears to the mind as an object, just as the corpses of a dog, a human, and a snake appear to one who has awakened from sleep. Great King, there, through two conditions, the last consciousness as the dominant condition and that karma as the object, the first consciousness belonging to the side of birth arises. Immediately after that first consciousness ceases, there arises without interruption a continuum of mind of similar kind, in which the experience of karmic maturation becomes manifest.

"In this, the cessation of the last consciousness is reckoned as what is called death, and the arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as what is called

birth. Thus, Great King, there is no phenomenon whatsoever that passes from this world to the world beyond, and yet death and birth do appear. Great King, in this, when the last consciousness arises, it comes from nowhere, and when it ceases, it goes nowhere. Karma, karmic maturation, and the first consciousness, too, when they arise, come from nowhere, and when they cease, go nowhere. Why is that? Because they are empty of intrinsic nature: from the last consciousness being empty of the intrinsic nature of a last consciousness, up to saṃsāra being empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra. That is emptiness, the door of liberation. What is empty of intrinsic nature and nonexistent is signlessness. What is signless is wishlessness. Great King, thus all phenomena are doors of liberation: inclining toward nirvāṇa, converging in emptiness, certain within the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu), and extending to the limits of the realm of space."

"Great king, suppose, for example, that a man asleep dreams that his own sense of smell has been damaged. On waking from sleep he remembers that very damage to his sense of smell. Great king, what do you think of that? Does the damaged sense of smell he saw in the dream exist?"

The king replied, "No, Blessed One, it does not."

The Blessed One said, "Great king, what do you think of that? In that case, would someone who clings to the damaged sense of smell in the dream be wise by nature?"

The king replied, "No, Blessed One, he would not. Why is that? Blessed One, the sense of smell seen in the dream does not exist at all and cannot be found, so how could its damage exist? Otherwise, a man who clings to it would only be destined for want and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great king, in the same way the unlearned, foolish ordinary person also clings to those smells that produce equanimity when the nose senses them. Having clung to them, he becomes utterly confused. Being utterly confused, he forms karma born of delusion: three kinds by body, four kinds by speech, and three kinds by mind. And the karma he has formed is exhausted, ceases, departs, and changes. It does not abide resting in the east, and so on up to: it is not here, it is not there, it is not in between.

"Then at another time, when the time and moment of death draw near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is wholly exhausted, and the karma that corresponds to it is also exhausted. As the final consciousness ceases, the mind takes that karma as its object, just as a man who has woken from sleep

recalls the damaged sense of smell.

"Great king, from two conditions, the final consciousness as the dominant condition and that karma as the object, there arises the first consciousness belonging to rebirth. Immediately after that first consciousness ceases, without any interval, there arises the corresponding stream of mind in which the experience of the karmic ripening becomes manifest.

"Here, the ceasing of the final consciousness is reckoned as death, and the arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as birth. Thus, great king, no phenomenon whatsoever passes from this world to the next world, and yet death and birth do appear.

"Great king, when that final consciousness arises, it does not come from anywhere, and when it ceases, it does not go anywhere. Karma, karmic ripening, and the first consciousness likewise do not come from anywhere when they arise, and do not go anywhere when they cease. Why is that? Because they lack essential nature. The final consciousness is empty of final consciousness, and so on up to: saṃsāra is empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra. Karma is not wasted, and the experience of karmic ripening does appear. Yet apart from mere conventional names, there is no agent and no experiencer whatsoever.

"Great king, suppose, for example, that a man asleep is hungry and dreams that he eats his fill of food with a hundred flavors. On waking from sleep he remembers that very thing. Great king, what do you think of that? Does the food of a hundred flavors he saw in the dream exist?"

The king replied, "No, Blessed One, it does not."

The Blessed One said, "Great king, what do you think of that? In that case, would someone who clings to the food of a hundred flavors seen in the dream be wise by nature?"

The king replied, "No, Blessed One, he would not. Why is that? Blessed One, the dream food of a hundred flavors does not exist at all and cannot be found, so how could he possibly enjoy it? Otherwise, a man who clings to it would only be destined for want and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great king, in the same way the unlearned, foolish ordinary person also clings to those flavors that produce mental pleasure when the tongue tastes them. Clinging to them, he becomes attached. Having become attached, he becomes thoroughly attached. Having become

thoroughly attached, he forms karma born of desire: three kinds by body, four kinds by speech, and three kinds by mind. And the karma he has formed is, from the very first, exhausted, ceases, departs, and changes. It does not abide resting in the east, and so on up to: it is not here, it is not there, it is not in between.

"Then at another time, when the time and moment of death draw near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is wholly exhausted, and the karma that corresponds to it is also exhausted. As the final consciousness ceases, the mind takes that karma as its object, just as a man who has woken from sleep recalls the food of a hundred flavors.

"Great king, from two conditions, the final consciousness as the dominant condition and that karma as the object, there arises the first consciousness belonging to rebirth. Immediately after that first consciousness ceases, without any interval, there arises the corresponding stream of mind in which the experience of the karmic ripening becomes manifest.

"Here, the ceasing of the final consciousness is reckoned as death, and the arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as birth. Thus, great king, no phenomenon whatsoever passes from this world to the next world, and yet death and birth do appear.

"Great king, when that final consciousness arises, it does not come from anywhere, and when it ceases, it does not go anywhere. Karma, karmic ripening, and the first consciousness likewise do not come from anywhere when they arise, and do not go anywhere when they cease.

Why is that? Because they are empty of essential nature. The last consciousness is empty of the intrinsic nature of a last consciousness, and so on, up to: saṃsāra is empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra. Yet actions are not wasted, and the experience of their ripening is evident as well. There, apart from mere conventional designation, there is no agent at all, and no one who partakes of the result.

Great King, it is like this. Suppose a man, asleep, dreams that he has become extremely hungry and has eaten the seed of a bitter gourd, or the seed of a kośātakī, or a neem seed, and on waking from sleep he remembers that very thing. Great King, what do you think of that? Do the bitter gourd and the other seeds, up to the neem seed, of the dream exist?

The king replied, "Blessed One, they do not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, then is the person who clings to having eaten the bitter gourd and the other seeds, up to the neem seed, of the dream someone of a wise nature?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, he is not. Why is that? Blessed One, if the bitter gourd and the other seeds, up to the neem seed, seen in the dream do not exist at all and cannot be apprehended, how could there be any eating of them? Otherwise, the man who clings to it would merely become one whose lot is privation and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, when the tongue of a childish ordinary person who has not heard the teaching experiences tastes, he clings even to those that are disagreeable. Having clung, he becomes angry. Having become angry, he feels aversion. Having felt aversion, he performs actions born of aversion: three kinds by body, four kinds by speech, and three kinds by mind. And the action so performed is, from the very first, exhausted, ceased, gone apart, and transformed. It does not abide resting in the eastern direction, and so on, up to: it is not here, it is not beyond, it is not in between. At another time, when the time of death and the term of life draw near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is wholly exhausted, and the actions of corresponding share are also exhausted. Then, at the moment the last consciousness ceases, the action comes to appear as an object to the mind, just as the bitter gourd and the other seeds, up to the neem seed, eaten in sleep appear to one who has woken.

"Great King, there, through two conditions, the dominance of the last consciousness and that action as its object, the first consciousness belonging to the portion of birth arises. Immediately upon the cessation of that first consciousness, without interruption, there arises a mental continuum of corresponding kind, in which the experience of ripening becomes evident. There, the ceasing of the last consciousness is reckoned as what is called death and transmigration; the arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as what is called birth. Thus, Great King, no phenomenon whatsoever passes from this world to the world beyond, and yet death, transmigration, and birth are evident.

"Great King, there, when the last consciousness arises, it does not come from anywhere, and when it ceases, it does not go anywhere. Action, ripening, and the first consciousness, when they arise, do not come from anywhere, and when they cease, they do not go anywhere. Why is that? Because they are

empty of intrinsic nature. The last consciousness is empty of the intrinsic nature of a last consciousness, and so on, up to: saṃsāra is empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra.

"Great King, thus this emptiness of all phenomena is the door of liberation that is emptiness. That which is empty of the sign of emptiness is the door of liberation that is signlessness. Where there is no sign, there is no wish; this is the door of liberation that is wishlessness. Great King, thus all phenomena are doors of liberation: inclining toward nirvāṇa, converging in emptiness, certain in the dharmadhātu, reaching to the limits of the element of space.

"Great King, it is like this. Suppose a man, asleep, dreams that his own tongue faculty has been impaired, and on waking from sleep he remembers that very impairment of the tongue faculty. Great King, what do you think of that? Does the impairment of the tongue faculty seen in the dream exist?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, it does not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, what do you think of that? Then is someone who clings to the impairment of the tongue faculty in the dream someone of a wise nature?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, he is not. Why is that? Blessed One, if even the tongue faculty seen in the dream does not exist at all and cannot be apprehended, how could there be any impairment of it? Otherwise, the man who clings to it would merely become one whose lot is privation and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, when the tongue of a childish ordinary person who has not heard the teaching experiences tastes, he clings even to those that are neutral. Having clung, he becomes utterly bewildered. Having become utterly bewildered, he performs actions born of delusion: three kinds by body, four kinds by speech, and three kinds by mind. And the action so performed is, from the very first, exhausted, ceased, gone apart, and transformed. It does not abide resting in the eastern direction, and so on, up to: it is not here, it is not beyond, it is not in between. At another time, when the time of death and the term of life draw near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is wholly exhausted, and the actions of corresponding share are also exhausted. Then, at the moment the last consciousness ceases, the action comes to appear as an object to the mind, just as the impairment of the tongue faculty in sleep appears to one who has woken.

Great King, from these two conditions, the dominant influence of the final consciousness and that karma which is its object, the first consciousness, the one that belongs to the portion of birth, arises. Immediately after that first consciousness ceases, without interruption, a mind-stream of similar kind arises, in which the experience of the karmic maturation becomes manifest. The ceasing of the final consciousness is reckoned as "death and transmigration," and the arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as "birth." Great King, in this way no phenomenon whatsoever passes from this world to the world beyond, and yet death, transmigration and birth do appear. Great King, from the final consciousness up to the first consciousness, when they arise they do not come from anywhere, and when they cease they do not go anywhere. Why is that? Because they are empty of intrinsic nature. The final consciousness is empty of final consciousness, and so on up to: saṃsāra is empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra. Actions are not wasted, and the experience of their maturation does appear, yet apart from mere conventional designation there is no agent and no experiencer at all.

Great King, suppose, for example, that a man asleep dreams that he holds the most beautiful woman in the land in his embrace. Having experienced her touch, he wakes from sleep and remembers that very beautiful woman. Great King, what do you think of that? Does that touch of the most beautiful woman of the land, seen in the dream, exist?

The king replied, "Blessed One, it does not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, what do you think of this? Would that man who clings to the touch of the most beautiful woman of the land seen in the dream be one whose nature is wise?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, he would not. And why? Blessed One, since that very beautiful woman of the dream does not exist at all and cannot be found, how could there be any touch of her?"

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, the childish, uninstructed ordinary person, when his body meets tangible objects, clings to those that are pleasing to the mind. Clinging to them, he becomes attached. Having become attached, he becomes thoroughly attached. Having become thoroughly attached, he performs actions born of desire: three kinds with the body, four with speech, and three with the mind. And those actions he has performed are, from the very beginning, exhausted, ceased, departed and changed. They do not rest and abide in the eastern direction, and so on up to: they are not here,

not over there, and not in between. Then, at another time, when the time and moment of death draw near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is entirely exhausted, and the actions of similar kind are also exhausted. When the final consciousness is ceasing, the mind takes those actions as its object, just as a man who has woken from sleep recalls the touch of the most beautiful woman of the land.

"Great King, from these two conditions, the dominant influence of the final consciousness and that karma which is its object, the first consciousness, the one that belongs to the portion of birth, arises. Immediately after that first consciousness belonging to the portion of birth ceases, without interruption, a mind-stream of similar kind arises, in which the experience of the karmic maturation becomes manifest. The ceasing of the final consciousness is reckoned as 'death and transmigration,' and the arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as 'birth.' Great King, in this way no phenomenon whatsoever passes from this world to the world beyond, and yet death, transmigration and birth do appear. Great King, from the final consciousness up to the first consciousness, when they arise they do not come from anywhere, and when they cease they do not go anywhere. Why is that? Because they are empty of intrinsic nature. Actions are not wasted, and the experience of their maturation does appear, yet apart from mere conventional designation there is no agent and no experiencer at all.

"Great King, suppose, for example, that a man asleep dreams that he holds a blazing sheet of copper in his embrace, and that, waking from sleep, he remembers it. Great King, what do you think of that? Is there any touch of the blazing copper sheet of the dream?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, there is not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, then would the person who clings to embracing the blazing copper sheet of the dream be one whose nature is wise?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, he would not. And why? Blessed One, since the blazing copper sheet seen in the dream does not exist at all and cannot be found, how could there be any touch of it? Otherwise, the man who clings to it would be destined for distress and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, the childish, uninstructed ordinary person, when his body meets tangible objects, also clings to those that are unpleasing to the mind. Clinging to them, he becomes angry. Having

become angry, he becomes hostile. Having become hostile, he performs actions born of aversion: three kinds with the body, four with speech, and three with the mind. And those actions he has performed are, from the very beginning, exhausted, ceased, departed and changed. They do not rest and abide in the eastern direction, and so on up to: they are not here, not over there, and not in between. Then, at another time, when the time and moment of death draw near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is entirely exhausted, and the actions of similar kind are also exhausted. When the final consciousness is ceasing, the mind takes those actions as its object, just as a man who has woken from sleep recalls the blazing sheet of copper."

"Great King, then, by two conditions, the force of the final consciousness and that action taken as its object, the first consciousness belonging to the portion of birth arises. Immediately after that first consciousness has ceased, there arises without interruption a mental continuum of similar kind, in which the karmic maturation comes to be manifestly experienced.

Here, the ceasing of the final consciousness is reckoned as what is called 'death-transference.' The arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as what is called 'birth.' Great King, in this way no phenomenon whatsoever transfers from this world to the world beyond, and yet death-transference and birth do appear. From the final consciousness to the first consciousness, when it arises it comes from nowhere at all, and when it ceases it goes nowhere at all. Why is that? Because it is empty of intrinsic nature. The final consciousness is empty of the intrinsic nature of the final consciousness, and so on up to: saṃsāra too is empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra.

Great King, in this way this emptiness of all phenomena is the door of liberation that is emptiness. That which is empty of the sign of emptiness is the door of liberation that is signlessness. Where there is no sign, there is no wishing; this is the door of liberation that is wishlessness. Great King, in this way all phenomena are doors of liberation: they incline toward nirvāṇa, they converge completely in emptiness, they are certain in the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu), and they reach to the limit of the element of space.

Great King, suppose, for example, a man, sleeping, dreamed that the faculty of his own body had been impaired, and on waking from sleep he remembered it. Great King, what do you think? Does that impaired bodily faculty seen in the dream exist?"

He replied, "Blessed One, it does not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, what do you think? Then is one who clings to the impaired bodily faculty in the dream of a wise nature?"

He replied, "No, Blessed One, he is not. Why is that? Blessed One, since the very bodily faculty seen in the dream does not exist at all and is not apprehended, how could its impairment exist?"

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, the childish ordinary person who has not heard the teaching, when touching tangible objects with the body, clings even to those that give rise to equanimity, and having clung, becomes utterly bewildered. Being utterly bewildered, he forms actions born of delusion: three with the body, four with speech, and three with the mind. And those actions he has formed are, from the very beginning, exhausted, ceased, departed and changed. They do not rest and abide in the eastern direction, and so on up to: they are not here, not over there, and not in between. Then, at another time, when the time and moment of death draw near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is entirely exhausted, and the actions of similar kind are also exhausted. When the final consciousness is ceasing, the mind takes those actions as its object, just as a man who has woken from sleep recalls the impaired bodily faculty.

Great King, then, by two conditions, the force of the final consciousness and that action taken as its object, the first consciousness belonging to the portion of birth arises. Immediately after that first consciousness has ceased, there arises without interruption a mental continuum of similar kind, in which the karmic maturation comes to be manifestly experienced.

Here, the ceasing of the final consciousness is reckoned as what is called 'death-transference.' The arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as what is called 'birth.' Great King, in this way no phenomenon whatsoever transfers from this world to the world beyond, and yet death-transference and birth do appear. Great King, from that final consciousness to the first consciousness, when it arises it comes from nowhere at all, and when it ceases it goes nowhere at all. Why is that? Because it is empty of essential nature. The final consciousness is empty of the final consciousness, and so on up to: saṃsāra is empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra. Yet actions are not wasted, and the experiencing of their maturation also appears. But in this there is no agent or experiencer whatsoever, apart from mere conventional designations of names.

The fourteenth fascicle.

Great King, suppose, for example, a man, sleeping, dreamed that he was endowed with the five qualities of sensual pleasure conjured by a master magician, and that he enjoyed them to complete satisfaction, and on waking from sleep he remembered those qualities of sensual pleasure. Great King, what do you think? Do those five qualities of sensual pleasure seen in the dream, conjured by the master magician, exist?"

He replied, "Blessed One, they do not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, what do you think? Then is one who clings to those five qualities of sensual pleasure seen in the dream, conjured by the master magician, of a wise nature?"

He replied, "No, Blessed One, he is not. Why is that? Blessed One, since the very magician of the dream does not exist at all and is not apprehended, how could those five conjured qualities of sensual pleasure and the enjoyment of them exist? On the contrary, the man who clings to them becomes one whose lot is want and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, the childish ordinary person who has not heard the teaching, when cognizing mental objects with the mind, clings to those that give rise to mental pleasure. Through that clinging he becomes attached. Having become attached, he becomes thoroughly attached. Having become thoroughly attached, he forms actions born of desire: three with the body, four with speech, and three with the mind. And those actions he has formed are, from the very beginning, exhausted, ceased, departed and changed. They do not rest and abide in the eastern direction, and so on up to: they are not here, not over there, and not in between. Then, at another time, when the time and moment of death draw near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is entirely exhausted, and the actions of similar kind are also exhausted. When the final consciousness is ceasing, the mind takes those actions as its object, just as a man who has woken from sleep recalls the five qualities of sensual pleasure conjured by the magician.

"Great King, then, by two conditions, the power of the final consciousness and the karma that has become its object, the first consciousness, which belongs to the portion of birth, arises. It arises either among the hell beings, or in the animal realm, or in the world of Yama, or among the classes of the asuras, or among humans, or among the gods. Immediately after that first consciousness has ceased, without interruption, there arises a mental continuum of similar type, in which the ripening is manifestly experienced.

"Great King, in this way karma is observed and its ripening is also observed, yet apart from a mere conventional designation by name there is no one at all who experiences it. Great King, the cessation of the final consciousness is reckoned as what is called 'death and transmigration.' The arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as what is called 'birth.' Great King, in this way no phenomenon whatsoever passes over from this world to the world beyond, and yet death, transmigration and birth do manifestly occur.

"Great King, from that final consciousness up to the first consciousness, when it arises it does not come from anywhere, and when it ceases it does not go anywhere. Why is that? Because it is empty of essential nature. The final consciousness is empty of final consciousness, and so on up to saṃsāra, which is empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra. Nirvāṇa too is empty of the intrinsic nature of nirvāṇa. All phenomena too are empty of the intrinsic nature of all phenomena. Great King, this emptiness of all phenomena is the door of liberation that is emptiness. What is empty of the sign of emptiness is signlessness. Where there is no sign, there is no wishing, and this is wishlessness. Great King, in this way all phenomena are doors of liberation: they fully converge in emptiness, have signlessness as their essential nature, are free of wishing, incline toward nirvāṇa, are certain within the dharmadhātu, and reach to the limits of the element of space.

"Great King, it is like this. Suppose a man, while asleep, dreamt that he and his attendants were carried away by a great river, and that he experienced there many kinds of suffering and unhappiness arising from the mind. Then, waking from sleep, he remembered it. Great King, what do you think? Does that great river of the dream exist?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, it does not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, what do you think? In that case, is the person who, in a dream, clings to seeing himself carried off by a great river and to his suffering and unhappiness someone of a wise nature?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, he is not. Why is that? Blessed One, if in the dream the great river itself, whose water carried that man away, does not exist at all and cannot be observed, how could his suffering and unhappiness exist? Otherwise, the man who clings to it would merely be one fated to weariness and exhaustion."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, the childish ordinary person who has not heard the teaching, when he cognizes phenomena with the mind, clings even to those things that bring unhappiness. Having clung, he becomes angry. Having become angry, he becomes malicious. Having become malicious, he becomes hateful. Having become hateful, he performs actions born of aversion: three kinds with the body, four kinds with speech, and three kinds with the mind. And the action thus performed is, from the very first, exhausted, ceased, separated and transformed. It does not abide supported in the east, and so on in the other directions; it is not here, not beyond, and not in between.

"At another time, when the time of death draws near and the hour is close, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is exhausted, and the actions of similar type are also exhausted. Then, when the final consciousness ceases, just as one who wakes from sleep recalls being carried away by the great river and his unhappiness, the mind takes that karma as its object. Great King, then, by two conditions, the power of the final consciousness and the karma that has become its object, the first consciousness, which belongs to the portion of birth, arises. Immediately after that first consciousness has ceased, without interruption, there arises a mental continuum of similar type, in which the ripening is manifestly experienced.

"Great King, in this way karma is observed, yet there is no agent at all. The ripening is observed, yet apart from a mere conventional designation by name there is no one at all here who experiences it. Great King, the cessation of the final consciousness is reckoned as what is called 'death and transmigration.' The arising of the first consciousness is reckoned as what is called 'birth.' Great King, in this way no phenomenon whatsoever passes over from this world to the world beyond, and yet death, transmigration and birth do manifestly occur.

"Great King, from that final consciousness up to the first consciousness, when it arises it does not come from anywhere, and when it ceases it does not go anywhere. Why is that? Because it is empty of essential nature. The final consciousness is empty of the intrinsic nature of final consciousness, and so on up to saṃsāra, which is empty of the intrinsic nature of saṃsāra. Nirvāṇa too is empty of the intrinsic nature of nirvāṇa. All phenomena too are empty of the intrinsic nature of all phenomena. This is the door of liberation that is emptiness. What is empty of the sign of emptiness is the door of liberation that is signlessness. Where there is no sign, there is no wishing, and this is the door

of liberation that is wishlessness. Great King, in this way all phenomena are doors of liberation: they fully converge in emptiness, have signlessness as their essential nature, are free of wishing, incline toward nirvāṇa, are certain within the dharmadhātu, and reach to the limits of the element of space."

Great King, suppose, for example, that a man asleep dreams that he is drunk on liquor and has become utterly deluded. In that state he does not know virtue, he does not know non-virtue, he does not know what is blameworthy, he does not know what is blameless, he does not know what helps, he does not know what harms, and he does not know good qualities or faults in any way at all. Then, when he wakes from sleep, he remembers that drunken delusion. Great King, what do you think of that? Does the drunkenness and delusion seen in the dream exist?

The king replied, "Blessed One, it does not."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, what do you think of that? Then is the man who clings to the drunkenness of the dream someone of a wise nature?"

The king replied, "Blessed One, he is not. And why is that? Blessed One, if even the liquor seen in the dream does not exist at all and cannot be found, how much less could there be delusion? Otherwise, the man who clings to it would be one whose lot is deprivation and weariness."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, in the same way, childish ordinary beings who are without learning, when they cognize phenomena with the mind, come to cling even to those phenomena that are neutral. Having clung to them, they become utterly bewildered. Having become utterly bewildered, they perform actions born of delusion: three kinds by body, four kinds by speech, and three kinds by mind. And the action so performed is, from its very first moment, exhausted, ceased, separated, and transformed. It does not abide, resting in the east, and so on, up to: it is not here, it is not in the beyond, and it is not in between.

At another time, when the time of death is near, the life faculty ceases, the lifespan is exhausted, and the actions of like fortune with it are also exhausted. Then, when the last consciousness ceases, the mind apprehends that action, just as someone who has woken from sleep recalls the drunken delusion.

Great King, then, by two conditions, the force of the last consciousness and that apprehended action, the first consciousness arises among the destinies.

Immediately after that first consciousness ceases, without interruption, there arises a continuum of mind of like fortune, in which the maturation will be manifestly experienced.

Great King, thus action is apprehended, yet there is no agent whatsoever. Maturation too is apprehended, yet apart from mere conventional designation by name, there is no one at all here who experiences it.

Great King, the ceasing of the last consciousness is what is reckoned as death. The arising of the first consciousness is what is reckoned as birth. Great King, thus there is no phenomenon whatsoever that passes from this world to the next world, and yet death and birth are evident.

Great King, when the last consciousness arises, it comes from nowhere at all, and when it ceases, it goes nowhere at all. Action, maturation, death, birth, and the first consciousness, when they arise, come from nowhere at all, and when they cease, go nowhere at all. Why is that? Because they are empty of essential nature. The last consciousness is empty of the intrinsic nature of the last consciousness. Likewise birth, destruction, action, maturation, the first consciousness, death, birth, and saṃsāra; and nirvāṇa is empty of the intrinsic nature of nirvāṇa. All phenomena too are empty of the intrinsic nature of all phenomena. This is the door of liberation that is emptiness. That which is empty of the sign of emptiness is the door of liberation that is signlessness. Where there is no sign, there is no wish: this is the door of liberation that is wishlessness.

Great King, thus all phenomena are doors of liberation: converging in emptiness, of the essential nature of signlessness, free from aspiration, inclined toward nirvāṇa, determined as the realm of phenomena (dharmadhātu), reaching to the limits of the element of space.

Great King, you should settle your mind firmly on this, and strive at settling your mind firmly. Do not depend on others; you should understand it by yourself. This is the awakening of the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, the future, and the present. It utterly destroys all clinging to sovereignty, completely dries up all craving, crushes all pride, and cuts off entirely every kind of view and all doubt. It is the sameness of all phenomena, which is not for childish ordinary beings, is not reached by the śrāvakas, and is not the domain of the pratyekabuddhas. It is the conduct of the bodhisattvas, and is realized by the perfectly awakened buddhas.

Great King, you should set your mind on this, thinking: 'How shall I become the eye of the world with its gods, its lamp, its light, its illumination, its boat, its shore, its landing place, its guide, its leader, its teacher, its caravan leader, and its forerunner?' And thinking: 'Having been freed, I shall free others. Having crossed over, I shall carry others across. Having found relief, I shall bring others relief. Having passed completely into nirvāṇa, I shall bring others completely into nirvāṇa.'

Great King, as for sovereignty, not even the limit of what has been experienced in the past can be discerned. Great King, thus the senses are like an illusion: they never know contentment and cannot be satisfied. Sense objects are like a dream: they are incapable of satisfying and never bring fulfillment.

Great King, long ago, in times past, there lived a king called Anantayaśas. Great King, that king Anantayaśas had palanquins, armies, and mounts without limit, and he ruled with an unobstructed wheel. He possessed an unshakable vehicle and perfect conduct. He had developed roots of virtue under former buddhas and possessed the power of having his wishes fulfilled: whatever he thought of, all of it was accomplished for him, and not one of his intentions was ever in vain.

In this way, by the splendor of his own roots of virtue, whatever that king intended came about just as he wished, and nothing was ever in vain.

Great King, then King Anantayaśas thought, "I should test whether the power of my merit has diminished." He thought, "Ah! May every tree there is in my world system of four great continents bear fruit just as I wish!" The very instant King Anantayaśas formed this thought, every tree there was in the world system of four great continents bore fruit just as he wished.

Great King, furthermore, King Anantayaśas wished once more to test the power of his roots of virtue, and he thought, "Ah! May all the sentient beings dwelling in this world system of my four great continents be free of every harm, and may the thoughts in their minds be fruitful!" The very instant King Anantayaśas formed this thought, all the sentient beings, however many dwelt in the world system of four great continents, were free of every harm, and all the thoughts in their minds became fruitful.

Great King, furthermore, King Anantayaśas wished to test the power of his roots of virtue, and he thought, "Ah! May a rain of scented water pour down upon this world system of my four great continents!" Great King, the very

instant King Anantayaśas formed this thought, a rain of scented water poured down over the whole world system of four great continents.

Great King, then again King Anantayaśas wished to test the power of his roots of virtue more extensively, and he thought, "Ah! May a rain of flowers pour down upon this world system of my four great continents!" Great King, the very instant King Anantayaśas formed this thought, a rain of flowers poured down over the whole world system of four great continents.

Great King, furthermore, King Anantayaśas thought, "Ah! May a rain of divine garments, a rain of wealth, a rain of gold, a rain of various jewels, and a rain of every kind of requisite pour down upon this world system of my four great continents!" Great King, the very instant King Anantayaśas formed this thought, by the cause of vast roots of virtue accumulated in common with all sentient beings, a rain of divine garments, a rain of wealth, a rain of gold, a rain of various jewels, and a rain of every kind of requisite poured down.

Great King, at that time this Jambudvīpa was eighteen thousand yojanas in extent, and at that time there were six hundred million cities in Jambudvīpa. In the middle of Jambudvīpa was the royal capital, the city called Adorned with Jewels, twelve yojanas in length and twelve in width, square, even, spotless, and well laid out.

Great King, that royal capital Adorned with Jewels was completely encircled by seven rows of tāla trees. Those tāla trees were made of four kinds of precious substance: they were all tāla trees of gold, of silver, of beryl, and of crystal. The golden tāla trees had leaves, flowers, and fruit of silver. The silver tāla trees had leaves, flowers, and fruit of gold. The beryl tāla trees had leaves, flowers, and fruit of crystal. The crystal tāla trees had leaves, flowers, and fruit of beryl.

Above the royal capital Adorned with Jewels were stretched seven layers of bright and beautiful nets of bells and tinkling chimes made of the seven precious substances. The seven precious substances of the great jeweled nets were these: gold, silver, beryl, crystal, red pearl, agate, and emerald, these seven.

The royal capital Adorned with Jewels was surrounded on all sides by deep moats filled with water, half a yojana deep and one yojana wide, brimming to the edge with water possessing the eight qualities, so full that a crow could drink from it, filled throughout with utpala, lotus, kumuda, and white lotus flowers, and encircled by seven layers of spread golden sand. All around those

moats were set bright and beautiful staircases made of four precious substances, namely gold, silver, beryl, and crystal. On the golden frames were laid silver steps, on the silver frames golden steps, on the beryl frames crystal steps, and on the crystal frames beryl steps. Those staircases, too, were encircled on all sides by seven rows of bright and beautiful railings of the seven precious substances.

Atop each of those jeweled staircases were erected bright and beautiful archways of the seven precious substances. At the head of each staircase were planted bright and beautiful plantain trees of Jambū River gold, and on the waters of each of the moats were bright and beautiful boats of the seven precious substances.

Great King, by the splendor of the merit of King Anantayaśas, eighty thousand bright and beautiful parks came into being all around the royal capital Adorned with Jewels, belonging to no one and claimed by no one. King Anantayaśas gave them for all people to enjoy, and the people went into those parks and played and took their enjoyment there with the supreme and perfect happiness.

In each of those pleasure groves eight ponds were laid out, and every one of those ponds was half a krośa across. Each of those ponds had eight bright and beautiful stairways made of four kinds of jewel, namely gold, silver, beryl and crystal. Above those stairways bright and beautiful archways of the seven precious substances were set up. At the head of each stairway bright and beautiful plantain trees of Jambu River gold were planted. Those ponds were filled to the brim with water of the eight qualities, so full that a crow could drink from them. In those ponds such water-born flowers as these were made to grow: utpala lotuses, padma lotuses, kumuda lotuses, white lotuses, and fragrant ones. All around, such land-born flowers as these were made to grow: atimuktaka, campaka, varṣaka, sumanā flowers, mayuka, dhanuskari, and many other land-born flowers besides.

In the sky above that royal palace city adorned with jewels a great net of bells and tinkling bells was spread out. When the wind stirred the tāla trees of the royal palace city adorned with jewels, those nets of jewels and those nets of bells and tinkling bells, a sound arose that was sweet, delightful and pleasing to hear, like the sound of five-part music and cymbals played well by skilled musicians. At that time all the people who lived in that royal palace city adorned with jewels took delight in that sound and enjoyed it. That royal

palace city adorned with jewels was prosperous, happy and blessed with good harvests, filled with a great multitude of people, and filled with utpala lotuses, padma lotuses, kumuda lotuses and white lotuses.

Then King Anantayaśas thought, "Now I shall go to the eastern continent of Pūrvavideha." No sooner had the thought arisen than he rose into the sky together with his fourfold army and went to where the eastern continent of Pūrvavideha lay, and there he ruled as king for many hundreds of years and many thousands of years.

Then King Anantayaśas thought, "Now I shall go to the western continent of Aparagodānīya." No sooner had the thought arisen than he rose into the sky together with his fourfold army and went to where western Aparagodānīya lay, and there he ruled as king for many hundreds of years and many thousands of years.

Then King Anantayaśas thought, "Now I shall go to the northern continent of Uttarakuru." No sooner had the thought arisen than he rose into the sky together with his fourfold army and went to where the great northern continent of Uttarakuru lay, and there, for many hundreds of years and many thousands of years, he directed his own army.

Then, at a time when a long while had passed, King Anantayaśas thought, "If there are gods called the Thirty-Three who dwell on the summit of Sumeru, I shall go to where the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three are." No sooner had the thought arisen than he rose into the sky together with his fourfold army, mounted on the back of the precious elephant, and went up onto Sumeru, the king of mountains.

Then King Anantayaśas said to his driver, "Driver, how do the four great continents, Sumeru the king of mountains, and the great ocean look to you?"

The driver said, "Great King, just as a potter's wheel spins round when it is set going with a stick, so too I see the four great continents, Sumeru the king of mountains, and this great ocean spinning round."

The king said, "Driver, in that case the precious elephant has not yet put forth its stride."

Again King Anantayaśas said to his driver, "Driver, how do the four great continents, Sumeru the king of mountains, and this great ocean look to you now?"

The driver said, "Great King, I now see the four great continents, Sumeru the king of mountains, and the great oceans moving, moving strongly, and moving strongly all over."

The king said, "Driver, in that case the precious elephant has still not put forth its stride."

Again King Anantayaśas said to his driver, "Driver, how do the four great continents, Sumeru the king of mountains, and this great ocean look to you now?"

The driver said, "Great King, now I see the four great continents, Sumeru the king of mountains, and the great oceans as well standing without stirring, moving or shaking."

The king said, "Driver, now that the king of elephants has raised its stride, before long we shall reach the summit of Sumeru, the king of mountains."

Then King Anantayaśas, together with his fourfold army, before long reached the summit of Sumeru, the king of mountains, and Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, saw King Anantayaśas coming from far away. Seeing him, he moved over to half of his seat and said, "Come here, Great King! Welcome, Great King! Great King, sit on half of the seat!" King Anantayaśas sat on half of the seat of Śakra, lord of the gods, and there, for many hundreds of thousands of years, he exercised sovereign lordship over half the kingdom of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

Then, a long time later, King Anantayaśas thought, "Ah! I should sit upon the whole of Śakra's (Indra's) seat." The very instant he formed that thought, he fell from that half of the seat, together with his fourfold army, and came to be in Jambudvīpa. The people living at the enclosure of the pleasure park of the royal city called Jewel-Adorned saw that King Anantayaśas had come into the jewel pleasure park of the royal city Jewel-Adorned and was staying there. As soon as they saw this, they hurried with all speed to the royal city Jewel-Adorned and told King Nandaka, who was ruling as king there.

When King Nandaka heard that a man of the gods was staying in the Jewel Casket pleasure park together with a fourfold army, he quickly mounted his finest vehicle, came out of the royal city Jewel-Adorned with his fourfold army, and went to where the Jewel Casket pleasure park was. All who lived in the royal city Jewel-Adorned were amazed and came running as well.

Then King Nandaka got down from his vehicle and went to where King Anantayaśas was. He offered perfume, flowers, garlands, ointments and incense, draped his robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, bowed with joined palms toward King Anantayaśas, and asked King Anantayaśas, "Who are you?"

The king said to him, "Have you heard of one called King Anantayaśas?"

King Nandaka replied, "I have indeed heard of him. The elders say that the universal monarch called King Anantayaśas went to the heavens together with his retinue, army and mounts. That is what I have heard."

He said, "I am that one called King Anantayaśas."

Then King Anantayaśas, whose eyes could not take in the splendor of humans, and who could not bear human enjoyments, began to sink and could not stay. Just as a lump of butter or a lump of fresh butter placed on hot sand melts and does not stay, so King Anantayaśas too sank and could not stay.

Then King Nandaka said this to King Anantayaśas as he was sinking: "If people ask what fine words King Anantayaśas spoke, what shall I declare to the world?"

He said, "Great King, declare this: 'Great King Anantayaśas held sovereign power over the four great continents. His wishes were accomplished just as he intended and never came to nothing. He experienced all trees bearing fruit at will, all harm brought to an end, the thoughts in the minds of all beings fulfilled, a rain of scented water, a rain of divine wish-fulfilling garments, a rain of treasure, a rain of gold, a rain of various jewels, and a rain of every necessity. Dwelling in the four great continents and holding sovereign power over the four great continents, he occupied half of Śakra's seat, yet great desire did not let him go, and with his desire still unsatisfied he died.'" Having said this, King Anantayaśas died.

Great King, if you suspect and doubt that the universal monarch called King Anantayaśas who lived at that time was someone else, do not see it that way. Why is that? Great King, I myself was, at that time, the universal monarch called King Anantayaśas. Therefore, Great King, you should understand that the senses are like an illusion and their objects like a dream. Having understood this, you should settle your mind firmly, and not leave it to depend on others.

Then the Blessed One (the Buddha) spoke these verses:

From every form of lordship over desires
the wise move the mind away;
toward the joy of lordship over the Dharma
they direct the mind in truth.
Giving up lordship over the pleasures of desire,
setting the mind on mastery of the Dharma,
if one relies wholly on taming the mind,
the afflictions are utterly destroyed.
For those who rely on destroying the afflictions,
the path of karma too is cut off.
And when the path of karma is cut off,
one becomes a shrine for the world.
Not afflicted by desires,
fully seeing the faults of desire,
with a mind intent on benefiting beings:
for this he is called a shrine of offering.
When the faults of desire are heard,
the Omniscient One purifies
people's minds of attachment to desires:
for this he is called a shrine of offering.
The abandoning of beings' hatred
the supreme person fully knows;
since he frees the mind from hatred,
for this he is called a shrine of offering.
The abandoning of beings' delusion
the Bull of the Śākyas fully knows;
since he purifies the mind of delusion,
for this he is called a shrine of offering.
The abandoning of beings' pride
the guide of beings knows as well;
since he purifies the mind of pride,
for this he is called a shrine of offering.

The Blessed One further said to King Śuddhodana: "Great King, long ago in time past there lived a king called Bhūdeva, a righteous Dharma king possessed of the seven precious things. His seven precious things were these: the precious wheel, the precious elephant, the precious horse, the precious jewel, the precious woman, the precious householder and the precious

minister, seven in all. The father of King Bhūdeva was called King Earth-Arising. The eldest son of King Earth-Arising was Prince Bhūdeva. Then, when King Earth-Arising was dying, Prince Bhūdeva was consecrated into the kingship.

Then King Bhūdeva became an anointed king of the kṣatriya caste. Later, on the poṣadha day of the full moon, King Bhūdeva, the anointed kṣatriya king, washed his hair and put on new cotton cloth. He had his hair and beard trimmed, put on garlands and ornaments, and put on jewels, earrings and bracelets. He was seated on the upper story of his palace, surrounded by a retinue of women arrayed before him. As he sat there, a divine wheel jewel appeared from the east. It had a thousand spokes, a hub and a rim, and it was supreme in every aspect. It was radiant and luminous, seven cubits high, and made entirely of gold.

King Bhūdeva had heard before that an anointed kṣatriya king who, on the poṣadha day of the full moon, is surrounded by a gathering of women arrayed before him, as described above, and to whom there appears from the east a divine wheel jewel with a thousand spokes, made entirely of gold, as described above, becomes a wheel-turning king. So he thought, "Am I perhaps a wheel-turning king? I shall put this to the test." King Bhūdeva rose from his seat, arranged his robe over one shoulder, and set his right knee on the ground. Bowing with joined palms toward the divine wheel jewel, he spoke to it: "O wheel jewel, come down and rest on the ground!" At this the divine wheel jewel came down from the sky and rested on the ground.

Then King Bhūdeva wiped the divine wheel jewel with a clean fine cloth, set it in motion with his right hand, and said: "O wheel jewel, conquer the east!" The wheel jewel then turned toward the east. At that very moment, throughout the lands of the east, there appeared the road of the wheel-turning kings of the past: level, very pleasant, delightful, made of the substance of the seven precious things, and covered with all kinds of scattered flowers. The low-lying places along it rose up, and the ridges sank down. Its wells, springs, lakes, ponds and dried-up rivers filled to the brim with water possessing the eight qualities, namely: cool, sweet, light, soft, clear, free of foul odor, not harming the throat when drunk, and soothing the stomach when drunk. The flowering trees came into blossom, and the fruit trees bore fruit. The blossoming trees blossomed constantly, and the fruit-bearing trees bore fruit constantly.

The wheel-turning king followed behind the wheel jewel together with his fourfold army, and wherever the wheel jewel came to rest, there the wheel-turning king also halted with his fourfold army. Then the kings of the east, the provincial kings, the townspeople and the farmers all brought golden bowls filled with pieces of silver and silver bowls filled with gold dust. They went out to welcome the wheel-turning king and said: "Come, Your Majesty! Welcome, Your Majesty! These lands under Your Majesty's dominion are rich and flourishing, with good harvests, and filled with many people. We pray Your Majesty to rule over these lands and over us."

When they had said this, the wheel-turning king said to them: "I have no need of these riches. Let them remain your own wealth, and live on them. Follow me in this way: if you give up killing, give up taking what is not given, and so on up to giving up wrong view, then I shall consider that I have conquered these lands, and that those people who honor their mothers, honor their fathers, honor śramaṇas, honor brahmins, and serve the elders of their clans are my followers. From now on, do not indulge in unrighteous conduct or improper conduct within the realm. If you do so, I shall consider that I have conquered these lands and that these people are my followers." They answered him, "Excellent!" and diligently did just that.

His divine wheel jewel conquered the east, crossed the eastern ocean, and stood before him like the planted pole of a chariot. In the same way it conquered far and wide in the south and in the west. In the north it conquered as far as the great northern continent of Uttarakuru, crossed the northern ocean, and stood above the gate of the wheel-turning king's palace like the planted pole of a chariot.

As soon as King Bhūdeva had set the wheel jewel turning, at that very moment all four great continents came to be of the nature of jewels, brilliant and beautiful. The seven kinds of jewels are these: gold, silver, beryl, crystal, red pearl, musāragalva, and emerald; these are the seven.

As soon as King Bhūdeva had set the wheel jewel turning, all the hell beings were cut off. All the births as animals, all of Yama's world, all the realms of the asuras, and all the unfavorable states were cut off as well. Even the sounds of nonvirtue vanished entirely. Thus, through King Bhūdeva's former aspiration, sāli rice grew throughout all four great continents without being plowed or sown, and wish-fulfilling trees of every kind appeared. Among those beings, every kind of illness was cut off except three, namely desire, hunger, and old

age. The lifespan of those beings was a full ten million years.

Among those beings even the suffering of suffering did not appear at all, and it did them no harm. At that time these and other boundless marvels came about.

Great King, then King Bhūdeva thought, "If there are such enjoyments in the human world, are there or are there not some other enjoyments more vast than these and more exalted than these?" Then he thought, "I have heard it said that there are gods called the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, who dwell on the summit of Sumeru. What sort of enjoyments do they have?"

Then King Bhūdeva, because he had not abandoned desire, disparaged human enjoyments and longed for divine enjoyments, and he resolved, "In that case, I shall go to the abode of the Thirty-Three." Great King, the very moment Bhūdeva formed that resolve, he went together with his fourfold army to the summit of Sumeru, king of mountains. Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, seeing King Bhūdeva coming from far away, spoke these words: "Great King, come here! Great King, welcome!" He offered him half of his seat and said, "Great King, whenever you see fit, sit upon this seat." And King Bhūdeva sat upon half of Śakra's seat. There, for many hundreds of thousands of years, he held sway over half of the royal sovereignty among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

When a long time had passed, under the power of great desire he came to think, "Ah, I shall hold sway over all of the royal sovereignty among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three!" The very moment he formed that thought, he fell from half of the seat of Śakra, lord of the gods, and came back to dwell in Jambudvīpa, in the city called Happy Abode. Because he had come from such splendor to dwell in Jambudvīpa, he could not endure the splendor of humans, and he sank and could not remain. Then, as King Bhūdeva was sinking into the earth, he spoke these verses:

"Vast royal sovereignty
Does not quench the craving for desires;
It is like grass and wood to a fire.
Therefore abandon desires completely.

Though one indulges desires in an endless stream,
One never comes to be sated,
Just as one tormented by thirst,
Though drinking deep of salt water, burns all the more.

The rivers never
Fill the ocean to satiety;
Likewise, when one indulges desires,
One is never sated by more.

Though wood and grass are burned in plenty,
The fire is never sated;
Likewise, when one indulges desires,
One never knows satiety in sensual enjoyment.

Just as a mirror is never
Sated with reflections,
Likewise, when one indulges in forms,
One never knows satiety in sensual enjoyment.

Just as an echo is never
Sated with sounds,
Likewise, when one indulges in sounds,
One never knows satiety in sensual enjoyment.

Just as a censer is never
Sated with incense,
Likewise, though one indulges in smells,
The nose never knows satiety in smells.

Just as a ladle is never
Sated with the finest flavors,
Likewise the tongue is never
Sated with the finest flavors.

Just as space is never
Sated with winds,
Likewise the body is never
Sated with tactile objects.

Just as drinking water
In a dream one dreams brings no satiety,
Likewise the mind attached to desires
Never comes to be sated.

When beings indulge in desires,
Their craving grows again and again;
When they closely indulge in objects,

They are never sated by desire.

Whoever sees that suffering arises
From desires that are like thirst and fire,
Their craving will be pacified,
Like water poured upon a fire."

Great King, should you doubt, be uncertain, or be of two minds, thinking that the one who at that time, on that occasion, was the universal monarch called Bhūdeva was someone else, you should not regard it so. Why is that? Great King, I myself at that time, on that occasion, was the universal monarch called Bhūdeva. Although I held sway over a sovereignty so great and so vast, I died without having been sated by that sovereignty. Why is that? Great King, the faculties are unsated and cannot be sated, and objects do not bring satiety. The faculties are like a mirror, and objects are like reflections. The faculties are like an echo, and objects are like reverberations. The faculties are like an illusion, and objects are like a dream. Therefore, Great King, set your mind upon this, and do not depend on others.

The fifteenth and final fascicle.

Great King, furthermore, long ago in times gone by, there was a king called Māndhātā, renowned for his great miraculous power, great might, and great authority, who was born from the crown of the head of King Upoṣadha. He had previously gathered roots of virtue, had seen countless buddhas, had perfectly accomplished roots of virtue, and had fully accomplished pure qualities under many koṭis of niyutas of buddhas. He held sway over the four great continents. While he dwelt in Jambudvīpa, among all the beings of the desire realm, humans and gods alike, who indulged in desires, King Māndhātā was proclaimed supreme in enjoying desires in this way.

At that time Jambudvīpa was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful, and blessed with good harvests, populous and full of people. Its villages, cities, market towns, districts, provinces, and royal capitals were close together, and the villages were so near one another that a cock could reach the next in a single flight. Because it was governed by the Dharma, this great earth was free of gravel and pebbles, rich in gold and silver, and adorned with parks, pleasure groves, pools, and ponds.

The royal palace and its surroundings of King Māndhātṛ became the city called Ayodhyā. From east to west it measured twelve yojanas in length, and from

south to north seven yojanas in width. It became the first city of the kings, those born in the lineage renowned as the great clan of the wheel-turning kings who arose at the beginning of the eon. It was like the great city of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three called Sudarśana, which is spacious, with nets of bells and small bells hung from above.

In the same way, King Māndhātṛ's spring residence was the furnished palace called Moonrise. His summer residence was the furnished palace called Essence of Beryl, which was like Vaijayanta, the palace of Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods. King Māndhātṛ's winter residence was the furnished palace called Lofty Sunbeams, which was also like Vaijayanta, the palace of Śakra, lord of the gods.

When King Māndhātṛ stayed with his queens in the palace Moonrise, his body became cool, as if anointed with sandalwood. When he stayed in the palace Essence of Beryl, his body was comfortable in keeping with the season, as if anointed with tamāla leaves. When he stayed in the palace Lofty Sunbeams, his body became warm, as if anointed with aloeswood.

Great King, through the power of King Māndhātṛ's wishes, those palaces gave forth a touch that was pleasant to feel. Through the power of his wishes the wind would rise, rain would fall, and the sound of music would arise. Through the power of his wishes, happiness, wealth, and every kind of enjoyment appeared.

Great King, then King Māndhātṛ thought, "Oh, may a rain of riches fall in my palace for seven days!" The moment he formed this thought, a rain of riches fell in King Māndhātṛ's palace for seven days.

Great King, when those seven days had passed, King Māndhātṛ reflected on that rain of riches that had fallen and thought, "How wondrous and marvelous it is that, through the maturation of thoroughly pure karma, my wishes are seen to be fulfilled exactly as I intend, and that merit too does not deceive!" Then he thought further, "I have ruled over the great continent of Jambudvīpa, which is prosperous and flourishing, peaceful and with good harvests, full of many beings and people. Since a rain of riches has fallen in my house for seven days, now I shall go to the western continent of Aparagodānīya."

The moment he formed this thought, Great King, King Māndhātṛ rose up into the sky together with his fourfold army, went from Jambudvīpa to the western continent of Aparagodānīya, and there for many hundreds of thousands of years he ruled as king, with enjoyments that surpassed those of humans yet

had not become divine substances. While he dwelt in that great western continent of Aparagodānīya too, the moment he formed the thought, a rain of riches fell for seven days, just as it had fallen in Jambudvīpa.

Great King, then King Māndhātṛ thought, "I have ruled over Jambudvīpa, prosperous and flourishing and full of many beings and people, and a rain of riches fell in my house for seven days. I have also ruled over the great western continent of Aparagodānīya, and here too in my house a rain of riches has fallen for seven days. There is the great eastern continent called Pūrvavideha, so I shall go to where the great eastern continent of Pūrvavideha lies."

The moment he formed this thought, Great King, King Māndhātṛ rose up into the sky together with his fourfold army and went to the great continent of Pūrvavideha, and there too for many hundreds of thousands of years he ruled as king, with enjoyments that surpassed those of humans yet had not become divine substances.

Great King, then King Māndhātṛ thought there as well, "Since I have ruled over Jambudvīpa, the western Aparagodānīya, and the eastern Pūrvavideha, now I shall go to the great northern continent of Uttarakuru. Although its people have no sense of 'mine' and no possessiveness, I shall go there nonetheless and instruct my own army."

The moment he formed this thought, King Māndhātṛ rose up into the sky together with his fourfold army and went from the great continent of Pūrvavideha to the great northern continent of Uttarakuru. There, among people who had no sense of 'mine' and no possessiveness, he instructed his army for many hundreds of thousands of years.

Great King, then, after many hundreds of thousands of years had passed, King Māndhātṛ thought, "I have ruled over Jambudvīpa, and a rain of riches fell in my house for seven days. I have also ruled over the great western continent of Aparagodānīya. I have also ruled over the great eastern continent of Pūrvavideha. I have also ruled over the great northern continent of Uttarakuru. Now, it is said that there are gods called the Thirty-Three who dwell on the summit of Sumeru, so I shall go to the abode of the Thirty-Three."

Great King, the moment King Māndhātṛ formed this thought, he rose up into the sky together with his fourfold army and arrived at the summit of Sumeru. At that time the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three were gathered and seated in the assembly hall of the gods called Sudharmā. Śakra, lord of the gods, saw King Māndhātṛ coming from far away. Seeing him, he moved over to

half of his seat and said, "Come here, Great King! Welcome, Great King! Whenever you deem it fitting, please sit on half of this seat." And King Māndhātṛ sat down on half of the seat of Śakra, lord of the gods.

As soon as King Māndhātṛ sat on half of Śakra's seat, he outshone all the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three in ten divine respects. What are the ten? Divine lifespan, divine fame, divine complexion, divine happiness, divine command of sovereignty, divine form, divine sound, divine smell, divine taste, and divine touch. These are the ten, and by them he outshone everyone except Śakra, lord of the gods. Why was that? The gods could tell "This is King Māndhātṛ" and "This is Śakra, lord of the gods" only by the blinking and not blinking of their eyes. Apart from that, King Māndhātṛ and Śakra, lord of the gods, were equal in form, equal in conduct, and equal in enjoyments. Great King, it was a great wonder that the two, one born a human and the other born a god, came to have bodies so alike.

Great King, there King Māndhātṛ ruled over half the kingdom among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three for many hundreds of thousands of years. Then, Great King, King Māndhātṛ held sway over the dominion of the four great continents, and held sway over half the kingdom of the gods of the Thirty-Three. Yet, unsatisfied with that dominion, he gave rise to this thought: "Ah! I shall hold sway over the whole dominion of the kingdom of the gods of the Thirty-Three." As soon as this thought arose, he fell from the abode of the Thirty-Three together with his fourfold army, and arrived at the king's finest pleasure grove in Jambudvīpa.

When he came to be in Jambudvīpa, all the directions became bright. Even the light of the sun was outshone, just as the light of the moon is outshone by the sun. The sun standing in the sky was no longer radiant, just as the disc of the moon in the sky above cannot be seen when the sun outshines it. Then the people stationed in the supreme palace of the city called Unassailable saw that the king had arrived at that pleasure grove. Seeing this, they were amazed. They went into the city and cried aloud, proclaiming, "Friends, a son of the gods has come down from the sky and arrived at this royal pleasure grove!"

Great King, when the people of the realm and their king heard this, they hurried in great haste, carrying songs and music, flowers, incense, garlands, fumigating incense, unguents, parasols, victory banners, pennants, and canopies. Conducting themselves in purity, they came out of that city and

went to where the pleasure grove was. Great King, as soon as King Māndhātṛ had settled in that pleasure grove, this great earth quaked in six ways.

Great King, then the people of the realm and their king approached King Māndhātṛ, giving off the overpowering smell of human beings. King Māndhātṛ, accustomed to divine enjoyments, could not bear the things of humans, and he began to sink into the ground and could not stay upright, just as a lump of butter or a lump of fresh butter placed on hot sand melts and cannot hold its shape. When the people of the realm and their king saw him sinking, they asked, "Who are you?"

Then King Māndhātṛ said to the king and the people of the realm, "Have you heard that there once was someone called King Māndhātṛ?"

They replied, "We have heard from the elders that one called King Māndhātṛ went to heaven in that very body, together with his fourfold army."

King Māndhātṛ said to them, "Friends, the one called King Māndhātṛ is I. I have fallen from heaven and dropped down here."

When he had said this, the king and the people of the realm addressed him in verses of song:

"We have heard from the elders
That there was a lord of men, of great miraculous power,
Free from sorrow and of great renown,
Called Māndhātṛ.
With palanquins, troops, and mounts,
With his attendants, he went to the heavenly world.
That foremost lord of men dwells in the abode of the gods,
And guards the earth by Dharma too, so we have heard."

When they said this, that lord of men,
Afflicted by impermanence, now destitute,
Having lost his happiness and met with suffering,
Said, "That king is I."
When he said this, all the people
Joined their palms and touched his feet:
"King, what are we to say?
Please tell us of this marvel, this wonder."
At this the king, fallen from the gods, said:
"Hear the wonder of one who has found suffering.

Anyone who wishes for lasting happiness
Should always be heedful.
Māndhātṛ, supreme among kings,
Enjoyed the four continents as king,
And possessed the finest pleasures of the senses,
Yet he passed on, never sated by desire.
In his house, for seven days,
There fell a rain of showering treasure.
Having enjoyed the four continents,
Never sated by desire, he sank down.
On half of the seat of Śakra, lord of the gods,
The king sat;
Ruined by the thoughts of conceptual thinking,
Desiring for himself, crushed by pride, he declined.
The unwise, in this ocean of saṃsāra,
Sink again and again among the destinies.
When one indulges deeply in desires,
One does not find the satisfaction the Victor praised.
Like water drunk in a dream,
Which, though drunk, brings no relief from thirst,
So too with the pleasures of the senses:
Indulged in, they bring no satisfaction.
Those who are endowed with intelligence
Dispel the darkness with knowledge,
And, for the sake of satisfaction, rightly examine
The noble wisdom of the Blessed One.
The intelligent one who destroys existence
Examines aging, death, and birth;
Having fully abandoned craving,
He abandons existence and does not grasp.
He knows the aspects of feeling to be like fire,
And knows contact too to be like fire;
Toward ignoble feeling
And toward that contact he has no craving.
Like cymbals struck in music,
Object and faculty do not act on their own.
Those who follow the Victor's teaching understand the faculties;

Seeing their intrinsic nature, they cast the faculties aside.
Although the six sense sources do not exist,
The mind is stirred in connection with form.

Because it is imputed as consciousness,
Feeling is said to be thorough conceptualization.
Knowing it thus, the noble ones
Do not place their trust in the stream of existence.
Satisfied by noble wisdom,
They become still, like a fire without fuel.
Having taught that existence is impermanent
To the kings, and to the realm together with its people,
Māndhātā, having declared this,
That lord of men passed away.

Great King, you may suspect, doubt, or hesitate, thinking that the king called Māndhātā who appeared at that time was someone else. If so, you should not regard it that way. Why is that? Great King, at that time I myself was the universal monarch called Māndhātā. Although I held vast sovereign power over a kingdom, I died still unsatisfied by desires. Therefore, Great King, understand it in this way, abandon the pride of power, and be heedful. Abiding in heedfulness, you should truly accomplish the roots of virtue. Great King, one who delights in heedfulness will accomplish his aims. Therefore, Great King, through heedfulness you should truly realize the sameness of the elements. Great King, the conditioned element and the unconditioned element are not female and not male. They are not past, not future, and not present. Therefore, Great King, you should set your mind firmly on this and not depend on others.

Great King, long ago, in times past, there was a king called Nemi. He was righteous, a Dharma king devoted to heedfulness. Whatever undertaking he began, he conducted and carried out all of it with heedfulness. Great King, King Nemi applied himself to the sameness of the three times, thinking: "All these phenomena are the same through the sameness of the three times. In the past, too, all phenomena are devoid of intrinsic nature. In the future and in the present, too, all phenomena are devoid of intrinsic nature."

Because he saw all phenomena as the sameness of the three times, he had no attachment to any phenomenon. He saw that beings' minds had been

distorted by the four distortions of mind: perceiving the unattractive as attractive, perceiving suffering as happiness, perceiving the impermanent as permanent, and perceiving what is without self as a self. Then he thought: "These beings do not see that all phenomena are empty. Alas, alas, this world we live in is ruined! Alas, this world we live in is utterly ruined!" Having thought this, he reflected: "I shall gather these beings through the four means of gathering. If I gather them through the four means of gathering, I will be able to set them in the Dharma."

Great King, then King Nemi, putting skillful means first, gathered beings through the four means of gathering. He then taught them with instructions on the sameness of the three times: "O beings, all phenomena are empty of intrinsic nature. O beings, a phenomenon that has no intrinsic nature is neither past, nor future, nor present. Why is that? Because it has no intrinsic nature, it cannot be designated 'past,' nor can it be designated 'future' or 'present.'"

Great King, King Nemi urged those beings in this way toward the sameness of the three times. As a result, eighty hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of living beings attained acceptance of the unborn nature of phenomena.

At that time the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three had gathered and were seated in Sudharmā, the assembly hall of the gods. In the course of their gathering, this talk arose among them: "This Nemi is a righteous Dharma king endowed with skillful means. Through skillful means he correctly teaches what is free of distortion to beings whose minds are distorted. Oh, how fortunate are the people whose king he is! Oh, those people have truly gained a great gain!"

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, went to the Sudharmā hall of the gods. Having arrived, he sat on his own seat and said to the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, "You who are seated here now, what are you talking about?"

When he had said this, the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three said to Śakra, lord of the gods, "Lord of the gods, while we were here in the Sudharmā hall of the gods, this talk arose among us: 'This Nemi is a righteous Dharma king endowed with skillful means. Through skillful means he teaches beings whose minds are distorted, without distortion, that all phenomena are without intrinsic nature. Oh, how fortunate are the people whose king he is! Oh, those people have truly gained a great gain!' That is what we were saying."

When they had said this, Śakra, lord of the gods, said to those gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, "Friends, since the king called Nemi possesses inconceivable skill in means, do you wish that King Nemi come here so that

you may see him, or do you not?"

The gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three said, "Lord of the gods, we too wish that Nemi come here so that we may see him."

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, said to his charioteer Mātali, "Mātali, come here! Take the divine chariot drawn by thoroughbreds, with its thousand spokes, go to wherever King Nemi is, and say this to King Nemi: 'Great King, I have come bringing this chariot of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, drawn by thoroughbreds and with a thousand spokes. Great King, please mount it without hesitation. The gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three will rejoice to see you.' Say this, and when he has mounted the chariot, say this: 'Great King, by which road shall I take you? Shall we go by the realm of error, where those who have fallen into error dwell, or by the realm free of error, where those without error dwell?'"

Saying "Very well," the charioteer Mātali obeyed Śakra, lord of the gods, descended, and spoke to King Nemi just as he had been instructed. When he had said this, King Nemi said to the charioteer Mātali, "Mātali, in that case, let us go by both roads." Then the charioteer Mātali drove King Nemi through both the realm of error, where those who have fallen into error dwell, and the realm free of error, where those without error dwell, and so they went.

Then, Great King, King Nemi said to the charioteer Mātali, "Mātali, so that I may look upon the realm of error, let the chariot stop for a moment." Then, in just the interval for which the charioteer Mātali held the chariot still, King Nemi established eight hundred million living beings in the meditative absorption of the definitive teaching of reality, because he was one who sports in heedfulness and in the higher knowledges. They, too, attained acceptance of the nonarising of phenomena. Yet the charioteer Mātali did not know what deed King Nemi had done.

Then the charioteer Mātali drove on in the same way and arrived with King Nemi at the summit of Sumeru. Then King Nemi saw from far away a dense forest, blue-green in every way, and on seeing it he said to the charioteer Mātali, "Mātali, this dense forest is without doubt the abode of beings who are free of error."

Mātali said, "Great King, this is Sudharmā, the assembly hall of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, and the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three are gathered here. Great King, please go in without hesitation. The gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three wish to see you."

Then, Great King, King Nemi went in without hesitation, and Śakra, lord of the gods, saw King Nemi coming from far away. Seeing him, he spread out half of his seat. Then King Nemi sat on half of Śakra's seat. Then Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing that King Nemi was seated on the seat, greeted him with great delight and said, "Great King, since you have thus established the teaching of the buddhas, the blessed ones, in the world, you have truly gained a fine gain."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said to the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, "O friends, this King Nemi possesses inconceivable skill in means, for in a single instant he has tamed eight hundred million living beings in the Dharma of the Buddha."

Then King Nemi said this to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Lord of the gods, I wish to go back to Jambudvīpa. Why is that? So that I may go there and uphold the teaching of the Tathāgata."

Śakra said to him, "Great King, go whenever you see fit."

Then King Nemi went back to Jambudvīpa, and because he was endowed with great compassion and thoroughly trained in skillful means, countless tens of millions of beings were tamed in the teaching of the Buddha.

Great King, if you should have doubt or hesitation, thinking that the one who was the king called Nemi at that time, on that occasion, was someone else, Great King, you should not see it that way. Why is that? Great King, I myself was the one called King Nemi at that time, on that occasion. Great King, look how King Nemi, taking no delight in half of the seat of Śakra, lord of the gods, generated the power of heedfulness. Therefore, Great King, you should strive heedfully in the qualities of the Buddha. And, Great King, what are those qualities of the Buddha? Great King, all phenomena are the qualities of the Buddha.

When he had said this, King Śuddhodana said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, in that case, if all phenomena are the qualities of the Buddha, then all sentient beings, too, are buddhas."

The Blessed One said, "Great King, those who are free of error are buddhas. Great King, what is called 'buddha' is a synonym for seeing reality. What is called 'seeing reality' is a synonym for the true limit. What is called 'the true limit' is a synonym for the realm of phenomena. Great King, what is called 'the realm of phenomena' cannot be taught otherwise than as a mere name, a

mere sign, a mere convention, a mere conventional truth, a mere expression, or a mere designation.

Great King, this nonarising of all phenomena is a door of dhāraṇī. Why is that? Because in it all phenomena are unmoving, unwavering, and free of conceit; for that reason it is a door of dhāraṇī. Great King, the nonceasing of all phenomena is a door of dhāraṇī. Why is that? Because in it all phenomena are unmoving, unwavering, and free of conceit; for that reason it is a door of dhāraṇī."

In the same way, all phenomena are without defining characteristics, signless, unborn, and without intrinsic nature. They are without cognition, unmade, and unconditioned. They are without coming and without going. They are without a sentient being, without a life principle, without a nourisher, and without a person. They are without conceptual elaboration, signless, without designation, without entanglement, without latent tendencies, without affliction, and without purification. They are without attachment, without anger, without bondage, and without liberation. They are without going, without running, without turning back, without lowness, without abiding, without sitting, without meditative equipoise, and without error. They are without a knower, without a cognizer, without a seer, and without a non-seer. They are without moral discipline and without the absence of moral discipline, without regret and without the absence of regret. They are without delight and without the absence of delight, without joy and without the absence of joy, without pliancy and without the absence of pliancy, without happiness and without unhappiness. They are without meditative absorption and without the absence of meditative absorption. They are without the correct, as it really is, and without the wrong. They are without disenchantment and without the absence of disenchantment, without freedom from desire and without the absence of freedom from desire, without view and without non-view, without liberation and without non-liberation, without knowing and without not knowing, without seeing and without not seeing. They are without karma and without karmic maturation, without proper attention and without improper attention. Great King, one should enter into all phenomena through these seventy gateways of aspects.

Great King, the intrinsic nature of form has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present. Great King, in the same way, the intrinsic nature of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present.

Great King, it is like this: the intrinsic nature of the form of a reflection, for example, has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present. Great King, in the same way, the intrinsic nature of form, and the intrinsic nature of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present.

Great King, it is like this: the intrinsic nature of the sound of an echo, for example, has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present. In the same way, the intrinsic nature of form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present.

Great King, it is like this: the intrinsic nature of the water of a mirage, for example, has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present. In the same way, the intrinsic nature of form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present.

Great King, it is like this: a lump of foam, for example, has no core; it has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present. In the same way, everything from the intrinsic nature of form up to the intrinsic nature of consciousness has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present.

Great King, it is like this: a beautiful woman who is the object of a dream, for example, has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present. In the same way, everything from the intrinsic nature of form up to the intrinsic nature of consciousness has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present.

Great King, it is like this: the birth of a barren woman's son in a dream, for example, has not occurred, will not occur, and does not exist at present. In the same way, everything from the intrinsic nature of form up to the intrinsic nature of consciousness has not arisen, will not arise, and does not exist at present.

Great King, it is like this: space, for example, has no location. In the same way, everything from form up to consciousness has no location.

Great King, form has no arising. In the same way, up to consciousness, there is no arising. Great King, form has no cessation. In the same way, up to consciousness, there is no cessation.

Great King, it is like this: in the realm of nirvāṇa, for example, there is no arising or cessation. In the same way, in everything from form up to consciousness there is no arising or cessation. Great King, it is like this: in the

realm of phenomena, for example, there is no arising or cessation; in the same way, in everything from form up to consciousness there is no arising or cessation.

Great King, these are the domain of the Tathāgata, an inconceivable domain. It is a domain not shared with any childish ordinary beings, and not shared with any śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas. It is not diminished and not increased, not attained and not lost. It is not perfectly and fully awakened, nor not perfectly and fully awakened. It is not directly known, nor not directly known; not thoroughly known, nor not thoroughly known; not abandoned, nor not abandoned; not cultivated, nor not cultivated; not actualized, nor not actualized. It is not taught, nor not taught; not fully taught, nor not fully taught; not proclaimed, nor not proclaimed; not made to be heard, nor not made to be heard; not heard, nor not heard.

Why is that? Great King, because no phenomenon that could be added to or taken away is apprehended. Great King, all phenomena are without intrinsic nature. Great King, one should rejoice wholeheartedly in this, and not depend on others.

Then King Śuddhodana thought: "Here no phenomenon whatsoever is apprehended, by the realization of which one is called a buddha. Nevertheless, the Tathāgata has taught designations for phenomena that cannot be apprehended." At that moment seventy thousand Śākyas, King Śuddhodana among them, attained acceptance of the unborn nature of phenomena.

Then the Blessed One, knowing their superior intention, smiled.

This is the nature of reality of the buddhas, the blessed ones. Whenever they smile, rays of light of various colors, of many hues, issue from the Blessed One's mouth. They fill limitless, boundless world systems with their brilliance and rise up as far as the world of Brahmā. Then they turn back and dissolve into the crown of the Blessed One's head.

Then the venerable Aśvajit rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and placed his right knee on the ground. Bowing with palms joined toward the Blessed One, he addressed the Blessed One in verse:

"Guide of the world,
Great Hero, you have smiled.
You who bring light to the world,
Please tell the cause of your smile.

Omniscient One, Guide,
For what reason have you shown a smile?
Make it known to beings,
And swiftly cut off my doubts.
For the sake of the assembly of Śākyas
Gautama has smiled.
Hero who brings joy to beings,
Please dispel the doubts of beings.
Great meditator, when they hear your speech,
The doubts of beings are cut off;
Their minds become supremely joyful,
And all of them attain your teaching.
If your heirs come to understand
This deed of the Victor's smile,
Through diligence they will be fully certain
And will follow it with understanding.
Bull among Victors, please
Dispel these doubts of beings.
When the doubts of the world are cut off,
It will attain vast happiness."

When he had said this, the Blessed One replied to the venerable Aśvajit in verse:

"Aśvajit, hear from me
Why it is that I have smiled.
I have foretold, truly as it is,
The certainty of mind of the Śākyas.
That phenomena cannot be apprehended
The Śākyas truly understand.
Therefore on the qualities of a buddha
These have firmly set their minds.
Relying on non-apprehension,
The Śākyas of great renown,
Having gained certainty about all phenomena,
Will attain unsurpassed awakening.
These Śākyas who have gained certainty,
When they pass away from among humans,

Will go to the world of Sukhāvatī,
Into the presence of Amitābha.
As fearless bodhisattvas,
While they dwell in Sukhāvatī,
They will make offerings to countless millions
Of buddhas throughout the ten directions.
These wise ones, in a single realm,
Will honor and serve the buddhas dwelling there,
Will seek the good of all sentient beings,
And make aspirations for supreme awakening.
Making offerings to the tathāgatas,
They will wander from field to field;
Wherever a buddha appears,
They will go there by the power of miracles.
For countless millions of eons,
With flowers of every kind,
They will worship the tathāgatas,
And after that they will become guides.
At that time each of those buddhas
Will tame great multitudes of sentient beings
For the sake of awakening, as buddhas,
Guiding beings toward the buddhas' intent.
In the fields of all the buddhas
They will teach the bodhisattvas.
There, not a single buddha
Will ever come to train śrāvakas.
For each of those buddhas,
The span of life there will be such
That they will remain teaching the Dharma
For countless millions of years.
After they have passed into parinirvāṇa,
Fearless bodhisattvas,
Heirs of the Victor, will uphold the true Dharma
For a thousand million years.
Those sons of the lord of men, too,
By teaching the Dharma of emptiness,
Will train inconceivable millions of beings

Toward awakening.
Those who are conscientious,
Abiding in conscientiousness
And relying on the Dharma of emptiness,
Will surely go forth into omniscience."

When they heard this teaching by the perfect Buddha
About the destiny of the sons of the Śākyas,
The world with its gods rejoiced
And directed their minds toward awakening.

This concludes the twenty-sixth chapter, the Prophecy to the Śākyas.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Śāriputra, "Śāriputra, this bodhisattva samādhi, the Definitive Teaching of Suchness, should be proclaimed to bodhisattvas who have reached the consummation. Why is that? Śāriputra, this samādhi is without a person; in it the Tathāgata has not apprehended any phenomenon whatsoever. What is not apprehended has not been fully and perfectly awakened to. What has not been fully and perfectly awakened to has not been taught. What has not been taught has not been known. What has not been known is the teaching of the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, the future, and the present. It is the great drum of the Dharma of the tathāgatas. Therefore, Śāriputra, I entrust this to you, so that this bodhisattva samādhi, the Definitive Teaching of Suchness, may be held, read, and also correctly taught at length to others.

"Śāriputra, suppose a son or daughter of good family who has correctly entered the bodhisattva vehicle were to practice the five perfections, devoid of the perfection of wisdom, for ten eons. Śāriputra, one who even merely hears this bodhisattva samādhi, the Definitive Teaching of Suchness, will generate far more merit than that. Śāriputra, compared with one who listens to it for ten eons, one who teaches it to even a single sentient being will generate far more merit than that. Compared with one who listens to it for ten eons and explains it to others, one who meditates on it for as long as a snap of the fingers will generate far more merit than that.

"Therefore, Śāriputra, bodhisattvas should be instructed in this very bodhisattva samādhi, the Definitive Teaching of Suchness, with all diligence. Why is that? Śāriputra, because by meditating on this bodhisattva samādhi, the Definitive Teaching of Suchness, one swiftly attains patience regarding the

nonarising of phenomena. Śāriputra, all these assemblies of bodhisattvas whom I have prophesied to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening are, without exception, firmly established in this bodhisattva samādhi, the Definitive Teaching of Suchness."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Śāriputra, those monks, King Śuddhodana, Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, those guardians of the world, that entire assembly, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes "The Meeting of the Father and Son," the sixteenth chapter, which definitively teaches suchness, from the Dharma discourse of the noble Great Heap of Jewels in one hundred thousand chapters.

It was translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Śīlendrabodhi, Jinamitra, and Dānaśīla, and the chief editor and translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, and was then revised according to the new standard terminology and finalized.

## Translator's Notes

• The long series of paired epithets reproduces standard Indic stock terms (for example "one who had bathed" for snātaka, "the single guard" for ekārakṣa, "the four reliances" for the four apāśrayas, "partial truths" for pratyekasatya, "the unshakable" for āneñjya). Several are compressed and are rendered literally. The Buddha's reply to Kauṇḍinya is terse. It appears to mean that, as a most senior and highly honored disciple, he should not go himself but stay.
• In the second verse line the Tibetan reads "foremost in family and in deeds" (rigs dang byed); this is very likely a slip for rigs dad byed, "bringing families to faith," which echoes the Buddha's prose statement just before, and has been translated accordingly. "Crazed by a death" (shi bas myos) is read in light of the following verse, which speaks of a woman maddened by her husband's death.
• The king's name, rendered here as "Truth Increaser," could not be securely identified with a Sanskrit form (possibly Satyavardhana), so it is translated by meaning. Matigarbha and Candradatta are the usual Sanskrit equivalents of the Tibetan names. The line about "discarded mucus and ashes" is somewhat obscure in the Tibetan, and the rendering is approximate.
• The names of the prince and king in the jātaka verses (Essence of Intellect, Increase of Truth) and of the Śākya youths Joyful Face and Well Awakened are translated literally, since their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence; plausible originals would be Matigarbha, Satyavardhana, Nandamukha and Suprabuddha. In the description of the wheel-turning king's rule, □□□□ is taken in its sense of "punishment," not the doctrinal "annihilation."
• The lines describing Udāyin as one who "carries the Tathāgata's food" render □□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□ literally; the sense may be that of an envoy or bearer sent by the Buddha, but the Tibetan wording speaks of food or provisions. The second line of Udāyin's reply ("wherever it abides") is somewhat elliptical, and could alternatively be understood as asking where the king dwells.
• In the verse on the bull's gait, the text reads □□□□□ "praised," which makes little sense in context; I have read it as the similar □□□□□ "frightened," since the bull's bellow is a standard

image for terrifying rival teachers.
• The thirteenth verse has only two lines in the Tibetan as given; it is translated as it stands. In the third verse the doubled verb "did just as he had said" has been read as a single verb. The final stanza is completed in the next piece.
• "The excellent cloud of the four and the two" renders the Tibetan literally. It may mean "four times two," that is, the eightfold path, or it may refer to two sets of teachings, such as the four truths and two others. The text does not specify. The verb rendered "ferry across" in the king's recollection is used in its ordinary sense of rescuing across the flood of existence, not in its ritual sense.
• The large numbers bye ba (koṭi, ten million) and khrag khrig (niyuta, a very large number) are kept as Indian units because their exact values vary between sources. In the list of gods, the word "king of the gods" before Ābhāsvara may refer to that class or to its ruler; the list is rendered as the Tibetan gives it.
• In the fifth stanza, "bde sogs khyim thab sbyin ldan" is taken as Śakra with his consort Śacī and his other wives, with "sbyin ldan" read as the epithet Maghavan, "the Bountiful One"; this reading is tentative. The kings of the heavens in the verses are identified as Suyāma (Yāma heaven), Santuṣita (Tuṣita), Sunirmita (Nirmāṇarati), and the unnamed ruler of the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods ("the king of the gods who wields control"). The "three stains" are desire, hatred, and delusion.
• □□□□□□□□ is rendered "the five royal insignia," taking it as the standard five emblems of royalty. In this narrative context □□□□□□□ means "excellent horses," not the deity Paramāśva.
• The name Siddhārtha means "one whose aim is accomplished"; the king's final verse plays on this meaning, saying the name has now proven true.
• The number word □□□□□□□□ is taken as ten to the eleventh power, giving "six trillion" for □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; the exact value assigned to this term varies among sources. In the verse portion, □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered loosely as "countless myriads." The "lords of the secret ones" (guhyakādhipati) are taken as the yakṣa lords. The verb □□□□□ in "arranged hanging fringes" is read in the sense of fitting or setting up.
• The flower names rendered "white-hued" and "pale-hued" (with their "great" and "variegated" forms) are literal translations of Tibetan names whose Sanskrit equivalents could not be identified with confidence. The ornament rendered "strings of tinkling ornaments" is an uncertain interpretation. The jewel terms follow common equivalents: "agate" for musāragalva, "emerald" for aśmagarbha, and "chrysoberyl" for karketana. Khrag khrig is rendered "niyuta," an indefinitely vast number. The phrase "hundreds, sixty each" is rendered as "six thousand."
• The flower names rendered "white-hued," "pale," and "variegated pale" translate Tibetan descriptive terms whose Sanskrit equivalents I cannot identify with confidence; they are given by meaning. The large number □□□□□□□□ is rendered as a hundred billion following the standard Tibetan numeral series.
• The asura lords □□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence; their names are translated by meaning as "Fully Soothed" and "Excellent Chariot." The flower names □□□□□□□ (here "pale flowers") and its compounds are of uncertain identification and are rendered by their apparent sense. □□□□ / □□□□ is taken as musāragalva and □□□□□□□□□□□□□ (aśmagarbha) as emerald. The last stanza of the second praise sets out the three doors of liberation: emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness.
• The asura lord □□□□□□□□ is here taken as the asura Śambara rather than the tantric deity Cakrasaṃvara, since he appears in a list of asura kings. The names □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning ("Delighting in Battle," "Subduer of the Three Worlds"). Suratha and Sunetra are probable reconstructions of □□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□. The flowers called □□□□□□□□□□□□□ are of uncertain identity; rendered descriptively as "flowers of pale and

variegated hues."
• The names of two asura lords could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning: "Subjugator of the Three Worlds" and "Release-and-Hold." The Tibetan spells Vemacitrin's name with □□□ where the standard form has □□□; this is taken as the usual name.
• □□□□□□□□ is a very large number whose exact value varies between Indian and Tibetan numeral lists. "Trillion" is used here as an approximation. "The Delightful Eon" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□. It may simply mean "a delightful eon" rather than the name of an eon. The shared name of the future buddhas is given in English as "Victor Victorious over Foes," since the Sanskrit form cannot be identified with confidence. In "□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□," □□□ is read as □□ ("full, complete"). The verb □□□□□ ("choose") is rendered loosely as "lead."
• The Tibetan sentence about body, speech, and mind literally says there were no beings "endowed with completely pure" conduct, which contradicts the list of things absent from a pure buddha field. A negation appears to have dropped out, and the evident sense, "not completely pure," has been translated. In the verse, "unflagging in eloquence" renders the obscure phrase spobs mi bas, read as describing the praising buddhas' undiminished eloquence.
• The verb rendered "gathered" may also mean that the Tathāgata fostered or brought these beings to maturity. "Nothing dreadful left unabandoned" translates a phrase whose sense is somewhat obscure. It may instead refer to anxiety or doubt left unabandoned.
• The names of the eastern world system and its buddha are translated from the Tibetan, since their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence (possibly something like Candraraśmyalaṃkṛta and Tejodgatarāja).
• The precious substance rendered "agate" is uncertain; it is variously identified as coral, agate, or cat's eye. The phrase rendered "day and night" reads the honorific compound literally meaning "midday and night" in this sense. The place to which Airāvaṇa carries the gods is read as the Pārijāta tree of the Thirty-Three.
• The lines on the future buddhas' names are ambiguous: "wholly beautiful" may itself be their name, and "Banner of Sumeru" may be the name of the buddhas rather than of the eon; I have translated the names literally since I could not identify a secure Sanskrit form. The line beginning "The one who overpowers all" is a narrative frame within the Buddha's own verses, as in the Tibetan.
• "Crane-foot ornaments" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; it is evidently a kind of hanging ornament that sounds in the wind, but its exact form is uncertain. The two lines after the first wish ("Just as you who possess the ten powers... so may we too teach the Dharma") are read as continuing the maidens' aspiration; the second line could also be taken as a statement that the Buddha himself teaches and frees beings.
• The large numbers rendered "tens of millions and trillions" translate the Tibetan terms for koṭi and a much larger unit; they convey indefinitely vast quantities. The eon name "Like the Stars" is identified as Tārakopama.
• "Nine hundred million garlands" reads □□□□□ as a slip for □□□□□ (koṭi), matching the "nine hundred million nāgas" elsewhere in the passage. The rare word □□□□□□□□□ (a kind of smooth, polished stone) is rendered descriptively.
• The line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ has an unusual final verb, □□□; it is rendered by sense as "settle our doubt." The phrase □□□□□□□□□□, applied to the Sugata, is obscure and is rendered literally as "the father, the nature of reality itself."
• The line ending "taught thus to the son" is ambiguous in the Tibetan; "the son" may refer to the Buddha's royal father's son context of this sūtra or to a spiritual heir. The precious substance □□□□ is rendered "mother-of-pearl" (Skt. musāragalva) and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as "emerald" (Skt. aśmagarbha); identifications of these gems vary.
• The name of the future buddhas, rendered "Beyond Wonder," translates the Tibetan literally;

it echoes the epithet of the Buddha as one "never moved to wonder" earlier in the verses. I could not identify a Sanskrit form with confidence. In the verse "they will bring people to liberation," the Tibetan reads "the weary," which appears to be a slip for "people," as the similar-looking word fits the context.

• "Earth Guardian" translates □□□□□□, the name of the progenitor of these royal elephants; I could not securely identify the Sanskrit form. The flower name □□□□□□□ could not be identified and is given in phonetic form as "skyasnar." In the verse on suchness, □□□□□□□ ("forgetting") makes no sense in context and is read as □□□□□□□ ("expression"), a likely copyist's slip.

• "With horses and the finest elephants" reads the Tibetan "rta med" ("without horses") as an evident slip for "rta dang" ("horses and"). The line "As buddhas they will bear the name Infinite Realization" takes the phrase as a buddha-name given in the prophecy. It could also be read as "the buddhas' marks are realized as limitless," so the name is a literal translation, not an identified Sanskrit form.

• In the line on signlessness the Tibetan reads "shows" (stön); I have read it as "empty" (stong), a similar-sounding syllable that fits the parallel lines on either side. In the line "the wise know this, not the childish," the particle after "know" has been read as the instrumental marking the knower.

• "Wise in the World" translates the Tibetan name of the future buddhas literally; it may render a Sanskrit name such as Lokavid, but this cannot be confirmed. In the verse on space, "□□□□□□□□□□□□" was read as "□□□□□□□□" (dharmas). In the line about karma being exhausted, "through abandonment" interprets the somewhat compressed phrase literally rendered "karma exhausted by what abandons."

• □□□□□□, the addressee of these verses, is rendered "Druma," taking it as the Sanskrit name the Tibetan normally translates (as in the kinnara king Druma). If earlier pieces rendered it differently, that form should be kept. "The mindless Dharma" (□□□□□□□□□□□□) is translated literally; it refers to the teaching that mind has no arising or real existence.

• The line rendered "all phenomena are equal in their nonexistence" reads literally "all phenomena are equal/without equal, nonexistent" and is open to more than one construal. The letter a is the syllable of non-arising (anutpāda), the basis of the "door of A" dhāraṇī teaching.

• The god class □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is uncertain: □□□□□□□□ is taken as the Mālādhara gods, one of the classes below the Four Great Kings, and □□□□□□□□□ is translated literally as "Elephant Bearers." The line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as "do likewise for beings"; it could also be read as "inspire faith in beings."

• "Garland-Bearing Elephant gods" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally, since I could not securely identify the underlying Sanskrit name. The same applies to the buddha name "Possessor of the Flower Banner" (perhaps Puṣpadhvaja) and the eon "Supreme Joy" (perhaps Pramudita). The line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; I have taken it to mean that beings and the assembly together saw the smile appear. The last verse alludes to the three doors of liberation: emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness.

• The future buddhas' name "Bearer of Light Rays" translates the Tibetan literally; a Sanskrit form such as Raśmidhara is possible but not certain. The number rendered "hundreds of billions" translates khrag khrig, a large numeral of the Indian series (about ten to the eleventh power). The line rendered "drawn your mind out of ignorance" has an instrumental where an ablative would be expected; the sense of liberation from ignorance seems clear.

• The class rendered "the garland bearers with their elephants" translates the Tibetan literally. It is not separated from its neighbors in the list, so it is taken as a single class of being, and its Sanskrit name is not identified with confidence. "Coral" and "emerald" render two of the seven precious substances whose exact identification varies in the tradition.

• The verb rendered "free" in "they will free countless multitudes of beings" is written □□□□□ ("explain, untie"). It may be a slip for □□□□□ ("liberate"). Either reading gives a similar sense.

The phrase □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "dispel doubt."
• The line stating that the eight worldly concerns "do not arise" for beings who delight in "that" is translated as written; the following verses describe how these eight harm worldly beings, so the referent of "that" (the conventional teaching or the Buddha's teaching) is somewhat unclear. "The four hundred million" renders forty koṭis.
• "Equal to the Hosts of Stars" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taken here as the name of the eon; it could instead be descriptive (eons as numerous as the stars). "Pure Intellect" translates □□□□□□□□□□, the name under which the future buddhas will be known; no Sanskrit form is asserted. The line about twenty koṭis "twenty upon twenty" (□□□□□□□□□□□□) is somewhat obscure and may mean twenty koṭis in successive groups of twenty.
• The text reads □□ ("weak, inferior"), which does not fit; it has been read as □□□ ("cling"), giving "ordinary beings cling to them in another way." In this section □□□□□□□□□ refers to the Buddha's prophecy of beings to unsurpassed awakening, continuing the preceding discussion, and is rendered "prophecy."
• In the verse beginning "And whoever practices the aggregates," the Tibetan reads "aggregates alike to elaboration," which sits oddly beside the following "free of conceptual elaboration"; a reading such as "aggregates free of elaboration" may be intended, but the text has been rendered as written. The humble verb translated "understand" (and once "seek") can mean either; it is chosen by context.
• The buddha-name rendered "Kings Gentle in the Self-Arisen Dharma" is uncertain: the Tibetan reads "rnam des," which may be a slip for "rnam nges," "certain," which would give "Kings Certain in the Self-Arisen Dharma."
• The line "In their own ground, its approaches not left empty" renders the obscure □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; □□□□□ may mean the approach or preliminary stage (sāmantaka), and the sense is uncertain. In the austerity verse, □□□□□□□□□ is read as "not like this," taking □□□□□ as a slip for □□□□□□. The number □□□□□□□□ is a very large numeral whose exact value varies between sources; "trillion" is approximate. "Limit of reality" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□ (bhūtakoṭi).
• The number □□□□□□□□ is a very large numeral of uncertain exact value; "eighty trillion" follows a common convention. The word □□□ in "undefiled and stainless" is obscure; it is taken here as a term for impurity or defect. Following the established name list, the class of gods is rendered "Vaśavartin class" (the heaven otherwise called Paranirmitavaśavartin), and their king □□□□□□□□□ is also rendered Vaśavartin.
• The verse line rendered "You of meaningful renown" is terse in the Tibetan and its exact sense is uncertain. In the list at the end the Tibetan repeats the word for "coming" in the pair "neither gone nor come"; it is rendered as it stands.
• In Brahmā's first verse the text reads □□□□□□□□□ ("empty beer vessel"), which makes little sense in a list of similes; it is translated as the evident reading □□□□□□□□□ "empty house," a standard simile for emptiness. In the earlier verse, the line rendered "they will become guides skilled in method, honored with supreme offerings" could also be read as "they will honor the Guide skilled in method with supreme offerings."
• The name of the future buddhas, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, is translated by meaning as "Possessor of the Power of Wisdom"; a Sanskrit form such as Jñānabala cannot be confirmed. The "one kind of suffering" is the suffering of formations, the all-pervasive suffering of conditioned existence, as distinct from the suffering of change and the suffering of suffering, which the following lines say will be absent. The word □□□□□ in "relieving the suffering of the world" is read in the sense of loosening or relieving.
• The term □□□□□ in the list of attributes of a is rare; it is rendered "deceptive" from context (paired with "not false, not true"), but the exact sense is uncertain. The "voice endowed with eight qualities" renders □□□□□□□□□□□, the traditional eight qualities of a buddha's or Brahmā's

voice.
• The verse line rendered "phenomena have no nature of reality" translates the Tibetan literally (phenomena are "without dharmatā"); the sense is presumably that not even the nature of reality exists as a real entity. In the closing stanza the line about the Sugata being "perfectly honored with the Dharma" leaves the agent unstated in the Tibetan; it may be read as the gods' offering of Dharma.
• "Eight qualities" refers to the eight-limbed voice of a buddha. The line "Rain down the nectar..." could also be read as "those who thirst will receive it." The final verses of praise after the gods' homage are not closed by a separate quotation marker in the Tibetan, so they are taken here as a continuation of the gods' words. The rendering "bringing beyond sorrow" reads the unusual phrase mya ngan bzlas as referring to nirvāṇa.
• "Mog gcod" in the execution clause is read as srog gcod, "to put to death," which fits the context and matches the later phrase "take my life in every way." Here dbang lnga means the five masteries or powers of a bodhisattva, not ritual empowerment. Several items in the list of tortures, such as "rolled up like a dried ball" and "heated like a warming pot," are obscure and are rendered literally.
• In the list "no sentient being, no life, no human, no nourisher, no person," □□□□□□ and □□□□□ are read as the standard renderings of manuja and poṣa in the usual list of synonyms for a self. The verses then run through the four immeasurables, the four applications of mindfulness, the bases of miraculous power, the five faculties, the five powers, the seven limbs of awakening, and the eightfold path ("twice four"), each affirmed conventionally and denied ultimately.
• The number □□□□□□□□, a very large numeral, is rendered "billions" throughout. The word □□□ in "dispel my doubt" is unusual and is read from context as removing or subduing doubt.
• "Eight hundred million" renders "eighty koṭis." The eleven kinds of eloquence (pratibhāna) are rendered by their plain sense; "apposite" for □□□□ (literally "near") is an interpretive choice. "Clear sensitivity" renders □□□□ (Skt. prasāda), the subtle sense-matter of the eye formed from the elements.
• "Empty fist" renders □□□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. riktamuṣṭi), the standard image of something that seems to hold something but holds nothing. The phrase □□□□□□ in the final sentence is taken as an abbreviated or slipped form of □□□□□□□□□, "is designated, but." The term rendered "without association" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is somewhat uncertain; it may also mean "without mixture" or "without familiarity."
• In the list of negations, the Tibetan reads "consciousness" where every parallel pair has a negated form ("not cognized, cannot be cognized"). It is translated as the evident negated reading, which is likely a scribal slip. The clause "the result of the path is not cessation" is translated as written. It apparently means that, with no afflictions to abandon, there is no cessation to serve as the path's result.
• The phrase rendered "it is so in mere name" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, where □□ is evidently a slip for a verb such as □□□□□ or □□□; the sense is unaffected.
• The sentence "there is no alteration in the dharmadhātu, and it is likewise impossible..." renders a terse construction (literally "there is no change in the dharmadhātu, and also there is"). It is taken here as linking the unchanging dharmadhātu to the certainty of those beings' awakening.
• The verses on the movements of the smile's light (circling swiftly or slowly, "pressing down," "a parasol with endless eyes") are terse and their referents somewhat obscure; they are rendered closely to the Tibetan. □□□ is taken as an imperative "quell, subdue" (doubts).
• The buddha name "Glory of the Disk of Sunlight" and the eon name "Golden Banner" are translated literally, since a Sanskrit form could not be identified with confidence. Most of the gods' names in the praise section are likewise given by meaning: Devoted to Generosity, Endowed with Splendor, Intelligence of the Elements, Mind Ornament, Swift Action, and the

others. The epithet rendered "you who hold all embodied beings" (gdos 'dzin) is uncertain. The verse of the god Intelligence of the Elements lists the four means of attracting disciples: giving, pleasant speech, beneficial conduct, and consistency.

• The names of the many gods (devaputras) in this sequence are Tibetan translations whose Sanskrit originals cannot be identified with confidence, so their meanings have been rendered in English. "Imperturbable" renders the same Tibetan word that elsewhere stands for Akṣobhya; here it names a god, not the buddha. The line rendered "Reversing their way" is terse; it may mean that the Buddha teaches in a manner contrary to ordinary worldly views.

• The names of the gods are descriptive and have been translated into English in keeping with the earlier pieces. Two names occur twice in this piece, "Delighting in Insight" and "Arisen from Insight". Each repeat is rendered the same way as its first occurrence. In the verse of Holding to Conscientiousness, "never grew weary" takes skyor as skyo ("to weary"). In the verse of Gone Forth through Insight, the last line is obscure; "no recollection of that attainment arises" is a tentative reading. The final verse continues into the next piece.

• The speakers are young gods whose names are formed from the themes of insight, emptiness and signlessness; no Sanskrit forms can be reconstructed with confidence, so their names are translated by meaning. Two speakers have nearly identical names (one with □□□□□, one with □□□□); they are distinguished as "Relying on Emptiness" and "Depending on Emptiness."

• The names of the gods' sons are descriptive Tibetan names that cannot be confidently identified with Sanskrit forms; they are translated by meaning. In the verse of Free of Attachment to the Body, "Buddha who expounds" renders rnam 'grel as written; it may be a slip for rnam grol, "fully liberated."

• The names of the many gods (devaputras) in this passage are descriptive Tibetan names whose Sanskrit originals cannot be confidently reconstructed, so they are translated by meaning. "Lord of Men" (mi dbang) is taken as an epithet of the Buddha. The last verse's "through a fearlessness in which nothing is attained" renders a terse line (thob med pas) that could also be read as "because they have attained fearlessness without attainment."

• The names of the gods who speak these verses are descriptive Tibetan renderings that cannot be confidently traced to established Sanskrit forms, so they are translated by meaning. The Tibetan word for "abode" also means "ground, possibility." In the verse on the possible and the impossible, which alludes to the first of the ten powers, it is rendered accordingly, and in the verses on karma it is rendered "basis." The final verse continues in the next piece.

• The names of the gods' sons are translated literally, as their Sanskrit originals cannot be identified with confidence. These verses track the ten powers of a tathāgata, especially the knowledge of karma's undertaking and ripening, the knowledge of the various elements, and the knowledge of the paths that lead everywhere. "Undertaking" renders □□□□□ in its sense of the undertaking of actions (samādāna) in that formula. The "three groups" are the three classes of beings: those fixed in wrongness, those fixed in rightness, and the undetermined. In the verse spoken by Fearless on the Path, the first line names only the group fixed in wrongness.

• The names of the many gods' sons are translated by meaning, as their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence. "Renounced through This Condition" alludes to idampratyayatā, the specific conditionality of dependent origination. In the verse of Delighting in the Faculties, the text reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; the second word is taken as a slip, and the line is read as affliction paired with purification. "Certain of the right" and "certain of the wrong" render the two fixed groups of beings, those destined for liberation and those fixed in wrongdoing.

• The names of the many gods' sons in this sequence are descriptive and cannot be identified with known Sanskrit forms; they are translated by meaning. "The six streams of existence" renders rgyud drug, here evidently the six destinies of rebirth, not tantra. The verse "In the

past you gave various gifts" is syntactically compressed and its construal is somewhat uncertain.
• The names of the gods' sons (devaputras) are descriptive Tibetan names that cannot be confidently traced to established Sanskrit forms, so they are translated by meaning. The first line completes a verse begun in the previous piece.
• The names of the many gods in this section are Tibetan renderings of Sanskrit names that cannot be reconstructed with confidence, so they are translated by meaning. The name read here as "Crossed Beyond the Swamp" is written with a syllable that makes no sense; it has been taken as the word for "swamp," which the same god's verse uses twice. In the verse of the god Skilled in Conceptualization, the word rendered "kinsfolk" is obscure in this list, and the rendering is literal. In the verse of the god Free of Craving, "having put an end to further existence" renders an unclear verb taken in that sense.
• The opening verse continues the speech of the god's son introduced at the end of the previous piece. The names of the gods' sons are translated by meaning because their Sanskrit originals cannot be identified with confidence. The verb written □□, as in "removed" or "eliminated", appears to mean "removed, exhausted." In the eighth verse, □□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□, "removed without remainder," which fits the parallel lines.
• The names of the many gods (devaputras) in this passage cannot be confidently matched to Sanskrit forms, so they are translated by meaning, following the convention already used for Pure Mind. In the verse of the god Knower of Virtue and Nonvirtue, the word rendered "takes up" literally means "examined" or "imputed"; the sense appears to be adopting or engaging with what is afflicted.
• The devaputra names are translated by meaning, as no Sanskrit forms can be identified with confidence. In the name rendered "Steadfast in Reality," the element □□□□ is uncertain (perhaps for □□□□□ or a related word), and the name in "Conjuring in Former Times" (□□□□□□□) is likewise uncertain. The opening verse belongs to the devaputra Dismantler of Perceptions, whose introduction ends the previous piece.
• The names of the many young gods are translated by meaning, since their Sanskrit originals cannot be identified with confidence. "Savior of the World" renders an epithet of the Buddha here, not the goddess Tārā. The term rendered "garland-bearing elephant riders" is uncertain; it seems to name one class of spirits, perhaps the Mālādhara attendants of the Four Great Kings. The vessel of sesame oil alludes to the image of carrying a full vessel of oil without spilling a drop, a picture of unbroken mindfulness.
• The phrase rendered "You have been ruined by those who are themselves ruined" renders a terse Tibetan expression, literally "consumed by the consumed." It most naturally means that the ascetics have been led to ruin by teachers who were themselves ruined.
• "Ford-maker" renders the term that elsewhere in this text designates non-Buddhists (tīrthikas). Here it is used in its root sense, tīrthakara, "one who makes a ford," as part of the Buddha's play on fords and ferrying across, so the literal sense has been kept. "The way out" renders a term that also means "emergence" or "deliverance" (probably niḥsaraṇa). The "embryo" is the earliest embryonic stage (kalala). Some vocal qualities in the list of signs ("must be puzzled out," "booming") are uncertain renderings, as is "overpowered by dogs," where the original may describe being seized or attacked by them.
• "Wanderers" renders □□□□□□□□□□ (parivrājaka), wandering ascetics who are being addressed. The world of Yama here designates the realm of pretas, or hungry ghosts. The asura trait □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "self-exalting, boastful." Some items in the lists, such as "desires distinction" for □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and "fond of going about" for □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, are tentative renderings of terse expressions.
• "Holding to be supreme" renders the Tibetan for clinging to one's own practice as the highest (Skt. parāmarśa, as in śīlavrataparāmarśa). "The world of Yama" is the realm of departed spirits

(pretas), to which miserliness leads.
• "Go forth to omniscience" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which can also be read as "definitively attain" or "emerge into" omniscience. The phrase "as he goes about there and follows it through with familiarization" interprets a terse Tibetan construction.
• "Sovereign over the whole collection of dharmas" reads the evident □□□□□□□ ("sovereignty") for the written □□□□□□□, which makes no sense here. In the verse on the fearlessnesses, □□□□□□□□□□□ is unclear; it is rendered as "the foes who challenged him," taking it as a slip for □□□□□□□□□□□□ ("opposing foes"). Cakradhara ("wheel-holder") most likely refers to Viṣṇu, and Īśvara to the creator god (Śiva).
• "Victorious over Foes" and "Destroyer of Pride" translate names of buddhas whose Sanskrit forms I could not identify with confidence. The line "grievous kinds of views" renders a phrase whose wording is unusual; the sense is that these beings had held harmful wrong views. In the closing verse, the abbreviated epithet is read as "the Victor who destroyed pride," describing the Buddha Śākyamuni as speaker.
• In the list of watery substances the text reads "dust" (rdul), which makes no sense there; it is evidently a slip for "sweat" (rngul), and is translated so. Several of the body parts in the earth list (stomach, pleura, mesentery, brain membrane) are standard but approximate identifications. Among the mountains, "Vajra Holders" and "Bare Peaks" translate names I could not confidently identify with a Sanskrit form.
• In the simile of the raindrops, the Tibetan reads "on the great" without a noun; this is taken as "on the great earth," assuming a dropped syllable for "earth." "Palm tree" renders the tāla tree used as a measure of height.
• □□□□□□□□ in the description of the internal space element is read as □□□□□□□□ "hollow," the reading found in the parallel phrase for the external space element; "upper torso" makes little sense in a list of cavities.
• "Dominant condition" and "object" render bdag po and dmigs pa (adhipati and ālambana). "Clear matter" renders dang ba (prasāda), the subtle translucent matter that constitutes the sense organs. "Impinge" renders thogs pa (pratigha), and "alighting" renders 'bab pa. Here mtshan ma is "sign" (nimitta), not the major marks of a great being.
• The addressee "Great King" is King Śuddhodana, the Buddha's father, as throughout this sūtra. In the passage on rebirth, the term usually meaning "empowerment" is rendered here as "governing condition" (adhipati), its Abhidharma sense of one of the conditions, since the text speaks of "two conditions." The phrase rendered "not over there" reads oddly in the Tibetan; it is taken as a variant of the word for "beyond, over there."
• In the first of the two parallel passages, the Tibetan reads "the final consciousness is empty of all consciousness," whereas the second passage has the expected "empty of the final consciousness." This may be a scribal variant, but it is translated as written.

The term rendered "force" (literally "power") in "the force of the final consciousness" is used here in its ordinary sense, not in the ritual sense of empowerment.
• In this passage the glossary words with several senses are used in their non-ritual senses. "Dominance" renders the term the glossary gives as "empowerment"; here it means the last consciousness acting as the dominant condition (adhipatipratyaya) for rebirth. "Mind-stream" renders the term the glossary gives as "tantra"; here it means the mental continuum (saṃtāna). The word the glossary gives as "mantra" appears here only inside the compound for "lamenting."
• In the first of the two parallel passages, the Tibetan reads "Karma, ripening, and the first consciousness are empty of the intrinsic nature of a first consciousness," compressing what the second passage spells out item by item; this has been translated as it stands.
• The text as transmitted reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "karmas are wasted," which

contradicts the point being made, that karma still bears fruit. The Sanskrit of this passage, as quoted in the Śikṣāsamuccaya, has "karma is not lost" (karmaṇām avipraṇāśaḥ). The translation follows that sense, taking the Tibetan as a slip for □□□□□□□□.

• In the phrase "the final consciousness as the dominant condition," the Tibetan □□□ is not "empowerment." Here it means dominance or governing power, the dominant condition (adhipatipratyaya) of Abhidharma, paired with karma as the object condition. The doubled □□□□□□□ is read as a simple repetition, "one who has slept and woken."

• The three bitter seeds are plant names: the bitter gourd, kośātakī (a bitter luffa-like gourd), and picumarda, the neem tree. In the second example "neem" renders a spelling with an initial p instead of b; these are the same word. "Of corresponding share" and "of corresponding kind" render the Tibetan for Sanskrit sabhāga.

• The king addressed throughout is the Buddha's father, King Śuddhodana, who is not named in this piece. Here □□□ is rendered "dominant influence" (the dominant condition, adhipati) rather than the glossary's ritual sense "empowerment," which does not fit this context. The phrase "the most beautiful woman in the land" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. janapadakalyāṇī).

• "Fascicle" renders the Tibetan division marker bampo, which falls mid-discourse here. "Wishlessness" renders the third door of liberation (apraṇihita).

• In the first occurrence of the formula, the Tibetan lists the realms of rebirth without stating the verb "arises"; the parallel later passage supplies it, and the translation adds it in both places. The phrase "does not abide supported in the east, and so on" abbreviates the standard list of the directions.

• Here □□□□□□□□ is not the name Īśvara but the common noun "sovereignty, lordship" (aiśvarya), since the Buddha is warning the king against attachment to royal power; it is translated accordingly. The king's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Anantayaśas ("Boundless Fame"); Anantakīrti is an equally possible Sanskrit form.

• The name of the capital, rendered literally as "Adorned with Jewels," likely reflects a Sanskrit form such as Ratnālaṃkṛtā, but this could not be confirmed, so the meaning is translated. Among the seven precious substances, "agate" and "emerald" render the traditional equivalents of Tibetan spug (musāragalva) and rdo'i snying po (aśmagarbha), whose exact mineral identities are debated.

• The king's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Anantayaśas ("Boundless Fame"), the standard Sanskrit equivalent; this is the figure known elsewhere in the Māndhātṛ type of story. Several flower names (□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□) are transliterated as spelled since they cannot be confidently identified. □□□□□□□ here means "all around" rather than the Cakravāla mountain range.

• The names Nandaka (□□□□□□□□) and Bhūdeva (□□□□□□) are probable reconstructions; the father's name □□□□□□□, spelled once as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), could not be identified with confidence and is translated as "Earth-Arising." The city name "Jewel-Adorned" and the park name "Jewel Casket" are translated from the Tibetan.

• The king's name □□□□□□ is rendered Bhūdeva; the Sanskrit is a reconstruction ("God of the Earth") and may correspond to Pṛthivīdeva in other sources. The father's name □□□□□□□□ in the preceding context is likewise uncertain. The term □□□□ among the seven jewels is rendered by its Mahāvyutpatti equivalent musāragalva, a stone variously identified as agate or cat's eye. Following the context, the three remaining "illnesses" are taken as desire, hunger (literally "not eating food"), and old age.

• The king's name □□□□□□ has been rendered Bhūdeva, a literal Sanskrit equivalent of "Earth God"; the Sanskrit original of this name is not securely attested and should be harmonized with the form used in earlier pieces. The city name □□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with a known Sanskrit name and is translated by meaning as "Happy Abode." The clause about splendor is somewhat terse; it is taken to mean that, coming from divine splendor, the king

could not bear the human condition and therefore sank into the earth.
• The city name rendered literally "Unassailable" is taken as Ayodhyā, of which the Tibetan is a standard rendering. The three palace names (Moonrise, Essence of Beryl, Lofty Sunbeams) are translated from their meanings, as their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence.
• The city name "Unassailable" renders □□□□□□□□□ literally; it may stand for an Indian name (possibly Ayodhyā, "the unconquerable"), but this cannot be confirmed. In "held sway over half the kingdom" the text reads □□□□, which is taken as a slip for □□□□ "half," matching the preceding sentence. In the verses, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□ "enjoyed," as in the parallel line earlier.
• □□□□□□□ ("rim, felly") is taken as King Nemi, the king whom Mātali brings to the Heaven of the Thirty-Three in the parallel story. □□□□□□□ (and □□□□ in the verse) is the standard Tibetan rendering of Māndhātā. The large number □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□